# The Wilson Loop Functions on Two Orientations of the Lattice

**Abstract**

The limits of the renormalised Wilson loop expectations constructed in the paper are covariant under the symmetries of the lattice, and nothing is known about the rotations which are not among them. The smallest instance in which the invariance under such a rotation is a statement about the limits is that of two parallel planar loops whose separation $(5, 0)$ is turned into $(3, 4)$. On a torus whose periods are tilted against the lattice, the reflection which exchanges the two configurations maps the lattice to a second lattice, and we show that the invariance is equivalent to the independence of the limit of the choice between these two lattices. If the blocking factor is a multiple of 5, the construction of the paper can be compared with a run of the renormalisation group which has the same lattices, cubes, and expansions and differs from it in one respect: its fine lattice is turned. We record, in the order of the proofs, the modifications which Bałaban's proofs require for this run. The present text contains the setting, the symmetries which the run retains, its averaging operations with their momentum representation, and the description of its blocks as unions of cells with a Poincaré inequality. It then goes through the seven papers on the propagators, the averaging operations, and the background fields: the two papers on the propagators of the Gaussian theory and the paper on the scalar Green's functions, for which the bounds in $L^2$, in the supremum norm, and in Hölder norms, with exponential decay, are proved for the turned lattice on the whole lattice, on tori, for sequences of domains, and with Dirichlet conditions; and the papers on the averaging operations, on the propagators in a background field, on the spaces of regular configurations, and on the variational problem, for which the statements in which the turned lattice enters anew are proved and the remaining ones are traced to these. One of Bałaban's methods, the passage to a box with Neumann conditions by reflections, is not available for a turned lattice, and it is replaced by operators without a boundary. The equality itself is not proved. The last section states which proofs are written out, which are reduced to Bałaban's by named substitutions, and what has not been examined: the papers on the renormalisation transformations, the flow of the coupling, for which the symmetries of the tilted run leave three quadratic forms of the field strength where those of one lattice leave one, and the comparison of the two runs.

## 1 Introduction

The paper constructs, for every ensemble $\mathcal{C}$ of admissible loops on the torus $(\mathbb{R}/T\mathbb{Z})^4$, the limit $W(\mathcal{C})$ of the renormalised expectations $W_K(\mathcal{C})$ as the lattice spacing $\varepsilon_K = uL^{-K}$ tends to zero (Paper, Theorem 1.5), and it shows that the limits are covariant under the translations by vectors of the lattice of the loops and under the reflections in coordinate hyperplanes (Paper, Corollary 1.6). One expects more. The lattice breaks the invariance of the continuum theory under rotations, and the limit in which the lattice is removed should restore it, as far as the torus permits. We ask whether this can be proved for the limits of the paper.

For most ensembles the question cannot be posed within the construction: a rotation which is not a symmetry of the lattice maps a path of the lattice to a path which is not one,

and the limits are defined for paths of the lattice only. There is one family of ensembles for which it can. Let the loops lie in planes parallel to $e_0$ and $e_1$, and let the rotation turn the plane of $e_2$ and $e_3$ and fix the other two coordinates. It then maps each loop to a translate of itself, and it maps the ensemble to an ensemble of the lattice whenever it maps the positions of the planes to points of the lattice. This happens for rotations which are not symmetries of the lattice, because a circle around a point of the square lattice may pass through points which the symmetries of the lattice do not relate: $5^2 = 3^2 + 4^2$. The smallest instance is a loop $C$ with a parallel copy, and the question is whether

$$W(C, C + 5\varepsilon_q e_2) = W(C, C + 3\varepsilon_q e_2 + 4\varepsilon_q e_3) \,, \tag{1.1}$$

where $\varepsilon_q$ is the spacing of the lattice of the loops. The two sides are two numbers of one lattice theory, and none of the properties which we know relates them. Nor could these properties relate them: the kernel $(d_2, d_3) \mapsto e^{-|d_2|-|d_3|}$ is continuous, it is invariant under the symmetries of the square lattice, and it is reflection positive in both coordinate directions, since $e^{-(x_2+y_2)}$ is a product and $e^{-|x_3-y_3|}$ is a positive definite kernel, and it takes different values at $(5, 0)$ and $(3, 4)$.

The first difficulty is the torus. The rotation which turns $(5, 0)$ into $(3, 4)$ is not an isometry of $(\mathbb{R}/T\mathbb{Z})^4$, and on this torus the two configurations are not congruent, so that there is no reason for (1.1) to hold there. We therefore change the torus. Writing $z = x_2 + ix_3$, the reflection $\rho\colon z \mapsto \frac{3+4i}{5}\bar{z}$ of the plane maps 5 to $3+4i$, and it is an isometry of the torus whose periods in this plane are $T(2 + i)$ and $iT(2 + i)$, a torus which the lattices of the paper fit as well. On this torus $\rho$ maps the lattice $\Lambda_K$ of spacing $\varepsilon_K$ to a second lattice $\Lambda'_K = \rho\Lambda_K$, tilted against the first, and it maps the lattice theory on the one to the lattice theory on the other. The expectation of the configuration $(5, 0)$ on $\Lambda_K$ is therefore equal to the expectation of the configuration $(3, 4)$ on $\Lambda'_K$, at every $K$ and every coupling (Proposition 4.2). The configuration $(3, 4)$ consists of paths of both lattices, and (1.1) becomes the statement that the limit of its renormalised expectations is the same along the two families of lattices: the independence of the continuum limit of the orientation of the lattice, in the one case in which the two orientations share an observable.

A comparison of two lattice theories is what the paper does when it proves that the limit exists. It compares the construction on $\Lambda_K$ with that on $\Lambda_{K+1}$, two runs of the renormalisation group which share every lattice but the finest (Paper, Section 9.1). The lattices $\Lambda_K$ and $\Lambda'_K$ share nothing, but if the blocking factor $L$ is a multiple of 5, then $\Lambda_K$ is a sublattice of $\Lambda'_{K+1}$ (Lemma 2.2). A run which starts from the lattice theory on the tilted lattice $\Lambda'_{K+1}$ and passes, by one renormalisation step, to the lattice $\Lambda_K$ of the paper, and from there to $\Lambda_{K-1}, \Lambda_{K-2}, \ldots$, shares every lattice but the finest with the construction of the paper on $\Lambda_K$. Its coarse lattices, its cubes, its localisations, and its expansions are those of the paper. What differs is the fine lattice, on which every background field and every propagator of the run is defined: it is turned by $\rho$ against everything else.

The proofs of Bałaban on which the paper rests are written for a fine lattice of which the coarser lattices are sublattices spanned by multiples of the same basis. Our aim is to record what changes in them when the fine lattice is turned, and only that: each statement which is used is assigned to one of three classes, those which hold with the same proof, those which hold after a modification, which we state and prove, and those which we have not examined. We proceed in the order of the proofs. Sections 2–4 contain the setting: the arithmetic of the two lattices, the torus, and the identity between the expectations which reduces (1.1) to a comparison of two runs. Section 5 determines the symmetries which the tilted run retains; they leave three invariant quadratic forms of the field strength where the symmetries of one lattice leave one, which affects the definition of the running coupling.

Section 6 defines the averaging operations of the tilted run and proves the properties which replace those of [2, Sections A and B], and Section 7 gives their momentum representation, in which the turned lattice appears as one fixed trigonometric polynomial multiplying Bałaban's symbols and as a matrix in place of a scalar. Section 8 describes a block as a union of cells of $5^4$ points, which gives contours inside the blocks and a Poincaré inequality, and Section 9 proves the $L^2$-bounds of [2] for the tilted run by counting paths. Section 10 goes through [2] formula by formula and Section 11 through the first two sections of [1]. Sections 12–14 then prove the bounds on the scalar operator of the whole lattice which these two papers use, the kernel with its exponential decay, the equation which relates the scales, and the bounds in the supremum and Hölder norms; Section 15 bounds the kernel of the gauge-fixing projection, and Section 16 proves Bałaban's Proposition 1.2 on the propagator of the vector field. Section 17 completes the first paper: the inverse of $Q_k G Q_k^*$, which is $\Delta_k + a$, the minimiser $H_k$ with its bounds, the second derivatives in $L^2$, and the commutators of the averages with functions, whose values do not depend on the contours. Section 18 begins the second paper on the propagators: it replaces the local inverses on boxes with Neumann conditions, from which Bałaban's expansion of the scalar operator of a sequence of domains starts, by operators of two neighbouring scales on the whole lattice, and Section 19 proves Bałaban's lemma on the distance in which the decay of these operators is measured, for contours which run along the turned directions in the region of the finest scale. Section 20 then carries out Section B of that paper for the tilted run: Bałaban's Proposition 2.2 on the scalar operator of a sequence of domains, and his Proposition 2.3 on the inverse of $Q' G'^2 Q'^*$, with the bound on the kernel of the gauge-fixing projection of the sequence. Section 21 prepares Section C of that paper: it treats the operators $H'_j$ and $\Delta'_j$ of the gauge functions which relate the gauge conditions of two neighbouring scales, with their kernels and the covariance of the corresponding Gaussian integral, and Section 22 proves, for the blocks of the turned lattice, the inequality which bounds a field in the axial gauge by its curl. Section 23 proves Bałaban's representation of the propagator of two neighbouring scales, by minimising quadratic forms in the place of his transformations of Gaussian integrals, and his Proposition 2.5; Section 24 completes the second paper on the propagators with the propagator of a sequence of domains, the inverse of its averages, and the minimiser, his Propositions 2.6 and 2.7 and Corollary 2.8. Section 25 treats the operators with Dirichlet conditions outside a neighbourhood of the first domain, which the later papers use: since the averages are the identity in the region of the finest scale, these operators are given by those of the whole lattice through exact formulae. Section 26 turns to the fields with values in the group: it defines the average of the first step of the tilted run, proves the bounds on its plaquettes, and goes through the paper on the averaging operations. Sections 27, 28, and 29 go through the papers on the propagators in a background field, on the spaces of regular configurations, and on the variational problem. In these the turned lattice enters through the earlier sections and through three statements which we prove: further bounds on the scalar operator of a sequence at the trivial background, Bałaban's lemma on a configuration in the axial gauge of one step, and the construction of a regular configuration with given averages from which the induction on the number of the levels starts. Section 30 takes up the one place at which the first paper on the renormalisation transformations uses the symmetries of the lattice, the analysis of the vacuum polarisation: under the symmetries of the tilted run its part of the second order has three coefficients, one for each class of planes, while the corresponding part of the action has one. Section 31 says with what degree of detail each paper has been treated and lists what remains; the first item which is not a modification of an argument of Bałaban is a bound on the differences of these three coefficients.

Throughout, $G$, $L$, $u$, $m_T$, $T = 2L^{m_T} u$, and $\varepsilon_K = u L^{-K}$ are as in Paper, Section 1.1; in particular $L$ is odd.

## 2 The Two Lattices

We identify the plane of the coordinates $x_2$ and $x_3$ with $\mathbb{C}$ through $z = x_2 + ix_3$, and we write a point of $\mathbb{R}^4$ as $(x_0, x_1, z)$. The points of this plane with integer coordinates are the Gaussian integers $\mathbb{Z}[i] = \mathbb{Z} + i\mathbb{Z}$. We put

$$\omega := \frac{3+4i}{5} = \frac{(2+i)^2}{5} = \frac{2+i}{2-i}\,, \qquad \rho(x_0, x_1, z) := (x_0, x_1, \omega\bar{z})\,. \tag{2.1}$$

Since $|\omega| = 1$ and $\omega\,\overline{\omega\bar{z}} = z$, the map $\rho$ is a linear isometry of $\mathbb{R}^4$ with $\rho^2 = 1$. It fixes $e_0$ and $e_1$, it fixes $2 + i$ because $\omega(2 - i) = 2 + i$, and it maps $i(2 + i)$ to $\omega(-i)(2 - i) = -i(2 + i)$; it is therefore the reflection in the hyperplane spanned by $e_0$, $e_1$, and $2e_2 + e_3$. We write $e'_\nu := \rho e_\nu$, so that $e'_0 = e_0$, $e'_1 = e_1$, and, because $\omega\bar{1} = \omega$ and $\omega\bar{i} = (4 - 3i)/5$,

$$e'_2 = \tfrac{1}{5}(3e_2 + 4e_3)\,, \quad e'_3 = \tfrac{1}{5}(4e_2 - 3e_3)\,, \qquad e_2 = \tfrac{1}{5}(3e'_2 + 4e'_3)\,, \quad e_3 = \tfrac{1}{5}(4e'_2 - 3e'_3)\,, \tag{2.2}$$

the last two by applying $\rho$ to the first two. In particular $\rho(5e_2) = 3e_2 + 4e_3$.

**Lemma 2.1** (Gaussian Integers). *(i) For $w \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$, $\omega w \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ if and only if $w \in (2-i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$. Consequently $\mathbb{Z}[i] \cap \omega\mathbb{Z}[i] = (2 + i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$.*

*(ii) The group $(2 + i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$ has the index 5 in $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ and in $\omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$.*

*(iii) $\omega\,\overline{(2 + i)\mathbb{Z}[i]} = (2 + i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$.*

*(iv) $5\omega\mathbb{Z}[i] \subset \mathbb{Z}[i]$ and $5\mathbb{Z}[i] \subset \omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$, each with the index 25.*

*Proof.* (i) Let $w = a+bi$ with integers $a$, $b$. Then $5\omega w = (3a-4b)+(4a+3b)i$, and $\omega w \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ if and only if $3a \equiv 4b$ and $4a \equiv -3b$ modulo 5. Multiplying the first congruence by 2 and the second by 4, each of them is equivalent to $a \equiv 3b$, that is, to $a + 2b \equiv 0$ modulo 5. On the other hand $(2 - i)(m + ni) = (2m + n) + (2n - m)i$, for which $a + 2b = 5n$; and if $a + 2b = 5n$, then $m := 2n - b$ satisfies $2m + n = 5n - 2b = a$, so that $w = (2 - i)(m + ni)$. This is the first assertion. For such $w = (2 - i)w'$ we have $\omega w = (2 + i)w'$, so that the elements of $\omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$ which lie in $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ are those of $(2 + i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$.

(ii) The multiplication by $2+i$ is the linear map of $\mathbb{Z}^2$ with the columns $(2, 1)$ and $(-1, 2)$, of determinant 5, so that its image has the index 5 in $\mathbb{Z}[i]$. The multiplication by $\omega^{-1}$ maps $\omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$ onto $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ and $(2 + i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$ onto $(2 - i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$, which has the index 5 in $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ for the same reason.

(iii) Complex conjugation maps $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ onto itself, so that $\omega\,\overline{(2 + i)\mathbb{Z}[i]} = \omega(2 - i)\mathbb{Z}[i] = (2 + i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$.

(iv) $5\omega = 3 + 4i \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ gives the first inclusion, and the multiplication by $3 + 4i$ has the determinant 25. Since $\omega\bar{\omega} = 1$ and $5\bar{\omega} = 3 - 4i \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$, we have $5\mathbb{Z}[i] = \omega(5\bar{\omega})\mathbb{Z}[i] \subset \omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$, with the index of $(3 - 4i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$ in $\mathbb{Z}[i]$, which is 25. *q.e.d.*

For an integer $K \geq 0$ we consider the two lattices in $\mathbb{R}^4$

$$\Lambda_K := \varepsilon_K\mathbb{Z}^4 = \varepsilon_K(\mathbb{Z}^2 \times \mathbb{Z}[i])\,, \qquad \Lambda'_K := \rho\Lambda_K = \varepsilon_K(\mathbb{Z}^2 \times \omega\mathbb{Z}[i])\,. \tag{2.3}$$

The lattice $\Lambda_K$ is the lattice of the paper before the periods are divided out, and $\Lambda'_K$ is a lattice of the same spacing whose axes are the vectors $e'_\nu$.

**Lemma 2.2** (The Two Families of Lattices). *(i)* $\Lambda_K \cap \Lambda'_K = \varepsilon_K(\mathbb{Z}^2 \times (2+i)\mathbb{Z}[i])$, *a sublattice of the index* 5 *in* $\Lambda_K$ *and in* $\Lambda'_K$, *and* $\rho$ *maps it onto itself.*

*(ii) If* $L$ *is a multiple of* 5, *then* $\Lambda_K \subset \Lambda'_{K+1}$ *and* $\Lambda'_K \subset \Lambda_{K+1}$, *each with the index* $L^4$.

*Proof.* (i) is Lemma 2.1(i)–(iii). (ii) Since $\varepsilon_K = L\varepsilon_{K+1}$ and $L\mathbb{Z}[i] \subset 5\mathbb{Z}[i] \subset \omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$ by Lemma 2.1(iv), the definition (2.3) gives $\Lambda_K = \varepsilon_{K+1}(L\mathbb{Z}^2 \times L\mathbb{Z}[i]) \subset \Lambda'_{K+1}$. Both are lattices of rank four, and $\rho$ preserves volumes, so that the index is the quotient $\varepsilon_K^4/\varepsilon_{K+1}^4 = L^4$ of the volumes of their cells. Applying $\rho$ gives $\Lambda'_K \subset \Lambda_{K+1}$ with the same index. *q.e.d.*

Thus, for $L$ a multiple of 5, the two families form one chain $\cdots \supset \Lambda'_{K+1} \supset \Lambda_K \supset \Lambda'_{K-1} \supset \Lambda_{K-2} \supset \ldots$, each lattice of the index $L^4$ in the one before, while no lattice of one family contains a lattice of the same index of the other.

## 3 One Torus for Both Lattices

The torus $(\mathbb{R}/T\mathbb{Z})^4$ of the paper is of no use for our question: $\rho(Te_2) = \frac{1}{5}T(3e_2 + 4e_3)$ is not a period, so that $\rho$ does not act on it. We need a group of periods which $\rho$ preserves and which lies in both lattices, and Lemma 2.2(i) provides one.

**Definition 3.1** (The Tilted Torus). Let

$$\Gamma := T(\mathbb{Z}^2 \times (2+i)\mathbb{Z}[i]) \,, \qquad \mathbb{T}_\Gamma := \mathbb{R}^4/\Gamma \,. \tag{3.1}$$

The periods of $\mathbb{T}_\Gamma$ are $Te_0$, $Te_1$, and the two vectors $T(2e_2 + e_3)$ and $T(-e_2 + 2e_3)$ of the plane, which are orthogonal and of the length $\sqrt{5}\,T$.

**Lemma 3.2** (The Torus and the Lattices). *(i)* $\Gamma \subset \Lambda_K \cap \Lambda'_K$ *for every* $K \geq 0$, *and the quotients* $\Lambda_K/\Gamma$ *and* $\Lambda'_K/\Gamma$ *have* $5(T/\varepsilon_K)^4$ *elements each.*

*(ii)* $\rho\Gamma = \Gamma$, *so that* $\rho$ *induces an isometry of* $\mathbb{T}_\Gamma$, *which maps* $\Lambda_K/\Gamma$ *onto* $\Lambda'_K/\Gamma$.

*(iii)* $\Gamma$ *has the index* 5 *in* $T\mathbb{Z}^4$, *so that* $\mathbb{T}_\Gamma$ *covers the torus of the paper five times.*

*Proof.* (i) The number $T/\varepsilon_K = 2L^{m_T+K}$ is an integer, so that $\Gamma \subset \varepsilon_K(\mathbb{Z}^2 \times (2+i)\mathbb{Z}[i])$, which is $\Lambda_K \cap \Lambda'_K$ by Lemma 2.2(i). The index of $\Gamma$ in this group is $(T/\varepsilon_K)^4$, and the index of this group in each of the two lattices is 5. (ii) is Lemma 2.1(iii), and $\rho\Lambda_K = \Lambda'_K$ by definition. (iii) is Lemma 2.1(ii). *q.e.d.*

## 4 The Identity between the Two Lattice Theories

We now define the lattice theory on $\mathbb{T}_\Gamma$ for each of the two lattices and show that $\rho$ carries the one to the other. Let $\Xi$ be $\Lambda_K$ or $\Lambda'_K$. A *bond* of $\Xi$ is an ordered pair $b = (x, y)$ of points of $\Xi$ at the distance $\varepsilon_K$, with the reversed bond $b^{-1} = (y, x)$; the bonds from $x$ are the eight pairs $(x, x \pm \varepsilon_K e_\mu)$ for $\Xi = \Lambda_K$ and $(x, x \pm \varepsilon_K e'_\mu)$ for $\Xi = \Lambda'_K$. A *plaquette* of $\Xi$ is a square of side $\varepsilon_K$ with corners in $\Xi$, and $\partial p$ is its boundary, a closed path of four bonds. The group $\Gamma \subset \Xi$ acts on the bonds and on the plaquettes by translations, and a translation by $\gamma \neq 0$ fixes no bond and no plaquette and reverses no bond. A *gauge field* on $(\Xi, \Gamma)$ is a map $U$

from the bonds of $\Xi$ to $G$ with $U(b^{-1}) = U(b)^{-1}$ and $U(b+\gamma) = U(b)$ for every $\gamma \in \Gamma$. The lattice theory at the coupling $g_0 > 0$ is the probability measure

$$\mathrm{d}\mu^{\Xi}_{\Gamma,g_0}(U) \coloneqq \frac{1}{Z^{\Xi}_{\Gamma,g_0}} \exp\Big(-\frac{1}{g_0^2}\sum_p (1 - \operatorname{Re}\operatorname{tr} U(\partial p))\Big)\,\mathrm{d}U\ , \tag{4.1}$$

where the sum runs over one plaquette from each orbit of $\Gamma$ on the unoriented plaquettes of $\Xi$ and $\mathrm{d}U$ is the product of the normalised Haar measures over one bond from each orbit of $\Gamma$ on the unoriented bonds. Neither depends on the choices, because $U$ is periodic, $\operatorname{Re}\operatorname{tr}$ is invariant under conjugation and, on unitary matrices, under inversion, and the Haar measure is invariant under inversion. This is the measure of Paper, (1.2), with the group of periods $\Gamma$ in place of $T\mathbb{Z}^4$ and, for $\Xi = \Lambda'_K$, with the lattice turned by $\rho$. We write $\mathbb{E}^{\Xi}_{\Gamma,g_0}$ for its expectation. For a closed path $C$ of bonds of $\Xi$ in $\mathbb{R}^4$ and a character $\chi$ we put $W_\chi(C;U) \coloneqq \chi(U(C))$, where $U(C)$ is the ordered product of $U$ over the bonds of $C$, and for a finite family $\mathcal{C} = ((C_1,\chi_1),\dots,(C_n,\chi_n))$ of such paths with characters, $W_{\mathcal{C}} \coloneqq \prod_i W_{\chi_i}(C_i)$. For a linear map $O$ we write $O\mathcal{C}$ for the family of the images $OC_i$ with the same characters.

**Lemma 4.1** (Transport)**.** *Let $\Xi$ be $\Lambda_K$ or $\Lambda'_K$, and let $O$ be a linear isometry of $\mathbb{R}^4$ with $O\Gamma = \Gamma$ for which $O\Xi$ is again one of the two lattices. Then, for every family $\mathcal{C}$ of closed paths of bonds of $\Xi$ with characters and every $g_0 > 0$,*

$$\mathbb{E}^{O\Xi}_{\Gamma,g_0}[W_{O\mathcal{C}}] = \mathbb{E}^{\Xi}_{\Gamma,g_0}[W_{\mathcal{C}}]\ . \tag{4.2}$$

*Proof.* The map $O$ is a bijection from the points of $\Xi$ onto those of $O\Xi$ which preserves distances, so that it maps bonds to bonds, reversed bonds to reversed bonds, and plaquettes to plaquettes with their boundaries; and since $O(b+\gamma) = Ob + O\gamma$ with $O\Gamma = \Gamma$, it maps the orbits of $\Gamma$ on the bonds and on the plaquettes of $\Xi$ bijectively onto those of $O\Xi$. For a gauge field $U$ on $(\Xi,\Gamma)$ put $(O_*U)(b) \coloneqq U(O^{-1}b)$ for the bonds $b$ of $O\Xi$. Then $O_*U$ is a gauge field on $(O\Xi,\Gamma)$, the map $O_*$ is a bijection between the two spaces of gauge fields which carries the product of the Haar measures of the one to that of the other, and $(O_*U)(O\gamma) = U(\gamma)$ for every path $\gamma$ of bonds of $\Xi$. In particular $(O_*U)(\partial(Op)) = U(\partial p)$ for every plaquette $p$ of $\Xi$, so that the sums in (4.1) for $O_*U$ on $O\Xi$ and for $U$ on $\Xi$ agree, and $O_*$ carries $\mu^{\Xi}_{\Gamma,g_0}$ to $\mu^{O\Xi}_{\Gamma,g_0}$. Since $W_{O\mathcal{C}}(O_*U) = W_{\mathcal{C}}(U)$, this gives (4.2). *q.e.d.*

We apply the lemma to $O = \rho$ and to the ensembles for which the question of the introduction can be posed. Let $q \geq 0$, and let $C_1,\dots,C_n$ be closed paths of bonds of $\Lambda_q$ in the plane $\{z=0\}$, so that all their bonds are parallel to $e_0$ or $e_1$. For $d = (d_1,\dots,d_n)$ with $d_j \in \varepsilon_q\mathbb{Z}[i]$ we write

$$\mathcal{C}_d \coloneqq ((C_1+d_1,\chi_1),\dots,(C_n+d_n,\chi_n))\ , \qquad \rho d \coloneqq (\omega\bar{d}_1,\dots,\omega\bar{d}_n)\ , \tag{4.3}$$

where $C_j + d_j$ is the translate of $C_j$ to the plane $\{z = d_j\}$. Since $\rho$ fixes the plane $\{z=0\}$ pointwise and is linear, $\rho(C_j + d_j) = C_j + \omega\bar{d}_j$, that is, $\rho\mathcal{C}_d = \mathcal{C}_{\rho d}$.

**Proposition 4.2** (Reduction)**.** *Let $q \geq 0$, let $C_1,\dots,C_n$ and $\mathcal{C}_d$ be as above, and let $d_j \in \varepsilon_q(2+i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$ for every $j$. Then $\rho d_j \in \varepsilon_q(2+i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$ for every $j$, the families $\mathcal{C}_d$ and $\mathcal{C}_{\rho d}$ consist of closed paths of bonds of both $\Lambda_K$ and $\Lambda'_K$ for every $K \geq q$, and for every $K \geq q$ and every $g_0 > 0$,*

$$\mathbb{E}^{\Lambda_K}_{\Gamma,g_0}[W_{\mathcal{C}_d}] = \mathbb{E}^{\Lambda'_K}_{\Gamma,g_0}[W_{\mathcal{C}_{\rho d}}]\ . \tag{4.4}$$

*Consequently*

$$\mathbb{E}^{\Lambda_K}_{\Gamma,g_0}[W_{\mathcal{C}_{\rho d}}] - \mathbb{E}^{\Lambda_K}_{\Gamma,g_0}[W_{\mathcal{C}_d}] = \mathbb{E}^{\Lambda_K}_{\Gamma,g_0}[W_{\mathcal{C}_{\rho d}}] - \mathbb{E}^{\Lambda'_K}_{\Gamma,g_0}[W_{\mathcal{C}_{\rho d}}]\ . \tag{4.5}$$

*Proof.* By Lemma 2.1(iii), $\rho d_j = \omega \bar{d}_j \in \varepsilon_q(2+i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$. The sites of $C_j + d_j$ are the points $(x_0, x_1, d_j)$ with $(x_0, x_1, 0)$ a site of $C_j$; they lie in $\varepsilon_q(\mathbb{Z}^2 \times (2+i)\mathbb{Z}[i]) = \Lambda_q \cap \Lambda'_q$, and the bonds of $C_j + d_j$ are parallel to $e_0 = e'_0$ or $e_1 = e'_1$ and of the length $\varepsilon_q$. A straight path of the length $\varepsilon_q$ between two points of $\Lambda_q$, or of $\Lambda'_q$, along one of its axes is a path of $L^{K-q}$ bonds of $\Lambda_K$, or of $\Lambda'_K$; so $C_j + d_j$ is a closed path of bonds of both lattices, and the same holds for $C_j + \rho d_j$. Lemma 4.1 with $\Xi = \Lambda_K$ and $O = \rho$, for which $O\Gamma = \Gamma$ by Lemma 3.2(ii) and $O\Xi = \Lambda'_K$, gives (4.4) because $\rho \mathcal{C}_d = \mathcal{C}_{\rho d}$, and (4.5) follows by subtracting both sides of (4.4) from $\mathbb{E}^{\Lambda_K}_{\Gamma, g_0}[W_{\mathcal{C}_{\rho d}}]$. *q.e.d.*

The left side of (4.5) measures how far the lattice theory on $\Lambda_K$ is from being invariant under $\rho$ on this ensemble, and the right side how much the expectation of one ensemble differs between the two lattices. The first instance in which $\mathcal{C}_{\rho d}$ is not the image of $\mathcal{C}_d$ under a symmetry of $\Lambda_q$ is $n = 2$, $d_1 = 0$, and $d_2 = 5\varepsilon_q = (2+i)(2-i)\varepsilon_q$, for which $\rho d_2 = (3+4i)\varepsilon_q$; this is (1.1). The step factors of the paper do not depend on the position of a loop (Paper, Proposition 7.13), so that $C_j + d_j$ and $C_j + \rho d_j$ have the same normalisation on $\Lambda_K$, and (1.1) is the statement that the left side of (4.5), divided by this normalisation, tends to zero as $K \to \infty$ along the couplings of the paper. On the right side, the first term is the object of the construction of the paper on $\Lambda_K$, carried out on the torus $\mathbb{T}_\Gamma$, and the second, read at $K+1$, is the object of the tilted run of the introduction.

## 5 The Symmetries of the Tilted Run

The tilted run has only those symmetries which preserve the lattices of both families. We determine them, and what they leave of the argument by which a single coupling describes the leading term of an effective action.

**Lemma 5.1** (The Common Symmetries)**.** *Let $\mathfrak{G}_0$ be the group of the linear isometries $O$ of $\mathbb{R}^4$ with $O\mathbb{Z}^4 = \mathbb{Z}^4$ and $O\rho\mathbb{Z}^4 = \rho\mathbb{Z}^4$. Its elements are the maps*

$$(x_0, x_1, z) \mapsto (A(x_0, x_1), i^k z)\ , \tag{5.1}$$

*with $A$ one of the eight signed permutation matrices of the first two coordinates and $k \in \{0,1,2,3\}$. It has 32 elements, it contains the reflections in the hyperplanes $\{x_0 = 0\}$ and $\{x_1 = 0\}$, and it contains no reflection of the plane of $x_2$ and $x_3$.*

*Proof.* An isometry $O$ with $O\mathbb{Z}^4 = \mathbb{Z}^4$ permutes the eight vectors $\pm e_\mu$, the elements of $\mathbb{Z}^4$ of the length 1, and an isometry with $O\rho\mathbb{Z}^4 = \rho\mathbb{Z}^4$ permutes the eight vectors $\pm e'_\nu$. By (2.2) the only vectors common to the two sets are $\pm e_0$ and $\pm e_1$. An element $O$ of $\mathfrak{G}_0$ permutes both sets, hence their intersection, so that $Oe_0, Oe_1 \in \{\pm e_0, \pm e_1\}$; the map $O$ therefore preserves the plane of $e_0$ and $e_1$ and its orthogonal complement, and it acts on the first as a signed permutation matrix $A$ and on the second as a signed permutation matrix of $e_2$ and $e_3$, that is, as $z \mapsto i^k z$ or as $z \mapsto i^k \bar{z}$. Every such map preserves $\mathbb{Z}^4$, and it preserves $\rho\mathbb{Z}^4 = \mathbb{Z}^2 \times \omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$ if and only if its second part preserves $\omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$. The maps $z \mapsto i^k z$ do. The maps $z \mapsto i^k \bar{z}$ send $\omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$ to $\bar{\omega}\mathbb{Z}[i]$, which is equal to $\omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$ only if $\omega^2 \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$, and $\omega^2 = (-7+24i)/25$. This gives (5.1) and the count $8 \cdot 4$. The reflections named are the cases $A = \mathrm{diag}(-1, 1)$ and $A = \mathrm{diag}(1, -1)$ with $k = 0$. *q.e.d.*

The group of all symmetries of $\mathbb{Z}^4$, the signed permutation matrices, has 384 elements and exchanges any two coordinate planes. The group $\mathfrak{G}_0$ does not, and this has the following consequence. Let $F = (F_{\mu\nu})$ be an antisymmetric tensor, on which an isometry $O$ acts by $(OF)_{\mu\nu} = \sum_{\kappa,\lambda} O_{\mu\kappa} O_{\nu\lambda} F_{\kappa\lambda}$.

**Lemma 5.2** (Invariant Quadratic Forms)**.** *The real quadratic forms of the antisymmetric tensors $F$ which are invariant under $\mathfrak{G}_0$ are the combinations*

$$\alpha F_{01}^2 + \beta F_{23}^2 + \lambda \sum_{a\in\{0,1\}} \sum_{j\in\{2,3\}} F_{aj}^2 \tag{5.2}$$

*with real $\alpha$, $\beta$, $\lambda$, a space of dimension three. Those which are invariant under all signed permutation matrices are the multiples of $\sum_{\mu<\nu} F_{\mu\nu}^2$.*

*Proof.* Let $\mathsf{q}$ be an invariant quadratic form, a combination of the products of two of the six components $F_{01}$, $F_{23}$, $F_{aj}$. The three elements $\theta_0$, $\theta_1$, and $\sigma$ of $\mathfrak{G}_0$ which change the sign of $x_0$, of $x_1$, and of $z$ multiply each component by a sign: $F_{01}$ by $(-,-,+)$, $F_{23}$ by $(+,+,+)$, $F_{0j}$ by $(-,+,-)$, and $F_{1j}$ by $(+,-,-)$. A product of two components is invariant under the three only if the two have the same signs, so that

$$\mathsf{q}(F) = \alpha F_{01}^2 + \beta F_{23}^2 + \sum_{j,j'} (m^0_{jj'} F_{0j} F_{0j'} + m^1_{jj'} F_{1j} F_{1j'}) \tag{5.3}$$

with symmetric matrices $m^0$ and $m^1$. The element of $\mathfrak{G}_0$ which exchanges $x_0$ and $x_1$ exchanges $F_{0j}$ and $F_{1j}$, so that $m^0 = m^1 =: m$. The element $z \mapsto iz$ maps $e_2$ to $e_3$ and $e_3$ to $-e_2$, so that it replaces the vector $(F_{a2}, F_{a3})$ by $(-F_{a3}, F_{a2})$; the invariance of (5.3) then requires $m_{22} = m_{33}$ and $m_{23} = -m_{23}$, that is, $m = \lambda \mathbf{1}$. This is (5.2). Conversely each of the three forms is invariant: an element (5.1) multiplies $F_{01}$ by $\det A = \pm 1$, fixes $F_{23}$, because $z \mapsto i^k z$ has the determinant 1, and replaces the matrix $(F_{aj})$ by its product with $A$ on one side and with a rotation matrix on the other, which preserves the sum of the squares of its entries. Finally a signed permutation matrix which exchanges the planes of two pairs of coordinates exchanges the corresponding components up to signs, so that the invariance under all of them forces $\alpha = \beta = \lambda$. *q.e.d.*

*Modification of [9, (1.20)–(1.22), p. 264].* Bałaban defines the coefficient $\beta_{j+1}$ of the flow of the coupling as a second derivative of the Fourier transform of the vacuum polarisation $\Pi_{j+1,\mu\nu}$ of a step, for one pair $\mu \neq \nu$, and the definition does not depend on the pair because, by his (1.21), the vacuum polarisation is covariant under the rotations which leave the lattice invariant. In the tilted run the covariance holds for the elements of $\mathfrak{G}_0$ only, and by Lemma 5.2 the second derivatives define three numbers, one for each of the forms (5.2): those of the pair $(0,1)$, of the pair $(2,3)$, and of the four pairs $(a,j)$. We do not know whether the three agree, and the consequences for the inductive description of the densities have not been examined.

## 6 The Averages of the Tilted Run

From here on $L$ is a multiple of 5. After $k \geq 1$ steps of the tilted run, and in the unit of the lattice which it has reached, the situation is that of [2, Section B] with one change: the unit lattice is $\mathbb{Z}^4$ and the lattices of the intermediate steps are $L^{-j}\mathbb{Z}^4$, $1 \leq j \leq k-1$, as there, but the fine lattice is

$$T_\eta \coloneqq \eta\rho\mathbb{Z}^4 = \eta(\mathbb{Z}^2 \times \omega\mathbb{Z}[i]) \,, \qquad \eta = L^{-k} \,, \tag{6.1}$$

in place of $\eta\mathbb{Z}^4$. Its bonds are the pairs $\langle x, x \pm \eta e'_\nu \rangle$. We call a number $a$ a *scale* if $a/(5\eta)$ and $1/a$ are integers; the numbers $L^{-j}$, $0 \leq j \leq k-1$, are scales, and so is $5\eta$. For a scale $a$ we have $a\mathbb{Z}^4 \subset T_\eta$, because $a/\eta$ is a multiple of 5 and $5\mathbb{Z}[i] \subset \omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$ by Lemma 2.1(iv). A real field is a function $A$ on the bonds of $T_\eta$ with $A(b^{-1}) = -A(b)$, and $A(\gamma) \coloneqq \sum_{b\in\gamma} A(b)$ for a

path $\gamma$ of bonds. We consider infinite lattices in this section and the next; all the operations commute with the translations by $\mathbb{Z}^4$ and therefore act on the fields which are periodic with respect to a subgroup of $\mathbb{Z}^4$.

Bałaban's averages are sums, over the points $x$ of a cube of the fine lattice, of the values of a function at $x$ or of the sums of a field over the straight segment $[x, x(b)]$ from $x$ to its translate by a bond $b$ of the coarse lattice [2, (1.6), (1.11), (1.18), pp. 18–20]. In the tilted run the cubes keep their meaning, as the sets of the points of $T_\eta$ in a cube of the coarse lattice, but for the directions $e_2$ and $e_3$ the segment does not consist of bonds of $T_\eta$, and we replace it by a path which follows it.

**Definition 6.1** (Blocks, Staircases, and Averages)**.** Let $a$ be a scale.

(i) The *block* of $y \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$ is $B_a(y) \coloneqq \{x \in T_\eta \,|\, y_\mu \le x_\mu < y_\mu + a,\ \mu = 0, \dots, 3\}$.

(ii) For $x \in T_\eta$ the *staircases* from $x$ are the following paths of bonds of $T_\eta$. For $\mu \in \{0, 1\}$, $\sigma^a_\mu(x)$ is the straight path of $a/\eta$ bonds in the direction $e_\mu$. The path $\sigma^a_2(x)$ repeats $a/(5\eta)$ times the seven steps $\eta e'_3, \eta e'_2, \eta e'_3, \eta e'_2, \eta e'_3, \eta e'_2, \eta e'_3$, and $\sigma^a_3(x)$ repeats $a/(5\eta)$ times the seven steps $\eta e'_2, -\eta e'_3, \eta e'_2, -\eta e'_3, \eta e'_2, -\eta e'_3, \eta e'_2$.

(iii) For a function $\lambda$ on $T_\eta$ and $y \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$,

$$(Q'_a\lambda)(y) \coloneqq \left(\frac{\eta}{a}\right)^4 \sum_{x \in B_a(y)} \lambda(x)\ . \tag{6.2}$$

(iv) For a real field $A$ and a bond $b = \langle y, y + ae_\mu\rangle$ of $a\mathbb{Z}^4$,

$$(Q_a A)(b) \coloneqq \left(\frac{\eta}{a}\right)^5 \sum_{x \in B_a(y)} A(\sigma^a_\mu(x))\ , \tag{6.3}$$

and $(Q_a A)(b^{-1}) \coloneqq -(Q_a A)(b)$.

We write $Q'_k \coloneqq Q'_1$ and $Q_k \coloneqq Q_1$.

For $a = 1$ these are the operators $Q'_k$ of [2, p. 20] and $Q_k$ of [2, (1.18), p. 20], with $T_\eta$ turned and with $\sigma^1_\mu(x)$ in place of $[x, x(b)]$, and for the directions $e_0$ and $e_1$ nothing has changed. For two scales $a$ and $a'$ with $a'/a$ an integer we also need Bałaban's own averages between the lattices $a\mathbb{Z}^4$ and $a'\mathbb{Z}^4$, which we denote by

$$(Q'^{\mathrm{st}}_{a,a'}\lambda)(y) \coloneqq \left(\frac{a}{a'}\right)^4 \sum_z \lambda(z)\ , \qquad (Q^{\mathrm{st}}_{a,a'}B)(\langle y, y+a'e_\mu\rangle) \coloneqq \left(\frac{a}{a'}\right)^5 \sum_z B([z, z+a'e_\mu])\ , \tag{6.4}$$

the sums over the points $z \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$ with $y_\mu \le z_\mu < y_\mu + a'$ for every $\mu$, for functions $\lambda$ and fields $B$ on $a\mathbb{Z}^4$.

**Lemma 6.2** (Blocks and Staircases)**.** *Let $a$ and $a'$ be scales with $a'/a$ an integer.*

*(i) The blocks $B_a(y)$, $y \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$, are pairwise disjoint, their union is $T_\eta$, each has $(a/\eta)^4$ points, and $B_a(y + w) = B_a(y) + w$ for $w \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$. The block $B_{a'}(y)$ is the union of the blocks $B_a(z)$ over the points $z \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$ with $y_\mu \le z_\mu < y_\mu + a'$.*

*(ii) The staircase $\sigma^a_\mu(x)$ ends at $x + ae_\mu$, and $\sigma^{a'}_\mu(x)$ is the concatenation of the staircases $\sigma^a_\mu(x + nae_\mu)$, $0 \le n < a'/a$. Each site of $\sigma^a_\mu(x)$ is at a distance of at most $\frac{3}{5}\eta$ from the segment $[x, x + ae_\mu]$.*

*Proof.* (i) Since $a\mathbb{Z}^4$ is a subgroup of $T_\eta$ and the cube $y + [0,a)^4$ contains exactly one point of every class of $\mathbb{R}^4$ modulo $a\mathbb{Z}^4$, the block $B_a(y)$ contains exactly one point of every class of $T_\eta$ modulo $a\mathbb{Z}^4$. The number of these classes is the quotient $a^4/\eta^4$ of the volumes of the cells of the two lattices, because $\rho$ preserves volumes. The remaining assertions follow from the corresponding ones for the cubes.

(ii) For $\mu \in \{0,1\}$ there is nothing to prove. By (2.2), seven steps of $\sigma_2^a$ add up to $\eta(3e_2' + 4e_3') = 5\eta e_2$ and seven steps of $\sigma_3^a$ to $\eta(4e_2' - 3e_3') = 5\eta e_3$, which gives the end point and the concatenation. The distance of a point $\eta(ne_2' + n'e_3')$ from the line through the origin in the direction $3e_2' + 4e_3'$ is $\eta|4n - 3n'|/5$. After one to seven steps of $\sigma_2^a$ from the origin the pair $(n,n')$ is $(0,1)$, $(1,1)$, $(1,2)$, $(2,2)$, $(2,3)$, $(3,3)$, $(3,4)$, with $|4n-3n'| = 3,1,2,2,1,3,0$, and the foot of the perpendicular lies between the origin and $5\eta e_2$ in each case; the eighth site lies on the line, so that the same holds in every period. For $\sigma_3^a$ the pairs are $(1,0)$, $(1,-1)$, $(2,-1)$, $(2,-2)$, $(3,-2)$, $(3,-3)$, $(4,-3)$, and the distance from the line in the direction $4e_2' - 3e_3'$ is $\eta|3n + 4n'|/5$, with the same values. *q.e.d.*

The next lemma replaces the calculation [2, (1.16)–(1.18), p. 20] by which a composition of averages is an average, and it contains a second statement which has no counterpart there: the tilted average is one of Bałaban's averages, preceded by an average over cells of $5^4$ points which is the same at every step.

**Lemma 6.3** (Composition)**.** *For scales $a$ and $a'$ with $a'/a$ an integer,*

$$Q_{a'} = Q^{\mathrm{st}}_{a,a'} Q_a \ , \qquad Q'_{a'} = Q'^{\mathrm{st}}_{a,a'} Q'_a \ . \tag{6.5}$$

*In particular $Q_k = Q^{\mathrm{st}}_{L^{-1},1} Q_{L^{-1}}$ and $Q_k = Q^{\mathrm{st}}_{5\eta,1} Q_{5\eta}$, and likewise for $Q'_k$.*

*Proof.* Let $b = \langle y, y + a'e_\mu \rangle$, and let $z$ run over the points of $a\mathbb{Z}^4$ with $y_\nu \le z_\nu < y_\nu + a'$. The segment $[z, z + a'e_\mu]$ consists of the $a'/a$ bonds $\langle z + nae_\mu, z + (n+1)ae_\mu \rangle$ of $a\mathbb{Z}^4$, so that by (6.4) and (6.3)

$$\begin{aligned} (Q^{\mathrm{st}}_{a,a'} Q_a A)(b) &= \Big(\frac{a}{a'}\Big)^5 \Big(\frac{\eta}{a}\Big)^5 \sum_z \sum_{n=0}^{a'/a-1} \sum_{x \in B_a(z+nae_\mu)} A(\sigma_\mu^a(x)) \\ &= \Big(\frac{\eta}{a'}\Big)^5 \sum_z \sum_{x \in B_a(z)} \sum_{n=0}^{a'/a-1} A(\sigma_\mu^a(x + nae_\mu)) \ , \end{aligned} \tag{6.6}$$

where we have used $B_a(z + nae_\mu) = B_a(z) + nae_\mu$. By Lemma 6.2(ii) the inner sum is $A(\sigma_\mu^{a'}(x))$, and by Lemma 6.2(i) the points $x$ run over $B_{a'}(y)$; this is $(Q_{a'}A)(b)$. The proof for $Q'$ is the last assertion of Lemma 6.2(i). *q.e.d.*

**Lemma 6.4** (The Identities of the Averages)**.** *Let $a$ be a scale, and write $(\partial^\eta \lambda)(b) := \eta^{-1}(\lambda(b_+) - \lambda(b_-))$ for a function $\lambda$ on $T_\eta$ and a bond $b = \langle b_-, b_+ \rangle$ of $T_\eta$, and $\partial^a$ for the same operation on $a\mathbb{Z}^4$.*

*(i)* $Q_a \partial^\eta = \partial^a Q'_a$.

*(ii) $Q'_a$ maps the constant function 1 to 1, and so does its adjoint. For $v \in \mathbb{R}^4$, $Q_a$ maps the constant field $A(\langle x, x + \eta e'_\nu \rangle) := v \cdot e'_\nu$ on $T_\eta$ to the constant field $B(\langle y, y + ae_\mu \rangle) := v \cdot e_\mu$ on $a\mathbb{Z}^4$, and its adjoint maps $B$ to $A$. Here the adjoints are taken with respect to the sums over the points, or the positive bonds, with the weights $\eta^4$ on $T_\eta$ and $a^4$ on $a\mathbb{Z}^4$.*

*(iii) $Q_a$ and $Q'_a$ commute with the translations by the vectors of $a\mathbb{Z}^4$.*

*Proof.* (i) The sum of $\partial^\eta\lambda$ over a path from $x$ to $x'$ is $\eta^{-1}(\lambda(x')-\lambda(x))$, so that $(Q_a\partial^\eta\lambda)(\langle y, y+ae_\mu\rangle) = (\eta/a)^5\eta^{-1}\sum_{x\in B_a(y)}(\lambda(x+ae_\mu)-\lambda(x))$ by Lemma 6.2(ii). Since $x\mapsto x+ae_\mu$ maps $B_a(y)$ onto $B_a(y+ae_\mu)$, this is $a^{-1}((Q'_a\lambda)(y+ae_\mu)-(Q'_a\lambda)(y))$.

(ii) $Q'_a1 = 1$ is the count of Lemma 6.2(i), and $(Q'^*_a\omega)(x) = \omega(y)$ for $x\in B_a(y)$, because every point lies in one block. The sum of the constant field $A$ over a path from $x$ to $x'$ is $\eta^{-1}v\cdot(x'-x)$, so that every term of (6.3) is $\eta^{-1}av\cdot e_\mu$, and $(\eta/a)^5(a/\eta)^4\eta^{-1}a = 1$. For the adjoint we count the staircases through a bond. By (6.3) and the weights, $(Q^*_aB)(b') = (\eta/a)\sum_\mu\sum_x \pm B(\langle y(x), y(x)+ae_\mu\rangle)$ for a positive bond $b'$ of $T_\eta$, the inner sum over the points $x\in T_\eta$ whose staircase $\sigma^a_\mu(x)$ contains $b'$ or its reverse, with the sign $-$ in the second case, and with $y(x)$ the corner of the block of $x$. A bond in the direction $e_0$ or $e_1$ lies on $a/\eta$ staircases of that direction and on no other. Each period of $\sigma^a_2$ has three steps $\eta e'_2$ and four steps $\eta e'_3$, and each period of $\sigma^a_3$ has four steps $\eta e'_2$ and three steps $-\eta e'_3$; since every translate of a staircase by a vector of $T_\eta$ is a staircase, a bond in the direction $e'_2$ lies on $3a/(5\eta)$ staircases $\sigma^a_2$ and on $4a/(5\eta)$ staircases $\sigma^a_3$, and a bond in the direction $e'_3$ on $4a/(5\eta)$ staircases $\sigma^a_2$ and, reversed, on $3a/(5\eta)$ staircases $\sigma^a_3$. For the constant field $B$ this gives the values $\frac15(3v\cdot e_2+4v\cdot e_3) = v\cdot e'_2$ and $\frac15(4v\cdot e_2-3v\cdot e_3) = v\cdot e'_3$ by (2.2).

(iii) The blocks and the staircases are carried to each other by these translations. *q.e.d.*

Statement (i) is [2, (1.55), p. 27], and with it [2, (1.9), (1.13), (1.20)]. Statement (ii) says that the average of a constant field is the same constant vector, with its components in the basis $e'_\nu$ replaced by those in the basis $e_\mu$. On the constant fields $Q_a$ is therefore an isometry with $Q^*_aQ_a = 1$, where Bałaban's average is the identity, and $Q_a$ and $Q'_a$ map the orthogonal complements of the constants to the orthogonal complements of the constants.

## 7 The Momentum Representation

Bałaban's bounds on the operators built from $Q_k$, $Q'_k$, and the Laplace operator of the fine lattice are read off from their momentum representation, in which $Q'_k$ is the multiplication by the function $u_k$ of [2, (1.31), p. 23] and $Q_k$ the multiplication of the component $\mu$ by $u_kv_\mu$ [2, (1.61), p. 28]. Both are products of quotients of sines, and their properties are evident from this form. For the tilted averages the factorisation $Q_k = Q^{\mathrm{st}}_{5\eta,1}Q_{5\eta}$ of Lemma 6.3 gives the corresponding form: Bałaban's functions for the lattice of the spacing $5\eta$, multiplied by one trigonometric polynomial of 25 terms for the cell, and with a matrix of polynomials of at most four terms in place of the scalar $v_\mu$ in the two turned directions.

For $p\in\mathbb{R}^4$ we write $e_p(x) := e^{ip\cdot x}$, and for a number $a>0$

$$\begin{aligned} \partial^a_\mu(p) &:= \frac{e^{iap_\mu}-1}{a}\,, \qquad & \partial'_\nu(p) &:= \frac{e^{i\eta p\cdot e'_\nu}-1}{\eta}\,, \\ \Delta(p) &:= \sum_\nu|\partial'_\nu(p)|^2\,, \qquad & \Delta_0(p) &:= \sum_\mu|\partial^1_\mu(p)|^2\,. \end{aligned} \tag{7.1}$$

The functions $\partial'_\nu$ and $\Delta$ are the symbols of the difference operators and of the Laplace operator of $T_\eta$, and $\partial^1_\mu$ and $\Delta_0$ those of the unit lattice, as in [2, (1.31), p. 23, and p. 24]. For numbers $a$ and $a'$ with $a'/a$ an integer we put

$$D^{a,a'}_\mu(p) := \frac{a}{a'}\sum_{n=0}^{a'/a-1} e^{ianp_\mu}\,, \tag{7.2}$$

which is $\partial_\mu^{a'}(p)/\partial_\mu^a(p)$ wherever $\partial_\mu^a(p) \neq 0$ and satisfies $D_\mu^{a,a''} = D_\mu^{a,a'} D_\mu^{a',a''}$. Bałaban's functions are $u_k = \prod_\mu D_\mu^{\eta,1}$ and $v_\mu = D_\mu^{\eta,1}$. The cell enters through the set $\mathsf{C} \coloneqq \{c \in \omega\mathbb{Z}[i] \,|\, 0 \leq \operatorname{Re} c < 5,\ 0 \leq \operatorname{Im} c < 5\}$, which has 25 elements by Lemma 6.2(i) for $a = 5\eta$, and through the functions of $\theta = (\theta_2, \theta_3)$

$$\begin{aligned} \kappa(\theta) &\coloneqq \frac{1}{25} \sum_{c \in \mathsf{C}} e^{i\theta \cdot c} \,, \\ s_{22}(\theta) &\coloneqq e^{i\theta \cdot e_3'} + e^{i\theta \cdot (e_2' + 2e_3')} + e^{i\theta \cdot (2e_2' + 3e_3')} \,, \\ s_{23}(\theta) &\coloneqq 1 + e^{i\theta \cdot (e_2' + e_3')} + e^{i\theta \cdot (2e_2' + 2e_3')} + e^{i\theta \cdot (3e_2' + 3e_3')} \,, \\ s_{32}(\theta) &\coloneqq 1 + e^{i\theta \cdot (e_2' - e_3')} + e^{i\theta \cdot (2e_2' - 2e_3')} + e^{i\theta \cdot (3e_2' - 3e_3')} \,, \\ s_{33}(\theta) &\coloneqq -e^{i\theta \cdot (e_2' - e_3')} - e^{i\theta \cdot (2e_2' - 2e_3')} - e^{i\theta \cdot (3e_2' - 3e_3')} \,, \end{aligned} \tag{7.3}$$

where $c$ is read as the vector $(\operatorname{Re} c, \operatorname{Im} c)$ and $\theta \cdot e_\nu'$ is the product with the components of $e_\nu'$ in the plane.

**Lemma 7.1** (The Symbols of the Tilted Averages)**.** *Let $p \in \mathbb{R}^4$.*

*(i) $Q_k' e_p = u_k(p)\, e_p$ on $\mathbb{Z}^4$, with*

$$\begin{aligned} u_k(p) &\coloneqq \sum_{x \in B_1(0)} \eta^4 e^{ip \cdot x} \\ &= D_0^{\eta,1}(p)\, D_1^{\eta,1}(p)\, D_2^{5\eta,1}(p)\, D_3^{5\eta,1}(p)\, \kappa(\eta p_2, \eta p_3) \,. \end{aligned} \tag{7.4}$$

*(ii) For $w = (w_\nu) \in \mathbb{C}^4$ and the field $A(\langle x, x + \eta e_\nu' \rangle) \coloneqq w_\nu e^{ip \cdot x}$, we have $(Q_k A)(\langle y, y + e_\mu \rangle) = u_k(p) \sum_\nu V_{\mu\nu}(p) w_\nu\, e^{ip \cdot y}$, where $V_{\mu\mu}(p) \coloneqq D_\mu^{\eta,1}(p)$ for $\mu \in \{0, 1\}$,*

$$V_{\mu\nu}(p) \coloneqq \tfrac{1}{5} D_\mu^{5\eta,1}(p)\, s_{\mu\nu}(\eta p_2, \eta p_3) \tag{7.5}$$

*for $\mu, \nu \in \{2, 3\}$, and $V_{\mu\nu} \coloneqq 0$ for the other pairs.*

*(iii) $\sum_\nu V_{\mu\nu}(p)\, \partial_\nu'(p) = \partial_\mu^1(p)$ for every $\mu$.*

*(iv) $u_k$ and $V$ are periodic with respect to $2\pi\eta^{-1}\rho\mathbb{Z}^4$, which is a subgroup of $2\pi\mathbb{Z}^4$; $u_k(0) = 1$; $u_k(l) = 0$ for every $l \in 2\pi\mathbb{Z}^4$ which does not lie in $2\pi\eta^{-1}\rho\mathbb{Z}^4$; and $V_{\mu\nu}(0) = e_\mu \cdot e_\nu'$.*

*Proof.* (i) By (6.2), $(Q_k' e_p)(y) = \sum_{x \in B_1(0)} \eta^4 e^{ip \cdot (y+x)}$, which is the first equality. By Lemma 6.2(i), $B_1(0)$ is the disjoint union of the sets $z + B_{5\eta}(0)$ over the $z \in 5\eta\mathbb{Z}^4$ with $0 \leq z_\mu < 1$, and $B_{5\eta}(0)$ is the set of the points $\eta(n_0, n_1, c)$ with $n_0, n_1 \in \{0, \dots, 4\}$ and $c \in \mathsf{C}$. Hence

$$\begin{aligned} u_k(p) &= \Big( \sum_z (5\eta)^4 e^{ip \cdot z} \Big) \Big( \frac{1}{5^4} \sum_{n_0, n_1 = 0}^{4} \sum_{c \in \mathsf{C}} e^{i\eta(n_0 p_0 + n_1 p_1)} e^{i\eta(p_2, p_3) \cdot c} \Big) \\ &= \prod_{\mu=0}^{3} D_\mu^{5\eta,1}(p) \cdot D_0^{\eta,5\eta}(p)\, D_1^{\eta,5\eta}(p)\, \kappa(\eta p_2, \eta p_3) \,, \end{aligned} \tag{7.6}$$

and $D_\mu^{\eta,5\eta} D_\mu^{5\eta,1} = D_\mu^{\eta,1}$.

(ii) For $\mu \in \{0, 1\}$ the sum of $A$ over $\sigma_\mu^1(x)$ is $w_\mu e^{ip \cdot x} \sum_{n < 1/\eta} e^{i\eta n p_\mu} = \eta^{-1} D_\mu^{\eta,1}(p) w_\mu e^{ip \cdot x}$, and (6.3) with (i) gives the assertion. For $\mu = 2$, the bonds of the first period of $\sigma_2^1(x)$ start at

the points $x+\eta c$ with $c = 0$, $e'_3$, $e'_2+e'_3$, $e'_2+2e'_3$, $2e'_2+2e'_3$, $2e'_2+3e'_3$, $3e'_2+3e'_3$, and they have the directions $e'_3, e'_2, e'_3, e'_2, e'_3, e'_2, e'_3$; the sum of $A$ over them is $e^{ip\cdot x}(s_{22}(\eta p)w_2 + s_{23}(\eta p)w_3)$. The $n$-th period is the translate of the first by $5\eta n e_2$, so that the sum of $A$ over $\sigma_2^1(x)$ is this number multiplied by $\sum_{n<1/(5\eta)} e^{5i\eta n p_2} = (5\eta)^{-1} D_2^{5\eta,1}(p)$. For $\mu = 3$ the steps in the direction $e'_2$ start at the points $x + \eta j(e'_2 - e'_3)$, $j = 0, \dots, 3$, and a step $-\eta e'_3$ from $x+\eta c$ is the reversed bond $\langle x+\eta(c-e'_3), x+\eta c\rangle$, on which $A$ takes the value $-w_3 e^{ip\cdot(x+\eta(c-e'_3))}$; the three such steps end at $x + \eta j(e'_2 - e'_3)$, $j = 1, 2, 3$. This gives $s_{32}$ and $s_{33}$.

(iii) Multiply each term of $s_{\mu\nu}(\theta)$ by $e^{i\theta\cdot e'_\nu} - 1$ and add: each step of a period from $c$ to $c'$ contributes $e^{i\theta\cdot c'} - e^{i\theta\cdot c}$, a step $-\eta e'_3$ included, since $-(e^{i\theta\cdot e'_3} - 1)e^{i\theta\cdot(c-e'_3)} = e^{i\theta\cdot(c-e'_3)} - e^{i\theta\cdot c}$. The sum over a period telescopes to $e^{5i\theta_\mu} - 1$, because the period ends at $5e_\mu$. Hence $\sum_\nu V_{\mu\nu}\partial'_\nu = \frac{1}{5} D_\mu^{5\eta,1}(p)\eta^{-1}(e^{5i\eta p_\mu} - 1) = D_\mu^{5\eta,1}(p)\,\partial_\mu^{5\eta}(p) = \partial_\mu^1(p)$ for $\mu \in \{2,3\}$, and for $\mu \in \{0,1\}$ it is $D_\mu^{\eta,1}\partial_\mu^\eta = \partial_\mu^1$.

(iv) For $n \in \mathbb{Z}^4$ and $x \in T_\eta$ the product $2\pi\eta^{-1}\rho n \cdot x$ is a multiple of $2\pi$, because $\rho$ is an isometry and $\rho x \in \eta\mathbb{Z}^4$; this gives the periodicity of $u_k$, and that of $V$ follows in the same way from the positions of the bonds. The inclusion holds because $\eta^{-1}\omega\mathbb{Z}[i] \subset \mathbb{Z}[i]$ by Lemma 2.1(iv). The value $u_k(0) = 1$ is the count of Lemma 6.2(i). For $l \in 2\pi\mathbb{Z}^4$ the function $x \mapsto e^{il\cdot x}$ is a character of the group $T_\eta$ which is trivial on $\mathbb{Z}^4$, and $B_1(0)$ contains one point of every class of $T_\eta$ modulo $\mathbb{Z}^4$; the sum of a nontrivial character over a finite group vanishes, and the character is trivial only if $l\cdot x \in 2\pi\mathbb{Z}$ for every $x \in T_\eta$, that is, $l \in 2\pi\eta^{-1}\rho\mathbb{Z}^4$. Finally $s_{22}(0) = 3$, $s_{23}(0) = 4$, $s_{32}(0) = 4$, $s_{33}(0) = -3$, which are the numbers $5e_\mu\cdot e'_\nu$ of (2.2). *q.e.d.*

Statement (iii) is the identity $Q_k\partial = \partial_1 Q'_k$ in the momentum representation, and (iv) contains the two properties of $u_k$ which Bałaban uses after [2, (1.33), p. 23]. In his setting a momentum $p$ of the fine lattice is written as $p = p' + l$ with $p'$ in the dual of the unit lattice and $l \in 2\pi\mathbb{Z}^4$, the classes of $l$ being taken modulo $2\pi\eta^{-1}\mathbb{Z}^4$. Here they are taken modulo $2\pi\eta^{-1}\rho\mathbb{Z}^4$, and the number of the classes is again $\eta^{-4}$.

The bounds on $u_k$ are those of [2, (1.36), p. 24] with one change. For $p \in \mathbb{R}^4$ let $q_\mu$, for $\mu \in \{0,1\}$, be the number with $q_\mu \equiv p_\mu$ modulo $2\pi/\eta$ and $-\pi/\eta < q_\mu \le \pi/\eta$, and for $\mu \in \{2,3\}$ the number with $q_\mu \equiv p_\mu$ modulo $2\pi/(5\eta)$ and $-\pi/(5\eta) < q_\mu \le \pi/(5\eta)$, so that $(p_2, p_3) = (q_2, q_3) + \frac{2\pi}{5\eta} m$ with $m \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$. We call $p$ *central* if $m \in (3+4i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$.

**Lemma 7.2** (Bounds on the Symbols). *(i)* $\kappa(0) = 1$; $\kappa(\theta + \frac{2\pi}{5}m) = \kappa(\theta)$ *for* $m \in (3+4i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$; $\kappa(\frac{2\pi}{5}m) = 0$ *for* $m \in \mathbb{Z}[i] \setminus (3+4i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$; *and* $|\kappa(\theta) - \kappa(\theta')| \le 5\sqrt{2}|\theta - \theta'|$.

*(ii) For every* $p \in \mathbb{R}^4$, *with* $q$ *as above,*

$$|u_k(p)| \le \prod_{\mu=0}^{3} \min\Big(1, \frac{\pi|\partial_\mu^1(p)|}{2|q_\mu|}\Big) \cdot \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } p \text{ is central,} \\ \min(1, 5\sqrt{2}\,\eta|(q_2, q_3)|) & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases} \tag{7.7}$$

*and* $|V_{\mu\nu}(p)| \le \frac{4}{5}\min(1, \pi|\partial_\mu^1(p)|/(2|q_\mu|))$ *for* $\mu, \nu \in \{2,3\}$; *a quotient with* $q_\mu = 0$ *is read as* $\infty$.

*(iii) For* $p \in [-\pi, \pi]^4$,

$$|u_k(p)| \ge \Big(\frac{2}{\pi}\Big)^4 (1 - 10\pi\eta)\,, \tag{7.8}$$

*and the matrix* $V^{\mathrm{pl}}(p) := (V_{\mu\nu}(p))_{\mu,\nu\in\{2,3\}}$ *satisfies* $|V^{\mathrm{pl}}(p)w| \ge \frac{2}{\pi}(1 - 32\eta)|w|$ *for every* $w \in \mathbb{C}^2$.

*Proof.* (i) $\kappa(0) = 1$ because $\mathsf{C}$ has 25 elements. For $m \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$ the function $c \mapsto e^{i\frac{2\pi}{5}m\cdot c}$ is a character of the group $\omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$, trivial on $5\mathbb{Z}[i]$, since $m \cdot c \in 5\mathbb{Z}$ for $c \in 5\mathbb{Z}[i]$; and $\mathsf{C}$ contains one element of every class of $\omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$ modulo $5\mathbb{Z}[i]$. The character is trivial on $\omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$ if and only if $m \cdot \omega w \in 5\mathbb{Z}$ for every $w \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$, that is, since $m \cdot \omega w = \mathrm{Re}(\bar\omega m \bar w)$, if and only if $\bar\omega m \in 5\mathbb{Z}[i]$, which means $m \in 5\omega\mathbb{Z}[i] = (3+4i)\mathbb{Z}[i]$. If it is trivial, multiplying the terms of $\kappa$ by it changes nothing, which is the periodicity; if it is not, its sum over the classes vanishes. The last assertion holds because $|c| < 5\sqrt{2}$ for $c \in \mathsf{C}$.

(ii) For a number $a$ with $1/a$ an integer and a real $t$ with $|at| \le \pi$ we have $|e^{iat}-1|/a = 2|\sin(at/2)|/a \ge 2|t|/\pi$, so that $|D^{a,1}_\mu(p)| = |\partial^1_\mu(p)|/|\partial^a_\mu(q)| \le \pi|\partial^1_\mu(p)|/(2|q_\mu|)$ for $a = \eta$, $\mu \in \{0,1\}$, and for $a = 5\eta$, $\mu \in \{2,3\}$, because $\partial^a_\mu$ has the period $2\pi/a$ in $p_\mu$; and $|D^{a,1}_\mu| \le 1$ by (7.2). Further $|\kappa| \le 1$, and if $p$ is not central, then $\kappa(\eta(p_2,p_3)) = \kappa(\eta(q_2,q_3)+\frac{2\pi}{5}m)-\kappa(\frac{2\pi}{5}m)$ by (i), which is at most $5\sqrt{2}\,\eta|(q_2,q_3)|$ in modulus. With (7.4) this is (7.7), and the bound on $V$ follows from (7.5) and $|s_{\mu\nu}| \le 4$.

(iii) For $|t| \le \pi$ and $a \le 1$ we have $|e^{it}-1| = 2|\sin(t/2)| \ge 2|t|/\pi$ and $|e^{iat}-1|/a \le |t|$, so that $|D^{a,1}_\mu(p)| \ge 2/\pi$; and $|\kappa(\eta(p_2,p_3))-1| \le 5\sqrt{2}\,\eta|(p_2,p_3)| \le 10\pi\eta$ by (i). This gives (7.8). Let $R_0$ be the matrix with the entries $\frac15 s_{\mu\nu}(0) = e_\mu \cdot e'_\nu$, which is orthogonal by (2.2). Each $s_{\mu\nu}$ has at most four terms $\pm e^{i\theta\cdot c}$ with $|c| \le 3\sqrt{2}$, so that $|\frac15 s_{\mu\nu}(\theta) - \frac15 s_{\mu\nu}(0)| \le \frac{12\sqrt{2}}{5}|\theta|$, and the norm of the matrix of these differences is at most twice this number. For $\theta = \eta(p_2,p_3)$, $|\theta| \le \sqrt{2}\,\pi\eta$, this is at most $\frac{48\pi}{5}\eta \le 32\eta$. Since $V^{\mathrm{pl}}(p)$ is the product of the diagonal matrix of the numbers $D^{5\eta,1}_\mu(p)$, of modulus at least $2/\pi$, with the matrix $\frac15 s(\theta)$, the assertion follows. *q.e.d.*

The first product in (7.7) is Bałaban's bound $\prod_\mu |p'_\mu|/|p'_\mu + l_\mu|$, with the difference that in the turned directions $q_\mu$ is the representative of $p_\mu$ in an interval of the length $2\pi/(5\eta)$ rather than $2\pi/\eta$. Each value of $q$ therefore belongs to 25 of the classes of $l$; one of them is central, and on the other 24 the symbol carries the additional factor $\eta|q|$, while $\Delta(p)$ is of the order of $\eta^{-2}$ there.

As a first application we give the bound on the operator $\phi = Q_k \Delta^{-1} Q_k^*$ of [2, (1.58), (1.62), pp. 27–28], which in the tilted run is a matrix in the turned directions. For $p'$ in the dual of the unit lattice let

$$\phi_{\mu\mu'}(p') \coloneqq \sum_l \frac{|u_k(p'+l)|^2}{\Delta(p'+l)} \sum_\nu V_{\mu\nu}(p'+l)\,\overline{V_{\mu'\nu}(p'+l)}\,, \tag{7.9}$$

the sum over the classes of $l \in 2\pi\mathbb{Z}^4$ modulo $2\pi\eta^{-1}\rho\mathbb{Z}^4$. By Lemma 7.1(i) and (ii) this is the momentum representation of $\phi$: $(\widetilde{\phi\omega})_\mu(p') = \sum_{\mu'} \phi_{\mu\mu'}(p')\tilde\omega_{\mu'}(p')$. It is diagonal for $\mu \in \{0,1\}$, where it is the function $\phi_\mu$ of [2, (1.62)] with the tilted $u_k$, and a Hermitian matrix on the indices $\{2,3\}$.

**Lemma 7.3** (The Matrix $\phi$)**.** *Let $32\eta \le \frac12$. There are constants $0 < \gamma_0 \le \gamma_1$, which do not depend on $k$ and $L$, such that $\gamma_0|w|^2 \le \Delta_0(p')\sum_{\mu,\mu'} \bar w_\mu \phi_{\mu\mu'}(p') w_{\mu'} \le \gamma_1|w|^2$ for every $p' \in [-\pi,\pi]^4$, $p' \ne 0$, and every $w \in \mathbb{C}^4$.*

*Proof.* The quadratic form is $\sum_l |u_k(p'+l)|^2 \Delta_0(p')\Delta(p'+l)^{-1}|V(p'+l)^* w|^2$, a sum of non-negative terms. For the lower bound we keep the term $l = 0$. Since $|e^{it}-1| \le |t|$, we have $\Delta(p') \le \sum_\nu |p'\cdot e'_\nu|^2 = |p'|^2$, and $\Delta_0(p') \ge (4/\pi^2)|p'|^2$ because $|e^{it}-1| \ge 2|t|/\pi$ for $|t| \le \pi$. With Lemma 7.2(iii), applied to $V^{\mathrm{pl}}$ and to the adjoint of this invertible matrix, and with $|D^{\eta,1}_\mu(p')| \ge 2/\pi$ for $\mu \in \{0,1\}$, the term is at least $(4/\pi^2)(2/\pi)^8(1-10\pi\eta)^2(2/\pi)^2(1-32\eta)^2|w|^2$, and $10\pi\eta \le 32\eta \le \frac12$.

For the upper bound, $|V(p)^* w| \le \frac{8}{5}|w|$ by Lemma 7.2(ii). Let $\hat p$ be the representative of $p'+l$ with $|\eta\hat p \cdot e'_\nu| \le \pi$ for every $\nu$. Then $\Delta(p'+l) = \Delta(\hat p) \ge (4/\pi^2)|\hat p|^2$, and $\Delta_0(p') \le |p'|^2$. For $l=0$ we have $\hat p = p'$ and the term is at most $(\pi^2/4)(8/5)^2|w|^2$. For $l \ne 0$ the difference $\hat p - p'$ is a nonzero element of $2\pi\mathbb{Z}^4$ by Lemma 7.1(iv), so that one coordinate of $\hat p$ is at least $\pi$ in modulus, and $\Delta_0(p')/\Delta(p'+l) \le (\pi^2/4)|p'|^2/\pi^2 \le \pi^2$. By (7.7), $|u_k(p'+l)| \le \prod_\mu \min(1, \pi/|q_\mu|)$, since $|\partial^1_\mu| \le 2$, and each value of $q$, which is of the form $q_\mu = p'_\mu + 2\pi n_\mu$ with integers $n_\mu$, belongs to at most 25 classes of $l$. Hence the terms with $l \ne 0$ add up to at most $25\pi^2(8/5)^2 \prod_\mu \sum_{n\in\mathbb{Z}} \min(1, \pi/|p'_\mu + 2\pi n|)^2 |w|^2 \le 25\pi^2(8/5)^2(1+\pi^2/4)^4|w|^2$, because $|p'_\mu + 2\pi n| \ge \pi(2|n|-1)$ for $n \ne 0$ and $\sum_{n\ge1}(2n-1)^{-2} = \pi^2/8$. *q.e.d.*

## 8 The Cells

Several of Bałaban's arguments are local. They use paths of fine bonds inside a block, and they use the lower bound for the Laplace operator of a block with Neumann conditions on the functions of mean zero, which for a cube of the fine lattice is explicit [1, (2.27), p. 580]. In the tilted run a block is a cube of the coarse lattice filled with points of the turned lattice, and neither the paths nor the bound are evident. Both follow from the description of a block as a union of *cells*, the blocks $B_{5\eta}(z)$, $z \in 5\eta\mathbb{Z}^4$, of the scale $5\eta$: by Lemma 6.2(i) the cells of a block form a cubic array with the axes $e_\mu$, and each of them is a translate of the same set of $5^4$ points, which we now describe.

**Lemma 8.1** (The Cell)**.** *Let* $\mathsf{R} \subset \mathbb{Z}^2$ *be the set of the pairs* $(m,n)$ *with* $m \in \{3,4\}$ *for* $n=-3$, $2 \le m \le 5$ *for* $n=-2$, $1 \le m \le 6$ *for* $n=-1$, $0 \le m \le 6$ *for* $n=0$, $2 \le m \le 5$ *for* $n=1$, *and* $m \in \{3,4\}$ *for* $n=2$.

*(i)* $\mathsf{C} = \{me'_2 - ne'_3 \,|\, (m,n) \in \mathsf{R}\}$, *the vectors* $e'_2$ *and* $e'_3$ *being read in the plane. Hence the cell of* $z \in 5\eta\mathbb{Z}^4$ *consists of the points* $z + \eta(n_0 e_0 + n_1 e_1 + me'_2 - ne'_3)$ *with* $n_0, n_1 \in \{0,\dots,4\}$ *and* $(m,n) \in \mathsf{R}$.

*(ii) Every row* $\{m \,|\, (m,n) \in \mathsf{R}\}$ *is an interval which contains* 3 *and* 4.

*(iii) The points* $z + \eta(3e'_2 + 4e'_3)$ *and* $z + \eta(4e'_2 - 3e'_3)$ *are the corners* $z + 5\eta e_2$ *and* $z + 5\eta e_3$ *of the neighbouring cells.*

*Proof.* (i) An element of $\omega\mathbb{Z}[i]$ is $c = \omega(m+ni) = m\omega + n\omega i$ with integers $m$, $n$, and $\omega$ and $\omega i = (-4+3i)/5$ are the vectors $e'_2$ and $-e'_3$ of the plane by (2.2). Its real and imaginary parts are $(3m-4n)/5$ and $(4m+3n)/5$, so that $c \in \mathsf{C}$ if and only if $0 \le 3m-4n < 25$ and $0 \le 4m+3n < 25$, that is, $\max(\frac{4}{3}n, -\frac{3}{4}n) \le m < \min(\frac{25+4n}{3}, \frac{25-3n}{4})$. For $n = -3,\dots,2$ these bounds are $\frac{9}{4} \le m < \frac{13}{3}$, $\frac{3}{2} \le m < \frac{17}{3}$, $\frac{3}{4} \le m < 7$, $0 \le m < \frac{25}{4}$, $\frac{4}{3} \le m < \frac{11}{2}$, and $\frac{8}{3} \le m < \frac{19}{4}$, which give the rows of $\mathsf{R}$. For $n \ge 3$ they require $m \ge 4$ and $m < 4$, and for $n \le -4$ they require $m \ge 3$ and $m < 3$. (ii) is read off from the list, and (iii) is (2.2). *q.e.d.*

By (ii) and (iii) two neighbouring corners of cells are joined by short paths which stay in the cell of the first: for the direction $e_2$ three steps $\eta e'_2$ followed by four steps $\eta e'_3$, through the points $(m,n) = (1,0),(2,0),(3,0),(3,-1),(3,-2),(3,-3)$ of $\mathsf{R}$, and for the direction $e_3$ four steps $\eta e'_2$ followed by three steps $-\eta e'_3$, through $(1,0),\dots,(4,0),(4,1),(4,2)$. We call these paths, and the straight paths of five bonds in the directions $e_0$ and $e_1$, the *connectors* from $z$.

**Definition 8.2** (Contours in a Block)**.** Let $a$ be a scale, $y \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$, and $x \in B_a(y)$, let $z \in 5\eta\mathbb{Z}^4$ be the corner of the cell of $x$, and write $x = z + \eta(n_0 e_0 + n_1 e_1 + me'_2 - ne'_3)$ as in Lemma 8.1(i).

The contour $\Gamma^a_{y,x}$ is the following path of bonds of $T_\eta$ from $y$ to $x$. It first goes from $y$ to $z$ through corners of cells, changing the coordinates in the order $\mu = 3, 2, 1, 0$, each step from a corner to the next along the connector. It then makes $n_0$ steps $\eta e_0$ and $n_1$ steps $\eta e_1$, and finally it goes through the points of the cell with the plane coordinates $(1, 0)$, $(2, 0)$, $(3, 0)$, from there along the column $m = 3$ to $(3, n)$, and along the row $n$ to $(m, n)$.

By Lemma 8.1 every site of $\Gamma^a_{y,x}$ lies in $B_a(y)$, the part of the contour after $z$ lies in the cell of $x$ and has at most $4 + 4 + 9$ bonds, and the contour has at most $\frac{7}{5} \cdot 4a/\eta + 17$ bonds. These contours take the place of [2, (1.7), p. 18] and of the contours $\Gamma^{(k)}_{y,x}$ of [1, (1.4), p. 572], which are required to lie in the block.

**Lemma 8.3** (A Poincaré Inequality)**.** *For every scale $a$, every $y \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$, and every function $\lambda$ on $B_a(y)$ with $\sum_{x \in B_a(y)} \lambda(x) = 0$,*

$$\sum_{x \in B_a(y)} |\lambda(x)|^2 \le C_P \Big(\frac{a}{\eta}\Big)^2 \sum_b |\lambda(b_+) - \lambda(b_-)|^2 \,, \qquad C_P \coloneqq 1550 \,, \tag{8.1}$$

*the sum on the right over the bonds $b = \langle b_-, b_+ \rangle$ of $T_\eta$ with both ends in $B_a(y)$.*

*Proof.* Write $\delta\lambda(b) \coloneqq \lambda(b_+) - \lambda(b_-)$, and let $N \coloneqq a/(5\eta)$, so that $B_a(y)$ is the union of $N^4$ cells, whose corners form a cube of $N^4$ points of $5\eta\mathbb{Z}^4$. For a point $x$ of a cell with the corner $z$, the last part of the contour of Definition 8.2 is a path of at most 17 bonds inside the cell, so that $|\lambda(x) - \lambda(z)|^2$ is at most 17 times the sum of $|\delta\lambda|^2$ over the bonds of the cell; summing over the 625 points,

$$\sum_x |\lambda(x) - \lambda(z)|^2 \le 625 \cdot 17 \sum_b |\delta\lambda(b)|^2 \,, \tag{8.2}$$

the sums over the points and the bonds of the cell. Let $\Lambda$ be the restriction of $\lambda$ to the corners, and $\bar\Lambda$ its mean. For two neighbouring corners $z$ and $z + 5\eta e_\mu$ in $B_a(y)$ the connector has at most 7 bonds, all with both ends in $B_a(y)$, so that $|\Lambda(z + 5\eta e_\mu) - \Lambda(z)|^2$ is at most 7 times the sum of $|\delta\lambda|^2$ over its bonds, and a bond of $T_\eta$ lies on at most four connectors, those from the corner of its cell. For a function $f$ on $\{0, \dots, N-1\}$ with the mean $\bar f$ we have $\sum_i |f_i - \bar f|^2 = \frac{1}{2N} \sum_{i,j} |f_i - f_j|^2$ and $|f_i - f_j|^2 \le N \sum_m |f_{m+1} - f_m|^2$, hence $\sum_i |f_i - \bar f|^2 \le \frac{1}{2} N^2 \sum_m |f_{m+1} - f_m|^2$. On the cube of the corners, let $E_\mu$ be the average over the coordinate $\mu$; then $\Lambda - \bar\Lambda = \sum_{\mu=0}^3 E_0 \cdots E_{\mu-1}(1 - E_\mu)\Lambda$ is a sum of mutually orthogonal functions, the operators $E_\mu$ are contractions, and the inequality in one variable applies to $(1 - E_\mu)\Lambda$ on every line. Therefore

$$\sum_z |\Lambda(z) - \bar\Lambda|^2 \le \frac{N^2}{2} \sum_\mu \sum_z |\Lambda(z + 5\eta e_\mu) - \Lambda(z)|^2 \le \frac{N^2}{2} \cdot 7 \cdot 4 \sum_b |\delta\lambda(b)|^2 \,, \tag{8.3}$$

the last sum over the bonds with both ends in $B_a(y)$. Since $\lambda$ has the mean zero, $\sum_x |\lambda(x)|^2 \le \sum_x |\lambda(x) - \bar\Lambda|^2$, and $|\lambda(x) - \bar\Lambda|^2 \le 2|\lambda(x) - \lambda(z)|^2 + 2|\Lambda(z) - \bar\Lambda|^2$ for $x$ in the cell of $z$. With (8.2) and (8.3) the left side of (8.1) is at most $(2 \cdot 625 \cdot 17 + 2 \cdot 625 \cdot 14N^2) \sum_b |\delta\lambda(b)|^2 \le 38750\, N^2 \sum_b |\delta\lambda(b)|^2$, and $38750/25 = 1550$. *q.e.d.*

In the notation of [1, (2.27)], the lemma for $a = 1$ says that the Laplace operator of a unit block with Neumann conditions is at least $C_P^{-1}$ on the functions of mean zero, where for a cube of $\eta\mathbb{Z}^4$ the bound is $\pi^2$.

## 9 Bounds in Position Space

Bałaban obtains the bounds of his Proposition 1.1 and the inequality [2, (1.67)] by inspection of the momentum representation, in which every operator is a scalar in the index of the field. With the matrices of Section 7 this inspection becomes laborious, and we prove the same statements in another way: four inequalities for the tilted average, proved by counting paths, the Poincaré inequality of Lemma 8.3, and the momentum representation of two scalar operators only. In this section the fine lattice is the torus $T_\eta/\Gamma'$ with a group of periods $\Gamma' \subset \mathbb{Z}^4$, the scalar products are the sums over the points, the positive bonds, or the plaquettes, with the weight $\eta^4$ on the fine lattice and 1 on the unit lattice, and $\|\cdot\|$ are the corresponding norms. For a field $A$ and a positive direction $\nu$ we write $(\partial'_\nu A)(b) \coloneqq \eta^{-1}(A(b+\eta e'_\nu) - A(b))$, so that $\langle A, \Delta A\rangle = \sum_\nu \|\partial'_\nu A\|^2 = \|\partial A\|^2 + \|\partial^* A\|^2$ by [2, (1.21)], and $\partial_1$, $\partial_1^*$ are the operations of the unit lattice.

**Lemma 9.1** (Four Inequalities for the Average)**.** *For every real field $A$ on $T_\eta/\Gamma'$,*

*(i)* $\|Q_k A\|^2 \le 2\|A\|^2$;

*(ii)* $\|\partial_1^* Q_k A\|^2 \le 62\,\langle A, \Delta A\rangle$;

*(iii)* $\|\partial_1 Q_k A\|^2 \le 24\|\partial A\|^2$;

*(iv)* $\|A\|^2 \le (2C_P + 64)\langle A, \Delta A\rangle + 4\|Q_k A\|^2$.

*Proof.* Let $n_\mu$ be the number of the bonds of a staircase $\sigma^1_\mu$, so that $n_\mu \le \frac{7}{5\eta}$, and recall from the proof of Lemma 6.4(ii) that a bond of $T_\eta$ lies on at most $\frac{7}{5\eta}$ of the staircases $\sigma^1_\mu(x)$, $x \in T_\eta$, $\mu = 0, \dots, 3$. We use the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality in the form $|\sum_{t\in\mathcal{T}} c_t|^2 \le |\mathcal{T}| \sum_t |c_t|^2$.

(i) By (6.3), $(Q_k A)(\langle y, y + e_\mu\rangle)$ is $\eta^5$ times a sum of the values of $A$ over the $\eta^{-4} n_\mu$ pairs of a point $x \in B_1(y)$ and a bond of $\sigma^1_\mu(x)$. Its square is therefore at most $\eta^{10}\eta^{-4} n_\mu$ times the sum of $|A(b)|^2$ over these pairs, and in the sum over $y$ and $\mu$ every bond occurs at most $\frac{7}{5\eta}$ times. Hence $\|Q_k A\|^2 \le \frac{49}{25}\eta^4 \sum_b |A(b)|^2$.

(ii) We have $(\partial_1^* B)(y) = \sum_\mu (B(\langle y - e_\mu, y\rangle) - B(\langle y, y + e_\mu\rangle))$, and $(Q_k A)(\langle y, y + e_\mu\rangle) - (Q_k A)(\langle y - e_\mu, y\rangle) = \eta^5 \sum_{x\in B_1(y)} (A(\sigma^1_\mu(x)) - A(\sigma^1_\mu(x - e_\mu)))$. The staircase $\sigma^1_\mu(x)$ is the translate of $\sigma^1_\mu(x - e_\mu)$ by $e_\mu$. For a bond $b$ the difference $A(b + e_\mu) - A(b)$ is the sum of the $n_\mu$ differences of $A$ between the translates of $b$ by two consecutive sites of $\sigma^1_\mu(0)$, each of which is $\pm\eta(\partial'_\nu A)(b'')$ for a translate $b''$ of $b$ and a direction $\nu$. The difference of the two averages is therefore $\eta^5 \cdot \eta$ times a sum of $\eta^{-4} n_\mu^2$ values $\pm(\partial'_\nu A)(b'')$, and in the sum over $y$ every pair $(b'', \nu)$ occurs at most $n_\mu^2$ times. This gives $\sum_y |\cdot|^2 \le \eta^{12}\eta^{-4} n_\mu^4 \sum_{b'',\nu} |(\partial'_\nu A)(b'')|^2 \le (\frac{7}{5})^4 \langle A, \Delta A\rangle$ for every $\mu$, and $|(\partial_1^* Q_k A)(y)|^2$ is at most four times the sum of the squares of the four differences; $16(\frac{7}{5})^4 \le 62$.

(iii) Let $P$ be the plaquette of the unit lattice with the corners $y$, $y + e_\mu$, $y + e_\mu + e_\nu$, $y + e_\nu$. Since $B_1(y + e_\mu) = B_1(y) + e_\mu$, we have $(\partial_1 Q_k A)(P) = \eta^5 \sum_{x\in B_1(y)} A(\ell(x))$ with the closed path $\ell(x)$ which runs along $\sigma^1_\mu(x)$ and $\sigma^1_\nu(x + e_\mu)$ and back along $\sigma^1_\mu(x + e_\nu)$ and $\sigma^1_\nu(x)$. Let $s_0 = 0, s_1, \dots, s_{n_\mu} = e_\mu$ be the sites of $\sigma^1_\mu(0)$ and $s'_0, \dots, s'_{n_\nu}$ those of $\sigma^1_\nu(0)$. The points $x + s_i + s'_j$ form a mesh whose boundary is $\ell(x)$, and the sum of $A$ over $\ell(x)$ is the sum over $i$ and $j$ of the sums of $A$ over the closed paths through $x + s_i + s'_j$, $x + s_{i+1} + s'_j$, $x + s_{i+1} + s'_{j+1}$, $x + s_i + s'_{j+1}$. If the two steps $s_{i+1} - s_i$ and $s'_{j+1} - s'_j$ are parallel, such a path runs through each of its bonds once in each sense and contributes nothing; otherwise it is the boundary of a plaquette $p$ of $T_\eta$ and contributes $\pm\eta(\partial A)(p)$. Hence $(\partial_1 Q_k A)(P)$ is $\eta^5 \cdot \eta$ times a sum

of at most $\eta^{-4}n_\mu n_\nu$ values $\pm(\partial A)(p)$, and in the sum over $y$ every plaquette occurs at most $n_\mu n_\nu$ times. This gives $\sum_y|(\partial_1 Q_k A)(P)|^2 \le (\frac{7}{5})^4\|\partial A\|^2$ for each of the six pairs $\mu<\nu$, and $6(\frac{7}{5})^4 \le 24$.

(iv) Let $A_\nu(x) \coloneqq A(\langle x, x+\eta e'_\nu\rangle)$, and let $\bar A_\nu(y)$ be the mean of $A_\nu$ over $B_1(y)$. Lemma 8.3 with $a=1$, applied to $A_\nu - \bar A_\nu(y)$ on every block, gives $\sum_\nu\sum_x \eta^4|A_\nu(x)-\bar A_\nu(y(x))|^2 \le C_P\langle A,\Delta A\rangle$, where $y(x)$ is the corner of the block of $x$, because the differences of $A_\nu$ along the bonds of a block are among the numbers $\eta(\partial'_{\nu'}A)(b)$. Since a block has $\eta^{-4}$ points, $\|A\|^2 \le 2C_P\langle A,\Delta A\rangle + 2\sum_y\sum_\nu|\bar A_\nu(y)|^2$. By Lemma 6.4(ii) the average of the constant field with the values $\bar A_\nu(y)$ is $\sum_\nu(e_\mu\cdot e'_\nu)\bar A_\nu(y)$, so that $(Q_kA)(\langle y,y+e_\mu\rangle) - \sum_\nu(e_\mu\cdot e'_\nu)\bar A_\nu(y)$ is $\eta^5$ times the sum, over $x\in B_1(y)$ and over the bonds of $\sigma^1_\mu(x)$, of the differences between the value of $A$ on the bond and the value of the same component at $x$. Each of these differences is a sum of at most $n_\mu$ terms $\pm\eta(\partial'_{\nu'}A)(b'')$ along the staircase, and the counting of (ii) bounds the sum over $y$ of the squares by $(\frac{7}{5})^4\langle A,\Delta A\rangle$ for every $\mu$. The matrix $(e_\mu\cdot e'_\nu)$ is orthogonal, so that $\sum_\nu|\bar A_\nu(y)|^2 \le 2\sum_\mu|(Q_kA)(\langle y,y+e_\mu\rangle)|^2 + 2\sum_\mu|\cdot|^2$ with the differences just bounded, and $\sum_y\sum_\nu|\bar A_\nu(y)|^2 \le 2\|Q_kA\|^2 + 8(\frac{7}{5})^4\langle A,\Delta A\rangle$. Since $16(\frac{7}{5})^4 \le 64$, this is (iv). *q.e.d.*

The two scalar operators are those of [2, (1.38), (1.58)] for functions. As there, $\Delta^{-1}$ denotes the inverse of the Laplace operator $\Delta=\partial^*\partial$ of $T_\eta/\Gamma'$ on the functions orthogonal to the constants, and $\Delta_0 \coloneqq \partial_1^*\partial_1$ is the Laplace operator of the unit lattice.

**Lemma 9.2** (Two Scalar Operators)**.** *Let $10\pi\eta \le \frac12$. On the functions of the unit lattice which are orthogonal to the constants, the operators $\mathsf{S} \coloneqq Q'_k\Delta^{-2}Q'^*_k$ and $\mathsf{T} \coloneqq Q'_k\Delta^{-1}Q'^*_k$ satisfy*

$$\mathsf{S} \ge c_{\mathsf{S}}\Delta_0^{-2}\,, \qquad \mathsf{T} \le C_{\mathsf{T}}\Delta_0^{-1}\,, \qquad c_{\mathsf{S}} \coloneqq \tfrac14(\tfrac{2}{\pi})^{12}\,, \quad C_{\mathsf{T}} \coloneqq \tfrac{\pi^2}{4} + 100(1+\tfrac{\pi^2}{4})^4\,. \tag{9.1}$$

*Proof.* By Lemma 7.1(i) and its adjoint, both operators are multiplications in the momentum representation of the unit lattice, by $\mathsf{S}(p') = \sum_l|u_k(p'+l)|^2\Delta(p'+l)^{-2}$ and $\mathsf{T}(p') = \sum_l|u_k(p'+l)|^2\Delta(p'+l)^{-1}$, for $p'\in[-\pi,\pi]^4$, $p'\neq0$. As in the proof of Lemma 7.3, $(4/\pi^2)|p'|^2 \le \Delta_0(p') \le |p'|^2$ and $(4/\pi^2)|p'|^2 \le \Delta(p') \le |p'|^2$. The term $l=0$ of $\mathsf{S}$ is at least $(2/\pi)^8(1-10\pi\eta)^2|p'|^{-4}$ by (7.8), and $|p'|^{-4} \ge (4/\pi^2)^2\Delta_0(p')^{-2}$. The term $l=0$ of $\mathsf{T}$ is at most $(\pi^2/4)|p'|^{-2} \le (\pi^2/4)\Delta_0(p')^{-1}$. For $l\neq0$ we have $\Delta(p'+l)\ge4$ and $\sum_{l\neq0}|u_k(p'+l)|^2 \le 25(1+\pi^2/4)^4$ by the proof of Lemma 7.3, and $1 \le 16\Delta_0(p')^{-1}$. *q.e.d.*

**Proposition 9.3** (Proposition 1.1 and the Inequality (1.67) for the Tilted Run)**.** *Let $32\eta\le\frac12$ and $a>0$. There are constants $\gamma_0>0$ and $C$, which depend on $a$ and do not depend on $k$, $L$, and the torus, such that the operator $\Delta_a = \Delta - \partial P\partial^* + aQ_k^*Q_k$ of [2, (1.69)] and its inverse $G$ satisfy*

$$\Delta_a \ge \gamma_0(\Delta+I)\,, \tag{9.2}$$

$$\|GJ\|,\ \|\nabla GJ\|,\ \|G\nabla^*J\|,\ \|\nabla G\nabla^*J\| \le \gamma_0^{-1}\|J\|\,, \qquad \|\nabla\nabla GJ\|,\ \|G\nabla^*\nabla^*J\| \le C\|J\|\,, \tag{9.3}$$

*where $\nabla A \coloneqq (\partial'_\nu A)_\nu$, and such that the action $\Delta_k$ of [2, (1.65)] satisfies*

$$\tfrac{1}{24}\|\partial_1 B\|^2 \le \langle B,\Delta_k B\rangle \le \gamma_\phi^{-1}\|\partial_1 B\|^2\,, \tag{9.4}$$

*where $\gamma_\phi$ denotes the lower constant $\gamma_0$ of Lemma 7.3.*

*Proof.* We use the operator identities of [2], which hold in the tilted run by Section 10: $R = I - P$ is the orthogonal projection onto $\Delta N(Q'_k)$, where $N(Q'_k)$ is the null space of

$Q'_k$; $P = \Delta^{-1} Q'^*_k \mathsf{S}^{-1} Q'_k \Delta^{-1}$ on the functions orthogonal to the constants; and $\langle A, \Delta_a A\rangle = \|\partial A\|^2 + \|R\partial^* A\|^2 + a\|Q_k A\|^2$.

*A gauge transformation.* Let $A$ be a field. There is $\lambda \in N(Q'_k)$ with $\Delta\lambda = R\partial^* A$, and $A_s := A - \partial\lambda$ satisfies $\partial A_s = \partial A$, $Q_k A_s = Q_k A - \partial_1 Q'_k \lambda = Q_k A$ by Lemma 6.4(i), and $\partial^* A_s = \partial^* A - \Delta\lambda = P\partial^* A$. Hence

$$\langle A, \Delta_a A\rangle = \|\partial A_s\|^2 + a\|Q_k A_s\|^2 + \|\Delta\lambda\|^2 \,. \tag{9.5}$$

*The gauge part.* Since $\partial\partial\lambda = 0$, we have $\langle \partial\lambda, \Delta\partial\lambda\rangle = \|\partial^*\partial\lambda\|^2 = \|\Delta\lambda\|^2$. The function $\lambda$ has the mean zero on every unit block, so that $\|\lambda\|^2 \le C_P\|\partial\lambda\|^2$ by Lemma 8.3 with $a = 1$, and $\|\partial\lambda\|^2 = \langle\lambda, \Delta\lambda\rangle \le \|\lambda\|\|\Delta\lambda\|$; together, $\|\partial\lambda\|^2 \le C_P\|\Delta\lambda\|^2$.

*The divergence on the slice.* Put $f := \partial^* A_s$, so that $f = Pf$ is orthogonal to the constants, and $\mu := Q'_k \Delta^{-1} f$. Then $\|f\|^2 = \langle f, Pf\rangle = \langle \mu, \mathsf{S}^{-1}\mu\rangle \le c_{\mathsf{S}}^{-1}\|\Delta_0\mu\|^2$ by Lemma 9.2. The field $A^T := A_s - \partial\Delta^{-1} f$ satisfies $\partial^* A^T = 0$ and $\partial A^T = \partial A_s$, and $\partial_1\mu = Q_k\partial\Delta^{-1} f = Q_k A_s - Q_k A^T$ by Lemma 6.4(i). Hence $\Delta_0\mu = \partial_1^* Q_k A_s - \partial_1^* Q_k A^T$, where $\|\partial_1^* Q_k A_s\|^2 \le 16\|Q_k A_s\|^2$, each bond of the unit lattice entering $\partial_1^*$ at its two ends, and $\|\partial_1^* Q_k A^T\|^2 \le 62\langle A^T, \Delta A^T\rangle = 62\|\partial A_s\|^2$ by Lemma 9.1(ii). Therefore

$$\|\partial^* A_s\|^2 \le C_4(\|\partial A_s\|^2 + \|Q_k A_s\|^2) \,, \qquad C_4 := 124\, c_{\mathsf{S}}^{-1} \,. \tag{9.6}$$

*The lower bound.* By (9.6), $\langle A_s, \Delta A_s\rangle \le (1 + C_4)(\|\partial A_s\|^2 + \|Q_k A_s\|^2)$, and by Lemma 9.1(iv), $\|A_s\|^2 \le (2C_P + 64)\langle A_s, \Delta A_s\rangle + 4\|Q_k A_s\|^2$. With the bounds on the gauge part and $\langle A, (\Delta + I)A\rangle \le 2\langle A_s, (\Delta + I)A_s\rangle + 2\langle\partial\lambda, (\Delta + I)\partial\lambda\rangle$, the identity (9.5) gives (9.2) with

$$\gamma_0^{-1} := 2\max\Big(\frac{(2C_P + 65)(1 + C_4) + 4}{\min(1, a)},\ 1 + C_P\Big) \,. \tag{9.7}$$

*The bounds on $G$.* By (9.2), $\Delta_a$ is invertible and $(\Delta + I)^{1/2} G (\Delta + I)^{1/2}$ has the norm at most $\gamma_0^{-1}$; since $\|\nabla A\|^2 = \langle A, \Delta A\rangle$, this is the first half of (9.3). On the torus the operators $\partial'_\nu$ commute with each other and with their adjoints, so that $\|\nabla\nabla A\|^2 = \|\Delta A\|^2$, and $\Delta G = I + \partial P\partial^* G - aQ_k^* Q_k G$. Here $\|Q_k^* Q_k G J\| \le 2\gamma_0^{-1}\|J\|$ by Lemma 9.1(i). For a function $g$ orthogonal to the constants, $Pg = \Delta^{-1} Q'^*_k \omega$ with $\omega = \mathsf{S}^{-1} Q'_k \Delta^{-1} g$, so that $\|\partial Pg\|^2 = \langle Pg, \Delta Pg\rangle = \langle\omega, \mathsf{T}\omega\rangle \le C_{\mathsf{T}}\langle\omega, \Delta_0^{-1}\omega\rangle$, while $\|g\|^2 \ge \|Pg\|^2 = \langle\omega, \mathsf{S}\omega\rangle \ge c_{\mathsf{S}}\langle\omega, \Delta_0^{-2}\omega\rangle \ge \frac{1}{16} c_{\mathsf{S}}\langle\omega, \Delta_0^{-1}\omega\rangle$, because $\Delta_0 \le 16$. With $g = \partial^* GJ$, $\|g\| \le \|\nabla GJ\|$, this gives $\|\Delta GJ\| \le (1 + 2a\gamma_0^{-1} + (16C_{\mathsf{T}}/c_{\mathsf{S}})^{1/2}\gamma_0^{-1})\|J\|$, and the last bound of (9.3) follows by taking adjoints.

*The action.* By [2, (1.47)–(1.65)], $\langle B, \Delta_k B\rangle = \|\partial H_k B\|^2$ is the minimum of $\|\partial A\|^2$ over the fields with $Q_k A = B$ and $R\partial^* A = 0$, and by the gauge transformation above the second condition may be dropped. Lemma 9.1(iii) for $A = H_k B$ is the lower bound of (9.4). For the upper bound write $B = B_0 + B'$ with $B_0$ constant and $B'$ orthogonal to the constants, and $B' = B^T + \partial_1\nu$ with $\nu := \Delta_0^{-1}\partial_1^* B'$, so that $\partial_1^* B^T = 0$ and $\langle B^T, \Delta_0 B^T\rangle = \|\partial_1 B^T\|^2 = \|\partial_1 B\|^2$. Let $\phi = Q_k\Delta^{-1} Q_k^*$, whose momentum representation is (7.9); by Lemma 7.3, $\phi^{-1} \le \gamma_\phi^{-1}\Delta_0$ on the fields orthogonal to the constants. The field $A := Q_k^* B_0 + \Delta^{-1} Q_k^*\phi^{-1} B^T + \partial Q'^*_k\nu$ satisfies $Q_k A = B_0 + B^T + \partial_1 Q'_k Q'^*_k\nu = B$, by Lemma 6.4 and because $Q'_k Q'^*_k = I$, and $\partial A = \partial\Delta^{-1} Q_k^*\phi^{-1} B^T$. Hence $\langle B, \Delta_k B\rangle \le \|\partial A\|^2 \le \langle\Delta^{-1} Q_k^*\phi^{-1} B^T, Q_k^*\phi^{-1} B^T\rangle = \langle B^T, \phi^{-1} B^T\rangle \le \gamma_\phi^{-1}\|\partial_1 B\|^2$. *q.e.d.*

The proposition has the content of [2, Proposition 1.1, (1.89), (1.90), and (1.67)]; the two bounds on second derivatives hold with a constant other than $\gamma_0^{-1}$.

## 10 The Modifications in the First Paper on the Propagators

We go through [2] in its order. The paper treats the Gaussian theory of one real field, with the action $\frac{1}{2}\langle \partial A, \partial A\rangle$ on the fine lattice, and it derives the propagators of the later papers from the averages. In the tilted run its fine lattice is $T_\eta$ of (6.1), on a torus $T_\eta/\Gamma'$ with a group of periods $\Gamma' \subset \mathbb{Z}^4$ in place of the box of [2, p. 17]; the operators $\partial$, $\partial^*$, and $\Delta$ are those of this lattice, whose bonds have the directions $e'_\nu$, and a field has the components $A_\nu$ in these directions, while the fields $B$ and the multipliers $\omega$ on the unit lattice have the components in the directions $e_\mu$.

*Section A, (1.1)–(1.15).* The action [2, (1.3), (1.5)] and its gauge invariance [2, (1.4)] concern the fine lattice alone and are unchanged. The blocks [2, (1.6)] are those of Definition 6.1(i), and the average [2, (1.8), (1.11)] is replaced by Definition 6.1(iv); the transformation laws [2, (1.9), (1.13)] are Lemma 6.4(i). The contours [2, (1.7)] enter the axial gauge condition [2, (1.10)], which requires for every point $x$ of a block a path of fine bonds from the corner $y$ to $x$; we take the path which changes the coordinates of $x - y$ in the basis $\eta e'_\nu$ in the order $\nu = 3, 2, 1, 0$. Such a path may leave the block, by less than its side, which is of no consequence in [2, (1.10)–(1.15)]: these use only that the conditions $A(\Gamma_{y,x}) = 0$ fix the gauge transformations which vanish at the corners, one condition for each point $x \neq y$.

*Section B, (1.16)–(1.20).* The computation [2, (1.16)] of a composition is Lemma 6.3: the average of the first step of the tilted run is $Q_{L^{-1}}$ in the unit of the lattice reached after $k$ steps, the later ones are Bałaban's, and the composition is $Q_k$. The formula [2, (1.20)] is Lemma 6.4(i).

*Sections C to E, the operator identities.* The derivations of [2, (1.21)–(1.28), (1.38)–(1.44), (1.46)–(1.60), (1.64), (1.65), (1.68)–(1.82), (1.91)–(1.107)] are calculations with the operators $\partial$, $\partial^*$, $\Delta$ of the fine lattice, with $Q_k$, $Q'_k$, their adjoints, and with $\partial_1$ on the unit lattice. They use the following properties and no others: the decomposition [2, (1.21)] of the action, which holds on every lattice with four orthogonal directions of bonds and hence on $T_\eta$; the identity [2, (1.55)], which is Lemma 6.4(i); that $Q'_k$ maps constants to constants and their orthogonal complement to the orthogonal complement; and, in [2, (1.57)–(1.59), (1.74), (1.82)], that $Q_k$ and $Q_k^*$ map the constant fields to the constant fields with $Q_k^* Q_k = 1$ on them. The last two properties are Lemma 6.4(ii). These derivations therefore hold without change, and so do their results in operator form: the projection $R$ [2, (1.38), (1.44)], the operator $H_k$ [2, (1.60), (1.103)], the action $\Delta_k$ [2, (1.65)], the operator $G$ [2, (1.81), (1.82)], and the identities [2, (1.95), (1.97), (1.99), (1.107)].

*The momentum representation, (1.29)–(1.37) and (1.45).* The Fourier transform [2, (1.29)] is that of the finite group $T_\eta/\Gamma'$, whose dual consists of the classes modulo $2\pi\eta^{-1}\rho\mathbb{Z}^4$ of the $p$ with $p \cdot \gamma \in 2\pi\mathbb{Z}$ for $\gamma \in \Gamma'$, and the decomposition $p = p' + l$ is as described after Lemma 7.1. The symbols [2, (1.31)] are replaced by (7.1) and (7.4). The solution [2, (1.32)–(1.35), (1.37)] uses of $u_k$ only that $u_k(l) = 0$ for the classes $l \neq 0$ and $u_k(0) = 1$, which is Lemma 7.1(iv), and it holds without change. The bound $\Delta_0(p')/\Delta(p' + l) \leq O(1)(1 + |l|^2)^{-1}$ holds with $l$ replaced by $\hat{l} \coloneqq \hat{p} - p'$ for the representative $\hat{p}$ of the proof of Lemma 7.3: by the estimates given there the quotient is at most $\pi^4/|\hat{p}|^2$, and $|\hat{p}| \geq \max(\pi, |\hat{l}| - 2\pi)$ for $\hat{l} \neq 0$. The bound [2, (1.36)] is replaced by (7.7). The formula [2, (1.45)] and the bounds on it are taken from [1], which we have not examined.

*The momentum representation, (1.61)–(1.63), (1.66), (1.67), (1.83)–(1.88), and (1.101).* The representation [2, (1.61)] of $Q_k$ is replaced by Lemma 7.1(ii): the scalar $v_\mu$ becomes the matrix $V$. The function $\phi_\mu$ of [2, (1.62)] becomes the matrix (7.9), and the bounds $\gamma_0 \leq$

$\Delta_0\phi_\mu \le \gamma_1$ stated there are Lemma 7.3. The formulae [2, (1.63), (1.66), (1.83)–(1.88), (1.101)] are the operator formulae [2, (1.60), (1.65), (1.81), (1.99)] written in components under the assumption that $\phi$ is diagonal. In the tilted run they have to be written with the matrices $V$ and $\phi$ on the indices $\{2,3\}$, in which products such as $\overline{v_\mu}\phi_\mu^{-1}$ become $V^*\phi^{-1}$ and the function $\phi_\mu$ of [2, (1.84)] becomes $\mathbf{1} + a\phi$. Bałaban reads three bounds off from these formulae. Two of them, the inequality [2, (1.67)] and Proposition 1.1 [2, (1.89), (1.90)], are Proposition 9.3, which we have proved without the formulae in components. The third, the bound on the sum over $l$ stated after [2, (1.63)], from which the Hölder continuity of the derivatives of $H_kB$ follows, we obtain by another route. By [2, (1.103)], $H_k = GQ_k^*(Q_kGQ_k^*)^{-1}$, so that the properties of $H_k$ reduce to those of $G$, which are Proposition 16.2, and to the decay of the kernel of $(Q_kGQ_k^*)^{-1}$; this operator is $\Delta_k + a$, and its kernel decays by Lemma 17.1. The resulting bounds on $H_k$ are Corollary 17.2.

*Section F, Proposition 1.2.* The bounds [2, (1.110)–(1.113)] are Proposition 16.2, and the bounds [2, (1.114)] are Lemma 16.1 for the first derivatives and Lemma 17.3 for the second. The proof is organised differently from Bałaban's. His expansion [2, (1.119)–(1.123)] of $G$ over a partition of unity, with the commutators [2, (1.120), (1.121)] of the averages with functions, is not used; the decay comes from a weighted form of the lower bound (9.2). The bounds [2, (1.126), (1.127)] on the kernel of $\partial P\partial^*$ are Lemma 15.1, the identities [2, (1.132), (1.133)] are used as they stand, and the bounds [2, (1.135)–(1.137)] on the scalar operator are Propositions 14.3 and 14.4, which rest on Sections 12 and 13. The expansion over the partition of unity is, however, the model of the expansions of the later papers. Its commutators with the averages along the staircases are the subject of Lemma 17.4, which gives [2, (1.128)], so that the expansion is available in the tilted run as well.

## 11 The Modifications in the Paper on the Scalar Green's Functions

The paper [1] treats the operators $G_k(\Omega, A) = (-\Delta^\eta_{A,\Omega} + m^2 + aP_k(A))^{-1}$ for functions with values in $\mathbb{R}^N$, on a union $\Omega$ of big blocks, with Neumann conditions on its boundary and with an external field $A$. We have read its Sections 1 and 2, with the following result for the tilted run.

*The setting, (1.1)–(1.8).* The blocks [1, (1.1)] are those of Definition 6.1(i), and the big blocks are cubes of the unit lattice as before. The quadratic form [1, (1.3)] is the sum over the bonds of $T_\eta$ with both ends in $\Omega$. The covariant average [1, (1.4)] needs contours inside the blocks, which are those of Definition 8.2.

*The random walk representation, (2.2)–(2.13).* The partition of unity consists of functions of the coordinates $x_\mu/M$, whose differences along a bond of $T_\eta$ are $O(\eta/M)$ as before. The formulae [1, (2.3)–(2.5)] concern one bond or the bonds at one point and do not involve the blocks; the commutator [1, (2.8)] of $P_k(A)$ with a function uses the contours of the block only. The derivation of [1, (2.9)–(2.13)] is therefore unchanged.

*Lemma 2.1 and Corollary 2.3.* The proof of the lemma reduces the $L^2$-bounds, by the expansion [1, (2.24)–(2.26)] in the regular part of the field, to the lower bound [1, (2.27)] for one unit block at $A = 0$, where the Laplace operator of the block with Neumann conditions is bounded below by $\pi^2$ on the functions orthogonal to the constants. In the tilted run this bound is Lemma 8.3, with $C_P^{-1}$ in place of $\pi^2$, so that [1, (2.28)] holds with $c_0^{-1} = \min\{C_P^{-1}, a_k\}$, and [1, (2.29)] is unchanged. We have not checked the expansion [1, (2.24)] itself, which is quoted from another paper. Corollary 2.3 follows from the lemma and the random walk representation as in the text.

*Lemma 2.2 and the last assertion of the Theorem.* These concern a rectangular parallelepiped $\square$ with Neumann conditions, and their proof passes from the operator of the whole lattice to that of $\square$ by multiple reflections [1, (2.42)]. The reflections in the faces of $\square$ which are orthogonal to $e_2$ or $e_3$ do not map $T_\eta$ to itself: by Lemma 5.1 no reflection of the plane of these two directions preserves both lattices. The formula [1, (2.42)] is therefore not available in the tilted run, and neither are, by this proof, the bounds of Lemma 2.2 in the supremum, Hölder, and $L^p$ norms up to the boundary of a parallelepiped. In the proof of the Theorem the lemma is applied to the cubes $\square_j$ in the interior of $\Omega$, on which the functions $h_j$ vanish near the boundary; a replacement of the operators of these cubes by operators without a boundary has not been carried out.

*Lemma 2.4.* For the whole lattice the representation [1, (2.43)–(2.48)] is the solution of a linear equation in the momentum representation, and it holds with the function $u_j$ of (7.4). The bounds [1, (2.35), (2.36)], with the analytic continuation in $p'$ on which the exponential decay rests, are Proposition 12.2; of the lower bound on $u_j$ stated in [1, p. 585] for all $l$, which we have not proved for the tilted $u_j$, only the case $l = 0$ is used, and this case is (7.8). The bound [1, (2.37)] is Lemma 14.2, and the identity [1, (2.34)], which is quoted there from a paper that is not among our sources, is Lemma 13.1. The resulting bounds for the whole lattice at $A = 0$ are Proposition 14.3.

*Section 3, (3.1)–(3.10).* The representation [1, (3.6)] expresses the covariance $C_\Lambda^{(k)}$ of the unit lattice, the inverse of $\Delta^{(k)} + aL^{-2}P$ on a set $\Lambda$, through the operator [1, (3.5)], which has the averages of the next scale on $B^k(\Lambda)$ and those of the scale $k$ elsewhere. It is derived by integrating over the blocks with the formula [1, (3.3)], which uses of the next average only that it is the mean over the $L^d$ points of a block and of $Q_k$ only that it is an average; it therefore holds for the tilted run. At $A = 0$ and on the whole lattice the operator [1, (3.5)] is $\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}$ of Section 18, the relation between the two operators is Lemma 18.1(ii), read in the other direction, and the bounds on $C_\Lambda^{(k)}$ which the later papers use are Lemma 18.1(iii). The comparison [1, (3.9), (3.10)] of the operators of two sets is the resolvent identity, as in Lemma 20.5.

*Section 4, (4.1)–(4.22).* This is the lower bound of the quadratic form $\Delta^{(k)}$ by the squared differences on the unit lattice, Proposition 3.1′. Its proof separates pairs of neighbouring blocks by Neumann conditions and computes, for two blocks at a constant field, a Gaussian integral over the fields on the two blocks [1, (4.14)–(4.22)]. At $A = 0$ and on the whole lattice the statement is the inequality $a_j - a_j^2 Q'G'Q'^* \geq c_\Delta \Delta_0$ in the proof of Lemma 14.2, which we obtain from the momentum representation. For $A \neq 0$ we have not examined it.

*Section 5, (5.1)–(5.27).* The Theorem of this section bounds the inverse of an operator on a subset of $\mathbb{Z}^d$ which is bounded below and has an exponentially decaying kernel, together with its change under a change of the subset. It concerns a unit lattice of the paper. Its first statement [1, (5.7)] is Lemma 14.1, which we prove by a conjugation with weights and which holds on every countable set with a metric; the statement [1, (5.8)] on the change of the subset follows from the first and the formula (25.4), as in Proposition 25.1(i).

In the theory without matter fields the operators of this paper occur at $A = 0$ only: the scalar operators in a background field of [5] are those of the adjoint representation, and they are treated there by an expansion around $U = 1$ (Section 27). The statements of [1] for an external field $A \neq 0$, and its boxes with Neumann conditions, are therefore not used by the later sections.

## 12 The Kernel of the Scalar Operator on the Whole Lattice

We now carry out, for the tilted run, the part of the proof of [1, Lemma 2.4] which concerns the whole lattice: the bounds [1, (2.35), (2.36)] on the kernel of $G'Q_k'^*$, with their exponential decay. Bałaban obtains the decay by moving the integration over $p'$ into the complex domain, and says of the required bounds on the integrand in a complex neighbourhood that they are "more troublesome, but equally elementary" [1, p. 586]. For the tilted symbols they follow from two observations: $u_k$ is the Fourier transform of a probability measure on the unit cube, which bounds it and its differences in every strip, and its decay in $l$ is read off from the product (7.4) for complex arguments as for real ones.

In this section the fine lattice is the infinite lattice $T_\eta$, $a > 0$, and $G' \coloneqq (-\Delta + aQ_k'^*Q_k')^{-1}$ on the square-summable functions on $T_\eta$, where $-\Delta = \partial^*\partial$ and the adjoint is taken with the weights $\eta^4$ on $T_\eta$ and 1 on $\mathbb{Z}^4$, so that $(Q_k'^* g)(x) = g(y)$ for $x \in B_1(y)$ and $Q_k'^*Q_k'$ is the orthogonal projection onto the functions which are constant on the blocks. The inverse exists: by Lemma 8.3 with $a = 1$, applied on every block to the difference of a function and its mean, $-\Delta + aQ_k'^*Q_k' \geq \min(C_P^{-1}, a)$. We write $\mathcal{K}(x, y)$, $x \in T_\eta$, $y \in \mathbb{Z}^4$, for the kernel of $G'Q_k'^*$, that is, $(G'Q_k'^* g)(x) = \sum_y \mathcal{K}(x, y)g(y)$.

The symbols extend to entire functions of $p \in \mathbb{C}^4$: $u_k(p) = \sum_{x \in B_1(0)} \eta^4 e^{ip\cdot x}$, and

$$\Delta(p) \coloneqq \eta^{-2} \sum_\nu (2 - 2\cos(\eta p \cdot e_\nu')) \,, \tag{12.1}$$

which for real $p$ is the function of (7.1); for real $p$, $\overline{u_k(p)} = u_k(-p)$. Both are periodic with respect to $2\pi\eta^{-1}\rho\mathbb{Z}^4$. For $p \in \mathbb{C}^4$ we define $q$ from the real part of $p$ as before Lemma 7.2, and $\hat{p} \in \mathbb{R}^4$ is the representative of the real part of $p$ modulo $2\pi\eta^{-1}\rho\mathbb{Z}^4$ with $|\eta\hat{p} \cdot e_\nu'| \leq \pi$ for every $\nu$.

**Lemma 12.1** (The Symbols in a Strip)**.** *Let $10\eta \leq 1$, and let $p \in \mathbb{C}^4$ with the imaginary part $\tau$, $|\tau_\mu| \leq \frac{1}{4}$ for every $\mu$.*

*(i)* $|u_k(p)| \leq e^{9/4} \prod_\mu \min(1, \pi/|q_\mu|)$.

*(ii) If $s$ is the real part of $p$, then* $|u_k(p) - u_k(s)| \leq 2\sum_\mu |\tau_\mu|$.

*(iii)* $\operatorname{Re}\Delta(p) \geq (4/\pi^2)|\hat{p}|^2 - 2|\tau|^2$ *and* $|\Delta(p)| \leq |\hat{p}|^2 + 2|\tau|^2$*; and if the real part $s$ of $p$ satisfies $|\eta s \cdot e_\nu'| \leq \pi$ for every $\nu$, then* $|\Delta(p) - \Delta(s)| \leq 2|\tau|^2 + 4|s||\tau|$.

*Proof.* (i) Let $t \coloneqq \frac{1}{4}$. By (7.2), $|D_\mu^{a,1}(p)| \leq a\sum_{n<1/a} e^{an|\tau_\mu|} \leq e^t$. Further $|e^{ip_\mu} - 1| \leq 1 + e^t \leq 2e^t$, and for $z = ap_\mu$ with the real part $\varsigma$ and the imaginary part $\vartheta$, $|e^{iz} - 1|^2 = (1 - e^{-\vartheta})^2 + 4e^{-\vartheta}\sin^2(\varsigma/2) \geq e^{-t}(4/\pi^2)(aq_\mu)^2$, because $\varsigma \equiv aq_\mu$ modulo $2\pi$ and $|aq_\mu| \leq \pi$. Hence $|D_\mu^{a,1}(p)| = |e^{ip_\mu} - 1|a/|e^{iap_\mu} - 1| \leq 2e^t e^{t/2}\pi/(2|q_\mu|)$, and altogether $|D_\mu^{a,1}(p)| \leq e^{2t}\min(1, \pi/|q_\mu|)$, for $a = \eta$ and for $a = 5\eta$. Since $|c| < 5\sqrt{2}$ for $c \in \mathsf{C}$ and the imaginary part of $\eta(p_2, p_3)$ has the length at most $\sqrt{2}\,\eta t$, $|\kappa(\eta p_2, \eta p_3)| \leq e^{10\eta t} \leq e^t$. The product (7.4) of four factors $D$ and of $\kappa$ gives (i).

(ii) For $x \in B_1(0)$ we have $0 \leq x_\mu < 1$, so that $|\tau \cdot x| \leq \sum_\mu |\tau_\mu| \leq 1$ and $|e^{ip\cdot x} - e^{is\cdot x}| = |e^{-\tau\cdot x} - 1| \leq 2\sum_\mu |\tau_\mu|$, because $e^v - 1 \leq 2v$ for $0 \leq v \leq 1$; and $u_k$ is an average over these $x$.

(iii) By periodicity we may replace the real part of $p$ by $\hat{p}$. Let $\varsigma \coloneqq \eta\hat{p}\cdot e_\nu'$ and $\vartheta \coloneqq \eta\tau \cdot e_\nu'$, so that $|\varsigma| \leq \pi$ and $|\vartheta| \leq \eta|\tau| \leq \frac{1}{20}$. Then $2 - 2\cos(\varsigma + i\vartheta) = 2(1 - \cos\varsigma) - 2\cos\varsigma(\cosh\vartheta - 1) + 2i\sin\varsigma\sinh\vartheta$, where $(2/\pi^2)\varsigma^2 \leq 1 - \cos\varsigma \leq \frac{1}{2}\varsigma^2$, $\cosh\vartheta - 1 \leq \vartheta^2$, and $|\sinh\vartheta| \leq 2|\vartheta|$. The real

part is therefore at least $(4/\pi^2)\varsigma^2 - 2\vartheta^2$, the modulus is $4\sin^2(\varsigma/2) + 4\sinh^2(\vartheta/2) \le \varsigma^2 + 2\vartheta^2$, and the difference from the value at $\vartheta = 0$ is at most $2\vartheta^2 + 4|\varsigma||\vartheta|$ in modulus. Summing over $\nu$, with $\sum_\nu \varsigma^2 = \eta^2|\hat p|^2$, $\sum_\nu \vartheta^2 = \eta^2|\tau|^2$, and $\sum_\nu |\varsigma||\vartheta| \le \eta^2|\hat p||\tau|$, and dividing by $\eta^2$ gives (iii). *q.e.d.*

**Proposition 12.2** (The Kernel of $G'Q_k'^*$)**.** *Let $32\eta \le \frac12$ and $0 < a_- \le a \le a_+$. There are constants $\delta_0 > 0$ and $c_0$, and for every $\alpha \in [0,1)$ a constant $c_\alpha$, which depend on $a_-$ and $a_+$ and not on $k$ and $L$, such that for all $x, x' \in T_\eta$ with $|x - x'| \le 1$, all $y \in \mathbb{Z}^4$, and all $\nu$,*

$$\begin{gathered} |\mathcal{K}(x,y)| \ , \ |(\partial'_\nu \mathcal{K})(x,y)| \le c_0 e^{-\delta_0|x-y|} \ , \\ |(\partial'_\nu \mathcal{K})(x,y) - (\partial'_\nu \mathcal{K})(x',y)| \le c_\alpha |x-x'|^\alpha e^{-\delta_0 \min(|x-y|,|x'-y|)} \ , \end{gathered} \tag{12.2}$$

*where $\partial'_\nu$ acts on the first argument.*

*Proof. The representation.* We write a momentum of the fine lattice as $p'+l$ with $p' \in [-\pi,\pi]^4$ and $l$ in the set $\mathfrak{L}$ of the $\eta^{-4}$ classes of $2\pi\mathbb{Z}^4$ modulo $2\pi\eta^{-1}\rho\mathbb{Z}^4$. By Lemma 7.1(i), for $f$ on $T_\eta$ and $g$ on $\mathbb{Z}^4$, $(\widetilde{Q'_k f})(p') = \sum_l u_k(p'+l)\tilde f(p'+l)$ and $(\widetilde{Q'^*_k g})(p'+l) = u_k(-p'-l)\tilde g(p')$. The equation $(-\Delta + aQ'^*_k Q'_k)\phi = Q'^*_k g$ therefore reads $\Delta(p'+l)\tilde\phi(p'+l) + a u_k(-p'-l)w(p') = u_k(-p'-l)\tilde g(p')$ with $w(p') \coloneqq \sum_l u_k(p'+l)\tilde\phi(p'+l)$; multiplying by $u_k(p'+l)/\Delta(p'+l)$ and summing over $l$ gives $w = \mathsf{T}\tilde g/(1+a\mathsf{T})$ with $\mathsf{T}(p') = \sum_l u_k(p'+l)u_k(-p'-l)/\Delta(p'+l)$, and then, as in [1, (2.47), (2.48)],

$$\mathcal{K}(x,y) = (2\pi)^{-4}\int_{[-\pi,\pi]^4} \Phi(p')\,\mathrm{d}p' \ , \qquad \Phi(p') \coloneqq \sum_{l\in\mathfrak{L}} \frac{e^{i(p'+l)\cdot(x-y)}\,u_k(-p'-l)}{\Delta(p'+l)(1+a\mathsf{T}(p'))} \ . \tag{12.3}$$

The function $\Phi$ is periodic with respect to $2\pi\mathbb{Z}^4$, a translation of $p'$ by an element of $2\pi\mathbb{Z}^4$ permuting the classes. We single out the class $l = 0$ and put, for $p'$ in the set $U$ of the $p' \in \mathbb{C}^4$ whose real parts have the coordinates at most $\pi + \frac14$ and whose imaginary parts have the coordinates at most $\frac14$ in modulus,

$$\mathsf{T}_*(p') \coloneqq \sum_{l\neq 0} \frac{u_k(p'+l)u_k(-p'-l)}{\Delta(p'+l)} \ , \qquad \mathcal{D}(p') \coloneqq \Delta(p')(1+a\mathsf{T}_*(p')) + a u_k(p')u_k(-p') \ , \tag{12.4}$$

so that $\Delta(p')(1+a\mathsf{T}(p')) = \mathcal{D}(p')$ and

$$\Phi(p') = \frac{1}{\mathcal{D}(p')}\Big(e^{ip'\cdot(x-y)}u_k(-p') + \sum_{l\neq 0} e^{i(p'+l)\cdot(x-y)}u_k(-p'-l)\frac{\Delta(p')}{\Delta(p'+l)}\Big) \ . \tag{12.5}$$

*The terms $l \neq 0$ on $U$.* Let $p' \in U$ and $l \neq 0$, and let $\hat p$ be the representative of the real part of $p'+l$. The difference of $\hat p$ and the real part of $p'$ is a nonzero element of $2\pi\mathbb{Z}^4$, by Lemma 7.1(iv), so that one coordinate of $\hat p$ is at least $2\pi - \pi - \frac14$ in modulus, $|\hat p| \ge 2.8$, and by Lemma 12.1(iii), with $|\tau|^2 \le \frac14$,

$$\operatorname{Re}\Delta(p'+l) \ge \frac{4}{\pi^2}|\hat p|^2 - \frac12 \ge \frac{2}{\pi^2}|\hat p|^2 \ . \tag{12.6}$$

In particular $\mathsf{T}_*$ and $\mathcal{D}$ are analytic on $U$. We need three sums over the classes $l \neq 0$, for $\beta \in \{0, 1, 1+\alpha\}$:

$$\Sigma_\beta(p') \coloneqq \sum_{l\neq 0} |\hat p|^{\beta-2} \prod_\mu \min(1, \pi/|q_\mu|) \le C_\beta \ , \tag{12.7}$$

with constants $C_0$, $C_1$, and $C_{1+\alpha}$ which depend on nothing, respectively on $\alpha$. To see this, recall that $q$ is of the form $q_\mu = r_\mu + 2\pi n_\mu$ with $r$ the real part of $p'$ and integers $n_\mu$, and that every such $q$ belongs to 25 classes, one of them central. For the central class $\hat p = q$, the class is not zero only if $n \neq 0$, and then $|q_\mu| \geq 2\pi|n_\mu| - \pi - \frac14 \geq |n_\mu|$ and $|\hat p| \geq \max_\mu |n_\mu|$, so that the central classes contribute at most $\pi^4 \sum_{n\neq 0} (\max_\mu |n_\mu|)^{\beta-2} \prod_\mu \max(1,|n_\mu|)^{-1} \leq \pi^4 (\sum_{n\in\mathbb{Z}} \max(1,|n|)^{-1-(2-\beta)/4})^4$, which is finite for $\beta < 2$. For the other 24 classes the plane part of $\hat p$ is $(q_2, q_3) + \frac{2\pi}{5\eta} m$ with a nonzero $m \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$, and $|(q_2,q_3)| \leq \sqrt{2}\,\pi/(5\eta)$, so that $|\hat p| \geq (2-\sqrt{2})\pi/(5\eta) \geq 1/(3\eta)$; the number of the values of $n_\mu$ with $|q_\mu| \leq \pi/\eta$ is at most $1/\eta + 2$, and since $\pi/|q_\mu| \leq 2/|n_\mu|$ for $n_\mu \neq 0$, $\sum_{n_\mu} \min(1, \pi/|q_\mu|) \leq 5 + 4\log(2/\eta)$. These classes therefore contribute at most $24(3\eta)^{2-\beta}(5+4\log(2/\eta))^4$, which is bounded on $0 < \eta \leq 1$ for every $\beta < 2$. With (12.6), Lemma 12.1(i), and $\min(1,\pi/|q_\mu|)^2 \leq \min(1,\pi/|q_\mu|)$,

$$|\mathsf{T}_*(p')| \leq \frac{\pi^2}{2} e^{9/2}\, \Sigma_0(p') \leq C_* \coloneqq \frac{\pi^2}{2} e^{9/2} C_0 \tag{12.8}$$

for every $p' \in U$.

*The denominator.* Let $s \in [-\pi,\pi]^4$. Then $\Delta(s) \geq 0$, $\mathsf{T}_*(s) \geq 0$, and $u_k(s)u_k(-s) = |u_k(s)|^2 \geq c_u \coloneqq \frac14 (2/\pi)^8$ by (7.8), so that $\mathcal{D}(s) \geq a c_u$. Let $\tau \in \mathbb{R}^4$ with $|\tau_\mu| \leq \delta \leq \frac18$. The function $z \mapsto \mathsf{T}_*(s + z\tau/\delta)$ is analytic and bounded by $C_*$ on the disc $|z| < \frac14$, so that its derivative is at most $8C_*$ on the disc $|z| \leq \frac18$, and $|\mathsf{T}_*(s+i\tau) - \mathsf{T}_*(s)| \leq 8C_*\delta$. By Lemma 12.1(ii) and (i), $|u_k(s+i\tau)u_k(-s-i\tau) - |u_k(s)|^2| \leq 8\delta(e^{9/4}+1)$, and by Lemma 12.1(iii), with $|s| \leq 2\pi$ and $|\tau| \leq 2\delta$, $|\Delta(s+i\tau) - \Delta(s)| \leq 8\delta^2 + 16\pi\delta \leq 52\delta$ and $\Delta(s) \leq 4\pi^2$. Hence

$$|\mathcal{D}(s+i\tau) - \mathcal{D}(s)| \leq \delta(52(1+aC_*) + 32\pi^2 a C_* + 84a)\,, \tag{12.9}$$

and we let $\delta_0 \leq \frac18$ be so small that the right side with $\delta = \delta_0$ and $a = a_+$ is at most $\frac12 a_- c_u$. Then $|\mathcal{D}(s+i\tau)| \geq \frac12 a c_u$ whenever $|\tau_\mu| \leq \delta_0$, the function $\Phi$ is analytic in a neighbourhood of the set of these $s + i\tau$, by (12.5), and by its periodicity and Cauchy's theorem in each variable, $\int \Phi(s)\,\mathrm{d}s = \int \Phi(s+i\tau)\,\mathrm{d}s$ over $[-\pi,\pi]^4$.

*The bounds.* Let $\tau_\mu \coloneqq \delta_0$ if $x_\mu \geq y_\mu$ and $\tau_\mu \coloneqq -\delta_0$ otherwise, so that $|e^{i(s+i\tau+l)\cdot(x-y)}| = e^{-\delta_0 \sum_\mu |x_\mu - y_\mu|} \leq e^{-\delta_0|x-y|}$. For $p' = s + i\tau$ we have $|u_k(-p')| \leq e^{9/4}$, $|\Delta(p')| \leq 4\pi^2 + 1$, and, by (12.6) and Lemma 12.1(i), the sum over $l \neq 0$ in (12.5) is at most $(4\pi^2+1)\frac{\pi^2}{2} e^{9/4} \Sigma_0 e^{-\delta_0|x-y|}$. With (12.7) and the lower bound on $\mathcal{D}$ this is the first bound of (12.2). The difference operator $\partial'_\nu$ multiplies the term $l$ by $\eta^{-1}(e^{i\eta(p'+l)\cdot e'_\nu} - 1)$, which is at most $2(|\hat p|+1)$ in modulus because $|e^{iz} - 1| \leq |z| e^{|\mathrm{Im}\, z|}$; the term $l = 0$ stays bounded, and the terms $l \neq 0$ are bounded through $\Sigma_1$, which gives the second bound. For the third we may assume $|x' - y| \leq |x - y|$ and choose $\tau$ for the pair $(x', y)$. The difference of the two kernels has the terms of $(\partial'_\nu \mathcal{K})(x', y)$ multiplied by $e^{i(p'+l)\cdot(x-x')} - 1$, and for $|x - x'| \leq 1$ this factor is at most $2\min(2, (|\hat p|+1)|x-x'|) \leq 4(|\hat p|+1)^\alpha |x-x'|^\alpha$ in modulus. The terms $l \neq 0$ are then bounded through $\Sigma_{1+\alpha}$, with a constant which depends on $\alpha$. *q.e.d.*

The proposition replaces [1, (2.35), (2.36)] for the whole lattice. On a torus $T_\eta/\Gamma'$ the kernel is the sum of $\mathcal{K}(x, y+\gamma)$ over $\gamma \in \Gamma'$, which converges by (12.2).

## 13 The Equation of the Scales

The bounds on the scalar operator in the supremum and Hölder norms are obtained in [1] from the identity (2.34) there, which expresses the operator of $k$ steps through those of fewer steps and through operators on the intermediate lattices, and which is quoted from a paper

that is not among our sources. We derive it for the tilted run. Let $\ell_j := L^{j-k}$, $1 \le j \le k$, be the spacings of the lattices of the run in the unit of the last one, let $a > 0$, and put

$$\frac{1}{\alpha_j} := \frac{1}{a}\sum_{i=1}^{j} \ell_i^2 \,, \qquad P_{(j)} := Q'^{*}_{\ell_j} Q'_{\ell_j} \,, \qquad G_{(j)} := (-\Delta + \alpha_j P_{(j)})^{-1} \,, \tag{13.1}$$

on the functions on $T_\eta$, or on a torus $T_\eta/\Gamma'$. The adjoints are taken with the weights $\eta^4$ on $T_\eta$ and $\ell_j^4$ on $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$, so that $Q'_{\ell_j} Q'^{*}_{\ell_j} = I$ and $P_{(j)}$ is the orthogonal projection onto the functions which are constant on the blocks $B_{\ell_j}(y)$; the inverse exists by Lemma 8.3 for the scale $\ell_j$, as in Section 12. In the unit of the lattice $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$ the constant is $a_j := \alpha_j \ell_j^2$, with $1/a_j = a^{-1}\sum_{i=0}^{j-1} L^{-2i}$, so that $a(1-L^{-2}) \le a_j \le a$.

**Lemma 13.1** (The Equation of the Scales)**.** *For $1 \le j \le k-1$ let $Q'^{\mathrm{st}} := Q'^{\mathrm{st}}_{\ell_j,\ell_{j+1}}$ be Bałaban's average* (6.4) *from $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$ to $\ell_{j+1}\mathbb{Z}^4$, and let, on the functions on $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$,*

$$\Delta^{(j)} := \alpha_j - \alpha_j^2\, Q'_{\ell_j} G_{(j)} Q'^{*}_{\ell_j} \,, \qquad C^{(j)} := (\Delta^{(j)} + a\ell_{j+1}^{-2} Q'^{\mathrm{st}*} Q'^{\mathrm{st}})^{-1} \,. \tag{13.2}$$

*Then $\Delta^{(j)} \ge 0$, the inverse $C^{(j)}$ exists, and*

$$G_{(j+1)} = G_{(j)} + \alpha_j^2\, G_{(j)} Q'^{*}_{\ell_j} C^{(j)} Q'_{\ell_j} G_{(j)} \,, \qquad G_{(k)} = G_{(1)} + \sum_{j=1}^{k-1} \alpha_j^2\, G_{(j)} Q'^{*}_{\ell_j} C^{(j)} Q'_{\ell_j} G_{(j)} \,. \tag{13.3}$$

*Proof.* Write $\mathsf{q} := Q'_{\ell_j}$, $\Pi := Q'^{\mathrm{st}*} Q'^{\mathrm{st}}$, and $\beta := a\ell_{j+1}^{-2}$. By Lemma 6.3, $Q'_{\ell_{j+1}} = Q'^{\mathrm{st}}\mathsf{q}$, so that $P_{(j+1)} = \mathsf{q}^*\Pi\mathsf{q}$, and $\Pi$ is an orthogonal projection. By (13.1), $1/\alpha_{j+1} = 1/\alpha_j + 1/\beta$, that is, $\alpha_{j+1} = \alpha_j\beta/(\alpha_j+\beta)$. The operator $\alpha_j - \alpha_j^2(\alpha_j + \beta\Pi)^{-1}$ vanishes on the null space of $\Pi$ and is $\alpha_j - \alpha_j^2/(\alpha_j+\beta) = \alpha_{j+1}$ on its range, so that it is $\alpha_{j+1}\Pi$, and

$$G_{(j+1)}^{-1} = -\Delta + \alpha_{j+1}\mathsf{q}^*\Pi\mathsf{q} = G_{(j)}^{-1} - \alpha_j^2\, \mathsf{q}^*(\alpha_j + \beta\Pi)^{-1}\mathsf{q} \,. \tag{13.4}$$

For bounded operators $\mathsf{M}$, $\mathsf{K}$ with bounded inverses and a bounded operator $\mathsf{U}$ such that $\mathsf{M} - \mathsf{U}\mathsf{K}\mathsf{U}^*$ has a bounded inverse, $\mathsf{K}^{-1} - \mathsf{U}^*\mathsf{M}^{-1}\mathsf{U}$ has the bounded inverse $\mathsf{K} + \mathsf{K}\mathsf{U}^*(\mathsf{M} - \mathsf{U}\mathsf{K}\mathsf{U}^*)^{-1}\mathsf{U}\mathsf{K}$, and $(\mathsf{M} - \mathsf{U}\mathsf{K}\mathsf{U}^*)^{-1} = \mathsf{M}^{-1} + \mathsf{M}^{-1}\mathsf{U}(\mathsf{K}^{-1} - \mathsf{U}^*\mathsf{M}^{-1}\mathsf{U})^{-1}\mathsf{U}^*\mathsf{M}^{-1}$, as one checks by multiplication. We apply this with $\mathsf{M} = G_{(j)}^{-1}$, $\mathsf{U} = \alpha_j\mathsf{q}^*$, and $\mathsf{K} = (\alpha_j + \beta\Pi)^{-1}$, for which $\mathsf{M} - \mathsf{U}\mathsf{K}\mathsf{U}^* = G_{(j+1)}^{-1}$ by (13.4) and $\mathsf{K}^{-1} - \mathsf{U}^*\mathsf{M}^{-1}\mathsf{U} = \alpha_j + \beta\Pi - \alpha_j^2\mathsf{q}G_{(j)}\mathsf{q}^* = \Delta^{(j)} + \beta\Pi$. This gives the existence of $C^{(j)}$ and the first identity of (13.3), and the second follows by adding the first over $j$. Finally $G_{(j)}^{-1} \ge \alpha_j\mathsf{q}^*\mathsf{q}$ gives $\langle \mathsf{q}^*w, G_{(j)}\mathsf{q}^*w\rangle = \sup_\phi(2\langle w, \mathsf{q}\phi\rangle - \langle \phi, G_{(j)}^{-1}\phi\rangle) \le \sup_\phi(2\langle w, \mathsf{q}\phi\rangle - \alpha_j\|\mathsf{q}\phi\|^2) \le \|w\|^2/\alpha_j$, hence $\Delta^{(j)} \ge 0$. *q.e.d.*

The second identity of (13.3) is [1, (2.34)] for the whole lattice or a torus, with $G_{(1)}$ for the operator $C^{(0),\eta}$ there; the factor $(L^j\eta)^{-4}$ of that formula is contained in our adjoints. The operators $G_{(j)}$, $Q'_{\ell_j}$ are those of the tilted run at the scale $\ell_j$, to which Proposition 12.2 applies after a change of the unit of length, and the operators $C^{(j)}$ act on the lattices $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$ of the paper.

## 14 The Scalar Operator in the Supremum and Hölder Norms

With the equation of the scales and the kernel of Section 12 we obtain the bounds of [1, (1.9), (1.10)] for the whole lattice at the field $A = 0$, by the summation [1, (2.38), (2.39)]. This replaces Lemma 2.2 of that paper, which concerns a box, by a statement without a boundary;

the lattice in this section is $T_\eta$, and the statements hold on a torus $T_\eta/\Gamma'$ with the kernels summed over the periods. Two further inputs are needed, the decay of the kernels of $G_{(1)}$ and of $C^{(j)}$. Bałaban derives the second from his Proposition 2.3; we use that both are inverses of operators which are bounded below and have kernels of rapid decay.

**Lemma 14.1** (Inverses of Operators with Decaying Kernels)**.** *Let $Y$ be a countable set with a metric $d$, and let $\mathsf{M}$ be a bounded self-adjoint operator on the square-summable functions on $Y$, with the kernel $\mathsf{M}(y,y')$, such that $\mathsf{M} \geq \gamma > 0$ and, for some $\theta > 0$ and every $y$, $\sum_{y'} |\mathsf{M}(y,y')|(e^{\theta d(y,y')} - 1) \leq \frac{1}{2}\gamma$. Then $|\mathsf{M}^{-1}(y,y')| \leq (2/\gamma) e^{-\theta d(y,y')}$ for all $y, y' \in Y$.*

*Proof.* Fix $y_0 \in Y$ and $R > 0$, and let $w(y) \coloneqq \min(\theta d(y,y_0), R)$, a bounded function with $|w(y) - w(y')| \leq \theta d(y,y')$. The operator $\mathsf{M}_w \coloneqq e^w \mathsf{M} e^{-w}$ has the kernel $e^{w(y)-w(y')}\mathsf{M}(y,y')$, and the kernel of $\mathsf{M}_w - \mathsf{M}$ is at most $|\mathsf{M}(y,y')|(e^{\theta d(y,y')} - 1)$ in modulus, a bound which is symmetric in $y$ and $y'$; by the hypothesis and Schur's test $\|\mathsf{M}_w - \mathsf{M}\| \leq \frac{1}{2}\gamma$. Hence $\|\mathsf{M}_w \phi\| \geq \frac{1}{2}\gamma \|\phi\|$ for every $\phi$, and the same holds for the adjoint, so that $\mathsf{M}_w$ is invertible with $\|\mathsf{M}_w^{-1}\| \leq 2/\gamma$. Since $e^{\pm w}$ are bounded, $\mathsf{M}_w^{-1} = e^w \mathsf{M}^{-1} e^{-w}$, and $|\mathsf{M}^{-1}(y,y_0)| = e^{-w(y)+w(y_0)} |\mathsf{M}_w^{-1}(y,y_0)| \leq (2/\gamma) e^{-w(y)}$. Letting $R \to \infty$ gives the claim. *q.e.d.*

**Lemma 14.2** (The Operators of One Scale)**.** *Let $L \geq 64$ and $a > 0$. There are positive constants $c_1$, $\theta_1$, $c_C$, $\theta_C$, which depend on $a$ and $L$ and not on $k$, such that the kernel $g_1$ of $G_{(1)}$ and the kernels $\mathsf{C}_j$ of $C^{(j)}$, $1 \leq j \leq k-1$, with respect to the sums over the points of $T_\eta$ and of $\ell_j \mathbb{Z}^4$, satisfy*

$$|g_1(x,x')| \leq c_1 \eta^2 e^{-\theta_1 |x-x'|/\eta} , \qquad |\mathsf{C}_j(y,y')| \leq c_C \ell_j^2 e^{-\theta_C |y-y'|/\ell_j} . \tag{14.1}$$

*Proof.* For $g_1$, let $\mathsf{M} \coloneqq \eta^2(-\Delta + \alpha_1 P_{(1)})$ on the functions on $T_\eta$, with the metric $d(x,x') \coloneqq |x-x'|/\eta$. Since $\eta^2 \alpha_1 = a/L^2$, its kernel with respect to the sum over the points is 8 on the diagonal and $-1$ for the eight neighbours of a point, plus $(a/L^2)L^{-4}$ for two points of one block $B_{\ell_1}(y)$, whose distance $d$ is at most $2L$. By Lemma 8.3 for the scale $\ell_1 = L\eta$, $\mathsf{M} \geq L^{-2} \min(C_P^{-1}, a)$, and $\sum_{x'} |\mathsf{M}(x,x')|(e^{\theta d(x,x')} - 1) \leq 8(e^\theta - 1) + (a/L^2)(e^{2L\theta} - 1)$, which is at most half this lower bound for $\theta = \theta_1$ small. Lemma 14.1 and $G_{(1)} = \eta^2 \mathsf{M}^{-1}$ give the first bound.

For $\mathsf{C}_j$ we take $\ell_j$ as the unit of length. Then $T_\eta$ becomes the fine lattice of the spacing $L^{-j}$, $G_{(j)}$ becomes $\ell_j^2 G'$ with the operator $G'$ of Section 12 for the constant $a_j \in [a(1-L^{-2}), a]$, and $C^{(j)} = \ell_j^2 \mathsf{M}^{-1}$ with $\mathsf{M} \coloneqq a_j - a_j^2 Q' G' Q'^* + (a/L^2)\Pi$ on the functions on $\mathbb{Z}^4$, where $\Pi$ is the orthogonal projection onto the functions which are constant on the cubes of side $L$. The kernel of $Q'G'Q'^*$ is the average of $\mathcal{K}(x,y')$ over $x \in B_1(y)$, which by (12.2) is at most $c_0 e^{2\delta_0} e^{-\delta_0 |y-y'|}$ in modulus, and the kernel of $\Pi$ is $L^{-4}$ for two points of one cube. Hence $\sum_{y'} |\mathsf{M}(y,y')|(e^{\theta|y-y'|} - 1)$ tends to zero with $\theta$, uniformly in $k$ and $j$. For the lower bound we use the momentum representation: $Q'G'Q'^*$ is the multiplication by $\mathsf{T}(p')/(1 + a_j \mathsf{T}(p'))$, by the proof of Proposition 12.2, so that $a_j - a_j^2 Q'G'Q'^*$ is the multiplication by $a_j/(1 + a_j \mathsf{T}(p'))$, and $\mathsf{T} \leq C_\mathsf{T} \Delta_0^{-1}$ by Lemma 9.2, whose proof applies to the whole lattice. With $\Delta_0 \leq 16$ this gives $a_j - a_j^2 Q'G'Q'^* \geq c_\Delta \Delta_0$, $c_\Delta \coloneqq a_j/(16 + a_j C_\mathsf{T})$. The Laplace operator $\Delta_0$ of $\mathbb{Z}^4$ is at least the sum of those of the cubes of side $L$ with Neumann conditions, each of which is at least $2/L^2$ on the functions of mean zero by the inequality for the cube of the corners in the proof of Lemma 8.3. Therefore $\mathsf{M} \geq L^{-2} \min(2c_\Delta, a)$, and Lemma 14.1 gives the second bound after the return to the original unit. *q.e.d.*

**Proposition 14.3** (The Scalar Operator on the Whole Lattice)**.** *Let $L \geq 64$, so that $32L^{-j} \leq \frac{1}{2}$ for every $j \geq 1$, and let $a > 0$. There are constants $\delta > 0$ and $c$, and for every $\alpha \in [0,1)$ a*

*constant $c'_\alpha$, which depend on $a$ and $L$ and not on $k$, such that for every bounded function $f$ on $T_\eta$, all $x, x' \in T_\eta$ with $|x - x'| \le 1$, and every $\nu$,*

$$\begin{aligned} |(G_{(k)}f)(x)|\ ,\ |(\partial'_\nu G_{(k)}f)(x)| &\le c\, e^{-\delta \operatorname{dist}(x,\operatorname{supp} f)} \sup|f|\ , \\ |(\partial'_\nu G_{(k)}f)(x) - (\partial'_\nu G_{(k)}f)(x')| &\le c'_\alpha |x-x'|^\alpha e^{-\delta \operatorname{dist}(\{x,x'\},\operatorname{supp} f)} \sup|f|\ . \end{aligned} \tag{14.2}$$

*Proof.* By Lemma 13.1, $G_{(k)}f = G_{(1)}f + \sum_{j=1}^{k-1} \mathsf{T}_j f$ with $\mathsf{T}_j \coloneqq \alpha_j^2 G_{(j)} Q'^*_{\ell_j} C^{(j)} Q'_{\ell_j} G_{(j)}$. Let $\mathcal{K}_j(x,y)$, $x \in T_\eta$, $y \in \ell_j \mathbb{Z}^4$, be the kernel of $G_{(j)} Q'^*_{\ell_j}$. In the unit $\ell_j$ it is $\ell_j^2$ times the kernel of Proposition 12.2 for the constant $a_j$ and the fine spacing $L^{-j}$, so that, with the constants of that proposition for $a_- = a(1-L^{-2})$ and $a_+ = a$,

$$|\mathcal{K}_j(x,y)| \le c_0 \ell_j^2 e^{-\delta_0 |x-y|/\ell_j}\ , \qquad |(\partial'_\nu \mathcal{K}_j)(x,y)| \le c_0 \ell_j e^{-\delta_0 |x-y|/\ell_j}\ , \tag{14.3}$$

and $|(\partial'_\nu \mathcal{K}_j)(x,y) - (\partial'_\nu \mathcal{K}_j)(x',y)| \le c_\alpha \ell_j^{1-\alpha} |x-x'|^\alpha e^{-\delta_0 \min(|x-y|,|x'-y|)/\ell_j}$ for $|x-x'| \le \ell_j$; for $\ell_j < |x-x'| \le 1$ the same bound holds with $2c_0$ in place of $c_\alpha$, by the second bound of (14.3). With the weights of the adjoints, $(Q'_{\ell_j} G_{(j)} f)(y') = \ell_j^{-4} \sum_{x'} \eta^4 \mathcal{K}_j(x',y') f(x')$, and therefore

$$(\mathsf{T}_j f)(x) = \alpha_j^2 \sum_{y,y'} \mathcal{K}_j(x,y)\, \mathsf{C}_j(y,y')\, \ell_j^{-4} \sum_{x'} \eta^4 \mathcal{K}_j(x',y') f(x')\ . \tag{14.4}$$

The sums $\sum_{x'} \eta^4 e^{-\delta|x'-y'|/\ell_j}$ over $T_\eta$ and $\sum_y e^{-\delta|y-y'|/\ell_j}$ over $\ell_j \mathbb{Z}^4$ are at most a constant, depending on $\delta$, times $\ell_j^4$ and times 1, because $\eta \le \ell_j$. Taking half of each exponent for the summations and the other half for the decay, (14.3), (14.1), and $\alpha_j^2 = a_j^2 \ell_j^{-4}$ give

$$|(\mathsf{T}_j f)(x)| \le c'' \ell_j^{-4} \cdot \ell_j^2 \cdot \ell_j^2 \cdot \ell_j^{-4} \ell_j^4 \ell_j^2\, e^{-\delta \operatorname{dist}(x,\operatorname{supp} f)/\ell_j} \sup|f| = c'' \ell_j^2\, e^{-\delta \operatorname{dist}(x,\operatorname{supp} f)/\ell_j} \sup|f| \tag{14.5}$$

with $\delta \coloneqq \frac{1}{2}\min(\delta_0, \theta_C)$, and in the same way $|(\partial'_\nu \mathsf{T}_j f)(x)| \le c'' \ell_j e^{-\delta \operatorname{dist}(x,\operatorname{supp} f)/\ell_j} \sup|f|$ and the Hölder bound with the factor $\ell_j^{1-\alpha}|x-x'|^\alpha$. Since $\ell_j = L^{j-k} \le 1$, the sums over $j$ of $\ell_j^2$, $\ell_j$, and $\ell_j^{1-\alpha}$ are bounded uniformly in $k$, the last by a constant which depends on $\alpha$. For the first term, (14.1) gives $|(G_{(1)}f)(x)| \le c\eta^2 e^{-\theta_1 \operatorname{dist}(x,\operatorname{supp} f)/(2\eta)} \sup|f|$, the bound with $\eta$ in place of $\eta^2$ for its difference quotients, and, because two different points of $T_\eta$ are at least $\eta$ apart, the Hölder bound with the factor $2\eta^{1-\alpha}|x-x'|^\alpha$. *q.e.d.*

The proposition is [1, (1.9), (1.10)] for the whole lattice and $A = 0$, proved along [1, (2.38), (2.39)]. The constants depend on $L$, through Lemma 14.2, as Bałaban expects for the operators $C^{(j)}$ [1, p. 588].

The first paper on the propagators also needs the scalar operator applied to a derivative of the source, and, for sources which are Hölder continuous, two derivatives [2, (1.135)–(1.137), pp. 39–40]. We write $(\partial'^*_\nu f)(x) \coloneqq \eta^{-1}(f(x-\eta e'_\nu) - f(x))$ for the adjoint of $\partial'_\nu$, and for $0 < \epsilon \le 1$ we let $\|f\|_\epsilon$ be the supremum of $|f(x) - f(x')|/|x-x'|^\epsilon$ over the pairs of different points with $|x-x'| \le 1$, as in [2, (1.109)].

**Proposition 14.4** (Derivatives of the Source)**.** *Let $L \ge 64$ and $a > 0$, and let $\delta$ be as in Proposition 14.3. For $\alpha \in [0,1)$ and $\epsilon > 0$ with $\alpha + \epsilon < 1$ there are constants $c$, which depend on $a$, $L$, $\alpha$, and $\epsilon$ and not on $k$, such that for every bounded function $f$ on $T_\eta$, all $x, x' \in T_\eta$ with $|x-x'| \le 1$, and all $\nu$, $\nu'$, with $D \coloneqq \operatorname{dist}(\{x,x'\}, \operatorname{supp} f)$,*

*(i)* $|(G_{(k)}\partial'^*_\nu f)(x)| \le c\, e^{-\delta D} \sup|f|$ *and* $|(G_{(k)}\partial'^*_\nu f)(x) - (G_{(k)}\partial'^*_\nu f)(x')| \le c|x - x'|^\alpha e^{-\delta D} \sup|f|$*;*

*(ii)* $|(\partial'_{\nu'} G_{(k)} \partial'^*_{\nu} f)(x)| \le c\, e^{-\delta D/2} (\|f\|_\epsilon + \sup|f|)$;

*(iii)* $|(\partial'_{\nu'} G_{(k)} \partial'^*_{\nu} f)(x) - (\partial'_{\nu'} G_{(k)} \partial'^*_{\nu} f)(x')| \le c|x-x'|^\alpha e^{-\delta D/2} (\|f\|_{\alpha+\epsilon} + \sup|f|)$.

*Proof.* We use the decomposition of the proof of Proposition 14.3. By a summation by parts, $\sum_{x'} \eta^4 \mathcal{K}_j(x',y')(\partial'^*_\nu f)(x') = \sum_{x'} \eta^4 (\partial'_\nu \mathcal{K}_j)(x',y') f(x')$, so that $\mathsf{T}_j \partial'^*_\nu f$ is (14.4) with $\partial'_\nu \mathcal{K}_j$ in place of the last kernel. By (14.3) this replaces one factor $\ell_j^2$ of (14.5) by $\ell_j$: $|(\mathsf{T}_j \partial'^*_\nu f)(x)| \le c'' \ell_j e^{-\delta D/\ell_j} \sup|f|$, and the difference of the values at $x$ and $x'$ is at most $c'' \min(2\ell_j, |x-x'|) e^{-\delta D/\ell_j} \sup|f| \le 2c'' \ell_j^{1-\alpha} |x-x'|^\alpha e^{-\delta D/\ell_j} \sup|f|$, by the bound on $\partial' \mathcal{K}_j$. The sums over $j$ of $\ell_j$ and $\ell_j^{1-\alpha}$ are bounded, which gives (i) for these terms.

For (ii) and (iii), $(\partial'_{\nu'} \mathsf{T}_j \partial'^*_\nu f)(x) = \sum_{x''} \eta^4 k_j(x,x'') f(x'')$ with the kernel

$$k_j(x,x'') := \alpha_j^2 \ell_j^{-4} \sum_{y,y'} (\partial'_{\nu'} \mathcal{K}_j)(x,y)\, \mathsf{C}_j(y,y')\, (\partial'_\nu \mathcal{K}_j)(x'',y') \;, \tag{14.6}$$

for which (14.3), its Hölder counterpart, and (14.1) give, as in (14.5),

$$\begin{aligned} |k_j(x,x'')| &\le c'' \ell_j^{-4} e^{-\delta |x-x''|/\ell_j} \;, \\ |k_j(x,x'') - k_j(x',x'')| &\le c'' \ell_j^{-4} \Big( \frac{|x-x'|}{\ell_j} \Big)^\alpha e^{-\delta \min(|x-x''|, |x'-x''|)/\ell_j} \;, \end{aligned} \tag{14.7}$$

the second for $|x-x'| \le \ell_j$. Since $\partial'^*_\nu$ annihilates the constants and the sums converge absolutely, $\sum_{x''} \eta^4 k_j(x,x'') = 0$ for every $x$. Hence $(\partial'_{\nu'} \mathsf{T}_j \partial'^*_\nu f)(x) = \sum_{x''} \eta^4 k_j(x,x'') (f(x'') - f(x))$. Here $|f(x'') - f(x)| \le \|f\|_\epsilon |x-x''|^\epsilon$ for $|x-x''| \le 1$ and $|f(x'') - f(x)| \le 2 \sup|f|$ otherwise, and $\sum_{x''} \eta^4 \ell_j^{-4} e^{-\delta|x-x''|/\ell_j} |x-x''|^\epsilon$ is at most a constant times $\ell_j^\epsilon$, as is $e^{-\delta/(2\ell_j)}$. This gives $|(\partial'_{\nu'} \mathsf{T}_j \partial'^*_\nu f)(x)| \le c\, \ell_j^\epsilon (\|f\|_\epsilon + \sup|f|)$, with a sum over $j$ which is bounded. If $D \ge 1$, then $f$ vanishes at $x$ and the first bound of (14.7) gives directly $|(\partial'_{\nu'} \mathsf{T}_j \partial'^*_\nu f)(x)| \le c\, e^{-\delta D/(2\ell_j)} \sup|f|$, and $\sum_j e^{-\delta D/(2\ell_j)} \le e^{-\delta D/2} \sum_{i \ge 0} e^{-\delta(L^i-1)/2}$. The two cases give (ii). For (iii), the vanishing of the sums of $k_j(x,\cdot)$ and of $k_j(x',\cdot)$ gives

$$(\partial'_{\nu'} \mathsf{T}_j \partial'^*_\nu f)(x) - (\partial'_{\nu'} \mathsf{T}_j \partial'^*_\nu f)(x') = \sum_{x''} \eta^4 (k_j(x,x'') - k_j(x',x''))(f(x'') - f(x)) \;. \tag{14.8}$$

For $|x-x'| \le \ell_j$ the second bound of (14.7) and the estimate of the sum, with $\alpha+\epsilon$ in place of $\epsilon$, bound this by $c(|x-x'|/\ell_j)^\alpha \ell_j^{\alpha+\epsilon} (\|f\|_{\alpha+\epsilon} + \sup|f|)$; for $|x-x'| > \ell_j$ the two terms are bounded separately by $c\, \ell_j^{\alpha+\epsilon} \le c|x-x'|^\alpha \ell_j^\epsilon$ times the same norms. For $D \ge 1$ the decay is obtained as in (ii), with $\sum_i L^{i\alpha} e^{-\delta(L^i-1)/2} < \infty$.

The term $G_{(1)}$ is treated in the same way with $\eta$ in place of $\ell_j$: by (14.1) the kernels of $G_{(1)} \partial'^*_\nu$ and of $\partial'_{\nu'} G_{(1)} \partial'^*_\nu$ with respect to the weights $\eta^4$ are at most a constant times $\eta^{-3} e^{-\theta_1 |x-x''|/(2\eta)}$ and $\eta^{-4} e^{-\theta_1 |x-x''|/(2\eta)}$, the second has vanishing sums over $x''$, and two different points are at least $\eta$ apart. *q.e.d.*

Statement (ii) is [2, (1.137)], and (i) and (iii) are the corresponding bounds for the scalar operator in [2, (1.111), (1.113)].

## 15 The Kernel of the Gauge-Fixing Projection

The operator $\Delta_a$ of [2, (1.69)] contains the nonlocal term $\partial P \partial^*$, and the passage from $L^2$-bounds to bounds in the supremum norm needs the bounds [2, (1.126), (1.127)] on its kernel.

Bałaban refers for them to the representation [2, (1.44)], $P = G'Q_k'^*(Q_k'G'^2Q_k'^*)^{-1}Q_k'G'$, to [1, Lemma 2.4], and to the analyticity of the momentum representation [2, (1.45)]. In the tilted run the first two are available by Proposition 12.2, and for the inverse in the middle we use Lemma 14.1.

**Lemma 15.1** (The Kernel of $\partial P\partial^*$)**.** *Let $32\eta \le \frac{1}{2}$, let $a > 0$, and let $G'$ and $\mathcal{K}$ be as in Section 12. The operator $\mathsf{N} := Q_k'G'^2Q_k'^*$ on the square-summable functions on $\mathbb{Z}^4$ has a bounded inverse, $P := G'Q_k'^*\mathsf{N}^{-1}Q_k'G'$ is the orthogonal projection onto the orthogonal complement of $\Delta N(Q_k')$, and for every field $A$ of finite support*

$$\begin{aligned}(\partial P\partial^* A)_\nu(x) &= \sum_{\nu'}\sum_{x'} \eta^4 \varpi_{\nu\nu'}(x,x')A_{\nu'}(x')\;,\\ \varpi_{\nu\nu'}(x,x') &:= \sum_{y,y'} (\partial'_\nu\mathcal{K})(x,y)\,\mathsf{N}^{-1}(y,y')\,(\partial'_{\nu'}\mathcal{K})(x',y')\;.\end{aligned} \tag{15.1}$$

*There are constants $c_\varpi$ and $\delta_\varpi > 0$, and for $\alpha \in [0,1)$ a constant $c_{\varpi,\alpha}$, which depend on $a$ and not on $k$ and $L$, such that for $|x-x'| \le 1$*

$$\begin{aligned}|\varpi_{\nu\nu'}(x,x'')| &\le c_\varpi e^{-\delta_\varpi|x-x''|}\;,\\ |\varpi_{\nu\nu'}(x,x'') - \varpi_{\nu\nu'}(x',x'')| &\le c_{\varpi,\alpha}|x-x'|^\alpha e^{-\delta_\varpi \min(|x-x''|,|x'-x''|)}\;.\end{aligned} \tag{15.2}$$

*Proof.* With the weights of Section 12, $(Q_k'G'f)(y) = \sum_x \eta^4\mathcal{K}(x,y)f(x)$, so that $\mathsf{N}$ has the kernel $\mathsf{N}(y,y') = \sum_x \eta^4\mathcal{K}(x,y)\mathcal{K}(x,y')$, which by (12.2) is at most a constant times $e^{-\delta_0|y-y'|/2}$ in modulus. In the momentum representation $\mathsf{N}$ is the multiplication by $\sum_l |u_k(p'+l)|^2\Delta(p'+l)^{-2}(1+a\mathsf{T}(p'))^{-2}$, by the proof of Proposition 12.2, and the term $l=0$ of this sum is $|u_k(p')|^2/\mathcal{D}(p')^2$ with $\mathcal{D}$ of (12.4). For real $p' \in [-\pi,\pi]^4$ we have $\mathcal{D}(p') \le 4\pi^2(1+aC_*)+a$ by (12.8) and $|u_k(p')|^2 \ge c_u$, so that $\mathsf{N} \ge \gamma_\mathsf{N} := c_u(4\pi^2(1+aC_*)+a)^{-2}$. Lemma 14.1 gives $|\mathsf{N}^{-1}(y,y')| \le (2/\gamma_\mathsf{N})e^{-\theta_\mathsf{N}|y-y'|}$ with a $\theta_\mathsf{N} > 0$ which depends on $a$ only.

The operator $P$ is self-adjoint, and $P^2 = P$ because $Q_k'G'G'Q_k'^* = \mathsf{N}$. Its range is the range of $G'Q_k'^*$, whose orthogonal complement consists of the $f$ with $Q_k'G'f = 0$, that is, of the $f = (-\Delta + aQ_k'^*Q_k')\lambda = -\Delta\lambda$ with $Q_k'\lambda = 0$. This is the second assertion, and $P$ is the operator of [2, (1.38), (1.44)]. For a field $A$ of finite support, $\partial^*A = \sum_{\nu'}\partial'^*_{\nu'}A_{\nu'}$, and a summation by parts gives $(Q_k'G'\partial^*A)(y') = \sum_{\nu'}\sum_{x'}\eta^4(\partial'_{\nu'}\mathcal{K})(x',y')A_{\nu'}(x')$; applying $\mathsf{N}^{-1}$, then $G'Q_k'^*$ with its kernel $\mathcal{K}$, and $\partial'_\nu$ gives (15.1). The bounds (15.2) follow from (12.2) and the bound on $\mathsf{N}^{-1}$ by summation over $y$ and $y'$, with $\delta_\varpi := \frac{1}{2}\min(\delta_0,\theta_\mathsf{N})$. *q.e.d.*

The bounds (15.2) are [2, (1.126), (1.127)].

## 16 Proposition 1.2 for the Tilted Run

We can now prove the bounds of [2, Proposition 1.2] on the operator $G = \Delta_a^{-1}$ in the supremum and Hölder norms, with their exponential decay. Bałaban derives the decay from an expansion of $G$ over a partition of unity [2, (1.119)–(1.131)], whose terms contain the commutators of the averages with functions. We obtain it more directly, from the stability of the lower bound (9.2) under the conjugation with an exponential weight, the method which he mentions first [2, p. 36]; the passage from $L^2$ to the supremum norm is then his, through the identities [2, (1.132), (1.133)].

In this section the lattice is a torus $T_\eta/\Gamma'$ with $\Gamma' \subset \mathbb{Z}^4$, $d(x,x')$ is the distance on it, and $L \ge 64$. The operators of the whole lattice with the kernels of Sections 12–15 act on

the bounded functions, and they map periodic functions to periodic functions; since each of them is the inverse, or is built from inverses, of operators which are bounded below on the torus as on the whole lattice, their restrictions to the periodic functions are the corresponding operators of the torus. Propositions 14.3 and 14.4 and Lemma 15.1 therefore apply to the torus, with sums over the points of $T_\eta$ and with the distance to the periodic support, which is the distance on the torus. For a subset $X$ of the torus, $\|\cdot\|_X$ is the $L^2$-norm over the points, or the bonds starting, in $X$, and $\Delta(y) \coloneqq B_1(y)$ is the unit block of $y \in \mathbb{Z}^4$. We write $\|A\|_1^2 \coloneqq \langle A, (\Delta + I)A\rangle = \|\nabla A\|^2 + \|A\|^2$, and for a tuple $J = (J_\nu)$ of fields, $\nabla^* J \coloneqq \sum_\nu \partial'^*_\nu J_\nu$.

**Lemma 16.1** (Decay in $L^2$)**.** *Let $a > 0$. There are constants $\theta_0 > 0$ and $C$, which depend on $a$ and not on $k$, $L$, and the torus, such that for all $y, y' \in \mathbb{Z}^4$ and every field $J$, or tuple of fields $J$, supported in the bonds starting in $\{x \,|\, d(x, y') \le 2\}$,*

$$\begin{aligned} \|GJ\|_{\Delta(y)} + \|\nabla GJ\|_{\Delta(y)} &\le Ce^{-\theta_0 d(y,y')}\|J\| \,, \\ \|G\nabla^* J\|_{\Delta(y)} + \|\nabla G\nabla^* J\|_{\Delta(y)} &\le Ce^{-\theta_0 d(y,y')}\|J\| \,. \end{aligned} \tag{16.1}$$

*The same holds for $G_0 \coloneqq (\Delta + aQ_k^* Q_k)^{-1}$ in place of $G$.*

*Proof.* Let $w$ be a real function on the torus with $|w(x) - w(x')| \le \theta d(x, x')$, $\theta \le \frac14$, acting on a field by multiplication with its value at the starting point of the positive bond. We compare the forms of $e^w \Delta_a e^{-w}$ and of $\Delta_a$, term by term.

For the Laplace operator, $\langle A', e^w \Delta e^{-w} A\rangle = \sum_\nu \langle \partial'_\nu(e^w A'), \partial'_\nu(e^{-w}A)\rangle$. With $\varsigma \coloneqq w(x + \eta e'_\nu) - w(x)$, $|\varsigma| \le \theta\eta$, we have $\partial'_\nu(e^{\pm w} g)(x) = e^{\pm w(x)}(e^{\pm\varsigma}(\partial'_\nu g)(x) + \eta^{-1}(e^{\pm\varsigma} - 1)g(x))$, where $e^{|\varsigma|} \le 2$ and $\eta^{-1}|e^{\pm\varsigma} - 1| \le 2\theta$. The product of the two derivatives therefore differs from $(\partial'_\nu A')(\partial'_\nu A)$ by at most $4\theta(|\partial'_\nu A'||A| + |A'||\partial'_\nu A|) + 4\theta^2|A'||A|$ at every bond, and summing gives $|\langle A', (e^w \Delta e^{-w} - \Delta)A\rangle| \le 16\theta \|A'\|_1 \|A\|_1$.

For the average, $\langle A', e^w Q_k^* Q_k e^{-w} A\rangle = \sum_c (Q_k e^w A')(c)(Q_k e^{-w} A)(c)$, and for a bond $c$ from $y$ the two factors may be replaced by $Q_k(e^{w-w(y)}A')(c)$ and $Q_k(e^{-(w-w(y))}A)(c)$. The bonds which enter the average at $c$ start at a distance of at most 4 from $y$, so that $|e^{\pm(w-w(y))} - 1| \le e^{4\theta} - 1 \le 8\theta$ on them, and by the estimate in the proof of Lemma 9.1(i), which bounds the square of each average by a sum over its own bonds, $|\langle A', (e^w Q_k^* Q_k e^{-w} - Q_k^* Q_k)A\rangle| \le (32\theta + 128\theta^2)\|A'\|\|A\| \le 64\theta\|A'\|\|A\|$.

For the projection, $e^w \partial P \partial^* e^{-w} - \partial P \partial^*$ has the kernel $\varpi(x, x')(e^{w(x)-w(x')} - 1)$ with respect to the sums over the points of $T_\eta$ with the weights $\eta^4$, and $|e^{w(x)-w(x')} - 1| \le \theta|x - x'|e^{\theta|x-x'|}$. For $\theta \le \frac12 \delta_\varpi$, (15.2) and Schur's test bound its norm by $C_\varpi \theta$, with $C_\varpi \coloneqq 4c_\varpi \sup_x \sum_{x'} \eta^4 |x - x'| e^{-\delta_\varpi |x-x'|/2}$, which is finite and bounded uniformly in $\eta$.

Together, $|\langle A', (e^w \Delta_a e^{-w} - \Delta_a)A\rangle| \le C_w \theta \|A'\|_1 \|A\|_1$ with $C_w \coloneqq 16 + 64a + C_\varpi$. Let $\theta_0 \coloneqq \min(\frac14, \frac12\delta_\varpi, \gamma_0/(2C_w))$ with $\gamma_0$ of (9.2), and let $\theta \le \theta_0$. Then $\langle F, e^w \Delta_a e^{-w} F\rangle \ge \frac12 \gamma_0 \|F\|_1^2$ for every $F$, so that $e^w \Delta_a e^{-w}$ is invertible, and its inverse $G_w = e^w G e^{-w}$ satisfies $\|G_w J\|_1 \le (2/\gamma_0)\|J\|$ and, because $|\langle F, \nabla^* J\rangle| \le \|F\|_1 \|J\|$, also $\|G_w \nabla^* J\|_1 \le (2/\gamma_0)\|J\|$.

Now let $w(x) \coloneqq \theta_0 \max(0, d(x, y') - 3)$. It vanishes on the points at a distance of at most 3 from $y'$, hence on the supports of $J$ and of $\nabla^* J$, so that $GJ = e^{-w} G_w J$ and $G\nabla^* J = e^{-w} G_w \nabla^* J$; and $w \ge \theta_0(d(y, y') - 5)$ on $\Delta(y)$. Since $|\partial'_\nu(e^{-w}F)| \le 2e^{-w}(|\partial'_\nu F| + \theta_0|F|)$ by the formula above, this gives (16.1) with $C \coloneqq 8e^{5\theta_0}/\gamma_0$. For $G_0$ the term with the projection is absent, and the lower bound is $\Delta + aQ_k^* Q_k \ge \min(a/4, (2C_P + 65)^{-1})(\Delta + I)$, by Lemma 9.1(iv). *q.e.d.*

The lemma is [2, (1.114)] for the first derivatives.

**Proposition 16.2** (Proposition 1.2 for the Tilted Run)**.** *Let $L \geq 64$ and $a > 0$. For $\alpha \in [0,1)$ and $\epsilon > 0$ with $\alpha + \epsilon < 1$ there are constants $c$ and $\delta_G > 0$, which depend on $a$, $L$, $\alpha$, and $\epsilon$ and not on $k$ and the torus, such that for every bounded field $J$, or tuple of fields $J$, all points $x$, $x'$ with $d(x,x') \leq 1$, and $D := d(\{x,x'\}, \operatorname{supp} J)$,*

*(i)* $|(GJ)(x)|$, $|(\nabla GJ)(x)|$, $|(G\nabla^* J)(x)|$, *and* $|(\Delta GJ)(x)|$ *are at most* $c\, e^{-\delta_G D} \sup|J|$;

*(ii) the differences of the values of* $\nabla GJ$, *and of* $G\nabla^* J$, *at* $x$ *and* $x'$ *are at most* $c\, d(x,x')^\alpha e^{-\delta_G D} \sup|J|$ *in modulus;*

*(iii)* $|(\nabla G \nabla^* J)(x)| \leq c\, e^{-\delta_G D}(\|J\|_\epsilon + \sup|J|)$;

*(iv)* $|(\nabla G\nabla^* J)(x) - (\nabla G\nabla^* J)(x')| \leq c\, d(x,x')^\alpha e^{-\delta_G D}(\|J\|_{\alpha+\epsilon} + \sup|J|)$.

*Here the values of a field at a point are those on the positive bonds from it, and the Hölder norms are those of its components.*

*Proof.* Throughout, $c$ and $\delta > 0$ denote constants with the dependence stated, which may change from line to line; sums of exponentials $\sum_{y'} e^{-\delta d(y,y')} e^{-\delta' \operatorname{dist}(y',X)}$ over the unit lattice are bounded by a constant times $e^{-\min(\delta,\delta')\operatorname{dist}(y,X)/2}$.

*Two local bounds.* For a field $F$ and $y \in \mathbb{Z}^4$ let $X_y$ be the set of the points at a distance of at most 9 from $y$, which contains every bond entering the following estimate: a bond of $\Delta(y)$ lies on staircases from points at a distance of less than 2 from it, these points lie in blocks whose corners are at a distance of less than 2 from them, and the staircases from a block stay within the distance 4 of its corner. First, with $P' := Q_k'^* Q_k'$ acting on each component,

$$\sup_{\Delta(y)} |(P' - Q_k^* Q_k)F| \leq 3 \|F\|_{X_y} \,. \tag{16.2}$$

Indeed $P'F$ is on $\Delta(y)$ the mean of each component of $F$ over this block, at most $\|F\|_{\Delta(y)}$ in modulus. By the proof of Lemma 6.4(ii), the value of $Q_k^* B$ on a bond of $T_\eta$ is $\eta$ times a signed sum of at most $\frac{7}{5\eta}$ values of $B$, on bonds of the unit lattice from the corners of the blocks of the points whose staircases contain the bond; and by the estimate in the proof of Lemma 9.1(i) each value $(Q_k F)(c)$ is at most $\frac{7}{5}$ times the $L^2$-norm of $F$ over the bonds of the staircases from the block of $c$. Second, by (15.1), (15.2), and the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality on each block,

$$\sup_{\Delta(y)} |\partial P \partial^* F| \leq c \sum_{y'} e^{-\delta_\varpi |y-y'|} \|F\|_{\Delta(y')} \,, \tag{16.3}$$

the sum over the unit lattice of the whole space, with $F$ periodic.

*The operator $G_0$.* Let $G'$ be the scalar operator $G_{(k)}$ of Section 13 for the constant $a$, acting on each component of a field. Then $G'^{-1} - G_0^{-1} = a(P' - Q_k^* Q_k)$, hence

$$G_0 = G' + aG'(P' - Q_k^* Q_k) G_0 \,, \tag{16.4}$$

which is [2, (1.133)] with the same constant $a$ in both operators. Let $J$ be bounded, and decompose it into its restrictions $J_{y'}$ to the bonds starting in the blocks $\Delta(y')$, so that $\|J_{y'}\| \leq 2 \sup|J|$. By Lemma 16.1 for $G_0$ and (16.2), the field $h := a(P' - Q_k^* Q_k) G_0 J$ satisfies $\sup_{\Delta(y)} |h| \leq c \sum_{y'} e^{-\theta_0 d(y,y')} \sup_{\Delta(y')} |J| \leq c\, e^{-\delta \operatorname{dist}(y, \operatorname{supp} J)} \sup|J|$. Applying Proposition 14.3 to $J$ and to the restrictions of $h$ to the blocks, and summing, we obtain the bounds (i) and (ii) for $G_0 J$ and $\nabla G_0 J$. For a tuple $J$ we use (16.4) on $\nabla^* J$: the first term $G'\nabla^* J$ and its derivatives are bounded by Proposition 14.4, and in the second term $h := a(P' - Q_k^* Q_k) G_0 \nabla^* J$

is bounded as before, by the second half of (16.1), so that $G'h$ and $\nabla G'h$ are bounded by Proposition 14.3. This gives (i)–(iv) for $G_0$ in place of $G$, except the bound on $\Delta G_0 J$.

*The operator G.* Since $G_0^{-1} - G^{-1} = \partial P \partial^*$, we have $G = G_0 + G_0 \partial P \partial^* G$, which is [2, (1.132)]. For a bounded field $J$, Lemma 16.1 for $G$, applied to the restrictions $J_{y'}$, gives $\|GJ\|_{\Delta(y)} \le c\, e^{-\delta \operatorname{dist}(y, \operatorname{supp} J)} \sup|J|$, and then (16.3) gives the same bound for $\sup_{\Delta(y)}|g|$, $g := \partial P \partial^* G J$. The bounds for $G_0$, applied to $J$ and to the restrictions of $g$ to the blocks, give (i) and (ii) for $GJ$ and $\nabla GJ$. For a tuple $J$ the same argument with $\nabla^* J$ in place of $J$, the second half of (16.1), and the bounds for $G_0 \nabla^* J$ and $\nabla G_0 \nabla^* J$ give the bounds for $G \nabla^* J$ and (iii), (iv); in $\nabla G_0 g$ with $g := \partial P \partial^* G \nabla^* J$ only the first derivative of $G_0$ on a bounded field enters. Finally $\Delta G = I + \partial P \partial^* G - a Q_k^* Q_k G$, and the last two terms applied to $J$ are bounded in the supremum norm by (16.3), by the bound on $Q_k^* Q_k F$ in the proof of (16.2), and by the decay of $\|GJ\|_{\Delta(y)}$. *q.e.d.*

The proposition has the content of [2, (1.110)–(1.113)], with pointwise conditions on the supports in place of the cubes $\tilde{\Delta}(y)$ and the functions $\zeta$ there, and with constants which depend on $L$. With it, Proposition 9.3, and Lemma 16.1, the results of [2] on the operator $G$ hold in the tilted run, with one exception, the bounds [2, (1.114)] on the second derivatives in $L^2$ with their decay. These are proved in the next section, together with the statements of [2] on the minimiser $H_k$ and on the commutators of the averages with functions.

## 17 The Remaining Statements of the First Paper

Three statements of [2] were left aside in Section 10: the bounds on the minimiser $H_k$, the second derivatives in [2, (1.114)], and the commutators of the averages with functions, from which Bałaban builds his expansions. The second paper on the propagators uses all three, and we settle them here. For the first, Bałaban writes $Q_k G Q_k^*$ in the form [2, (1.99)] and reads its bounds off from the components [2, (1.101)], which are not available for the matrices of the tilted run. We use instead that the inverse of $Q_k G Q_k^*$ is the action $\Delta_k$ plus a constant, a fact which follows from the two variational problems defining these operators and does not involve the momentum representation.

The setting is that of Section 16: a torus $T_\eta/\Gamma'$, $L \ge 64$, $a > 0$, and $G = \Delta_a^{-1}$. For a positive bond $c = \langle y, y + e_\mu \rangle$ of the unit lattice we write $c_- := y$ and $d(c, c') := d(c_-, c'_-)$, we let $\delta_c$ be the field which is 1 at $c$ and 0 at the other positive bonds, and we put $J_c := Q_k^* \delta_c$. The kernel of an operator $\mathsf{M}$ on the fields of the unit lattice is $\mathsf{M}(c, c') := \langle \delta_c, \mathsf{M} \delta_{c'} \rangle$. By (6.3) and the weights of the adjoint, the value of $J_c$ at a positive bond $b$ of $T_\eta$ is $\eta$ times the number of the points $x \in B_1(c_-)$ whose staircase $\sigma_\mu^1(x)$ contains $b$, minus the number of those whose staircase contains $b^{-1}$. Hence

$$\sup|J_c| \le \tfrac{7}{5}\,, \qquad \|J_c\|^2 \le 2\,, \tag{17.1}$$

by the count in the proof of Lemma 9.1 and by part (i) of that lemma, and $J_c$ vanishes at the bonds which start at a distance of 4 or more from $c_-$.

**Lemma 17.1** (The Operator $Q_k G Q_k^*$)**.** *Let $\gamma_0$ and $\gamma_\phi$ be the constants of Proposition 9.3.*

*(i) $Q_k$ maps the fields on $T_\eta/\Gamma'$ onto the fields on the unit lattice, $Q_k G Q_k^*$ is invertible, and $(Q_k G Q_k^*)^{-1} = \Delta_k + a$. The minimiser is $H_k = G Q_k^* (\Delta_k + a)$.*

*(ii) $(a + 24\gamma_\phi^{-1})^{-1} \le Q_k G Q_k^* \le a^{-1}$ and $Q_k Q_k^* \ge c_Q := \gamma_0 (a + 24\gamma_\phi^{-1})^{-1}$.*

*(iii) There are constants $C$ and $\theta > 0$, which depend on $a$ and not on $k$, $L$, and the torus, such that $|(Q_k G Q_k^*)(c,c')| \le C e^{-\theta d(c,c')}$ and $|(\Delta_k + a)(c,c')| \le C e^{-\theta d(c,c')}$ for all positive bonds $c$, $c'$ of the unit lattice.*

*Proof.* (i) For every field $B$ on the unit lattice the last part of the proof of Proposition 9.3 exhibits a field $A$ with $Q_k A = B$, so that $Q_k$ is onto and $Q_k^*$ is injective; since $G$ is positive definite, so is $Q_k G Q_k^*$. Fix $B$ and consider the minimum of $\langle A, \Delta_a A\rangle$ over the fields with $Q_k A = B$. It is attained at one field $A_0$, and $\Delta_a A_0$ is orthogonal to the null space of $Q_k$, hence of the form $Q_k^*\omega$. Then $A_0 = G Q_k^*\omega$, the constraint gives $\omega = (Q_k G Q_k^*)^{-1} B$, and the minimum is $\langle A_0, \Delta_a A_0\rangle = \langle \omega, Q_k G Q_k^* \omega\rangle = \langle B, (Q_k G Q_k^*)^{-1} B\rangle$. On the other hand, $\langle A, \Delta_a A\rangle = \|\partial A\|^2 + \|R\partial^* A\|^2 + a\|B\|^2$ on these fields, and by the gauge transformation in the proof of Proposition 9.3 every such field has a companion $A_s$ with $Q_k A_s = B$, $\partial A_s = \partial A$, and $R\partial^* A_s = 0$. The minimum is therefore $a\|B\|^2$ plus the minimum of $\|\partial A\|^2$ over the fields with $Q_k A = B$, which is $\langle B, \Delta_k B\rangle$ by the same proof, and it is attained at a field with $R\partial^* A = 0$, that is, at $H_k B$. Two quadratic forms which agree define the same operator.

(ii) By (9.4), $0 \le \langle B, \Delta_k B\rangle \le \gamma_\phi^{-1} \|\partial_1 B\|^2$, and $\|\partial_1 B\|^2 \le 24 \|B\|^2$, because the value of $\partial_1 B$ at a plaquette is a signed sum of four values of $B$ and a bond lies in six plaquettes. With (i) this gives the bounds on $Q_k G Q_k^*$. By (9.2), $G \le \gamma_0^{-1}$, so that $(a + 24\gamma_\phi^{-1})^{-1} \|\omega\|^2 \le \langle Q_k^*\omega, G Q_k^*\omega\rangle \le \gamma_0^{-1} \|Q_k^*\omega\|^2$.

(iii) We have $(Q_k G Q_k^*)(c,c') = \langle J_c, G J_{c'}\rangle$. A point at a distance of less than 4 from $c_-$ lies in a block $\Delta(y'')$ with $d(y'', c_-) \le 6$, and there are at most $13^4$ such blocks. Let $J_{c,y''}$ be the restriction of $J_c$ to the bonds which start in $\Delta(y'')$, so that $J_c$ is the sum of these restrictions and $\|J_{c,y''}\|^2 \le 2$ by (17.1). Lemma 16.1 gives $|\langle J_{c,y''}, G J_{c',y'''}\rangle| \le 2 C_0 e^{-\theta_0 d(y'', y''')}$ with the constant $C_0$ of that lemma, and $d(y'', y''') \ge d(c,c') - 12$; summing over the pairs of blocks we obtain the first bound, with $\theta = \theta_0$. For the second we apply Lemma 14.1 to $\mathsf{M} := Q_k G Q_k^*$ on the set of the positive bonds of the unit lattice with the function $d(c,c')$, which vanishes for different bonds with the same starting point; the proof of that lemma uses only the triangle inequality. By (ii), $\mathsf{M} \ge \gamma := (a + 24\gamma_\phi^{-1})^{-1}$, and by the first bound $\sum_{c'} |\mathsf{M}(c,c')|(e^{\theta d(c,c')} - 1)$ is at most a constant times $\sum_{y \in \mathbb{Z}^4} e^{-\theta_0 |y|}(e^{\theta |y|} - 1)$, which is at most $\frac{1}{2}\gamma$ for $\theta$ small. The lemma and (i) give the second bound. *q.e.d.*

The identity (i) replaces [2, (1.99)], the bounds (ii) are [2, (1.100)] with the conclusion drawn there from [2, (1.101)], and the representation of $H_k$ is [2, (1.103)]. The bounds on $H_k$ now follow from those on $G$.

**Corollary 17.2** (The Minimiser)**.** *For $\alpha \in [0,1)$ there are constants $c$ and $\delta > 0$, which depend on $a$, $L$, and $\alpha$ and not on $k$ and the torus, such that for every field $B$ on the unit lattice and all points $x$, $x'$ of $T_\eta/\Gamma'$ with $d(x,x') \le 1$,*

$$
\begin{aligned}
|(H_k B)(x)|\ ,\ |(\nabla H_k B)(x)| &\le c \sum_{c'} e^{-\delta d(x, c'_-)} |B(c')|\ , \\
|(\nabla H_k B)(x) - (\nabla H_k B)(x')| &\le c\, d(x,x')^\alpha \sum_{c'} e^{-\delta d(\{x,x'\}, c'_-)} |B(c')|\ .
\end{aligned}
\tag{17.2}
$$

*Proof.* By Lemma 17.1(i), $H_k B = \sum_c ((\Delta_k + a)B)(c)\, G J_c$. By (17.1) and Proposition 16.2(i) and (ii), $G J_c$ and $\nabla G J_c$ are at most $\frac{7}{5} c\, e^{4\delta_G} e^{-\delta_G d(x, c_-)}$ in modulus at $x$, with the corresponding bound for the differences of $\nabla G J_c$, and by Lemma 17.1(iii), $|((\Delta_k + a)B)(c)| \le C \sum_{c'} e^{-\theta d(c,c')} |B(c')|$. The sum over $c$ of the product of the two exponentials is at most a constant times $e^{-\delta d(x, c'_-)}$ with $\delta := \frac{1}{2}\min(\delta_G, \theta)$. *q.e.d.*

We turn to the second derivatives. The decay of Lemma 16.1 was obtained with a weight which is Lipschitz continuous, and such a weight does not commute with the Laplace operator up to a bounded error. The second derivatives are therefore localised afterwards, with a cutoff which has two bounded derivatives. We write $\nabla\nabla A \coloneqq (\partial'_\nu \partial'_{\nu'} A)_{\nu,\nu'}$, and $\nabla^*\nabla^* J \coloneqq \sum_{\nu,\nu'} \partial'^*_{\nu'} \partial'^*_\nu J_{\nu\nu'}$ for a family $J = (J_{\nu\nu'})$ of fields.

**Lemma 17.3** (Second Derivatives in $L^2$)**.** *Let $a > 0$. There are constants $\theta_2 > 0$ and $C$, which depend on $a$ and not on $k$, $L$, and the torus, such that for all $y, y' \in \mathbb{Z}^4$ and every field $J$, or family of fields $J$, supported in the bonds starting in $\{x \,|\, d(x,y') \le 2\}$,*

$$\|\nabla\nabla G J\|_{\Delta(y)} \le C e^{-\theta_2 d(y,y')} \|J\| \,, \qquad \|G\nabla^*\nabla^* J\|_{\Delta(y)} \le C e^{-\theta_2 d(y,y')} \|J\| \,. \tag{17.3}$$

*Proof.* Let $F \coloneqq GJ$, regarded as a periodic field on $T_\eta$, and let $\chi(t) \coloneqq \prod_\mu \psi(t_\mu - y_\mu - \frac{1}{2})$ for $t \in \mathbb{R}^4$, with a fixed twice continuously differentiable function $\psi$ on $\mathbb{R}$ with values in $[0,1]$ which is 1 on $[-\frac{3}{2}, \frac{3}{2}]$ and 0 outside $[-\frac{5}{2}, \frac{5}{2}]$. Then $\chi F$ has a finite support, and for a field $A$ of finite support on $T_\eta$ we have $\|\nabla\nabla A\| = \|\Delta A\|$, because the operators $\partial'_\nu$ commute with each other and with their adjoints. The points which enter $\partial'_\nu \partial'_{\nu'} F$ at a point of $\Delta(y)$ have coordinates within $2\eta$ of the cube $y + [0,1)^4$, where $\chi = 1$, so that $\|\nabla\nabla F\|_{\Delta(y)} \le \|\Delta(\chi F)\|$. For a point $x$ and each component of $F$,

$$\begin{aligned}(\Delta(\chi F) - \chi \Delta F)(x) = &-\eta^{-2} \sum_\nu \sum_\pm (\chi(x \pm \eta e'_\nu) - \chi(x))(F(x \pm \eta e'_\nu) - F(x)) \\ &- \eta^{-2} \sum_\nu (\chi(x + \eta e'_\nu) + \chi(x - \eta e'_\nu) - 2\chi(x)) F(x) \,,\end{aligned} \tag{17.4}$$

as one sees by writing out the two second differences. The first differences of $\chi$ are at most $\varkappa\eta$ and the second ones at most $\varkappa_2\eta^2$ in modulus, with constants which depend on $\psi$ only, so that the right side is at most $\varkappa \sum_\nu (|(\partial'_\nu F)(x)| + |(\partial'_\nu F)(x - \eta e'_\nu)|) + 4\varkappa_2 |F(x)|$. The support of $\chi$ is contained in the union of the blocks $\Delta(y'')$ with $y'' - y \in \{-2, \dots, 2\}^4$, each of which is mapped injectively to the torus. Hence $\|\Delta(\chi F)\|$ is at most a constant times the sum, over the $y''$ with $y'' - y \in \{-3, \dots, 3\}^4$, of $\|\Delta F\|_{\Delta(y'')} + \|\nabla F\|_{\Delta(y'')} + \|F\|_{\Delta(y'')}$, the norms being those of the torus.

By Lemma 16.1 the last two norms are at most $C_0 e^{-\theta_0 d(y'',y')} \|J\|$. For the first we use $\Delta F = J + \partial P \partial^* F - a Q_k^* Q_k F$. The norm of $J$ over $\Delta(y'')$ is at most $\|J\|$, and it vanishes unless $d(y'', y') \le 4$. By (16.3) and Lemma 16.1, $\|\partial P \partial^* F\|_{\Delta(y'')} \le 2 \sup_{\Delta(y'')} |\partial P \partial^* F| \le 2c \sum_{y'''} e^{-\delta_\varpi |y'' - y'''|} C_0 e^{-\theta_0 d(y''', y')} \|J\|$, and by the estimates in the proof of (16.2), $\|Q_k^* Q_k F\|_{\Delta(y'')} \le 4 \|F\|_{X_{y''}}$, where $X_{y''}$ is contained in the blocks whose corners are at a distance of at most 11 from $y''$. Since $d(y'', y) \le 6$, all these terms are at most a constant times $e^{-\theta_2 d(y,y')} \|J\|$ with $\theta_2 \coloneqq \frac{1}{2} \min(\theta_0, \delta_\varpi)$, which is the first bound of (17.3).

For the second, let $\Phi$ be a field supported in the bonds starting in $\Delta(y)$. Since $G$ is symmetric, $\langle \Phi, G\nabla^*\nabla^* J \rangle = \langle \nabla\nabla G \Phi, J \rangle$, and the support of $J$ lies in the blocks $\Delta(y'')$ with $d(y'', y') \le 4$. The first bound, with $y$ and $y''$ exchanged, bounds this by a constant times $e^{-\theta_2 d(y,y')} \|\Phi\| \|J\|$. *q.e.d.*

With Lemma 16.1 this is [2, (1.114)]: for a function $\zeta$ supported in $\Delta(y)$ the norms there are at most $\sup|\zeta|$ times the norms over $\Delta(y)$.

It remains to describe the commutators. For a function $h$ on the torus and fields $A$ on $T_\eta/\Gamma'$ and $B$ on the unit lattice we write $(hA)(b) \coloneqq h(b_-)A(b)$ and $(hB)(c) \coloneqq h(c_-)B(c)$ for positive bonds. Bałaban defines the commutator of $Q_k$ with $h$ through the contours and the segments of his average [2, (1.120)]. The sums of $\partial h$ over paths which occur there are

differences of the values of $h$, so that the definition does not depend on the paths, and it can be stated for any average.

**Lemma 17.4** (Commutators with a Function)**.** *Let $h$ be a function on $T_\eta/\Gamma'$ with $|h(x) - h(x')| \le \varkappa\, d(x,x')$ for all $x$, $x'$ and $|h(x+\eta e'_\nu) + h(x-\eta e'_\nu) - 2h(x)| \le \varkappa_2 \eta^2$ for all $x$ and $\nu$, and put*

$$S(h) \coloneqq Q_k h - h Q_k \;, \qquad P_1(h) \coloneqq h\, \partial P \partial^* - \partial P \partial^* h \;. \tag{17.5}$$

*(i)* $Q_k^* Q_k h = h Q_k^* Q_k - S(h)^* Q_k + Q_k^* S(h)$*, and* $\Delta_a h = h \Delta_a - K(h)$ *with*

$$K(h) \coloneqq (h\Delta - \Delta h) + a S(h)^* Q_k - a Q_k^* S(h) - P_1(h) \;. \tag{17.6}$$

*(ii)* $|(S(h)A)(c)| \le \frac{28}{5} \varkappa \sup|A|$*, the supremum over the bonds which start at a distance of less than 4 from $c_-$, and $\|S(h)A\| \le 6\varkappa \|A\|$.*

*(iii)* $P_1(h)$ *has the kernel* $(h(x) - h(x'))\varpi_{\nu\nu'}(x,x')$*, which is at most* $\varkappa c_\varpi |x-x'| e^{-\delta_\varpi |x-x'|}$ *in modulus.*

*(iv)* $|((h\Delta - \Delta h)A)(x)| \le \varkappa \sum_\nu (|(\partial'_\nu A)(x)| + |(\partial'_\nu A)(x - \eta e'_\nu)|) + 4\varkappa_2 |A(x)|$ *for each component of $A$.*

*Proof.* (i) By the definition, $Q_k h = h Q_k + S(h)$, and taking adjoints, $h Q_k^* = Q_k^* h + S(h)^*$. Hence $Q_k^* Q_k h = Q_k^* h Q_k + Q_k^* S(h) = h Q_k^* Q_k - S(h)^* Q_k + Q_k^* S(h)$, and the formula for $K(h)$ follows from $\Delta_a = \Delta - \partial P \partial^* + a Q_k^* Q_k$. (ii) By (6.3), $(S(h)A)(c)$ is the average at $c$ of the field $(h - h(c_-))A$. The bonds which enter it start at a distance of less than 4 from $c_-$, where $|h - h(c_-)| \le 4\varkappa$, and the two bounds follow from the proof of Lemma 9.1(i), in which the average of a field is at most $\frac{7}{5}$ times its supremum, and its square is bounded by a sum over its own bonds. (iii) is (15.1) and (15.2), and (iv) is (17.4) with $h$ in place of $\chi$. *q.e.d.*

Statement (i) is [2, (1.120), (1.121)]. For the functions $h_z$ of [2, (1.118)], which are products of functions of the coordinates $x_\mu/M_0$, the constants are $\varkappa = O(M_0^{-1})$ and $\varkappa_2 = O(M_0^{-2})$, and (ii)–(iv) give the bound [2, (1.128)] on $h_{z_1} K(h_{z_2})$ as in the text. The expansion [2, (1.119)–(1.123)] with its estimates [2, (1.124)–(1.131)] is therefore available in the tilted run, although we have proved Proposition 16.2 without it.

## 18 The Scalar Operator of Two Neighbouring Scales

In the second paper on the propagators the averages act at different scales in different regions of the lattice: there is a decreasing sequence of domains, the points of the scale $j$ in the $j$-th region form a set $\Lambda_j$, and the scalar operator is $\Delta'_a = \Delta + Q'^* a Q'$ with $\langle \lambda, Q'^* a Q' \lambda \rangle = \sum_j \sum_{y \in \Lambda_j} a_j (L^j \eta)^{d-2} |(Q'_j \lambda)(y)|^2$ and $a_{j+1} = a a_j / (a L^{-2} + a_j)$, $a_1 = a$ [3, (2.14), p. 225]. These are the numbers $a_j = \alpha_j \ell_j^2$ of Section 13, because $1/a_{j+1} = 1/a + L^{-2}/a_j$. In Bałaban's formulae $\Delta$ stands for $\partial^* \partial$; in this section, as in Sections 13 and 14, $\Delta$ is the Laplace operator of the lattice, so that his $\Delta$ is our $-\Delta$. Bałaban's expansion of the inverse $G'$ starts from local inverses $G'(\square)$ on cubes $\square$ of the size $2ML^j\eta$, each "an inverse of $\Delta'_a$ with some boundary conditions on the boundary of $\square$, e.g. with Neumann boundary conditions" [3, (2.37), p. 229]. A cube of the scale $j$ meets the regions of the scales $j$ and $j+1$ at most, and for a cube which meets both he expresses $G'(\square)$ through the operator of the scale $j$ on the box and an operator $C_\Lambda^{(j)}(\square)$ on the points of the scale $j$ in the region of the scale $j+1$ [3, (2.41), (2.42), p. 230]; the two bounds [3, (2.43), (2.44)] on which the expansion rests then follow from the properties of these operators on a box with Neumann conditions.

For a turned fine lattice the box with Neumann conditions is not available (Section 11), and we do not need it. The expansion uses of $G'(\square)$ only that it inverts the operator of the sequence on the support of the function $h_\square$ and that it satisfies [3, (2.43)]. Both hold for an operator on the whole lattice, without any boundary: the operator whose averages are those of the scale $j+1$ on an arbitrary set of cubes and those of the scale $j$ everywhere else. This section constructs it and proves its bounds, by the argument of Sections 13 and 14 with a set of cubes in the place of the whole lattice.

We use the notation of Section 13: the unit is that of the last lattice, $\ell_j = L^{j-k}$, and $\alpha_j$, $G_{(j)}$, $\Delta^{(j)}$ are as in (13.1) and (13.2). Fix $1 \le j \le k-1$, and write $\mathsf{q} \coloneqq Q'_{\ell_j}$, $Q'^{\mathrm{st}} \coloneqq Q'^{\mathrm{st}}_{\ell_j,\ell_{j+1}}$, and $\beta \coloneqq a\ell_{j+1}^{-2}$, as in the proof of Lemma 13.1. Let $\Lambda'$ be any set of points of $\ell_{j+1}\mathbb{Z}^4$, let $\Lambda \subset \ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$ be the union of the cubes of $Q'^{\mathrm{st}}$ at the points of $\Lambda'$, and let

$$\Pi_{\Lambda'} \coloneqq Q'^{\mathrm{st}*}\mathbf{1}_{\Lambda'}Q'^{\mathrm{st}}\,, \qquad \mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'} \coloneqq -\Delta + \alpha_j\,\mathsf{q}^*\mathbf{1}_{\Lambda^c}\mathsf{q} + \alpha_{j+1}\,\mathsf{q}^*\Pi_{\Lambda'}\mathsf{q}\,. \tag{18.1}$$

Here $\Pi_{\Lambda'}$ is the orthogonal projection onto the functions on $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$ which vanish outside $\Lambda$ and are constant on each cube of $\Lambda$, and $\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}$ is the operator on the functions on $T_\eta$ which has the average of the scale $\ell_{j+1}$ with the constant $\alpha_{j+1}$ on the blocks of $\Lambda'$ and the average of the scale $\ell_j$ with the constant $\alpha_j$ on the other blocks; it is $G_{(j)}^{-1}$ for $\Lambda' = \emptyset$ and $G_{(j+1)}^{-1}$ for $\Lambda' = \ell_{j+1}\mathbb{Z}^4$. We write $\iota$ for the inclusion of the square-summable functions on $\Lambda$ into those on $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$.

**Lemma 18.1** (Two Neighbouring Scales)**.** *Let $L \ge 64$ and $a > 0$. For every $j$ and every $\Lambda'$ as above the following hold, with constants which depend on $a$ and $L$ and not on $k$, $j$, or $\Lambda'$.*

*(i) $\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'} \ge G_{(j+1)}^{-1}$; in particular $\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}$ has a bounded inverse.*

*(ii) The operator $\iota^*\Delta^{(j)}\iota + \beta\Pi_{\Lambda'}$ on the functions on $\Lambda$ has a bounded inverse $C_\Lambda$, and*

$$\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1} = G_{(j)} + \alpha_j^2\, G_{(j)}\mathsf{q}^*\iota\, C_\Lambda\, \iota^*\mathsf{q}G_{(j)}\,. \tag{18.2}$$

*(iii) The kernel $\mathsf{C}_\Lambda$ of $C_\Lambda$ with respect to the sum over the points of $\Lambda$ satisfies $|\mathsf{C}_\Lambda(y,y')| \le c_C\ell_j^2 e^{-\theta_C|y-y'|/\ell_j}$, with the constants of Lemma 14.2.*

*(iv) For every bounded function $f$ on $T_\eta$, every $\alpha \in [0,1)$, all $x, x' \in T_\eta$ with $|x-x'| \le \ell_j$, and every $\nu$, with $D \coloneqq \operatorname{dist}(\{x,x'\}, \operatorname{supp} f)$ and $\delta$ of Proposition 14.3,*

$$\begin{gathered}|(\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}f)(x)| \le c\,\ell_j^2 e^{-\delta D/\ell_j}\sup|f|\,, \qquad |(\partial'_\nu\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}f)(x)| \le c\,\ell_j e^{-\delta D/\ell_j}\sup|f|\,,\\ |(\partial'_\nu\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}f)(x) - (\partial'_\nu\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}f)(x')| \le c'_\alpha\ell_j^{1-\alpha}|x-x'|^\alpha e^{-\delta D/\ell_j}\sup|f|\,.\end{gathered} \tag{18.3}$$

*(v) With the same notation, $|(\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}\partial'^*_\nu f)(x)| \le c\,\ell_j e^{-\delta D/\ell_j}\sup|f|$, the difference of the values of $\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}\partial'^*_\nu f$ at $x$ and $x'$ is at most $c\,\ell_j^{1-\alpha}|x-x'|^\alpha e^{-\delta D/\ell_j}\sup|f|$, and $|(\Delta\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}f)(x)| \le c\,e^{-\delta D_x/(2\ell_j)}\sup|f|$, where $D_x \coloneqq \operatorname{dist}(x, \operatorname{supp} f)$.*

*Proof.* (i) Let $\Pi \coloneqq Q'^{\mathrm{st}*}Q'^{\mathrm{st}}$, the projection of the proof of Lemma 13.1. It is the sum of $\Pi_{\Lambda'}$ and of the corresponding projection for the complement of $\Lambda'$, which acts on the functions supported in $\Lambda^c$ and is therefore at most $\mathbf{1}_{\Lambda^c}$. Since $\alpha_j \ge \alpha_{j+1}$, this gives $\alpha_j\mathbf{1}_{\Lambda^c} + \alpha_{j+1}\Pi_{\Lambda'} \ge \alpha_{j+1}\Pi$, and $\mathsf{q}^*\Pi\mathsf{q} = P_{(j+1)}$ by Lemma 6.3, so that $\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'} \ge -\Delta + \alpha_{j+1}P_{(j+1)} = G_{(j+1)}^{-1}$, which is bounded below by a positive number (Section 13).

(ii) On the functions on $\Lambda$ the operator $\Pi_{\Lambda'}$ is an orthogonal projection, and, as in the proof of Lemma 13.1, $\alpha_j - \alpha_j^2(\alpha_j + \beta\Pi_{\Lambda'})^{-1}$ vanishes on its null space and equals $\alpha_{j+1}$ on its range. Hence $\alpha_j \mathbf{1}_{\Lambda^c} + \alpha_{j+1}\Pi_{\Lambda'} = \alpha_j - \alpha_j^2\, \iota(\alpha_j + \beta\Pi_{\Lambda'})^{-1}\iota^*$ on the functions on $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$, and

$$\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'} = G_{(j)}^{-1} - \alpha_j^2\, \mathsf{q}^*\iota(\alpha_j + \beta\Pi_{\Lambda'})^{-1}\iota^*\mathsf{q}\,. \tag{18.4}$$

We apply the inversion formula of the proof of Lemma 13.1 with $\mathsf{M} = G_{(j)}^{-1}$, $\mathsf{U} = \alpha_j\mathsf{q}^*\iota$, and $\mathsf{K} = (\alpha_j+\beta\Pi_{\Lambda'})^{-1}$. Then $\mathsf{M}-\mathsf{U}\mathsf{K}\mathsf{U}^* = \mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}$ has a bounded inverse by (i), and $\mathsf{K}^{-1}-\mathsf{U}^*\mathsf{M}^{-1}\mathsf{U} = \alpha_j + \beta\Pi_{\Lambda'} - \alpha_j^2\iota^*\mathsf{q}G_{(j)}\mathsf{q}^*\iota = \iota^*\Delta^{(j)}\iota + \beta\Pi_{\Lambda'}$ by (13.2), which gives the existence of $C_\Lambda$ and (18.2).

(iii) Since $\Lambda$ is a union of cubes, $\Pi$ commutes with $\mathbf{1}_\Lambda$ and $\iota^*\Pi\iota = \Pi_{\Lambda'}$, so that $C_\Lambda^{-1} = \iota^*(C^{(j)})^{-1}\iota$ is the compression of $(C^{(j)})^{-1}$ to the functions on $\Lambda$. In the unit $\ell_j$, $(C^{(j)})^{-1} = \ell_j^{-2}\mathsf{M}$ with the operator $\mathsf{M}$ of the proof of Lemma 14.2, for which that proof gives $\mathsf{M} \geq L^{-2}\min(2c_\Delta, a)$ and $\sum_{y'}|\mathsf{M}(y,y')|(e^{\theta C|y-y'|}-1)$ at most half of this lower bound. Both properties pass to the compression: its quadratic form is the restriction of that of $\mathsf{M}$, and its kernel is the restriction of the kernel of $\mathsf{M}$ to $\Lambda\times\Lambda$, whose sums over $y' \in \Lambda$ are not larger. Lemma 14.1 on the set $\Lambda$ gives the bound, with the constants of Lemma 14.2.

(iv) Proposition 14.3, applied to the run of $j$ steps and written in the unit of the last lattice of the run of $k$ steps, gives the three bounds for $G_{(j)}$ in the place of $\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}$: the operator $G_{(j)}$ is $\ell_j^2$ times the operator of that proposition in the unit $\ell_j$, a derivative costs $\ell_j^{-1}$ and a Hölder quotient of exponent $\alpha$ a further $\ell_j^{-\alpha}$. The second term of (18.2) is the operator $\mathsf{T}_j$ of (14.4) with $\mathsf{C}_\Lambda$ in the place of $\mathsf{C}_j$ and with the sums over $y, y'$ restricted to $\Lambda$, and the estimate (14.5), with its counterparts for the derivative and for the Hölder quotient, uses of $\mathsf{C}_j$ only the bound (14.1), which $\mathsf{C}_\Lambda$ satisfies by (iii).

(v) The first two bounds are Proposition 14.4(i) for $G_{(j)}$, in the unit $\ell_j$, and its proof for the second term of (18.2): the derivative of the source is moved to the last kernel $\mathcal{K}_j$ by a summation by parts, which replaces one factor $\ell_j^2$ by $\ell_j$. For the last bound, $-\Delta\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}f = f - \alpha_j\mathsf{q}^*\mathbf{1}_{\Lambda^c}\mathsf{q}\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}f - \alpha_{j+1}\mathsf{q}^*\Pi_{\Lambda'}\mathsf{q}\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}f$ by (18.1). The operators $\mathsf{q}^*\mathbf{1}_{\Lambda^c}\mathsf{q}$ and $\mathsf{q}^*\Pi_{\Lambda'}\mathsf{q}$ replace a function by its means over blocks of diameter at most $4L\ell_j$, or by zero, and $\alpha_{j+1} \leq \alpha_j = a_j\ell_j^{-2} \leq a\ell_j^{-2}$; with the first bound of (18.3) the two averaging terms are at most $2ac\, e^{4L\delta}e^{-\delta D_x/\ell_j}\sup|f|$, and $f(x) = 0$ unless $D_x = 0$. *q.e.d.*

The identity (18.2) is [3, (2.42)] with the whole lattice in the place of the box, and (18.3), read in the unit $\ell_j$, is [3, (2.43)]. To use the lemma in the expansion [3, (2.37), (2.38)], let $\square$ be a cube of the scale $j$ of the cover, $1 \leq j \leq k-1$, and let $\Lambda' \coloneqq \Omega_{j+1}^{(j+1)}$ be the set of the points of $\ell_{j+1}\mathbb{Z}^4$ in $\Omega_{j+1}$; we put $G'(\square) \coloneqq \mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1}$, an operator which depends on the scale of the cube only. It has the average of the scale $j+1$ on $\Omega_{j+1}$ and that of the scale $j$ elsewhere, so that the averaging terms of $\Delta'_a$ and of $\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}$, which at a point are determined by the block of that point, agree on the regions of the scales $j$ and $j+1$; and the support of $h_\square$ lies in these two regions, for the cover which we fix in Section 20. For the cubes of the scale $k$, whose functions $h_\square$ are supported in the region of the scale $k$, we put $G'(\square) \coloneqq G_{(k)}$; the bounds (iv) and (v) of the lemma hold for it with $\ell_k = 1$, by Propositions 14.3 and 14.4(i) and by the proof of the last bound of (v). Hence $h_\square\Delta'_aG'(\square) = h_\square\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}\mathcal{D}_{\Lambda'}^{-1} = h_\square$, the computation which leads to [3, (2.38)] goes through with the commutator [3, (2.39)], and (18.3) gives [3, (2.44)], the factor $M^{-1}$ coming from the derivatives of $h_\square$ as there. The commutator of $h$ with the average of a block is the average of $h(x') - h(x)$ over the block, which is [3, (2.39)] with the contour replaced by any path from $x$ to $x'$, and it does not depend on the contours, as in Lemma 17.4. There remains the pair of the scales 0 and 1, in which the average of the

finer scale is the identity, $(Q_0'\lambda)(x) = \lambda(x)$ for $x \in \Lambda_0$ [3, p. 225], so that the region of the scale 0 carries a mass term, and the average of the scale 1 is the tilted one. Let $a_0 > 0$, let $\Lambda'$ be a set of points of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ and $\Lambda \subset T_\eta$ the union of the blocks $B_{\ell_1}(y)$, $y \in \Lambda'$, and let

$$\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'} \coloneqq -\Delta + a_0\eta^{-2}\mathbf{1}_{\Lambda^c} + \alpha_1 Q'^*_{\ell_1}\mathbf{1}_{\Lambda'}Q'_{\ell_1} \tag{18.5}$$

on the functions on $T_\eta$.

**Lemma 18.2** (The First Scale)**.** *For every $\Lambda'$, $\eta^2\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'} \geq \gamma_{00} \coloneqq \min(a_0, L^{-2}\min(C_P^{-1}, a))$, and there are constants $c$ and $\theta_{00} > 0$, depending on $a$, $a_0$, and $L$ only, such that the kernel $g^0$ of $(\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'})^{-1}$ with respect to the sum over the points of $T_\eta$ satisfies $|g^0(x,x')| \leq c\,\eta^2 e^{-\theta_{00}|x-x'|/\eta}$. Consequently $(\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'})^{-1}$ satisfies* (18.3) *and the bounds of Lemma 18.1(v) with $\eta$ in the place of $\ell_j$ and $\frac{1}{2}\theta_{00}$ in the place of $\delta$. Moreover $\eta^2\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'} \leq 16 + a_0 + a$.*

*Proof.* For a function $\phi$ on $T_\eta$, $\langle\phi, \eta^2\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'}\phi\rangle$ is the sum of $\eta^2\|\partial\phi\|^2$, of $a_0\|\mathbf{1}_{\Lambda^c}\phi\|^2$, and of $(a/L^2)\|P\phi\|^2$, where $P$ replaces $\phi$ by its mean on each block of $\Lambda$ and by zero elsewhere, since $\eta^2\alpha_1 = a/L^2$. On a block of $\Lambda$, Lemma 8.3 for the scale $\ell_1$ bounds the squared norm of $\phi$ minus its mean by $C_P L^2$ times $\eta^2$ times the sum of the squares of the differences along the bonds inside the block, so that the part of the form which belongs to the block is at least $L^{-2}\min(C_P^{-1}, a)$ times the squared norm of $\phi$ on the block, as in the proof of Lemma 14.2; on $\Lambda^c$ the mass term gives $a_0$. The bonds inside different blocks are different, which gives the lower bound. The kernel of $\eta^2\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'}$ with respect to the sum over the points is that of $-\eta^2\Delta$, which has the range $\eta$, plus $a_0$ on the diagonal in $\Lambda^c$ and $(a/L^2)L^{-4}$ for two points of one block of $\Lambda$, whose distance is at most $2L\eta$. Hence, with $\mathsf{M} \coloneqq \eta^2\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'}$ and the metric $|x-x'|/\eta$, $\sum_{x'}|\mathsf{M}(x,x')|(e^{\theta|x-x'|/\eta} - 1) \leq 8(e^\theta - 1) + (a/L^2)(e^{2L\theta} - 1) \leq \frac{1}{2}\gamma_{00}$ for $\theta = \theta_{00}$ small, and Lemma 14.1 gives the bound on the kernel with $c = 2/\gamma_{00}$. The bounds (18.3) and those of Lemma 18.1(v) follow as at the end of the proof of Proposition 14.3: the sum of $e^{-\theta_{00}|x-x'|/(2\eta)}$ over $x' \in T_\eta$ is bounded, a difference quotient of the result or of the source costs $2\eta^{-1}$, the Laplace operator costs $16\eta^{-2}$, and two different points of $T_\eta$ are at least $\eta$ apart. The upper bound holds because $-\eta^2\Delta \leq 16$, the mass term is at most $a_0$, and the last term is $a/L^2$ times a projection. *q.e.d.*

With $G'(\square) \coloneqq (\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'})^{-1}$ for the cubes of the scale 0, and $\Lambda' \coloneqq \Omega_1^{(1)}$ the set of the points of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ in $\Omega_1$, so that $\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'}$ has the mass term on the region of the scale 0 and the average of the scale 1 on $\Omega_1$, the same reasoning gives [3, (2.38), (2.44)] for these cubes. The number $a_0$ is not fixed by the recursion of [3, (2.14)], which starts at $a_1 = a$; any $a_0 > 0$ serves.

## 19 The Distance of a Sequence of Domains

The decay of the operators of a sequence of domains is measured in [3] by a distance which counts every part of a path in the unit of the region in which it runs. Let $\mathfrak{B} = \bigcup_j \Lambda_j$ [3, (2.45)]. A contour is admissible if its part in the region $B^j(\Lambda_j)$ consists of bonds of the lattice $\Lambda_j$, and

$$d(y,y') \coloneqq \inf_{\Gamma_{y,y'}} \sum_{j=0}^{k} (L^j\eta)^{-1}|\Gamma_{y,y'} \cap B^j(\Lambda_j)| \tag{19.1}$$

for $y, y' \in \mathfrak{B}$, the infimum over the admissible contours from $y$ to $y'$, where $|\Gamma|$ is $\eta$ times the number of fine bonds of $\Gamma$ [3, (2.46), p. 231]. In the tilted run the definition is the same. The lattices $\Lambda_j$, $j \geq 1$, are those of the paper, and $\Lambda_0$ consists of points of the turned lattice $T_\eta$, so that the part of an admissible contour in the region of the scale 0 runs along the directions

$e'_\nu$. Since we shall need upper bounds for this distance as well as lower ones, we state how we read the definition at the surfaces between the regions. Write $\ell_j \coloneqq L^j\eta$ for $0 \le j \le k$, as in Section 18, let $[\Omega_j] \subset \mathbb{R}^4$ be the union of the cubes $y + [0,\ell_j)^4$ over the points $y$ of $\Omega_j^{(j)}$, so that $\Omega_j = T_\eta \cap [\Omega_j]$, put $[\Omega_0] \coloneqq \mathbb{R}^4$ and $[\Omega_{k+1}] \coloneqq \emptyset$, and let the *closed region* $\mathcal{R}_j$ of the scale $j$ be the closure of $[\Omega_j] \setminus [\Omega_{j+1}]$. A *step* of the scale $j$ is a pair of neighbours of the lattice $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$, or of $T_\eta$ for $j = 0$, both of which lie in $\mathcal{R}_j$. An admissible contour is a chain of steps, and $d(y,y')$ is the least number of steps of a chain from $y$ to $y'$; a step of the scale $j$ is a part of the length $\ell_j$ of the contour in the region of the scale $j$, which contributes 1 to (19.1). Two consecutive regions $\mathcal{R}_j$ and $\mathcal{R}_{j+1}$ meet in the boundary $\Sigma_{j+1}$ of $[\Omega_{j+1}]$, the surface of [3, p. 231], and a chain passes from the one to the other at a point of $\ell_{j+1}\mathbb{Z}^4$ on this surface, as in the decomposition [3, (2.47)]. The triangle inequality [3, (2.54)] follows from the definition, since two chains with a common end form a chain. For points $x, x' \in T_\eta$ the distance $d(x,x')$ is that of the points of $\mathfrak{B}$ in whose blocks they lie.

Bałaban's Lemma 2.1 on this distance has two inputs in which the directions of the bonds enter. The first is that a contour is at least as long as the distance of its ends: in [3, (2.48), p. 232] the lengths of the parts of a contour are bounded below by the distances $|y - y_1|$, $|y_l - y'_l|$, $|y'_l - y_{l+1}|$ of their ends, and in [3, (2.58), p. 233] the sums over these ends are computed as products over the coordinates, so that the distance there is the sum of the moduli of the coordinates, which we write $|\cdot|_1$. The second is the lower bound [3, (2.57)] on a part which joins two of the surfaces $\Sigma_j$, which comes from the separation [3, (2.2), p. 224] of the domains. For a turned lattice both need a remark.

**Lemma 19.1** (Lengths of Contours)**.** *Let $\Gamma$ be a contour of $n$ bonds of $T_\eta$ from $x$ to $x'$. Then $n\eta \ge |x - x'|_2 \ge |x - x'|_\infty$ and $n\eta \ge \frac{5}{7}|x - x'|_1$, where the norms are those of the coordinates of the paper. For a point $t \in \mathbb{R}^4$ and $c > 0$, the sum of $e^{-c|t-w|_1}$ over the points $w$ of $T_\eta$ is at most $(2/(1 - e^{-5c\eta/7}))^4$, and its sum over the points $w$ of $\ell\mathbb{Z}^4$ at most $(2/(1 - e^{-c\ell}))^4$.*

*Proof.* The difference $x' - x$ is $\eta$ times a sum of $n$ vectors $\pm e'_\nu$, each of Euclidean length one, which gives the first inequality. By (2.2), $|e'_\nu|_1 \le \frac{7}{5}$ for every $\nu$, so that $|x' - x|_1 \le \frac{7}{5}n\eta$. For the sums, $\sum_{z\in\mathbb{Z}} e^{-c|s-z|} \le 2\sum_{m\ge 0} e^{-cm} = 2/(1 - e^{-c})$ for every real $s$, which gives the statement for $\ell\mathbb{Z}^4$ coordinate by coordinate. The points of $T_\eta$ are the points $\eta\sum_\nu w'_\nu e'_\nu$ with integers $w'_\nu$, and since the matrix which expresses the coordinates of the paper through the coordinates $w'$ is orthogonal with rows of $|\cdot|_1$-norm at most $\frac{7}{5}$, the sum of the moduli of the coordinates $w'$ of a vector is at most $\frac{7}{5}$ of its norm $|\cdot|_1$; hence $e^{-c|t-w|_1} \le e^{-(5c/7)\eta\sum_\nu |t'_\nu - w'_\nu|}$, and the sum over the integers $w'_\nu$ is a product as before. *q.e.d.*

We read the separation [3, (2.2)] of the domains with the distance $|\cdot|_\infty$, the one in which the cubes are balls. The complement of $[\Omega_j]$ and the set $[\Omega_{j+1}]$ are unions of cubes of the side $M\ell_j$ of one grid, so that their distance in $|\cdot|_\infty$ is a multiple of $M\ell_j$. It is at least $RM\ell_j$: every cube of the side $5\eta$ contains a point of $T_\eta$ at a distance of at most $3\eta$ from any given point of its closure, so that otherwise there would be points of $\Omega_j^c$ and of $\Omega_{j+1}$ at a distance of at most $(R-1)M\ell_j + 6\eta \le RM\ell_j$. A step of the scale $j$ changes the position by at most $\ell_j$ in $|\cdot|_\infty$, by Lemma 19.1 for $j = 0$. A part of a chain which joins the surfaces $\Sigma_j$ and $\Sigma_{j+1}$ in $\mathcal{R}_j$ has therefore at least $RM$ steps, whatever the directions of its bonds, which is [3, (2.57)] with $\ge$ in the place of $>$; the proof of Lemma 2.1 uses no more. In [3, (2.48)] the parts of a contour which run through the region of the scale 0 are bounded below by $\frac{5}{7}$ of the distance $|\cdot|_1$ of their ends, and the other parts by this distance itself. The sums of [3, (2.58)] run over the scaled images of the ends on unit lattices, which are lattices $\mathbb{Z}^4$ for the surfaces and for the points of the $\Lambda_{j'}$ with $j' \ge 1$, and the turned unit lattice for the points of $\Lambda_0$; by

the second part of the lemma each of them is at most the fourth power of $\bar{c}_0(\frac{25}{98}\alpha) \le \bar{c}_0(\frac{1}{4}\alpha)$, where

$$\bar{c}_0(\alpha) := \frac{2}{1 - e^{-\alpha\bar{\delta}_0}} < \frac{4}{\alpha\bar{\delta}_0} \tag{19.2}$$

is the bound which Bałaban uses for his $c_0(\alpha)$ [3, p. 233], and $\bar{\delta}_0 \in (0, 1]$ is the number which stands for the rate $\delta_0$ in his formulae; we write it with a bar because $\delta_0$ is the rate of Proposition 12.2. One factor $\frac{5}{7}$ comes from the length of the contour and one from the sum over a turned lattice, and $\frac{1}{2} \cdot \frac{5}{7} \cdot \frac{5}{7} = \frac{25}{98} \ge \frac{1}{4}$. The rest of the proof of Lemma 2.1 is a summation over the number $m$ of the crossings and over the scales, in which the lattices do not enter. Hence:

**Lemma 19.2** (Lemma 2.1 for the Tilted Run)**.** *Let* $0 < \bar{\delta}_0 \le 1$ *and* $0 < \alpha < 1$*, let the sequence of domains satisfy [3, (2.2)] with the distance* $|\cdot|_\infty$*, and let* $\frac{1}{4}\alpha\bar{\delta}_0 RM > 8 \log \bar{c}_0(\frac{1}{4}\alpha) + 1$*. Then [3, (2.60)–(2.63), p. 234] hold in the tilted run with* $\bar{\delta}_0$ *in the place of* $\delta_0$ *and* $c_1(\alpha) := 12\bar{c}_0(\frac{1}{4}\alpha)^4$*.*

The rate enters the lemma through the product $\alpha\bar{\delta}_0$ only, and the condition on $RM$ at one value of this product implies the condition at every larger value, because $\bar{c}_0$ decreases. We may therefore use the lemma for finitely many rates at once, provided $RM$ is larger than a number which depends on the smallest of them.

The bound [3, (2.60)] uses only [3, (2.57)]. With this lemma the passage from the bound [3, (2.44)] on one term, which is Lemma 18.1(iv) and Lemma 18.2, to the convergence [3, (2.49), (2.50)] of the expansion of $G'$ and to its decay [3, (2.51)–(2.56), (2.64)] is as in the text: these steps compose operators with kernels which decay in the distance (19.1) and sum over the points of $\mathfrak{B}$.

## 20 The Scalar Operators of a Sequence of Domains

With the local inverses of Section 18 and the distance of Section 19 we can follow Bałaban's construction of the scalar operator $G' = \Delta'^{-1}_a$ of a sequence of domains and of the inverse of $Q'G'^2Q'^*$, which defines the gauge-fixing projection [3, (2.37)–(2.88), pp. 229–238]. Throughout this section a sequence of domains as in [3, (2.1), (2.2), p. 224] is given, with the separation read in the distance $|\cdot|_\infty$, $R \ge 2$, and $M$ is a multiple of $L$. We use the notation of Section 19: the scale $j$ has the spacing $\ell_j = L^j\eta$, $[\Omega_j]$ is the subset of $\mathbb{R}^4$ which the domain $\Omega_j$ fills, $\mathcal{R}_j$ is the closed region of the scale $j$, and all distances between subsets of $\mathbb{R}^4$ are taken in $|\cdot|_\infty$.

*The cover.* Bałaban covers the region of each scale $j$ by cubes of the size $2M\ell_j$ which are unions of $2^4$ big blocks, takes the functions $h$ of [2, (1.118)] "rescaled to proper scales", so that $\sum_\square h_\square^2 = 1$ [3, (2.36), p. 229], and uses that a cube of the scale $j$ meets the regions of the scales $j$ and $j+1$ only [3, p. 230]. The supports of these functions matter in what follows, and we fix a family with these properties. Let $h$ be the function of one variable of [2, (1.118)], smooth, supported in $(-\frac{2}{3}, \frac{2}{3})$, and with $\sum_{n\in\mathbb{Z}} h(t-n)^2 = 1$. For $0 \le j \le k$ and $y \in M\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$ let $\square_{j,y} := y + [-M\ell_j, M\ell_j)^4$ and $h_y^j(x) := \prod_\mu h((x_\mu - y_\mu)/(M\ell_j))$, so that $\sum_y (h_y^j)^2 = 1$ and $h_y^j$ vanishes outside the cube of the side $\frac{4}{3}M\ell_j$ around $y$. Let $V_j$ be the set of the $y$ with $\square_{j,y} \subset [\Omega_j]$, and

$$\zeta_j := \sum_{y\in V_j} (h_y^j)^2 \,, \qquad c_j := \sin(\tfrac{\pi}{2}\chi(\zeta_j)) \,, \qquad s_j := \cos(\tfrac{\pi}{2}\chi(\zeta_j)) \,, \tag{20.1}$$

with a fixed smooth function $\chi\colon [0,1] \to [0,1]$ which vanishes on $[0, \frac12]$ and equals 1 at 1; for $j = k+1$ we put $\zeta_{k+1} \coloneqq 0$. Then $\zeta_0 = 1$, and for $j \ge 1$ the function $\zeta_j$ vanishes at the points whose distance from the complement of $[\Omega_j]$ is less than $\frac13 M\ell_j$, and it equals 1 at the points $x$ whose distance from this complement is at least $\frac53 M\ell_j$, because every $y$ with $h^j_y(x) \ne 0$ then belongs to $V_j$. For $y \in V_j$ we put

$$h_{j,y} \coloneqq h^j_y \, \zeta_j^{-1/2} \, c_j \, s_{j+1} \ , \tag{20.2}$$

which is a smooth function, because $c_j$ vanishes where $\zeta_j \le \frac12$. The family $\mathscr{D}$ consists of the cubes $\square = \square_{j,y}$ with $0 \le j \le k$, $y \in V_j$, and $h_\square \coloneqq h_{j,y} \ne 0$; we call $j$ the scale of $\square$. We record four properties.

(a) $\sum_{\square\in\mathscr{D}} h^2_\square = 1$. Indeed the sum over the cubes of the scale $j$ is $c_j^2 s_{j+1}^2 = c_j^2 - c_j^2 c_{j+1}^2$, and $c_j c_{j+1} = c_{j+1}$: the function $c_{j+1}$ vanishes outside $[\Omega_{j+1}]$, whose distance from the complement of $[\Omega_j]$ is at least $RM\ell_j \ge 2M\ell_j$ (Section 19), and there $\zeta_j = 1$ and $c_j = 1$. The sum over $j$ is $c_0^2 - c_{k+1}^2 = 1$.

(b) The support of $h_\square$ lies in the cube of the side $\frac43 M\ell_j$ with the centre of $\square$, at a distance of at least $\frac13 M\ell_j$ from the complement of $\square$ and of $[\Omega_j]$; and it lies at a distance of at least $\frac13 M\ell_{j+1}$ from $[\Omega_{j+2}]$, because $s_{j+1}(x) \ne 0$ requires $\zeta_{j+1}(x) < 1$, hence a distance of less than $\frac53 M\ell_{j+1}$ from the complement of $[\Omega_{j+1}]$, while $[\Omega_{j+2}]$ is at a distance of at least $RM\ell_{j+1} \ge 2M\ell_{j+1}$ from this complement.

(c) $\square \subset \mathcal{R}_j \cup \mathcal{R}_{j+1}$: by the definition of $V_j$ the cube lies in $[\Omega_j]$, it contains a point at a distance of less than $\frac53 M\ell_{j+1}$ from the complement of $[\Omega_{j+1}]$, and its side is $2M\ell_j < \frac13 M\ell_{j+1}$. Since $M$ is a multiple of $L$, the faces of $\square$ lie in hyperplanes of the grid of the blocks of the scale $j+1$, so that $\square$ is a union of blocks of the sequence.

(d) The function $h_\square$ is Lipschitz continuous with the constant $\varkappa(M\ell_j)^{-1}$, and its second differences along the bonds of $T_\eta$ are at most $\varkappa_2(M\ell_j)^{-2}\eta^2$, with constants which depend on $h$ and $\chi$ only: $h_\square$ is a smooth function of the coordinates of the paper, composed of $h^j_y$, of $\zeta_j$, which is locally a sum of at most $2^4$ terms, and of $\zeta_{j+1}$, whose derivatives are smaller. Every point lies in the supports of at most $2 \cdot 2^4$ of the functions.

*The local inverses.* For a cube $\square$ of the scale $j$ the operator $G'(\square)$ is the one defined in Section 18: $\mathcal{D}^{-1}_{\Lambda'}$ with $\Lambda' = \Omega^{(j+1)}_{j+1}$ for $1 \le j \le k-1$, $(\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'})^{-1}$ with $\Lambda' = \Omega^{(1)}_1$ for $j = 0$, and $G_{(k)}$ for $j = k$. By (b) the support of $h_\square$ lies in the regions of the scales $j$ and $j+1$, on which the operator of the sequence and the inverse of $G'(\square)$ have the same averaging terms, so that $h_\square \Delta'_a G'(\square) = h_\square$.

*The two distances.* The bounds of Lemma 18.1 decay in the Euclidean distance, measured in the unit of the cube, and Bałaban's composition of the terms uses the distance (19.1); he passes from one to the other without comment [3, (2.44), (2.51)]. For the turned lattice, and for a cube which meets two regions, we check it.

**Lemma 20.1** (The Two Distances in a Cube)**.** *Let $\square \in \mathscr{D}$ be a cube of the scale $j$, and let $y, y' \in \mathfrak{B} \cap \square$. Then $d(y,y') \le 2|y-y'|_1/\ell_j + 34L$.*

*Proof.* The four hyperplanes through the centre of $\square$ divide it into $2^4$ boxes of the side $M\ell_j$, which are big blocks of the scale $j$, and each of them lies in $[\Omega_{j+1}]$ or in its complement, because $[\Omega_{j+1}]$ is a union of big blocks of the scale $j+1$ and these are unions of big blocks

of the scale $j$. By (c) a box of the first kind lies in $\mathcal{R}_{j+1}$ and a box of the second kind in $\mathcal{R}_j$; we call them coarse and fine.

Let first $j \geq 1$. The points $y$ and $y'$ belong to $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$, which contains $\ell_{j+1}\mathbb{Z}^4$. Let $p_0 = y, p_1, \dots, p_n = y'$ be the path of neighbours in $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$ which changes the coordinates one after the other, each monotonically, so that $n = |y - y'|_1/\ell_j$ and the path crosses each of the four hyperplanes at most once. Let $r$ be the map which replaces every coordinate of a point by the largest multiple of $\ell_{j+1}$ below or equal to it. Since the faces of the boxes lie in hyperplanes whose positions are multiples of $M\ell_j$, hence of $\ell_{j+1}$, the map $r$ maps every box to itself, and it maps the points of the path in the coarse boxes to points of $\mathfrak{B}$. We put $q_i \coloneqq p_i$ if $p_i$ lies in a fine box and $q_i \coloneqq r(p_i)$ if it lies in a coarse one, so that $q_0 = y$ and $q_n = y'$, and we join each $q_i$ to $q_{i+1}$ by a chain. If both points lie in fine boxes, the pair is a step of the scale $j$. If both lie in coarse boxes, then $q_i = q_{i+1}$ or the pair is a step of the scale $j+1$, and along the part of the path which changes one coordinate the second case occurs at most once in $L$ consecutive instances and once more. There remain the at most four instances in which the path passes between a fine and a coarse box, through a face in a hyperplane $\{x_\mu = t\}$. If the fine box is the one below the face, we move from the point of the fine box in its layer $\{x_\mu = t - \ell_j\}$, by at most $3(L-1)$ steps of the scale $j$, to the point whose other coordinates are those of the image under $r$ of the point of the coarse box, and one more step of the scale $j$ leads to this image, which lies on the face and hence in $\mathcal{R}_j \cap \mathcal{R}_{j+1}$. If the fine box is the one above, the point of the fine box lies on the face; we move within the face, by at most $3(L-1)$ steps of the scale $j$, to the point $u$ whose other coordinates are multiples of $\ell_{j+1}$, which belongs to $\ell_{j+1}\mathbb{Z}^4$ and to both regions, and the pair of $u$ and $u - \ell_{j+1}e_\mu$, the image under $r$ of the point of the coarse box, is a step of the scale $j+1$. Altogether the chain has at most $n + (n/L + 4) + 4 \cdot 3L$ steps.

For $j = 0$ the points of $\mathfrak{B}$ in the fine boxes are points of $T_\eta$, and we use the cells of Section 8. Since $M$ is a multiple of 5, the boxes are unions of cells. A point of a fine box is joined to the corner of its cell by at most 17 bonds inside the cell (Definition 8.2), and two neighbouring corners $z$ and $z + 5\eta e_\mu$ are joined by the connector from $z$, which has at most 7 bonds and stays in the closure of the cell of $z$ (Lemma 8.1). We apply the construction above to the lattice $5\eta\mathbb{Z}^4$ of the corners in the place of $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$, with $\ell_1 = (L/5) \cdot 5\eta$, starting from the corners of the cells of $y$ and $y'$, whose distance in $|\cdot|_1$ is at most $|y - y'|_1 + 20\eta$, and realising each step between corners in a fine box, or onto a face, by a connector. The path between the corners has $n_c \leq |y - y'|_1/(5\eta) + 4$ steps, and the chain has at most $34 + 7n_c + (5n_c/L + 4) + 4 \cdot 7 \cdot 3L/5$ steps. In both cases the number of steps is at most $2|y - y'|_1/\ell_j + 34L$, because $L \geq 64$. *q.e.d.*

Since $|v|_1 \leq 2|v|_2$ in four dimensions, the lemma gives $e^{-\delta|y-y'|_2/\ell_j} \leq e^{9L\delta}e^{-\frac{1}{4}\delta d(y,y')}$ for such points and every $\delta > 0$. We put

$$\bar{\delta}_0 \coloneqq \tfrac{1}{4}\min(\delta, \tfrac{1}{2}\theta_{00}, 1)\,, \tag{20.3}$$

with $\delta$ of Proposition 14.3 and $\theta_{00}$ of Lemma 18.2. This number takes the place of Bałaban's $\delta_0$ in the rest of the section, as in Lemma 19.2; it depends on $a$, $a_0$, and $L$.

**Proposition 20.2** (Proposition 2.2 for the Tilted Run)**.** *Let $L \geq 64$ be a multiple of 5, $a, a_0 > 0$, and $\bar{\delta}_0$ as in (20.3). There are numbers $M_0$ and $\varrho_0$, which depend on $a$, $a_0$, and $L$, such that for every sequence of domains with $R \geq 2$, $M \geq M_0$ a multiple of $L$, and $RM \geq \varrho_0$ the operator $\Delta'_a$ of the sequence has a bounded inverse $G'$, given by the expansion [3, (2.50)] with the cover and the local inverses above, and $G'$ satisfies the bounds [3, (2.67), p. 234] with $\bar{\delta}_0$ in the place of $\delta_0$ and with constants which depend on $a$, $a_0$, $L$, and the Hölder exponent, and not on $k$, on the sequence, on $M$, or on $R$.*

*Proof.* We follow [3, (2.37)–(2.66)] and name the inputs. Since $h_\square \Delta'_a G'(\square) = h_\square$ and $\sum_\square h_\square^2 = 1$, we have $\Delta'_a G'_0 = I - R$ with $G'_0$ and $R$ as in [3, (2.37), (2.38)] and the commutator $K(h)$ of [3, (2.39)]: its first two terms are those of (17.4), and its averaging term at a point $x$ of a block of the scale $j'$ is $a_{j'}\ell_{j'}^{-2}$ times the mean of $(h(x') - h(x))\lambda(x')$ over the points $x'$ of this block. Let $\square$ be a cube of the scale $j$, and let $\lambda$ be supported in a block of the sequence in $\square$. By (d), and because a block which meets the support of $h_\square$ has the scale $j$ or $j+1$ and a diameter of at most $2L\ell_j$, the three terms of $K(h_\square)$ applied to a function $\phi$ are at most $\varkappa(M\ell_j)^{-1}$ times the sum of the moduli of the eight difference quotients of $\phi$ at the point, $4\varkappa_2(M\ell_j)^{-2}|\phi|$, and $2a\varkappa LM^{-1}\ell_j^{-2}$ times the supremum of $|\phi|$ over the block. With $\phi = G'(\square)h_\square\lambda$ and Lemma 18.1(iv), or Lemma 18.2, this gives $|(K(h_\square)G'(\square)h_\square\lambda)(x)| \le cLM^{-1}e^{-\delta D/\ell_j}\sup|\lambda|$, where $D$ is the Euclidean distance of the block of $x$ from the support of $\lambda$, which is [3, (2.44)]. Since $D$ differs from the distance of the two points of $\mathfrak{B}$ by at most $4L\ell_j$, Lemma 20.1 and (20.3) turn it into [3, (2.51)] for $R$, the factor $e^{13L\delta}$ and the number of the cubes which contribute at a point entering the constant. The composition [3, (2.52)–(2.56)] uses the triangle inequality of the distance and Lemma 2.1, which is Lemma 19.2 at $\alpha = \frac{1}{2}$; it gives [3, (2.64), (2.65)] and the convergence of the series for $M$ large. The series $G'_0\sum_n R^n$ is then a bounded right inverse of $\Delta'_a$ on the bounded functions. The operator $\Delta'_a$ is bounded below on the square-summable functions, by [3, (2.11)] with Lemma 8.3 in the place of the bound for a cube, and the series applied to a function of finite support gives a square-summable function, by its decay, so that the series is the inverse $G'$. The first factor $h_\square G'(\square)h_\square$ of a term is bounded by Lemma 18.1(iv) and Lemma 20.1 in the same way; at a point of the region of the scale $j$ the cubes which contribute have the scales $j$ and $j-1$, and $\ell_{j-1} \le \ell_j$. This gives [3, (2.66)], the first bound of [3, (2.67)], and, with the second and third bounds of (18.3) for the first factor, the bounds on $\nabla G'\lambda$ and on its Hölder norm. For the Laplace operator on the left we use (17.4) and the last bound of Lemma 18.1(v).

For the two bounds with a derivative of the source the series $G'_0\sum_n R^n$ cannot be used term by term, because its terms with $n \ge 1$ contain a derivative of $G'(\square)$ applied to a derivative of the source, which is not bounded in the supremum norm. We use the adjoint series instead. Since $G'$, $G'_0$, and the operators $G'(\square)$ are symmetric, $G' = \sum_n (R^*)^n G'_0$ with $R^* = \sum_\square h_\square G'(\square)K(h_\square)^*$, and the adjoint of $K(h)$ consists of the operator $g \mapsto \sum_\nu \partial'^*_\nu((\partial'_\nu h)g)$ and its counterpart for the backward differences, of the multiplication by the second differences of $h$, and of an averaging term of the same form as that of $K(h)$. Every term of the series for $G'\partial'^*_\nu\lambda$ therefore ends with $G'(\square)h_\square\partial'^*_\nu\lambda$, in which $h_\square\partial'^*_\nu\lambda$ is $\partial'^*_\nu(h_\square\lambda)$ plus a difference quotient of $h_\square$ times a translate of $\lambda$, and it contains the operators $G'(\square)$ applied to bounded functions and to the adjoint derivatives $\partial'^*_\nu$ of bounded functions only. The first two bounds of Lemma 18.1(v) and Lemma 20.1 give the bound [3, (2.51)] for $R^*$ and the bounds on $G'\nabla^*\lambda$ and on its Hölder norm as before. *q.e.d.*

Bałaban's bounds [3, (2.68), (2.83)] compare powers of $L^{j-j'}$ with the factor [3, (2.60)], and we do the same below. This requires $\bar\delta_0 RM$ to be larger than a multiple of $\log L$, a condition which he does not state and which appears among the hypotheses of Lemma 20.5 and of Proposition 20.6.

*Conventions for the functions on* $\mathfrak{B}$. The average $Q'$ of the sequence maps a function $\lambda$ on $T_\eta$ to the function on $\mathfrak{B}$ whose value at $y \in \Lambda_j$ is the mean of $\lambda$ over the block $B(y) := B_{\ell_j}(y)$ for $j \ge 1$, and $\lambda(y)$ for $j = 0$, in which case we put $B(y) := \{y\}$ [3, p. 225]. We write $j(y)$ for the scale of a point $y \in \mathfrak{B}$ and $\mathsf{w}(y) := \ell_{j(y)}^4$, which is $\eta^4$ times the number of the points of $B(y)$. The functions on $\mathfrak{B}$ carry the scalar product $\langle\omega,\omega'\rangle := \sum_{y\in\mathfrak{B}} \mathsf{w}(y)\omega(y)\omega'(y)$ of [3, (2.69)], so that $(Q'^*\omega)(x) = \omega(y)$ for $x \in B(y)$, $Q'Q'^* = I$, and $\|Q'^*\omega\| = \|\omega\|$. As in [3,

(2.68), (2.81), (2.87)], the *kernel* of an operator $K$ on the functions on $\mathfrak{B}$ is the function $K(y,y')$ with $(K\omega)(y) = \sum_{y'} \mathsf{w}(y')K(y,y')\omega(y')$, and the kernel of a product $KK'$ is then $\sum_{y''} \mathsf{w}(y'')K(y,y'')K'(y'',y')$. For two points, $|y-y'|$ without an index is the Euclidean distance, as in Section 18, and we put $\mathsf{z}(\vartheta) := \sum_{n\in\mathbb{Z}^4} e^{-\vartheta|n|}$ for $\vartheta > 0$.

*The local operators.* For a cube $\square \in \mathscr{D}$ of the scale $j$ we write $A_\square := G'(\square)$, $\ell_\square := \ell_j$, and $\mathfrak{B}_\square := \mathfrak{B} \cap \square$, and we use the letter $\square$ also for the multiplication of a function on $\mathfrak{B}$ by the characteristic function of $\mathfrak{B}_\square$; the function $h_\square$ acts on the functions on $\mathfrak{B}$ through its values at the points of $\mathfrak{B}$. For the inverse of $Q'G'^2Q'^*$ Bałaban takes, for each cube, $C_\square := ((Q'G'(\tilde\square)^2Q'^*) \restriction_\square)^{-1}$ and $C := \sum_\square h_\square C_\square h_\square$, where $G'(\tilde\square)$ is the inverse on a box $\tilde\square$ of the size $4M$ around $\square$ [3, (2.70), p. 235]. We take $A_\square$ in the place of $G'(\tilde\square)$ and put

$$N_\square := \square\, Q' A_\square^2 Q'^*\, \square\,, \qquad C := \sum_{\square\in\mathscr{D}} h_\square C_\square h_\square\,, \tag{20.4}$$

where $C_\square$ is the inverse of $N_\square$ on the functions on $\mathfrak{B}_\square$, extended by zero to the functions on $\mathfrak{B}$; it exists by Lemma 20.4 below. We first collect what the cover gives for the distance (19.1).

**Lemma 20.3** (The Support of $h_\square$ and the Distance)**.** *Let $\square \in \mathscr{D}$ be a cube of the scale $j$, and let $y'' \in \mathfrak{B}$ be a point of the support of $h_\square$.*

*(i) Every point of $\mathfrak{B}_\square$ has the scale $j$ or $j+1$, its block lies in $\square$, and $d(y,y') \le 16M+34L$ for all $y, y' \in \mathfrak{B}_\square$.*

*(ii) $d(y,y'') \ge M/(3L)$ for every $y \in \mathfrak{B}$ outside $\square$.*

*(iii) $d(u,y'') \ge M/3$ for every $u \in \mathfrak{B}$ whose scale is smaller than $j$ or larger than $j+1$.*

*Proof.* We use four facts. First, a point of $\mathfrak{B}$ of the scale $m$ lies in $[\Omega_m]$ and not in $[\Omega_{m+1}]$, by the definition of $\Lambda_m$. Secondly, the closed region $\mathcal{R}_m$ lies in the closure of $[\Omega_m]$; here and below $[\Omega_m] := \emptyset$ for $m > k$ and $\ell_{k+1} := L\ell_k$. Thirdly, a step of the scale $m$ changes the position by at most $\ell_m$ in $|\cdot|_\infty$ (Section 19), and the distance of a point from a fixed set, taken in $|\cdot|_\infty$, changes by at most as much. Fourthly, $\square$ does not meet the closure of $[\Omega_{j+2}]$: by the proof of (c) the cube contains a point at a distance of less than $\frac{5}{3}M\ell_{j+1}$ from the complement of $[\Omega_{j+1}]$ and its side is less than $\frac{1}{3}M\ell_{j+1}$, so that each of its points is at a distance of less than $2M\ell_{j+1}$ from this complement, while every point of the closure of $[\Omega_{j+2}]$ is at a distance of at least $RM\ell_{j+1} \ge 2M\ell_{j+1}$ from it (Section 19).

(i) Let $y \in \mathfrak{B}_\square$ have the scale $m$. Since $\square \subset [\Omega_j]$ by the definition of $V_j$, the point $y$ lies in $[\Omega_j]$, which contains $[\Omega_{m+1}]$ if $m < j$; hence $m \ge j$ by the first fact. If $m \ge j+2$, then $y \in [\Omega_m] \subset [\Omega_{j+2}]$, against the fourth fact. By (c) the cube is a union of blocks of the sequence, and $y$ lies in its block, so that this block lies in $\square$. For $y, y' \in \mathfrak{B}_\square$ we have $|y-y'|_1 \le 4|y-y'|_\infty < 8M\ell_j$, and Lemma 20.1 gives $d(y,y') \le 16M+34L$.

(ii) Let $q_0 = y'', q_1, \dots, q_n = y$ be a chain of steps, and let $\mathsf{d}(q)$ be the distance of $q$ from the complement of $\square$. By (b), $\mathsf{d}(q_0) \ge \frac{1}{3}M\ell_j$, and $\mathsf{d}(q_n) = 0$. Let $t$ be the first index with $\mathsf{d}(q_t) = 0$. For $i < t$ the point $q_i$ lies in $\square$, hence outside the closure of $[\Omega_{j+2}]$ by the fourth fact and in no region $\mathcal{R}_m$ with $m \ge j+2$ by the second, so that the step from $q_i$ to $q_{i+1}$ has a scale of at most $j+1$ and, by the third fact, lowers $\mathsf{d}$ by at most $\ell_{j+1}$. Hence $t\ell_{j+1} \ge \frac{1}{3}M\ell_j$ and $n \ge t \ge M/(3L)$.

(iii) Let $q_0 = y'', \dots, q_n = u$ be a chain of steps. Suppose first that the scale of $u$ is smaller than $j$, so that $u$ does not lie in $[\Omega_j]$ by the first fact, and let $\mathsf{d}(q)$ be the distance of

$q$ from the complement of $[\Omega_j]$. Then $\mathsf{d}(q_n) = 0$ and $\mathsf{d}(q_0) \geq \frac{1}{3}M\ell_j$ by (b). Let $s$ be the last index for which $q_s$ lies in the closure of $[\Omega_{j+1}]$, and $s := 0$ if there is none. In the first case $\mathsf{d}(q_s) \geq RM\ell_j$, because the distance of $[\Omega_{j+1}]$ from the complement of $[\Omega_j]$ is at least $RM\ell_j$ (Section 19); in both cases $\mathsf{d}(q_s) \geq \frac{1}{3}M\ell_j$. For $i > s$ the point $q_i$ lies outside the closure of $[\Omega_{j+1}]$, hence in no region $\mathcal{R}_m$ with $m \geq j+1$, so that the step from $q_{i-1}$ to $q_i$ has a scale of at most $j$ and lowers $\mathsf{d}$ by at most $\ell_j$. Hence $(n-s)\ell_j \geq \frac{1}{3}M\ell_j$ and $n \geq M/3$. Suppose now that the scale of $u$ is larger than $j+1$, so that $u \in [\Omega_{j+2}]$, and let $\mathsf{d}(q)$ be the distance of $q$ from $[\Omega_{j+2}]$. Then $\mathsf{d}(q_n) = 0$ and $\mathsf{d}(q_0) \geq \frac{1}{3}M\ell_{j+1}$ by (b). Let $t$ be the first index with $\mathsf{d}(q_t) = 0$. For $i < t$ the point $q_i$ lies outside the closure of $[\Omega_{j+2}]$, the step from $q_i$ to $q_{i+1}$ has a scale of at most $j+1$ as in (ii), and it lowers $\mathsf{d}$ by at most $\ell_{j+1}$. Hence $t\ell_{j+1} \geq \frac{1}{3}M\ell_{j+1}$ and $n \geq M/3$. *q.e.d.*

The next lemma contains the three properties of the local operators which the construction uses. Bałaban proves the lower bound [3, (2.78)] with Bessel's inequality and a comparison of the box with the whole lattice [3, (2.73), (2.74)]; for the operators of Section 18 there is no box, and the comparison disappears.

**Lemma 20.4** (The Local Inverses)**.** *Let $L \geq 64$ be a multiple of 5 and $a, a_0 > 0$. There are constants $c_A$, $c_N$, $c_\square$ and a rate $\theta_\square \in (0, \frac{1}{384}\bar{\delta}_0]$, which depend on $a$, $a_0$, and $L$ only, such that for every sequence of domains with $R \geq 2$ and $M$ a multiple of $L$, and every cube $\square \in \mathscr{D}$ of the scale $j$, the following hold.*

*(i) For every bounded, square-summable function $f$ on $T_\eta$ and every $x \in T_\eta$, with $D := \operatorname{dist}(x, \operatorname{supp} f)$,*

$$|(A_\square f)(x)| \leq c_A \ell_j^2 e^{-4\bar{\delta}_0 D/\ell_j} \sup|f| \,, \qquad |(A_\square^2 f)(x)| \leq c_N \ell_j^4 e^{-2\bar{\delta}_0 D/\ell_j} \sup|f| \,. \tag{20.5}$$

*(ii) For every function $\omega$ on $\mathfrak{B}_\square$,*

$$\langle \omega, N_\square \omega \rangle \geq \gamma_j^2 \, \ell_j^4 \|\omega\|^2 \,, \qquad \gamma_{\mathsf{T}} := \frac{t_0}{1 + a t_0} \,, \qquad \gamma_0 := \frac{1}{16 + a_0 + a} \,, \tag{20.6}$$

*where $\gamma_j := \gamma_{\mathsf{T}}$ for $j \geq 1$ and $t_0 := c_u/(4\pi^2)$ with $c_u$ of Section 12.*

*(iii) The operator $N_\square$ on the functions on $\mathfrak{B}_\square$ has an inverse $C_\square$, whose kernel satisfies*

$$|C_\square(y, y')| \leq c_\square \ell_j^{-8} e^{-\theta_\square |y - y'|/\ell_j} \tag{20.7}$$

*for all $y, y' \in \mathfrak{B}_\square$.*

*Proof.* (i) The first bound is Lemma 18.1(iv) for $1 \leq j \leq k-1$, Proposition 14.3 for $j = k$, where $\ell_k = 1$, and Lemma 18.2 for $j = 0$, where $\ell_0 = \eta$; the rates of these statements are $\delta$, $\delta$, and $\frac{1}{2}\theta_{00}$, each of which is at least $4\bar{\delta}_0$ by (20.3), and $c_A$ is the largest of their constants. For the second bound let $S$ be the support of $f$, put $g := A_\square f$ and $r := 4\bar{\delta}_0$, and let $g_n$, $n \geq 0$, be the product of $g$ and of the characteristic function of the set of the points $z$ with $n\ell_j \leq \operatorname{dist}(z, S) < (n+1)\ell_j$. By the first bound $\sup|g_n| \leq c_A \ell_j^2 e^{-rn} \sup|f|$, and a point of the support of $g_n$ is at a distance of less than $(n+1)\ell_j$ from $S$, so that $\operatorname{dist}(x, \operatorname{supp} g_n) \geq D - (n+1)\ell_j$. The functions $g_n$ have disjoint supports and their sum $g$ is square-summable, so that $g = \sum_n g_n$ converges in the space of the square-summable functions, on which $A_\square$ is bounded; hence $A_\square g = \sum_n A_\square g_n$ at every point, and the first bound, applied to each $g_n$, gives with $t := D/\ell_j$

$$|(A_\square^2 f)(x)| \leq c_A^2 \ell_j^4 \sup|f| \sum_{n \geq 0} e^{-rn} e^{-r \max(t-n-1, 0)} \,. \tag{20.8}$$

Each of the at most $t$ terms with $n+1 \le t$ equals $e^r e^{-rt}$, and the terms with $n > t-1$ add up to at most $e^{-r(t-1)}/(1-e^{-r})$. Since $te^{-rt/2} \le 2/(er)$, the sum is at most $e^r(2/(er)+1/(1-e^{-r}))e^{-rt/2}$, which is the second bound with $c_N := c_A^2 e^r(2/(er)+1/(1-e^{-r}))$.

(ii) Let first $j \ge 1$, and let $\mathsf{q} = Q'_{\ell_j}$ as in Section 18. By Lemma 20.3(i) a point of $\mathfrak{B}_\square$ has the scale $j$ or $j+1$. Let $\omega_1$ be the function on $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$ which equals $\omega(y)$ at the points $y$ of $\mathfrak{B}_\square$ of the scale $j$, equals $\omega(y)$ at the $L^4$ points $z$ with $y_\mu \le z_\mu < y_\mu + \ell_{j+1}$ for each point $y$ of $\mathfrak{B}_\square$ of the scale $j+1$, and vanishes elsewhere; this is the function $Q''^*\omega$ of [3, p. 236]. Since $\ell_{j+1}^4 = L^4\ell_j^4$, we have $\|\omega_1\| = \|\omega\|$, and since the block $B_{\ell_{j+1}}(y)$ is the union of the blocks $B_{\ell_j}(z)$ over these $z$ (Lemma 6.2(i)), $Q'^*\omega = \mathsf{q}^*\omega_1$. Hence

$$\langle \omega, N_\square \omega\rangle = \|A_\square \mathsf{q}^*\omega_1\|^2 \ge \|\mathsf{q}A_\square\mathsf{q}^*\omega_1\|^2 \ge \frac{\langle \omega_1, \mathsf{q}A_\square\mathsf{q}^*\omega_1\rangle^2}{\|\omega_1\|^2}\ . \tag{20.9}$$

The equality is [3, (2.71), (2.72)]; the first inequality holds because $\mathsf{q}^*\mathsf{q} = P_{(j)}$ is a projection, so that $\|\mathsf{q}\phi\|^2 = \langle\phi, P_{(j)}\phi\rangle \le \|\phi\|^2$ for every $\phi$, and the second is Schwarz's inequality, which replaces Bessel's inequality of [3, (2.73)]. For $j \le k-1$ the second term of (18.2), multiplied by $\mathsf{q}$ on the left and by $\mathsf{q}^*$ on the right, is of the form $\mathsf{X}^*C_\Lambda\mathsf{X}$, and $C_\Lambda$ is the inverse of a nonnegative operator, hence nonnegative; therefore $\mathsf{q}A_\square\mathsf{q}^* \ge \mathsf{q}G_{(j)}\mathsf{q}^*$, and for $j = k$ the two sides are equal. In the unit $\ell_j$ the operator $\mathsf{q}G_{(j)}\mathsf{q}^*$ is the multiplication by $\mathsf{T}(p')/(1+a_j\mathsf{T}(p'))$ in the momentum representation, with the symbols of the run of $j$ steps, as in the proof of Lemma 14.2. For $p' \in [-\pi,\pi]^4$ the term $l = 0$ of the sum which defines $\mathsf{T}$ gives $\mathsf{T}(p') \ge |u_k(p')|^2/\Delta(p') \ge c_u/(4\pi^2) = t_0$, by the bounds $|u_k|^2 \ge c_u$ and $\Delta \le 4\pi^2$ on this cube which the proof of Proposition 12.2 uses; at $p' = 0$, where $\Delta$ vanishes, the multiplier is $1/a_j$. Since $t \mapsto t/(1+a_jt)$ increases and $a_j \le a$, the multiplier is at least $\gamma_\mathsf{T}$, so that $\langle\omega_1, \mathsf{q}G_{(j)}\mathsf{q}^*\omega_1\rangle \ge \gamma_\mathsf{T}\ell_j^2\|\omega_1\|^2$ in the unit of the last lattice, which is [3, (2.76)]; with (20.9) this gives (20.6). For $j = 0$ we have $A_\square = (\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'})^{-1} \ge \gamma_0\eta^2$ by the upper bound of Lemma 18.2, hence $A_\square^2 \ge \gamma_0^2\eta^4$, and $\langle\omega, N_\square\omega\rangle = \|A_\square Q'^*\omega\|^2 \ge \gamma_0^2\eta^4\|Q'^*\omega\|^2 = \gamma_0^2\eta^4\|\omega\|^2$.

(iii) By (ii) the operator $N_\square$, which acts on a space of finite dimension, has an inverse. For $y, y' \in \mathfrak{B}_\square$ its kernel is $N_\square(y,y') = \mathsf{w}(y')^{-1}\mathsf{n}(y,y')$, where $\mathsf{n}(y,y')$ is the mean of $A_\square^2\mathbf{1}_{B(y')}$ over $B(y)$, because $Q'^*\omega = \sum_{y'}\omega(y')\mathbf{1}_{B(y')}$. By Lemma 20.3(i) the two blocks have scales of at most $j+1$, so that each of them lies in a cube of the side $L\ell_j$, whose Euclidean diameter is $2L\ell_j$, and contains its point of $\mathfrak{B}$. A point of $B(y)$ is therefore at a distance of at least $|y-y'| - 4L\ell_j$ from $B(y')$, and (20.5) gives

$$|\mathsf{n}(y,y')| \le c_N e^{8L\bar\delta_0}\ell_j^4 e^{-2\bar\delta_0|y-y'|/\ell_j}\ . \tag{20.10}$$

The functions $\mathsf{w}(y)^{-1/2}\mathbf{1}_{\{y\}}$, $y \in \mathfrak{B}_\square$, form an orthonormal basis, in which $\ell_j^{-4}N_\square$ has the matrix $\mathsf{M}(y,y') := \ell_j^{-4}\mathsf{w}(y)^{1/2}\mathsf{n}(y,y')\mathsf{w}(y')^{-1/2}$. This matrix is symmetric, because $N_\square$ is self-adjoint, it is bounded below by $\gamma_*^2 := \min(\gamma_\mathsf{T},\gamma_0)^2$ by (ii), and since the weights of two points of $\mathfrak{B}_\square$ differ by the factor $L^4$ at most, $|\mathsf{M}(y,y')| \le L^2c_Ne^{8L\bar\delta_0}e^{-2\bar\delta_0|y-y'|/\ell_j}$. The differences of the points of $\mathfrak{B}_\square$ lie in $\ell_j\mathbb{Z}^4$ for $j \ge 1$ and in $\eta\rho\mathbb{Z}^4$ for $j = 0$, and $\rho$ preserves the Euclidean length, so that for every $y$ and every $\theta \le \bar\delta_0$

$$\sum_{y'\in\mathfrak{B}_\square}|\mathsf{M}(y,y')|(e^{\theta|y-y'|/\ell_j}-1) \le L^2c_Ne^{8L\bar\delta_0}\sum_{n\in\mathbb{Z}^4}e^{-2\bar\delta_0|n|}(e^{\theta|n|}-1)\ . \tag{20.11}$$

The terms of the last sum are at most $e^{-\bar\delta_0|n|}$ and tend to zero with $\theta$, so that the sum tends to zero by dominated convergence, and we let $\theta_\square \in (0, \frac{1}{384}\bar\delta_0]$ be so small that the right side of (20.11) is at most $\frac12\gamma_*^2$ for $\theta = \theta_\square$. Lemma 14.1 on the set $\mathfrak{B}_\square$ with the metric $|y-y'|/\ell_j$ then gives $|\mathsf{M}^{-1}(y,y')| \le (2/\gamma_*^2)e^{-\theta_\square|y-y'|/\ell_j}$; this is the second of the two methods

which Bałaban names for [3, (2.79)]. In the same basis $C_\square$ has the matrix $\ell_j^{-4}\mathsf{M}^{-1}(y,y') = \mathsf{w}(y)^{1/2}C_\square(y,y')\mathsf{w}(y')^{1/2}$, and $\mathsf{w} \ge \ell_j^4$ on $\mathfrak{B}_\square$, which gives (20.7) with $c_\square := 2/\gamma_*^2$. It is [3, (2.81)]. *q.e.d.*

There remains the difference between the squares of $G'$ and of a local operator, for which Bałaban refers to "the usual estimate of the type (1.12) [3] connected with a change of a domain" [3, p. 238]. Here the two operators are the inverses of operators which differ only far from the support of $h_\square$, in the distance of the sequence, and the estimate follows from the resolvent identity. The difference of the two operators themselves cannot be made small in this way at every point, since the decay of $A_\square$ is Euclidean and does not pay the powers of $L$ which the finer regions produce; the identity is therefore arranged so that $G'$, whose decay is measured in the distance of the sequence, stands next to the source.

**Lemma 20.5** (The Change of the Domain)**.** *Suppose that the hypotheses of Proposition 20.2 hold, that the condition of Lemma 19.2 holds for $\alpha = \frac{1}{16}$, and that $\bar\delta_0 RM \ge 32 \log L$. There is a constant $c_E$, which depends on $a$, $a_0$, and $L$ only, such that for every cube $\square \in \mathscr{D}$ of the scale $j$, every bounded function $f$ on $T_\eta$ which is supported in the union of the blocks $B(y'')$ of the points $y'' \in \mathfrak{B}$ of the support of $h_\square$, and every $x \in T_\eta$,*

$$|((G'^2 - A_\square^2)f)(x)| \le c_E\, \ell_j^4 e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/48} \sup|f| \,. \tag{20.12}$$

*Proof.* Let $S$ be the set of the points of $\mathfrak{B}$ in the support of $h_\square$. It is finite, so that $f$ has a finite support, and its points have the scales $j$ and $j+1$ by Lemma 20.3(i). For $u \in \mathfrak{B}$ we write $d(u,S)$ for the least of the distances $d(u,y'')$, $y'' \in S$. We write $c_G$ for the constant of the bounds [3, (2.67)] in Proposition 20.2, $\bar a := \max(a, a_0)$, and $c_1(\alpha)$ for the constant of Lemma 19.2; by the remark which follows that lemma, [3, (2.61)] holds for every $\alpha \in [\frac{1}{16}, 1)$.

*The resolvent identity.* Let $E := \Delta'_a - A_\square^{-1}$. Then $A_\square - G' = A_\square E G'$, and therefore

$$A_\square^2 - G'^2 = A_\square(A_\square - G') + (A_\square - G')G' = A_\square^2 E G' + A_\square E G'^2 \,. \tag{20.13}$$

Both $\Delta'_a$ and $A_\square^{-1}$ are the sum of $-\Delta$ and of an averaging term, which at a point $z$ is a constant times the mean over a block which contains $z$. For $\Delta'_a$ it is the block of the sequence, of some scale $m$, with the constant $a_m \ell_m^{-2} \le \bar a \ell_m^{-2}$. For $A_\square^{-1}$ it is the block of the scale $j$ with the constant $\alpha_j \le a\ell_j^{-2}$ if $z \notin \Omega_{j+1}$, and the block of the scale $j+1$ with the constant $\alpha_{j+1} \le a\ell_{j+1}^{-2}$ if $z \in \Omega_{j+1}$ (Section 18); for $j = 0$ the first of these is the mass $a_0\eta^{-2}$ at the point, and for $j = k$ there is only the first. On $\Omega_j \setminus \Omega_{j+2}$ the two averaging terms agree. Hence $(Eg)(z) = 0$ for $z \in \Omega_j \setminus \Omega_{j+2}$, and at every other point

$$|(Eg)(z)| \le \bar a\, \ell_m^{-2} \sup_B |g| + a\, \ell_{j'}^{-2} \sup_{B'} |g| \,, \tag{20.14}$$

where $B$ is the block of the sequence which contains $z$ and $m$ is its scale, and where $B'$ is the block of the scale $j' := j$ which contains $z$ if $z \notin \Omega_j$, and the block of the scale $j' := j+1$ which contains $z$ if $z \in \Omega_{j+2}$. Since $\Omega_j$ and $\Omega_{j+2}$ are unions of blocks of the scales $j$ and $j+2$, the block $B'$ is in the first case a union of blocks of the sequence of scales smaller than $j$, and in the second case it lies in one block of the sequence, of a scale of at least $j+2$. In both cases every block of the sequence which meets $B$ or $B'$ is the block of a point $u \in \mathfrak{B}$ whose scale is smaller than $j$ or larger than $j+1$, so that

$$d(u,S) \ge \tfrac{1}{3}M \tag{20.15}$$

by Lemma 20.3(iii).

*The function $G'f$.* Let $z'$ lie in the block of a point $u \in \mathfrak{B}$ of the scale $m$. We write $f$ as the sum of its restrictions to the blocks $B(y'')$, $y'' \in S$, and apply [3, (2.67)] to each of them:

$$|(G'f)(z')| \le c_G \ell_m^2 \sum_{y'' \in S} e^{-\frac{1}{2}\bar\delta_0 d(u,y'')} \sup|f| \le c_G c_1(\tfrac14)\, \ell_m^2 e^{-\frac14 \bar\delta_0 d(u,S)} \sup|f| \,. \tag{20.16}$$

The second inequality takes the factor $e^{-\frac14\bar\delta_0 d(u,y'')} \le e^{-\frac14\bar\delta_0 d(u,S)}$ out of the sum and uses [3, (2.61)] with $\alpha = \frac14$ for the rest.

*The powers of $L$.* For $u \in \mathfrak{B}$ of the scale $m$ and $y'' \in S$ we have $m - j \le 2 + \max(|m - j(y'')| - 1, 0)$, because $j(y'') \le j + 1$. By [3, (2.60)] with $\alpha = \frac{1}{16}$ and by $\frac{1}{16}\bar\delta_0 RM \ge 2 \log L$, taking for $y''$ a point of $S$ nearest to $u$,

$$L^{2(m-j)} \le L^4 e^{\frac{1}{16}\bar\delta_0 d(u,S)} \,. \tag{20.17}$$

*The first term of* (20.13). We insert (20.16) into (20.14) with $g = G'f$. For the block $B$ the factor $\ell_m^{-2}$ cancels $\ell_m^2$. For $B'$ in the first case the blocks of the sequence in $B'$ have scales $m' < j$, and $\ell_j^{-2}\ell_{m'}^2 \le 1$. In the second case $B'$ lies in a block of the sequence of the scale $m' \ge j + 2$, and $\ell_{j+1}^{-2}\ell_{m'}^2 = L^{-2}L^{2(m'-j)} \le L^2 e^{\frac{1}{16}\bar\delta_0 d(u,S)}$ by (20.17). With (20.15) and $(\frac14 - \frac{1}{16})\frac13 = \frac{1}{16}$ this gives

$$\sup|EG'f| \le 2\bar a c_G c_1(\tfrac14) L^2 e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/16} \sup|f| \,. \tag{20.18}$$

The function $EG'f$ is bounded and square-summable, and the first bound of (20.5), applied twice, gives $|(A_\square^2 EG'f)(x)| \le c_A^2 \ell_j^4 \sup|EG'f|$.

*The second term.* Let again $z'$ lie in the block of $u \in \mathfrak{B}$ of the scale $m$. We write $G'f$ as the sum of its restrictions to the blocks $B(v)$, $v \in \mathfrak{B}$, which converges in the space of the square-summable functions, and apply [3, (2.67)] to each of them, with (20.16) for its supremum:

$$|(G'^2 f)(z')| \le c_G^2 c_1(\tfrac14)\, \ell_m^2 \sum_{v \in \mathfrak{B}} e^{-\frac12\bar\delta_0 d(u,v)}\, \ell_{j(v)}^2 e^{-\frac14\bar\delta_0 d(v,S)} \sup|f| \,. \tag{20.19}$$

By (20.17), $\ell_{j(v)}^2 = \ell_j^2 L^{2(j(v)-j)} \le L^4 \ell_j^2 e^{\frac{1}{16}\bar\delta_0 d(v,S)}$. The triangle inequality gives $e^{-\frac18\bar\delta_0 d(u,v)} e^{-\frac18\bar\delta_0 d(v,S)} \le e^{-\frac18\bar\delta_0 d(u,S)}$, and the remaining factors are at most $e^{-\frac38\bar\delta_0 d(u,v)}$, whose sum over $v$ is at most $c_1(\frac38)$ by [3, (2.61)]. Hence

$$|(G'^2 f)(z')| \le c_G^2 c_1(\tfrac14) c_1(\tfrac38) L^4\, \ell_j^2 \ell_m^2 e^{-\frac18\bar\delta_0 d(u,S)} \sup|f| \,. \tag{20.20}$$

We insert this into (20.14) with $g = G'^2 f$. The three kinds of blocks give the same factors as before, namely 1, $\ell_j^{-2}\ell_{m'}^2 \le 1$, and $L^{-2}L^{2(m'-j)} \le L^2 e^{\frac{1}{16}\bar\delta_0 d(u,S)}$, and with (20.15) and $(\frac18 - \frac{1}{16})\frac13 = \frac{1}{48}$,

$$\sup|EG'^2 f| \le 2\bar a c_G^2 c_1(\tfrac14) c_1(\tfrac38) L^6\, \ell_j^2 e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/48} \sup|f| \,. \tag{20.21}$$

By the first bound of (20.5), $|(A_\square EG'^2 f)(x)| \le c_A \ell_j^2 \sup|EG'^2 f|$. Adding the two terms of (20.13) gives (20.12) with $c_E := 2\bar a c_A c_G c_1(\frac14) L^6 (c_A + c_G c_1(\frac38))$. *q.e.d.*

**Proposition 20.6** (Proposition 2.3 for the Tilted Run)**.** *Let $L \ge 64$ be a multiple of 5, $a, a_0 > 0$, $\theta_\square$ as in Lemma 20.4, and $\delta_1 := \frac14\theta_\square$. There are numbers $M_1 \ge M_0$, $\varrho_1 \ge \varrho_0$, and $c$, which depend on $a$, $a_0$, and $L$ only, such that for every sequence of domains with $R \ge 2$, $M \ge M_1$ a multiple of $L$, and $RM \ge \varrho_1$ the following hold for all $y, y' \in \mathfrak{B}$, of the scales $j$ and $j'$.*

*(i) The kernel of* $N \coloneqq Q'G'^2Q'^*$ *satisfies* $|N(y,y')| \le c\,\ell_j^4\ell_{j'}^{-4}e^{-\frac14\bar\delta_0 d(y,y')}$, *which is [3, (2.68), p. 235].*

*(ii) The operator* $N$ *has a bounded inverse on the square-summable functions on* $\mathfrak{B}$. *On the functions of finite support it is given by the series [3, (2.86)] with the operators* (20.4), *and* $|N^{-1}(y,y')| \le c\,\ell_j^{-4}\ell_{j'}^{-4}e^{-\frac12\delta_1 d(y,y')}$, *which is [3, (2.87), p. 238].*

*(iii) Let* $P \coloneqq G'Q'^*N^{-1}Q'G'$. *For* $x \in B(y)$, $x' \in B(y')$, *and all* $\mu$ *and* $\nu$, *the kernel of* $\partial'_\mu P \partial'^*_\nu$ *with respect to the sum over the points of* $T_\eta$ *with the weights* $\eta^4$ *is at most* $c\,\ell_j^{-2}\ell_{j'}^{-4}e^{-\frac18\delta_1 d(y,y')}$ *in modulus, which is [3, (2.88)] with* $\delta_2 = \frac18\delta_1$.

*Proof.* We write $c_G$, $\bar a$, and $c_1(\alpha)$ as in the proof of Lemma 20.5, and we put $\alpha_1 \coloneqq \delta_1/(2\bar\delta_0)$ and $\alpha_2 \coloneqq \delta_1/(8\bar\delta_0)$. Let $\varrho_1 \ge \varrho_0$ be such that $RM \ge \varrho_1$ implies the condition of Lemma 19.2 for $\alpha = \alpha_2$ and the inequality $\delta_1 RM \ge 32\log L$. Since $\delta_1 \le \bar\delta_0/1536$, we have $\alpha_2 < \frac{1}{16}$, so that [3, (2.61)] holds for every $\alpha \in [\alpha_2, 1)$ by the remark which follows Lemma 19.2, and the hypotheses of Lemma 20.5 are satisfied. We use [3, (2.60)] in the following form: if $p > 0$ and $\alpha\bar\delta_0 RM \ge p\log L$, then for all $u, v \in \mathfrak{B}$

$$L^{p(j(u)-j(v))} \le L^p e^{\alpha\bar\delta_0 d(u,v)}\,, \tag{20.22}$$

because $j(u) - j(v) \le 1 + \max(|j(u) - j(v)| - 1, 0)$. By the choice of $\varrho_1$ it applies with every $p \le 4$ and every $\alpha \ge \alpha_2$.

(i) Since $Q'^*\omega = \sum_{y'} \omega(y')\mathbf{1}_{B(y')}$, the kernel is $N(y,y') = \mathsf{w}(y')^{-1}\mathsf{n}(y,y')$, where $\mathsf{n}(y,y')$ is the mean of $G'^2\mathbf{1}_{B(y')}$ over $B(y)$. By [3, (2.67)], $|G'\mathbf{1}_{B(y')}| \le c_G\ell^2_{j(v)}e^{-\frac12\bar\delta_0 d(v,y')}$ on the block of $v \in \mathfrak{B}$. We write $G'\mathbf{1}_{B(y')}$ as the sum of its restrictions to the blocks, which converges in the space of the square-summable functions, and apply [3, (2.67)] to each of them:

$$|\mathsf{n}(y,y')| \le c_G^2\ell_j^2 \sum_{v\in\mathfrak{B}} e^{-\frac12\bar\delta_0 d(y,v)}\,\ell^2_{j(v)}e^{-\frac12\bar\delta_0 d(v,y')}\,. \tag{20.23}$$

By (20.22) with $p = 2$ and $\alpha = \frac16$, $\ell^2_{j(v)} \le L^2\ell_j^2 e^{\frac16\bar\delta_0 d(y,v)}$. Of the remaining exponent $\frac13\bar\delta_0 d(y,v) + \frac12\bar\delta_0 d(v,y')$, the part $\frac14\bar\delta_0(d(y,v) + d(v,y'))$ is at least $\frac14\bar\delta_0 d(y,y')$ by the triangle inequality, and the part $\frac{1}{12}\bar\delta_0 d(y,v)$ is summed by [3, (2.61)]. This gives (i) with the constant $c_{N'} \coloneqq c_G^2L^2c_1(\frac{1}{12})$.

The operator $N$ is bounded and self-adjoint on the square-summable functions on $\mathfrak{B}$, because $Q'$ and $Q'^*$ have the norm one and $G'$ is bounded. It is bounded below: the operator $\Delta'_a$ is the sum of $-\Delta \le 16\eta^{-2}$ and of an averaging term which is at most $\bar a\eta^{-2}$, so that $\|G'\psi\| \ge (16+\bar a)^{-1}\eta^2\|\psi\|$ for every $\psi$, and $\langle\omega, N\omega\rangle = \|G'Q'^*\omega\|^2 \ge (16+\bar a)^{-2}\eta^4\|\omega\|^2$. Hence $N$ has a bounded inverse, and it remains to identify its kernel.

(ii) *The identity.* The operator $C$ of (20.4) is bounded: $\|C_\square\| \le \gamma_*^{-2}\eta^{-4}$ by (20.6), every point lies in the supports of at most $2\cdot 2^4$ functions $h_\square$ by (d), and $\sum_\square\|h_\square\phi\|^2 = \|\phi\|^2$ by (a), so that $\|C\phi\|^2 \le 32\sum_\square\|h_\square C_\square h_\square\phi\|^2 \le 32\gamma_*^{-4}\eta^{-8}\|\phi\|^2$. Let $\square \in \mathscr{D}$. The support of $h_\square$ lies in $\square$ by (b), so that $h_\square = \square h_\square$ and $Nh_\square = \square N\square h_\square + (1-\square)Nh_\square$. By the definition of $N_\square$, $\square N\square = N_\square + \square Q'(G'^2 - A_\square^2)Q'^*\square$, and $N_\square h_\square C_\square h_\square = h_\square N_\square C_\square h_\square - [h_\square, N_\square]C_\square h_\square = h_\square^2 - [h_\square, N_\square]C_\square h_\square$, because $N_\square C_\square = \square$. Summing over the cubes, with $\sum_\square h_\square^2 = 1$, we obtain

$$\begin{gathered} NC = I - \mathsf{R}\,, \qquad \mathsf{R} \coloneqq \mathsf{R}^{(1)} + \mathsf{R}^{(2)} + \mathsf{R}^{(3)}\,, \qquad \mathsf{R}^{(1)} \coloneqq \sum_\square [h_\square, N_\square]C_\square h_\square\,, \\ \mathsf{R}^{(2)} \coloneqq \sum_\square \square\, Q'(A_\square^2 - G'^2)Q'^* h_\square C_\square h_\square\,, \qquad \mathsf{R}^{(3)} \coloneqq -\sum_\square (1-\square)Nh_\square C_\square h_\square\,, \end{gathered} \tag{20.24}$$

which is [3, (2.82)]; there the last term carries a further partition of unity, which we do not need. We bound the kernels of the three operators. In each of them the term of a cube $\square$ vanishes unless $h_\square(y') \neq 0$, which for a given $y'$ happens for at most 32 cubes, and for such a cube of the scale $j_\square$ we have $\ell_\square^{-4} \le L^4 \mathsf{w}(y')^{-1}$ by Lemma 20.3(i). For two points of $\mathfrak{B}_\square$, Lemma 20.1 gives, as after that lemma,

$$e^{-\theta_\square |y-y'|/\ell_\square} \le e^{9L\theta_\square} e^{-\delta_1 d(y,y')} \,. \tag{20.25}$$

*The commutators.* The kernel of $[h_\square, N_\square]$ is $(h_\square(y) - h_\square(y''))\mathsf{w}(y'')^{-1}\mathsf{n}_\square(y,y'')$ with the function $\mathsf{n}_\square$ of (20.10), so that the term of $\square$ in $\mathsf{R}^{(1)}(y,y')$ is $\sum_{y''\in\mathfrak{B}_\square}(h_\square(y) - h_\square(y''))\mathsf{n}_\square(y,y'')C_\square(y'',y')h_\square(y')$, for $y \in \mathfrak{B}_\square$. By (d), $|h_\square(y) - h_\square(y'')| \le \varkappa|y-y''|/(M\ell_\square)$. With (20.10), the inequality $te^{-2\bar\delta_0 t} \le (e\bar\delta_0)^{-1}e^{-\bar\delta_0 t}$, and (20.7), the modulus of this term is at most

$$\frac{\varkappa c_N e^{8L\bar\delta_0} c_\square}{e\bar\delta_0 M}\,\ell_\square^{-4} \sum_{y''\in\mathfrak{B}_\square} e^{-\bar\delta_0|y-y''|/\ell_\square} e^{-\theta_\square|y''-y'|/\ell_\square} \le \frac{\varkappa c_N e^{8L\bar\delta_0} c_\square \mathsf{z}(\frac12\bar\delta_0)}{e\bar\delta_0 M}\,\ell_\square^{-4} e^{-\theta_\square|y-y'|/\ell_\square} \,, \tag{20.26}$$

where we have used $\theta_\square \le \frac12\bar\delta_0$, the triangle inequality, and the fact that the differences $y-y''$ lie in $\ell_\square\mathbb{Z}^4$, or in $\eta\rho\mathbb{Z}^4$ for the scale 0. By (20.25) and the remarks before it, $|\mathsf{R}^{(1)}(y,y')| \le c^{(1)}M^{-1}e^{-\delta_1 d(y,y')}\mathsf{w}(y')^{-1}$ with $c^{(1)} := 32L^4 e^{9L\theta_\square}\varkappa c_N e^{8L\bar\delta_0} c_\square \mathsf{z}(\frac12\bar\delta_0)/(e\bar\delta_0)$.

*The change of the domain.* The kernel of $h_\square C_\square h_\square$ is $h_\square(y'')C_\square(y'',y')h_\square(y')$, and $Q'^*$ maps a function $\psi$ on $\mathfrak{B}$ to $\sum_{y''}\psi(y'')\mathbf{1}_{B(y'')}$. For $y \in \mathfrak{B}_\square$ the term of $\square$ in $\mathsf{R}^{(2)}(y,y')$ is therefore the mean over $B(y)$ of $(A_\square^2 - G'^2)f$ with

$$f := \sum_{y''} h_\square(y'')C_\square(y'',y')h_\square(y')\mathbf{1}_{B(y'')} \,. \tag{20.27}$$

This function is supported in the blocks of the points of the support of $h_\square$, and $\sup|f| \le c_\square\ell_\square^{-8}$ by (20.7). Lemma 20.5 bounds the term by $c_E c_\square \ell_\square^{-4} e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/48}$. This bound does not decay in the distance of $y$ and $y'$, but both points lie in $\square$, so that $\delta_1 d(y,y') \le \delta_1(16M + 34L) \le \bar\delta_0 M/96 + 34L\delta_1$ by Lemma 20.3(i) and $16\delta_1 = 4\theta_\square \le \bar\delta_0/96$. Hence $|\mathsf{R}^{(2)}(y,y')| \le c^{(2)}e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/96}e^{-\delta_1 d(y,y')}\mathsf{w}(y')^{-1}$ with $c^{(2)} := 32L^4 c_E c_\square e^{34L\delta_1}$.

*The terms outside the cube.* For $y \notin \square$ the term of $\square$ in $\mathsf{R}^{(3)}(y,y')$ is

$$-\sum_{y''} \mathsf{w}(y'')N(y,y'')h_\square(y'')C_\square(y'',y')h_\square(y') \,, \tag{20.28}$$

where $y''$ runs over the points of $\mathfrak{B}$ in the support of $h_\square$. By (i), (20.7), and (20.25), its modulus is at most

$$c_{N'}c_\square e^{9L\theta_\square} \sum_{y''} \ell_j^4 \ell_\square^{-8} e^{-\frac14\bar\delta_0 d(y,y'')} e^{-\delta_1 d(y'',y')} \,. \tag{20.29}$$

Since $j(y'') \le j_\square + 1$, (20.22) with $p = 4$ and $\alpha = \frac{1}{16}$ gives $\ell_j^4 \le L^4\ell_{j(y'')}^4 e^{\frac{1}{16}\bar\delta_0 d(y,y'')} \le L^8\ell_\square^4 e^{\frac{1}{16}\bar\delta_0 d(y,y'')}$. Of the remaining exponent $\frac{3}{16}\bar\delta_0 d(y,y'')$, one third is at least $\bar\delta_0 M/(48L)$ by Lemma 20.3(ii), one third is at least $\delta_1 d(y,y'')$, because $\delta_1 \le \frac{1}{16}\bar\delta_0$, and gives $e^{-\delta_1 d(y,y')}$ with the last factor of (20.29) by the triangle inequality, and one third is summed over $y''$ by [3, (2.61)] with $\alpha = \frac{1}{16}$. Hence $|\mathsf{R}^{(3)}(y,y')| \le c^{(3)}e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/(48L)}e^{-\delta_1 d(y,y')}\mathsf{w}(y')^{-1}$ with $c^{(3)} := 32L^{12}c_{N'}c_\square e^{9L\theta_\square}c_1(\frac{1}{16})$.

*The series.* Altogether, since $e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/96} \le e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/(48L)}$,

$$|\mathsf{R}(y,y')| \le \varepsilon_M\, e^{-\delta_1 d(y,y')}\mathsf{w}(y')^{-1} \,, \qquad \varepsilon_M := c^{(1)}M^{-1} + (c^{(2)} + c^{(3)})e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/(48L)} \,, \tag{20.30}$$

which is [3, (2.85)]. Two remarks on kernels are needed before we sum the series. The operator $\mathsf{R} = I - NC$ is bounded, and the computations above give its values on the functions of finite support, for which all the sums over the cubes are finite. If a bounded operator $K$ is given on these functions by a kernel with $\sup_y \sum_{y'} \mathsf{w}(y')|K(y,y')| < \infty$, then it is given by this kernel on every bounded, square-summable function $\phi$: the truncations of $\phi$ to finite sets converge to $\phi$ in the space of the square-summable functions, hence their images converge at every point, and the sums $\sum_{y'} \mathsf{w}(y')K(y,y')\phi(y')$ converge absolutely. By (20.30) and [3, (2.61)] this applies to $\mathsf{R}$. We now show by induction that $|\mathsf{R}^n(y,y')| \le \varepsilon_M^n c_1(\alpha_1)^{n-1} e^{-\frac12\delta_1 d(y,y')}\mathsf{w}(y')^{-1}$ for $n \ge 1$. In the kernel $\sum_v \mathsf{w}(v)\mathsf{R}^n(y,v)\mathsf{R}(v,y')$ of $\mathsf{R}^{n+1}$ the weight $\mathsf{w}(v)$ cancels against the factor $\mathsf{w}(v)^{-1}$ of the bound for $\mathsf{R}^n(y,v)$; the triangle inequality gives $e^{-\frac12\delta_1 d(y,v)}e^{-\frac12\delta_1 d(v,y')} \le e^{-\frac12\delta_1 d(y,y')}$, and the remaining factor $e^{-\frac12\delta_1 d(v,y')}$ is summed over $v$ by [3, (2.61)] with $\alpha = \alpha_1$. Let $M_1 \ge M_0$ be such that $\varepsilon_M c_1(\alpha_1) \le \frac12$ for $M \ge M_1$. Then the kernels of the operators $\mathsf{R}^n$, $n \ge 1$, add up to a kernel $\mathsf{S}'(y,y')$ with $|\mathsf{S}'(y,y')| \le 2\varepsilon_M e^{-\frac12\delta_1 d(y,y')}\mathsf{w}(y')^{-1}$, because $\sum_{n\ge1}\varepsilon_M^n c_1(\alpha_1)^{n-1} \le 2\varepsilon_M$. Let $\omega$ have a finite support, and let $\phi \coloneqq \omega + \mathsf{S}'\omega$, where $\mathsf{S}'\omega$ is defined through the kernel. Then $|\phi|$ is at most a constant times $\sum_{y'} e^{-\frac12\delta_1 d(\cdot,y')}$, the sum over the support of $\omega$, so that $\phi$ is bounded, and it is summable, hence square-summable, by [3, (2.61)] and $\mathsf{w} \le 1$. Since the series converges absolutely, $\mathsf{R}\phi = \sum_{n\ge1}\mathsf{R}^n\omega = \phi - \omega$, and (20.24) gives $NC\phi = \omega$. As $N$ is injective, $N^{-1}\omega = C\phi = C(I + \mathsf{S}')\omega$, which is the series [3, (2.86)].

*The kernel of the inverse.* By (20.7), (20.25), and Lemma 20.3(i), by which $\ell_\square^{-8} \le L^8\mathsf{w}(y)^{-1}\mathsf{w}(v)^{-1}$ for two points of $\mathfrak{B}_\square$, the kernel of $C$ satisfies $|C(y,v)| \le c_{\text{inv}}\mathsf{w}(y)^{-1}\mathsf{w}(v)^{-1}e^{-\delta_1 d(y,v)}$ with $c_{\text{inv}} \coloneqq 32L^8 c_\square e^{9L\theta_\square}$. In the kernel $\sum_v \mathsf{w}(v)C(y,v)\mathsf{S}'(v,y')$ of $C\mathsf{S}'$ the weight $\mathsf{w}(v)$ cancels again, and the triangle inequality and [3, (2.61)] with $\alpha = \alpha_1$ give

$$|N^{-1}(y,y')| \le c_{\text{inv}}(1 + 2\varepsilon_M c_1(\alpha_1))\mathsf{w}(y)^{-1}\mathsf{w}(y')^{-1}e^{-\frac12\delta_1 d(y,y')} \le 2c_{\text{inv}}\,\ell_j^{-4}\ell_{j'}^{-4}e^{-\frac12\delta_1 d(y,y')}\,. \tag{20.31}$$

Since $\mathsf{w} \ge \eta^4$, the sums $\sum_{y'}\mathsf{w}(y')|N^{-1}(y,y')|$ are bounded uniformly in $y$ by [3, (2.61)], and by the remark on kernels above this kernel represents the bounded operator $N^{-1}$ on every bounded, square-summable function.

(iii) Let $\lambda$ be a function of finite support on $T_\eta$. The mean of a function over $B(y_2)$ is $\mathsf{w}(y_2)^{-1}$ times its sum over $B(y_2)$ with the weights $\eta^4$, and $G'$ is symmetric, so that

$$(Q'G'\partial_\nu'^*\lambda)(y_2) = \mathsf{w}(y_2)^{-1}\sum_{x'\in T_\eta}\eta^4(\partial_\nu' G'\mathbf{1}_{B(y_2)})(x')\lambda(x')\,. \tag{20.32}$$

This function of $y_2$ is bounded and square-summable. Applying $N^{-1}$ through its kernel, in which the weight $\mathsf{w}(y_2)$ cancels, then $Q'^*$, which maps a function $\psi$ to $\sum_{y_1}\psi(y_1)\mathbf{1}_{B(y_1)}$ with convergence in the space of the square-summable functions, and then the bounded operator $\partial_\mu' G'$, we find that $\partial_\mu' P\partial_\nu'^*$ has the kernel

$$K(x,x') = \sum_{y_1,y_2\in\mathfrak{B}}(\partial_\mu' G'\mathbf{1}_{B(y_1)})(x)\,N^{-1}(y_1,y_2)\,(\partial_\nu' G'\mathbf{1}_{B(y_2)})(x') \tag{20.33}$$

with respect to the sum over $x'$ with the weights $\eta^4$. By [3, (2.67)], $|(\partial_\mu' G'\mathbf{1}_{B(y_1)})(x)| \le c_G\ell_j e^{-\frac12\bar\delta_0 d(y,y_1)}$ for $x \in B(y)$, and likewise for the last factor with $\ell_{j'}$ and $d(y',y_2)$. With (20.31),

$$|K(x,x')| \le 2c_G^2 c_{\text{inv}}\,\ell_j\ell_{j'}\sum_{y_1,y_2}\mathsf{w}(y_1)^{-1}\mathsf{w}(y_2)^{-1}e^{-\frac12\bar\delta_0 d(y,y_1)}e^{-\frac12\delta_1 d(y_1,y_2)}e^{-\frac12\bar\delta_0 d(y_2,y')}\,. \tag{20.34}$$

By (20.22) with $p = 4$ and $\alpha = \alpha_2$, $\mathsf{w}(y_1)^{-1} \le L^4 \ell_j^{-4} e^{\frac{1}{8}\delta_1 d(y,y_1)}$ and $\mathsf{w}(y_2)^{-1} \le L^4 \ell_{j'}^{-4} e^{\frac{1}{8}\delta_1 d(y_2,y')}$. Since $\bar\delta_0 \ge \delta_1$, each of the three exponents which remain is at least $\frac{3}{8}\delta_1$ times its distance. The parts $\frac{1}{4}\delta_1$ give $e^{-\frac{1}{4}\delta_1 d(y,y')}$ by the triangle inequality, and the parts $\frac{1}{8}\delta_1 d(y,y_1)$ and $\frac{1}{8}\delta_1 d(y_2,y')$ are summed by [3, (2.61)] with $\alpha = \alpha_2$. Hence $|K(x,x')| \le 2c_G^2 c_{\text{inv}} L^8 c_1(\alpha_2)^2\, \ell_j^{-3} \ell_{j'}^{-3} e^{-\frac{1}{4}\delta_1 d(y,y')}$. Finally $\ell_j^{-3}\ell_{j'}^{-3} = \ell_j^{-2}\ell_{j'}^{-4} L^{j'-j} \le L\, \ell_j^{-2}\ell_{j'}^{-4} e^{\frac{1}{8}\delta_1 d(y,y')}$ by (20.22) with $p = 1$ and $\alpha = \alpha_2$, which gives (iii). The constant $c$ of the proposition is the largest of $c_{N'}$, $2c_{\text{inv}}$, and $2c_G^2 c_{\text{inv}} L^9 c_1(\alpha_2)^2$. *q.e.d.*

The two propositions and [3, (2.88)] are all that Section B of [3] contains. In the tilted run they hold with constants which depend on $L$, as those of Section 14 do, and the conditions that $M$ and $RM$ be large are conditions in terms of $a$, $a_0$, and $L$. Three of the numbers differ from Bałaban's in kind and not only in value. The factor $e^{-\frac{1}{8}\delta_0 M}$ of [3, (2.83)] becomes $e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/(48L)}$, because a chain which leaves a cube of the scale $j$ may run through the part of the cube in the region of the scale $j+1$, where a step is $L$ times longer; the rate $\delta_1$ is chosen small compared with $\bar\delta_0$, so that the term of the change of the domain, which is bounded without decay inside a cube, decays at the rate $\delta_1$ at the cost of a part of its small factor; and $RM$ has to be large compared with $\delta_1^{-1} \log L$.

## 21 The Operators of the Gauge Functions

In Section C of [3] the propagator of a cube which meets the regions of two scales is expressed through operators of one scale and of the unit lattice, by a change of the gauge [3, (2.95)–(2.129), pp. 240–246]. The gauge transformations which leave the gauge-fixing term of the finer scale unchanged are the functions $\lambda = H'_j \mu$ of [3, (2.101), p. 241], the minimisers of $\|\Delta\lambda\|^2$ at given averages $\mu$, and the integral over their parameters is Gaussian with the quadratic form $\Delta'_j = H'^*_j \Delta^2 H'_j$ [3, (2.107), p. 242]. Bałaban reads the properties of these two operators off their momentum representations [3, (2.132), (2.108)], "together with the analyticity method described in [3]" [3, p. 246]. For the tilted run the representations are the same with the symbols of Section 7, and the method is that of Proposition 12.2 with the square of the Laplace operator in the place of the operator itself. This section carries it out. In Bałaban's formulae $\Delta$ stands for $\partial^*\partial$; here, as in Section 12, $\Delta(p)$ is the nonnegative symbol (7.1), and only squares of the Laplace operator occur, so that the sign plays no role.

The setting is that of Section 12: the fine lattice is the infinite lattice $T_\eta$, the unit lattice is $\mathbb{Z}^4$, $Q' \coloneqq Q'_k$, the adjoints are taken with the weights $\eta^4$ and 1, a momentum of the fine lattice is written $p' + l$ with $p' \in [-\pi,\pi]^4$ and $l \in \mathfrak{L}$, and $U$ is the complex neighbourhood of $[-\pi,\pi]^4$ of the proof of Proposition 12.2. For $p' \in U$ let

$$\mathsf{S}_*(p') \coloneqq \sum_{l \ne 0} \frac{u_k(p'+l) u_k(-p'-l)}{\Delta(p'+l)^2}\,, \qquad \mathcal{D}'(p') \coloneqq u_k(p') u_k(-p') + \Delta(p')^2\, \mathsf{S}_*(p')\,. \tag{21.1}$$

For real $p' \ne 0$ we have $\mathcal{D}'(p') = \Delta(p')^2 \mathsf{S}(p')$ with the function $\mathsf{S}$ of Lemma 9.2, and $\mathcal{D}'(p') \ge |u_k(p')|^2 \ge c_u$ for every real $p' \in [-\pi,\pi]^4$, by (7.8) and with $c_u = \frac{1}{4}(2/\pi)^8$ as in Section 12. We define an operator $H'$ from the square-summable functions on $\mathbb{Z}^4$ to those on $T_\eta$, and an operator $\Delta'$ on the former, by their momentum representations

$$\widetilde{(H'\mu)}(p'+l) \coloneqq \frac{u_k(-p'-l)\,\Delta(p')^2}{\Delta(p'+l)^2\,\mathcal{D}'(p')}\,\tilde\mu(p')\,, \qquad \widetilde{(\Delta'\mu)}(p') \coloneqq \frac{\Delta(p')^2}{\mathcal{D}'(p')}\,\tilde\mu(p')\,, \tag{21.2}$$

where for $l = 0$ the first quotient is read as $u_k(-p')/\mathcal{D}'(p')$. For $p' \ne 0$ these are [3, (2.132), (2.108)], written with $\mathcal{D}'$ so that the point $p' = 0$ needs no separate treatment.

**Lemma 21.1** (The Minimiser of the Gauge Functions)**.** *Let* $10\pi\eta \le \frac{1}{2}$.

*(i) The operators* $H'$ *and* $\Delta'$ *are bounded,* $Q'H' = I$, $\Delta^2 H' = Q'^*\Delta'$, *and* $\Delta' = H'^*\Delta^2 H'$.

*(ii) For every square-summable* $\mu$ *on* $\mathbb{Z}^4$ *and every square-summable* $\lambda$ *on* $T_\eta$ *with* $Q'\lambda = \mu$, $\|\Delta\lambda\|^2 = \langle\mu, \Delta'\mu\rangle + \|\Delta(\lambda - H'\mu)\|^2$.

*(iii) With* $c_{\mathsf{S}}$ *of Lemma 9.2 and* $C_{\mathsf{S}} := \frac{\pi^4}{16} + 400(1 + \frac{\pi^2}{4})^4$, *and with the Laplace operator* $\Delta_0$ *of the unit lattice,* $C_{\mathsf{S}}^{-1}\|\Delta_0\omega\|^2 \le \langle\omega, \Delta'\omega\rangle \le c_{\mathsf{S}}^{-1}\|\Delta_0\omega\|^2 \le 256\, c_{\mathsf{S}}^{-1}\|\omega\|^2$ *for every square-summable* $\omega$ *on* $\mathbb{Z}^4$.

*Proof.* (i) For real $p'$ the multiplier of $\Delta'$ is at most $(4\pi^2)^2/c_u$, since $\Delta(p') \le |p'|^2 \le 4\pi^2$. The squared norm of $H'\mu$ is the integral of $|\tilde\mu(p')|^2\mathcal{D}'(p')^{-2}$ times $|u_k(p')|^2 + \Delta(p')^4\sum_{l\neq 0}|u_k(p'+l)|^2\Delta(p'+l)^{-4}$, and this sum is bounded because $|u_k| \le 1$, $\Delta(p'+l) \ge 4$ for $l \neq 0$, and $\sum_{l\neq 0}|u_k(p'+l)|^2 \le 25(1+\pi^2/4)^4$ (proof of Lemma 7.3). By Lemma 7.1(i), as in the proof of Proposition 12.2, $\widetilde{(Q'f)}(p') = \sum_l u_k(p'+l)\tilde f(p'+l)$ and $\widetilde{(Q'^*g)}(p'+l) = u_k(-p'-l)\tilde g(p')$. Hence $\widetilde{(Q'H'\mu)}(p') = \mathcal{D}'(p')^{-1}(u_k(p')u_k(-p') + \Delta(p')^2\mathsf{S}_*(p'))\tilde\mu(p') = \tilde\mu(p')$, and $\widetilde{(\Delta^2 H'\mu)}(p'+l) = u_k(-p'-l)\Delta(p')^2\mathcal{D}'(p')^{-1}\tilde\mu(p') = \widetilde{(Q'^*\Delta'\mu)}(p'+l)$. The third identity follows from the first two: $H'^*\Delta^2 H' = H'^*Q'^*\Delta' = (Q'H')^*\Delta' = \Delta'$.

(ii) Let $\nu := \lambda - H'\mu$, so that $Q'\nu = 0$ by (i). The operator $\Delta$ is bounded and symmetric, and by (i) $\langle\Delta H'\mu, \Delta\nu\rangle = \langle\Delta^2 H'\mu, \nu\rangle = \langle Q'^*\Delta'\mu, \nu\rangle = \langle\Delta'\mu, Q'\nu\rangle = 0$ and $\|\Delta H'\mu\|^2 = \langle\mu, H'^*\Delta^2 H'\mu\rangle = \langle\mu, \Delta'\mu\rangle$. Expanding $\|\Delta(H'\mu + \nu)\|^2$ gives the assertion.

(iii) For real $p' \neq 0$ the multiplier of $\Delta'$ is $\mathsf{S}(p')^{-1}$, and $\mathsf{S} \ge c_{\mathsf{S}}\Delta_0^{-2}$ by Lemma 9.2. For the upper bound of $\mathsf{S}$ we use the inequalities of the proof of that lemma: the term $l = 0$ is at most $\Delta(p')^{-2} \le (\pi^2/4)^2|p'|^{-4} \le (\pi^4/16)\Delta_0(p')^{-2}$, and the terms with $l \neq 0$ add up to at most $\frac{1}{16}\cdot 25(1+\pi^2/4)^4 \le 400(1+\pi^2/4)^4\Delta_0(p')^{-2}$, because $\Delta(p'+l) \ge 4$ and $\Delta_0 \le 16$. Hence $C_{\mathsf{S}}^{-1}\Delta_0^2 \le \mathsf{S}^{-1} \le c_{\mathsf{S}}^{-1}\Delta_0^2$, and $\Delta_0 \le 16$ gives the last inequality. *q.e.d.*

Statement (ii) says that $H'\mu$ is the solution of the variational problem behind [3, (2.102)], and (iii) is [3, (2.109)]. The identity $\Delta^2 H' = Q'^*\Delta'$ contains [3, (2.99)]: the function $\Delta H'\mu$ is the image of $Q'^*\Delta'\mu$ under the inverse of $\Delta$.

**Proposition 21.2** (The Kernels of $H'$ and $\Delta'$)**.** *Let* $32\eta \le \frac{1}{2}$. *There are constants* $\delta_0' \in (0, \frac{1}{8}]$ *and* $c'$, *and for every* $\alpha \in [0,1)$ *a constant* $c'_\alpha$, *which do not depend on* $k$ *and* $L$, *with the following properties. Let* $\mathcal{H}(x,y)$, $x \in T_\eta$, $y \in \mathbb{Z}^4$, *be the kernel of* $H'$, *so that* $(H'\mu)(x) = \sum_y \mathcal{H}(x,y)\mu(y)$, *and let* $\partial^{(n)}$ *be a product of* $n$ *of the operators* $\partial'_\nu$, *acting on the first argument.*

*(i) For* $0 \le n \le 3$, $|(\partial^{(n)}\mathcal{H})(x,y)| \le c' e^{-\delta_0'|x-y|}$, *and for* $n = 3$ *and* $|x - x'| \le 1$,

$$|(\partial^{(3)}\mathcal{H})(x,y) - (\partial^{(3)}\mathcal{H})(x',y)| \le c'_\alpha|x-x'|^\alpha e^{-\delta_0'\min(|x-y|,|x'-y|)}\,. \tag{21.3}$$

*(ii) The operator* $\Delta'$ *commutes with the translations of* $\mathbb{Z}^4$, *and its kernel satisfies* $|\Delta'(y,y')| \le c' e^{-\delta_0'|y-y'|}$.

*Proof. The representation.* As in (12.3), by (21.2),

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{H}(x,y) &= (2\pi)^{-4}\int_{[-\pi,\pi]^4}\Psi(p')\,\mathrm{d}p'\,, \\ \Psi(p') &:= \frac{1}{\mathcal{D}'(p')}\Big(e^{ip'\cdot(x-y)}u_k(-p') + \sum_{l\neq 0} e^{i(p'+l)\cdot(x-y)}u_k(-p'-l)\frac{\Delta(p')^2}{\Delta(p'+l)^2}\Big)\,, \end{aligned} \tag{21.4}$$

and $\Psi$ is periodic with respect to $2\pi\mathbb{Z}^4$, a translation of $p'$ permuting the classes.

*The terms $l \neq 0$ on $U$.* Let $p' \in U$ and $l \neq 0$, and let $\hat{p}$ and $q$ be defined from the real part of $p'+l$ as in Section 12. By (12.6), $|\Delta(p'+l)| \geq (2/\pi^2)|\hat{p}|^2$ and $|\hat{p}| \geq 2.8$, and by Lemma 12.1(i), applied to $p'+l$ and to $-p'-l$, $|u_k(p'+l)u_k(-p'-l)| \leq e^{9/2}\prod_\mu \min(1, \pi/|q_\mu|)$. Hence $\mathsf{S}_*$ and $\mathcal{D}'$ are analytic on $U$, and with the sum $\Sigma_0$ of (12.7) and $|\hat{p}|^{-4} \leq |\hat{p}|^{-2}/7.84$,

$$|\mathsf{S}_*(p')| \leq \frac{\pi^4}{4} e^{9/2} \sum_{l\neq 0} |\hat{p}|^{-4} \prod_\mu \min(1, \pi/|q_\mu|) \leq C'_* \coloneqq \frac{\pi^4}{31} e^{9/2} C_0 \,. \tag{21.5}$$

*The denominator.* Let $s \in [-\pi, \pi]^4$ and $\tau \in \mathbb{R}^4$ with $|\tau_\mu| \leq \delta \leq \frac{1}{8}$, and put $p' \coloneqq s + i\tau$. As in the proof of Proposition 12.2, Cauchy's estimate on the disc of the radius $\frac{1}{4}$ gives $|\mathsf{S}_*(p') - \mathsf{S}_*(s)| \leq 8C'_*\delta$, Lemma 12.1(ii) and (i) give $|u_k(p')u_k(-p') - |u_k(s)|^2| \leq 8\delta(e^{9/4}+1)$, and Lemma 12.1(iii) gives $|\Delta(p') - \Delta(s)| \leq 52\delta$ with $0 \leq \Delta(s) \leq 4\pi^2$, so that $|\Delta(p')| \leq 4\pi^2 + 7$ and $|\Delta(p')^2 - \Delta(s)^2| \leq 52\delta(8\pi^2+7)$. Therefore

$$|\mathcal{D}'(p') - \mathcal{D}'(s)| \leq \delta(8(e^{9/4}+1) + 52(8\pi^2+7)C'_* + 128\pi^4 C'_*) \,, \tag{21.6}$$

where the second term bounds $|\Delta(p')^2 - \Delta(s)^2||\mathsf{S}_*(p')|$ and the third $\Delta(s)^2|\mathsf{S}_*(p') - \mathsf{S}_*(s)|$. Let $\delta'_0 \leq \frac{1}{8}$ be so small that the right side with $\delta = \delta'_0$ is at most $\frac{1}{2}c_u$. Since $\mathcal{D}'(s) \geq c_u$, we have $|\mathcal{D}'(s+i\tau)| \geq \frac{1}{2}c_u$ whenever $|\tau_\mu| \leq \delta'_0$; the function $\Psi$ is analytic in a neighbourhood of the set of these $s + i\tau$, and by its periodicity and Cauchy's theorem in each variable $\int \Psi(s)\,\mathrm{d}s = \int \Psi(s+i\tau)\,\mathrm{d}s$ over $[-\pi,\pi]^4$.

*The bounds.* Let $\tau_\mu \coloneqq \delta'_0$ if $x_\mu \geq y_\mu$ and $\tau_\mu \coloneqq -\delta'_0$ otherwise, so that the exponentials in (21.4) at $p' = s + i\tau$ are at most $e^{-\delta'_0|x-y|}$ in modulus. A difference operator $\partial'_\nu$ multiplies the term $l$ by a factor of modulus at most $2(|\hat{p}|+1)$, as in the proof of Proposition 12.2, where $\hat{p}$ belongs to $p'+l$; for $l=0$ this is at most $2(2\pi+1)$, and for $l \neq 0$ at most $3|\hat{p}|$, because $|\hat{p}| \geq 2.8$. With $n$ such operators the term $l=0$ is at most $e^{9/4}(4\pi+2)^n$, and by (12.6) and Lemma 12.1(i) the terms $l \neq 0$ add up to at most

$$e^{9/4}(4\pi^2+7)^2 \frac{\pi^4}{4} 3^n \sum_{l\neq 0} |\hat{p}|^{n-4} \prod_\mu \min(1, \pi/|q_\mu|) \,, \tag{21.7}$$

where the sums are those of (12.7): for $n \leq 2$ the sum is at most $\Sigma_0 \leq C_0$, since $|\hat{p}| \geq 1$, and for $n=3$ it is $\Sigma_1 \leq C_1$. Dividing by $|\mathcal{D}'| \geq \frac{1}{2}c_u$ gives the first part of (i). For (21.3) we may assume $|x'-y| \leq |x-y|$ and choose $\tau$ for the pair $(x', y)$; the difference has the terms of $(\partial^{(3)}\mathcal{H})(x', y)$ multiplied by $e^{i(p'+l)\cdot(x-x')} - 1$, of modulus at most $4(|\hat{p}|+1)^\alpha |x-x'|^\alpha$, and the terms $l \neq 0$ are bounded through $\Sigma_{1+\alpha} \leq C_{1+\alpha}$.

(ii) The operator $\Delta'$ is a multiplication in the momentum representation of the unit lattice, so that it commutes with the translations and $\Delta'(y, y') = (2\pi)^{-4} \int e^{ip'\cdot(y-y')} \Delta(p')^2 \mathcal{D}'(p')^{-1}\,\mathrm{d}p'$. For real $p' \neq 0$ the integrand is $e^{ip'\cdot(y-y')}\mathsf{S}(p')^{-1}$, which is periodic with respect to $2\pi\mathbb{Z}^4$, and it is analytic where $|\tau_\mu| \leq \delta'_0$. Moving the integration as before, we obtain $|\Delta'(y,y')| \leq 2(4\pi^2+7)^2 c_u^{-1} e^{-\delta'_0|y-y'|}$. *q.e.d.*

The proposition gives the properties which Bałaban states after [3, (2.132)]: the derivatives of $H'_j$ up to the third order and the Hölder norms of the third are bounded and decay exponentially, uniformly. Three is the largest number of derivatives for which the sum (21.7) converges. For the run of $j$ steps, in the unit $\ell_j$, $H'_j$ and $\Delta'_j$ are the operators $H'$ and $\Delta'$ with the fine spacing $L^{-j}$. On a torus the operators are defined by the same multipliers on the dual of the torus, their kernels are the sums of the kernels above over the periods,

and Lemma 21.1 holds as it stands; the constants are mapped to themselves, because the multiplier of $H'$ at $p' = 0$ is 1 for $l = 0$ and 0 for $l \neq 0$.

The integral over the parameters of the gauge transformations runs over the functions $\omega$ on a set of cubes with vanishing means, $\int \mathrm{d}\omega \restriction_\Lambda \delta(Q'_1\omega)$ in [3, (2.106)], and its covariance $C'^{(j)}_\Lambda$ is the inverse of $\Delta'_j$ on this space. Bałaban obtains its decay from [3, (2.110)] and from the theorem on the operators of the unit lattice in [1]; we use Lemma 14.1. Let $\Lambda'$ be a set of points of $L\mathbb{Z}^4$, let $\Lambda \subset \mathbb{Z}^4$ be the union of the cubes $\{z \,|\, y_\mu \leq z_\mu < y_\mu + L\}$, $y \in \Lambda'$, let $\mathcal{S}_\Lambda$ be the space of the square-summable functions on $\mathbb{Z}^4$ which vanish outside $\Lambda$ and have the mean zero on each of these cubes, and let $E$ be the orthogonal projection onto $\mathcal{S}_\Lambda$. It is $\mathbf{1}_\Lambda - \Pi_{\Lambda'}$, where $\Pi_{\Lambda'}$ replaces a function by its means over the cubes of $\Lambda$ and by zero elsewhere, as in (18.1).

**Lemma 21.3** (The Covariance of the Gauge Functions)**.** *Let $32\eta \leq \frac{1}{2}$ and $L \geq 2$. For every $\Lambda'$ and every $\omega \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$,*

$$\gamma' \|\omega\|^2 \leq \langle \omega, \Delta'\omega \rangle \leq 256\, c_{\mathsf{S}}^{-1} \|\omega\|^2 \,, \qquad \gamma' \coloneqq \frac{4}{C_{\mathsf{S}} L^4} \,. \tag{21.8}$$

*The operator $E\Delta'E$ on $\mathcal{S}_\Lambda$ has an inverse $C'_\Lambda$, and there are constants $c''$ and $\theta' > 0$, which depend on $L$ and not on $k$, $\eta$, or $\Lambda'$, such that the kernel of $C'_\Lambda E$ on the functions on $\mathbb{Z}^4$ satisfies $|(C'_\Lambda E)(y, y')| \leq c'' e^{-\theta'|y-y'|}$.*

*Proof.* Let $\Pi$ be the orthogonal projection onto the functions which are constant on each cube of the side $L$ of the grid $L\mathbb{Z}^4$. As in the proof of Lemma 14.2, $\Delta_0$ is at least the sum of the Laplace operators of these cubes with Neumann conditions, each of which is at least $2/L^2$ on the functions of mean zero, so that $\Delta_0 + (2/L^2)\Pi \geq 2/L^2$ and $\|(\Delta_0 + (2/L^2)\Pi)\omega\| \geq (2/L^2)\|\omega\|$ for every $\omega$. A function $\omega \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$ has the mean zero on every cube of the grid, so that $\Pi\omega = 0$ and $\|\Delta_0\omega\| \geq (2/L^2)\|\omega\|$. With Lemma 21.1(iii) this gives (21.8); this is [3, (2.110)].

Let $N \coloneqq E\Delta'E + (1-E)$ on the square-summable functions on $\mathbb{Z}^4$. Then $N \geq \min(\gamma', 1) = \gamma'$, and $N$ commutes with $E$, so that $C'_\Lambda \coloneqq N^{-1} \restriction_{\mathcal{S}_\Lambda}$ maps $\mathcal{S}_\Lambda$ to itself and inverts $E\Delta'E$ there. The kernel of $E$ is $\mathbf{1}_\Lambda(y)$ on the diagonal minus $L^{-4}$ for two points of one cube of $\Lambda$, whose distance is at most $2L$; hence $\sum_v |E(y,v)| \leq 2$ for every $y$, and by Proposition 21.2(ii) the kernel of $E\Delta'E$ is at most $4c' e^{4L\delta'_0} e^{-\delta'_0|y-y'|}$ in modulus, while that of $1 - E$ vanishes for $|y - y'| > 2L$ and is at most 1. Therefore $\sum_{y'} |N(y,y')|(e^{\theta|y-y'|} - 1)$ is at most $4c' e^{4L\delta'_0} \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}^4} e^{-\delta'_0|n|}(e^{\theta|n|} - 1) + 2(e^{2L\theta} - 1)$ for every $y$, which tends to zero with $\theta$, and we let $\theta' \in (0, \frac{1}{2}\delta'_0]$ be such that it is at most $\frac{1}{2}\gamma'$ for $\theta = \theta'$. Lemma 14.1 gives $|N^{-1}(y,y')| \leq (2/\gamma') e^{-\theta'|y-y'|}$, and $C'_\Lambda E = N^{-1}E$ has the kernel $\sum_v N^{-1}(y,v)E(v,y')$, which is at most $(4/\gamma') e^{2L\theta'} e^{-\theta'|y-y'|}$ in modulus. *q.e.d.*

For the pair of the scales 0 and 1 the average of the finer scale is the identity, so that $H'_0 = I$ and $\Delta'_0 = \Delta^2$ on the functions on $T_\eta$, and the cubes of $\Lambda$ are the blocks $B_{\ell_1}(y)$ of the tilted run. The lemma then holds in the following form, with the same proof. For a function $\omega$ on $T_\eta$ which vanishes outside the union $\Lambda$ of the blocks $B_{\ell_1}(y)$, $y \in \Lambda'$, and has the mean zero on each of them, the operator $\mathcal{D}^0_{\Lambda'}$ of (18.5) with $a = a_0 = 1$ acts as $-\Delta$, so that Lemma 18.2 gives $\eta^2 \|\Delta\omega\| \geq L^{-2} \min(C_P^{-1}, 1)\|\omega\|$; and $\eta^4\Delta^2 \leq 256$. The operator $\eta^4 E\Delta^2 E + (1-E)$ has a kernel which vanishes for points at a distance of more than $(4L+2)\eta$, and Lemma 14.1 with the metric $|y - y'|/\eta$ gives the decay of the inverse, at a rate and with a constant which depend on $L$ only.

## 22 The Axial Gauge on the Turned Lattice

In Section C of [3], and in the fluctuation integral of every renormalisation step [3, (2.152)], the fields of the unit lattice are restricted by the axial gauge condition in the blocks, and the lower bounds of the quadratic forms rest on the inequality [3, (2.123), p. 244], by which a field in this gauge is bounded inside a block by its curl. For the cubes of a scale $j \geq 1$ the unit lattice is a lattice of the paper, with its blocks of side $L$, and these arguments are as printed. For the pair of the scales 0 and 1, and for the first step, the unit lattice is the turned lattice $T_\eta$ and the blocks are those of Definition 6.1. Bałaban's proof of [3, (2.123)] expresses the value of the field at a bond through the plaquettes of a strip which joins the bond to the contours of the gauge condition; on the turned lattice the same strip exists in the coordinates of the lattice, and it may leave the block. We prove the inequality in this form.

For $x \in T_\eta$ we write $x'_\nu := \eta^{-1} x \cdot e'_\nu$ for its coordinates in the basis $\eta e'_\nu$, which are integers. For $o, x \in T_\eta$ let $\pi_o(x)$ be the path of bonds of $T_\eta$ from $o$ to $x$ which changes these coordinates one after the other, in the order $\nu = 3, 2, 1, 0$, each monotonically. For $o = y \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$ and $x \in B_a(y)$ these are the paths of the axial gauge condition of Section 10, and we say that a field $A$ is *axial on the block* $B_a(y)$ if $A(\pi_y(x)) = 0$ for every $x \in B_a(y)$; this is [2, (1.10)], and [3, (2.121)] for the turned lattice. As in Section 9, $(\partial A)(p)$ is $\eta^{-1}$ times the sum of $A$ over the boundary of the plaquette $p$, with an orientation which we do not need to fix.

**Lemma 22.1** (The Strip of a Bond)**.** *Let $A$ be a field, $o \in T_\eta$, and $b = \langle x, x + \eta e'_j \rangle$ a bond of $T_\eta$. There are a set $F_o(b)$ of $\sum_{i<j} |x'_i - o'_i|$ plaquettes and signs $\epsilon_p = \pm 1$, which do not depend on $A$, such that*

$$A(\pi_o(x)) + A(b) - A(\pi_o(x + \eta e'_j)) = \eta \sum_{p \in F_o(b)} \epsilon_p (\partial A)(p) \; . \tag{22.1}$$

*Each plaquette of $F_o(b)$ lies in a plane spanned by $e'_j$ and one of the vectors $e'_i$, $i < j$, and each coordinate of each of its corners lies between the corresponding coordinates of $o$ and of an end of $b$.*

*Proof.* The paths $\pi_o(x)$ and $\pi_o(x + \eta e'_j)$ change the coordinates $\nu > j$ in the same way, and they coincide up to the point $w$ at which the coordinate $j$ has been brought to the value which is nearer to $o'_j$ among $x'_j$ and $x'_j + 1$. From $w$ on, one of the two paths makes one more step in the direction $\pm e'_j$, and then both change the coordinates $i < j$ by the same sequence $\varsigma$ of $\sum_{i<j} |x'_i - o'_i|$ steps, the one at the level $x'_j$ of the coordinate $j$ and the other at the level $x'_j + 1$. The path $\pi_o(x)$ followed by $b$ and by the reverse of $\pi_o(x + \eta e'_j)$ is therefore, after the cancellation of the common part from $o$ to $w$, the boundary of the strip which the sequence $\varsigma$ sweeps between the two levels: its two long sides are the two copies of $\varsigma$, and its two short sides are $b$ and the additional step at $w$. The strip is the union of the plaquettes spanned by a step of $\varsigma$ and the vector $\eta e'_j$, one for each step, and two consecutive plaquettes share the bond in the direction $e'_j$ between them. The sum of $A$ over the boundary of the strip is the sum over these plaquettes of the sums of $A$ over their boundaries, all oriented alike, since the shared bonds are run through once in each sense. This gives (22.1), with $F_o(b)$ the set of these plaquettes. Their corners are points of the two copies of $\varsigma$, whose coordinates lie between those of $o$ and of $x$ or $x + \eta e'_j$. *q.e.d.*

**Lemma 22.2** (The Axial Gauge in a Block)**.** *Let $a$ be a scale, $N := a/\eta$, and $y \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$.*

*(i) For a field $A$ let $\lambda_A(x) \coloneqq \eta A(\pi_{y(x)}(x))$, where $y(x) \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$ is the point with $x \in B_a(y(x))$, and $\mathfrak{a}_a A \coloneqq A - \partial((1 - Q_a'^* Q_a')\lambda_A)$. Then $\mathfrak{a}_a A$ is axial on every block $B_a(y)$, $Q_a \mathfrak{a}_a A = Q_a A$, $\partial \mathfrak{a}_a A = \partial A$ on the plaquettes, and $\mathfrak{a}_a A = A$ if $A$ is axial on every block.*

*(ii) If $A$ is axial on $B_a(y)$, then*

$$\sum_b |A(b)|^2 \le \frac{17}{5} N^5 \eta^2 \sum_p |(\partial A)(p)|^2 \,, \tag{22.2}$$

*where $b$ runs over the bonds $\langle x, x+\eta e_\nu' \rangle$ with both ends in $B_a(y)$ and $p$ over the plaquettes of $T_\eta$ whose corners are at a Euclidean distance of less than $3a$ from $y$.*

*Proof.* (i) Let $\mu \coloneqq (1 - Q_a'^* Q_a')\lambda_A$, which on each block is $\lambda_A$ minus its mean over the block. For every function $\mu$ on $T_\eta$ and every path $\gamma$ from $y$ to $x$ the sum of $\partial\mu$ over $\gamma$ is $\eta^{-1}(\mu(x) - \mu(y))$, wherever the path runs. For $x \in B_a(y)$ this is $\eta^{-1}(\lambda_A(x) - \lambda_A(y)) = A(\pi_y(x))$, because $\lambda_A(y) = 0$, so that $(\mathfrak{a}_a A)(\pi_y(x)) = 0$. By Lemma 6.4(i), $Q_a \partial\mu = \partial^a Q_a' \mu = 0$, since $Q_a'(1 - Q_a'^* Q_a') = 0$; and the sum of $\partial\mu$ over the boundary of a plaquette vanishes. If $A$ is axial on every block, then $\lambda_A = 0$.

(ii) Let $b = \langle x, x + \eta e_j' \rangle$ have both ends in $B_a(y)$. Since $A(\pi_y(x)) = A(\pi_y(x + \eta e_j')) = 0$, Lemma 22.1 with $o = y$ gives $A(b) = \eta \sum_{p \in F_y(b)} \epsilon_p (\partial A)(p)$. The components of $x - y$ in the basis $e_\mu$ lie in $[0, a)$, so that by (2.2) $0 \le x_\nu' - y_\nu' < N$ for $\nu \in \{0, 1\}$, $0 \le x_2' - y_2' < \frac{7}{5}N$, and $-\frac{3}{5}N < x_3' - y_3' < \frac{4}{5}N$. Hence $F_y(b)$ has at most $N + N + \frac{7}{5}N = \frac{17}{5}N$ plaquettes, and by Schwarz's inequality $|A(b)|^2 \le \frac{17}{5} N \eta^2 \sum_{p \in F_y(b)} |(\partial A)(p)|^2$. A plaquette in a plane spanned by $e_i'$ and $e_j'$, $i < j$, belongs to $F_y(b)$ only for bonds $b$ of the direction $e_j'$, and there are $N^4$ bonds of each direction which start in $B_a(y)$; summing over $b$ gives (22.2). By Lemma 22.1 the coordinates of a corner of a plaquette of $F_y(b)$ differ from those of $y$ by at most $N$, $N$, $\frac{7}{5}N + 1 \le \frac{8}{5}N$, and $\frac{4}{5}N + 1 \le N$, because $N \ge 5$, so that its Euclidean distance from $y$ is at most $(1 + 1 + \frac{64}{25} + 1)^{1/2} N\eta < 3a$. *q.e.d.*

Statement (ii) is [3, (2.123)] for the turned lattice, with the plaquettes of a neighbourhood of the block in the place of those of the block, which suffices for [3, Lemma 2.4], where the field vanishes outside a union of blocks and all the plaquettes are summed. The operator $\mathfrak{a}_a$ of (i) is a projection onto the fields which are axial on every block; it changes a field by a gauge transformation $\partial\mu$ with $Q_a'\mu = 0$, and $(\mathfrak{a}_a A)(b)$ depends on $A$ only on the paths $\pi_y(x)$ of the blocks of the two ends of $b$.

For the bonds which join two blocks Bałaban compares, in a slab at the common face of two blocks, the average over a bond of the coarse lattice with the mean of the field over the bonds which cross the face, and he bounds the deviation from this mean by an inequality for a lattice of one dimension less [3, (2.124)–(2.127), p. 245]. On the turned lattice the bonds which leave a block do not form a slab, and a bond in the directions $e_2'$ and $e_3'$ may join two blocks which are neighbours across an edge. We compare paths instead: the sum of the field over a staircase differs from its value at any bond which crosses the same face by the sum over a closed path, which is a sum of values of the curl.

**Lemma 22.3** (Closed Paths)**.** *Let $\gamma$ be a closed path of $n$ bonds of $T_\eta$, and let $o \in T_\eta$ and $r$ be such that $|s_\nu' - o_\nu'| \le r$ for every site $s$ of $\gamma$ and every $\nu$. There are integers $n_\gamma(p)$, which do not depend on the field, with $A(\gamma) = \eta \sum_p n_\gamma(p)(\partial A)(p)$ for every field $A$, $|n_\gamma(p)| \le n$, and $\sum_p |n_\gamma(p)| \le 3rn$; and $n_\gamma(p) = 0$ unless every corner $s$ of $p$ satisfies $|s_\nu' - o_\nu'| \le r$ for every $\nu$.*

*Proof.* Let $s_0, s_1, \dots, s_n = s_0$ be the sites of $\gamma$. For the step from $s_{m-1}$ to $s_m$, Lemma 22.1, applied to this step or to its reverse, gives $A(\pi_o(s_{m-1})) + A(\langle s_{m-1}, s_m\rangle) - A(\pi_o(s_m)) = \pm\eta \sum_{p\in F} \epsilon_p (\partial A)(p)$ with a set $F$ of at most $3r$ plaquettes whose corners have the stated property. Since the path is closed, the terms $A(\pi_o(s_m))$ cancel in the sum over $m$, which is therefore $A(\gamma)$. Each step contributes each plaquette at most once. *q.e.d.*

**Lemma 22.4** (Lemma 2.4 for the Turned Lattice)**.** *Let $a$ be a scale with $N := a/\eta \geq 10$, let $\Lambda'$ be a set of points of $a\mathbb{Z}^4$ and $\Lambda$ the union of the blocks $B_a(y)$, $y \in \Lambda'$, and let $A$ be a field which is axial on $B_a(y)$ for every $y \in \Lambda'$. Then*

$$\sum_b \eta^4 |A(b)|^2 \leq 216 N^2 \sum_c a^4 |(Q_a A)(c)|^2 + C_1 N^5 a^2 \sum_p \eta^4 |(\partial A)(p)|^2 + C_2 N^5 \sum_{b'} \eta^4 |A(b')|^2 \,, \tag{22.3}$$

*with $C_1 := 2.2 \cdot 10^{12}$ and $C_2 := 3.1 \cdot 10^9$, where $b$ runs over the bonds of $T_\eta$ with at least one end in $\Lambda$, $c$ over the bonds of $a\mathbb{Z}^4$ with at least one end in $\Lambda'$, $p$ over the plaquettes of $T_\eta$, and $b'$ over the bonds of $T_\eta$ with no end in $\Lambda$.*

*Proof. Paths in the blocks.* For $y \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$ and $z, w \in B_a(y)$ let $\kappa_y(z,w)$ be the path from $z$ to $w$ which consists of the reverse of $\pi_y(z)$ and of $\pi_y(w)$ if $y \in \Lambda'$, and of the reverse of the contour $\Gamma^a_{y,z}$ of Definition 8.2 and of $\Gamma^a_{y,w}$ if $y \notin \Lambda'$. In the first case $A(\kappa_y(z,w)) = 0$, because $A$ is axial on the block. In the second case all the sites of the path lie in $B_a(y)$, so that its bonds have no end in $\Lambda$. A path $\pi_y(z)$ has at most $N + N + \frac{7}{5}N + \frac{4}{5}N$ bonds, by the bounds on the coordinates in the proof of Lemma 22.2, and a contour $\Gamma^a_{y,z}$ at most $\frac{28}{5}N + 17$; hence $\kappa_y(z,w)$ has at most $18N$ bonds. Its sites lie at a Euclidean distance of less than $3a$ from $y$.

*Three numbers.* Fix $y \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$. All the closed paths below consist of paths $\kappa$ of $B_a(y)$ and of at most two blocks $B_a(y_1)$ with $|y_1 - y|_\infty \leq a$ in the plane of $e_2$ and $e_3$ or with $y_1 = y + ae_\mu$, of bonds between these blocks, and of staircases which start in $B_a(y)$. Their sites lie at a Euclidean distance of less than $5a$ from $y$, so that Lemma 22.3 applies with $o = y$ and $r = 5N$, and the plaquettes which occur have their corners at a Euclidean distance of at most $10a$ from $y$. We write $\mathcal{P}(y)$ for the sum of $|(\partial A)(p)|^2$ over the plaquettes whose corners are at a distance of at most $12a$ from $y$, and $\mathcal{O}(y)$ for the sum of $|A(b')|^2$ over the bonds $b'$ with no end in $\Lambda$ whose ends are at a distance of at most $12a$ from $y$. For a closed path $\gamma$ of $n$ bonds of this kind, Schwarz's inequality and the two bounds of Lemma 22.3 give

$$\Big|\eta \sum_p n_\gamma(p)(\partial A)(p)\Big|^2 \leq \eta^2 \sum_p |n_\gamma(p)| \sum_p |n_\gamma(p)||(\partial A)(p)|^2 \leq 15 N n^2 \eta^2 \, \mathcal{P}(y) \,, \tag{22.4}$$

since $\sum_p |n_\gamma(p)| \leq 3rn = 15Nn$ and $|n_\gamma(p)| \leq n$.

*Bonds across a face.* Let $c = \langle y, y + ae_\mu\rangle$, and let $b = \langle z, z_+\rangle$ be a bond with $z \in B_a(y)$ and $z_+ \in B_a(y + ae_\mu)$, or the reverse of such a bond. For $x \in B_a(y)$ the staircase $\sigma^a_\mu(x)$, which has at most $\frac{7}{5}N$ bonds, followed by the reverse of the path which consists of $\kappa_y(x,z)$, of $b$, and of $\kappa_{y+ae_\mu}(z_+, x + ae_\mu)$, is a closed path $\gamma_x$ of at most $39N$ bonds. The sum of $A$ over the two paths $\kappa$ is a sum $S_x$ over at most $36N$ bonds with no end in $\Lambda$, so that $|S_x|^2 \leq 36N\mathcal{O}(y)$. Hence $A(\sigma^a_\mu(x)) = A(b) + S_x + A(\gamma_x)$, and the mean over the $N^4$ points $x$ of the block is, by (6.3),

$$N(Q_a A)(c) = A(b) + N^{-4} \sum_{x \in B_a(y)} (S_x + A(\gamma_x)) \,. \tag{22.5}$$

By (22.4) with $n = 39N$ and $15 \cdot 39^2 \leq 24000$, $|A(\gamma_x)|^2 \leq 24000 N^3 \eta^2 \mathcal{P}(y)$, and the square of a sum of three terms is at most three times the sum of their squares, so that

$$|A(b)|^2 \leq 3N^2 |(Q_a A)(c)|^2 + 72000 N^3 \eta^2 \, \mathcal{P}(y) + 108 N \, \mathcal{O}(y) \,. \tag{22.6}$$

In this bound only plaquettes at a distance of at most $10a$ from $y$ and bonds $b'$ at a distance of less than $5a$ from $y$ occur. If $c$ has no end in $\Lambda'$, then $b$ has no end in $\Lambda$ and $|A(b)|^2$ is one of the terms of $\mathcal{O}(y)$, so that (22.6) holds in this case with the first term omitted.

*Bonds across an edge.* A bond in the direction $e_0$ or $e_1$ changes one coordinate, and a bond in the direction $\pm e_2'$ or $\pm e_3'$ changes the coordinates 2 and 3 by less than $\eta$ each, by (2.2). A bond $b = \langle z, z_+ \rangle$ with $z \in B_a(y)$ whose ends lie in two different blocks which are not neighbours across a face therefore ends in $B_a(y')$ with $y' = y + a(\epsilon_2 e_2 + \epsilon_3 e_3)$, $\epsilon_2, \epsilon_3 = \pm 1$. Let $y'' := y + a\epsilon_2 e_2$. There is a bond $b_1$ from $B_a(y)$ to $B_a(y'')$ and a bond $b_2$ from $B_a(y'')$ to $B_a(y')$: for the point $x_0 := y + 5\eta\lfloor N/10 \rfloor (e_0 + e_1 + e_2 + e_3)$ every site of the staircase $\sigma_2^a(x_0)$ is at a distance of at most $\frac{3}{5}\eta$ from the segment $[x_0, x_0 + ae_2]$ (Lemma 6.2(ii)), whose points have their coordinates other than the second at a distance of at least $5\eta$ from the faces of the blocks, so that the staircase runs from $B_a(y)$ to $B_a(y + ae_2)$ through sites of these two blocks and contains a bond which joins them; the same holds for the other pairs. The bond $b$ followed by the reverse of the path which consists of $\kappa_y(z, \cdot)$, $b_1$, $\kappa_{y''}$, $b_2$, and $\kappa_{y'}(\cdot, z_+)$ is a closed path of at most $55N$ bonds, the three paths $\kappa$ contribute a sum over at most $54N$ bonds with no end in $\Lambda$, and by (22.4) with $15 \cdot 55^2 \leq 46000$,

$$|A(b)|^2 \leq 4|A(b_1)|^2 + 4|A(b_2)|^2 + 184000N^3\eta^2\,\mathcal{P}(y) + 216N\,\mathcal{O}(y)\,. \tag{22.7}$$

The bonds $b_1$ and $b_2$ cross the faces of the bonds $c_1$ and $c_2$ of $a\mathbb{Z}^4$ which join $y$ to $y''$ and $y''$ to $y'$, and (22.6) applies to them with the initial point $y_1 \in \{y, y'', y'\}$ of $c_1$ or $c_2$ in the place of $y$. Since $|y_1 - y| \leq 2a$, the plaquettes and the bonds which occur in it are among those of $\mathcal{P}(y)$ and $\mathcal{O}(y)$, by the remark after (22.6). Hence, with $8 \cdot 72000 + 184000 = 760000$ and $8 \cdot 108 + 216 = 1080$,

$$|A(b)|^2 \leq 12N^2(|(Q_a A)(c_1)|^2 + |(Q_a A)(c_2)|^2) + 760000N^3\eta^2\,\mathcal{P}(y) + 1080N\,\mathcal{O}(y)\,, \tag{22.8}$$

where a term with $c_i$ is omitted if $c_i$ has no end in $\Lambda'$.

*The sum.* A bond with an end in $\Lambda$ has both ends in one block of $\Lambda$, or it crosses a face, or an edge. For the first kind we use (22.2). A bond $c$ of $a\mathbb{Z}^4$ is crossed by at most $8N^4$ bonds of $T_\eta$, counted without orientation, and every $y$ is the initial point of four bonds $c$. At most $4N^4$ bonds which cross an edge start in a given block, and a bond $c$ occurs as $c_1$ or $c_2$ for at most four pairs of a block and one of its four neighbours across an edge. Finally a plaquette, or a bond $b'$, is counted in $\mathcal{P}(y)$, or in $\mathcal{O}(y)$, for at most $25^4$ points $y$. Adding (22.2), (22.6), and (22.8) we obtain

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_b |A(b)|^2 \leq (24 + 192)N^6 \sum_c |(Q_a A)(c)|^2 + 25^4 \cdot 5.4 \cdot 10^6 N^7 \eta^2 \sum_p |(\partial A)(p)|^2 \\ + 25^4 \cdot 7776 N^5 \sum_{b'} |A(b')|^2\,.\end{aligned} \tag{22.9}$$

Here $24N^6 = 8N^4 \cdot 3N^2$ and $192N^6 = 4 \cdot 4N^4 \cdot 12N^2$; for each $y$ the coefficient of $\eta^2\mathcal{P}(y)$ is at most $\frac{17}{5}N^5 + 4 \cdot 8N^4 \cdot 72000N^3 + 4N^4 \cdot 760000N^3 \leq 5.4 \cdot 10^6 N^7$, and that of $\mathcal{O}(y)$ is at most $4 \cdot 8N^4 \cdot 108N + 4N^4 \cdot 1080N = 7776N^5$. Since $25^4 \cdot 5.4 \cdot 10^6 \leq C_1$ and $25^4 \cdot 7776 \leq C_2$, multiplying by $\eta^4$ and using $N\eta = a$ gives (22.3). *q.e.d.*

Bałaban uses his Lemma 2.4 twice: for the lower bound of the quadratic form [3, (2.120)] of the fields of the unit lattice between two scales, whose inverse is the covariance $\tilde{C}_\Lambda^{(j)}$ of [3, (2.129)], and for the lower bound [3, (2.153)] of the quadratic form of the fluctuation integral of a renormalisation step. In both cases the Gaussian integral runs over the fields in the axial gauge, in the second with the further condition that the averages vanish, and he obtains the

covariance by solving the conditions for some of the variables [3, (2.155), (2.156)]. On the turned lattice the conditions are not solved by leaving out variables, since a bond lies on staircases of several bonds of the coarse lattice, and we describe the covariance through a projection onto the space of the conditions. The next lemma is the general statement; in a space of finite dimension it says, by completing the square, that $\tilde{C}$ is the covariance of the Gaussian integral over $\mathcal{S}$ with the quadratic form $\mathsf{M}$.

**Lemma 22.5** (Constrained Covariances)**.** *Let $\mathcal{X}$ be a real Hilbert space, $\mathcal{S}$ a closed subspace, $\Pi$ a bounded operator with $\Pi^2 = \Pi$ and the range $\mathcal{S}$, and $\mathsf{M}$ a bounded self-adjoint operator with $\langle v, \mathsf{M}v\rangle \geq \gamma\|v\|^2$ for every $v \in \mathcal{S}$, where $\gamma > 0$. Then the operator $\mathsf{N} \coloneqq \Pi^*\mathsf{M}\Pi + (1-\Pi)^*(1-\Pi)$ satisfies $\mathsf{N} \geq \frac{1}{2}\min(\gamma, 1)$. For every $J \in \mathcal{X}$ the vector $\tilde{C}J \coloneqq \mathsf{N}^{-1}\Pi^*J$ lies in $\mathcal{S}$, it is the only $B_0 \in \mathcal{S}$ with $\langle B, \mathsf{M}B_0\rangle = \langle B, J\rangle$ for every $B \in \mathcal{S}$, and for every $B \in \mathcal{S}$*

$$2\langle J, B\rangle - \langle B, \mathsf{M}B\rangle = \langle J, \tilde{C}J\rangle - \langle B - \tilde{C}J, \mathsf{M}(B - \tilde{C}J)\rangle \,. \tag{22.10}$$

*In particular $\tilde{C} = \Pi\mathsf{N}^{-1}\Pi^*$.*

*Proof.* For $v \in \mathcal{X}$, $\langle v, \mathsf{N}v\rangle = \langle \Pi v, \mathsf{M}\Pi v\rangle + \|(1-\Pi)v\|^2 \geq \min(\gamma, 1)(\|\Pi v\|^2 + \|(1-\Pi)v\|^2)$, because $\Pi v \in \mathcal{S}$, and $\|v\|^2 \leq 2\|\Pi v\|^2 + 2\|(1-\Pi)v\|^2$. Let $v \coloneqq \mathsf{N}^{-1}\Pi^*J$. Applying $(1-\Pi)^*$ to the equation $\mathsf{N}v = \Pi^*J$ and using $(1-\Pi)^*\Pi^* = 0$ and $((1-\Pi)^*)^2 = (1-\Pi)^*$, we find $(1-\Pi)^*(1-\Pi)v = 0$, hence $\|(1-\Pi)v\|^2 = 0$ and $v = \Pi v \in \mathcal{S}$. The equation then reads $\Pi^*\mathsf{M}v = \Pi^*J$, and for $B \in \mathcal{S}$ we have $B = \Pi B$ and $\langle B, \mathsf{M}v\rangle = \langle \Pi B, \mathsf{M}v\rangle = \langle B, \Pi^*J\rangle = \langle B, J\rangle$. If $B_0$ and $B_1$ in $\mathcal{S}$ both have this property, then $\langle B, \mathsf{M}(B_0 - B_1)\rangle = 0$ for $B = B_0 - B_1$, so that $B_0 = B_1$. For (22.10) we insert $\langle J, B\rangle = \langle B, \mathsf{M}\tilde{C}J\rangle$ and $\langle J, \tilde{C}J\rangle = \langle \tilde{C}J, \mathsf{M}\tilde{C}J\rangle$. Finally $\tilde{C}J = \Pi\tilde{C}J$. *q.e.d.*

We apply the lemma on the turned lattice for the scale $\ell_1 = L\eta$, whose blocks have $N = L$ points along each side. The fields are the square-summable fields on the bonds of $T_\eta$, with the scalar product of the weights $\eta^4$; the bonds of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ carry the weights $\ell_1^4$, and $Q \coloneqq Q_{\ell_1}$. A *local operator of the range $\varrho$* is an operator on these fields, or between them and the functions on the bonds of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$, whose kernel vanishes for two bonds at a distance of more than $\varrho\ell_1$ and has sums over either argument which are bounded by a constant depending on $L$ only. Products and adjoints of local operators are local.

**Proposition 22.6** (The Fields of the First Scale)**.** *Let $L \geq 64$ be a multiple of 5, let $a, a_0 > 0$, and let $C_1$, $C_2$ be the constants of Lemma 22.4.*

*(i) Let $\Lambda'$ be a set of points of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$, $\Lambda$ the union of their blocks, and for a field $A$ let*

$$\mathfrak{q}_\Lambda(A) \coloneqq a_0\eta^{-2}\sum_{b'}\eta^4|A(b')|^2 + a\ell_1^{-2}\sum_c \ell_1^4|(QA)(c)|^2 + \|\partial A\|^2 \,, \tag{22.11}$$

*with $b'$ and $c$ as in Lemma 22.4. If $A$ is axial on every block of $\Lambda$, then $\mathfrak{q}_\Lambda(A) \geq \gamma''\eta^{-2}\|A\|^2$ with $\gamma'' \coloneqq 1/\max(216L^4/a, C_1L^7, (C_2L^5+1)/a_0)$.*

*(ii) If $A$ is axial on every block $B_{\ell_1}(y)$, $y \in \ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$, and $QA = 0$, then $\|\partial A\|^2 \geq (C_1L^7)^{-1}\eta^{-2}\|A\|^2$.*

*(iii) In both cases let $\mathcal{S}$ be the space of the fields with the stated conditions and $\mathsf{M}$ the operator with $\langle A, \mathsf{M}A\rangle = \eta^2\mathfrak{q}_\Lambda(A)$, respectively $\eta^2\|\partial A\|^2$. There is a bounded projection $\Pi$ onto $\mathcal{S}$ such that the operator $\tilde{C} = \Pi\mathsf{N}^{-1}\Pi^*$ of Lemma 22.5 has a kernel, with respect to the sum over the positive bonds, with $|\tilde{C}(b, b')| \leq c\,e^{-\theta|b_- - b'_-|/\eta}$, where $c$ and $\theta > 0$ depend on $L$, $a$, and $a_0$ and not on $k$, $\eta$, or $\Lambda'$.*

*Proof.* (i) By (22.3) with $a$ replaced by the scale $\ell_1$ and $N = L$, and with $\ell_1 = L\eta$,

$$\|A\|^2 \le \frac{216L^4\eta^2}{a}\cdot a\ell_1^{-2}\sum_c \ell_1^4|(QA)(c)|^2 + C_1L^7\eta^2\|\partial A\|^2 + \frac{(C_2L^5+1)\eta^2}{a_0}\cdot a_0\eta^{-2}\sum_{b'}\eta^4|A(b')|^2\,, \tag{22.12}$$

where the term 1 accounts for the bonds $b'$ themselves. The right side is at most $\eta^2\mathfrak{q}_\Lambda(A)/\gamma''$. (ii) This is (22.3) for $\Lambda' = \ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$, where no bond $b'$ occurs and the first term vanishes.

(iii) *The projections.* For a set $\Lambda'$ let $\mathfrak{a}_\Lambda A := A - \partial((1-Q'^*_{\ell_1}Q'_{\ell_1})\lambda)$ with $\lambda(x) := \eta A(\pi_{y(x)}(x))$ for $x \in \Lambda$ and $\lambda(x) := 0$ otherwise. By the proof of Lemma 22.2(i), which treats each block by itself, $\mathfrak{a}_\Lambda A$ is axial on the blocks of $\Lambda$, $\mathfrak{a}_\Lambda A = A$ if $A$ is, and $Q\mathfrak{a}_\Lambda = Q$. The value $\lambda(x)$ is $\eta$ times a signed sum of at most $\frac{21}{5}L$ values of $A$ at bonds at a distance of less than $3\ell_1$ from $y(x)$, and a bond lies on the paths of at most $L^4$ points of each of at most $7^4$ blocks; hence $\mathfrak{a}_\Lambda$ is a local operator of the range 6. In the first case we take $\Pi := \mathfrak{a}_\Lambda$. In the second case let $\Pi := \mathfrak{a}_\Lambda(1 - Q^*(QQ^*)^{-1}Q)$ with $\Lambda' = \ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$. The operator $Q$ is local of the range 3: $(QA)(c)$ is $L^{-5}$ times a sum of the values of $A$ at the at most $\frac{7}{5}L^5$ bonds of the staircases from the points of $B_{\ell_1}(c_-)$, and a bond lies on at most $\frac{7}{5}L$ staircases of each direction (proof of Lemma 6.4(ii)). By Lemma 17.1(ii), applied to the run of one step with $a = 1$ there, in the unit $\ell_1$, the operator $QQ^*$ is bounded below by a positive constant which does not depend on $k$ and $L$; the lemma is stated for a torus, and it gives the bound on the infinite lattice, because for a function $\omega$ of finite support on the bonds of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ the norm of $Q^*\omega$ is the same on the infinite lattice and on a torus with large periods. Since $QQ^*$ is local, the kernel of its inverse decays exponentially by Lemma 14.1. The operator $1 - Q^*(QQ^*)^{-1}Q$ is the orthogonal projection onto the null space of $Q$, and $\mathfrak{a}_\Lambda$ maps this space to itself and to the axial fields, on which it is the identity; hence $\Pi$ is a projection onto $\mathcal{S}$.

*The decay.* The operator $\mathsf{M}$ is local: the first term of $\eta^2\mathfrak{q}_\Lambda$ is diagonal, the second is $(a/L^2)$ times the form of $Q^*\mathbf{1}Q$ with the characteristic function of a set of bonds of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$, and $\eta^2\|\partial A\|^2 \le 24\|A\|^2$ has a kernel of the range $2\eta$. By (i), (ii), and Lemma 22.5, $\mathsf{N} \ge \frac{1}{2}\min(\gamma, 1)$ with $\gamma = \gamma''$, respectively $(C_1L^7)^{-1}$. In the first case $\mathsf{N}$ is local, and in the second its kernel is bounded by a constant times $e^{-\theta_Q|b_- - b'_-|/\ell_1}$, with constants which depend on $L$. In both cases $\sum_{b'}|\mathsf{N}(b,b')|(e^{\theta|b_- - b'_-|/\eta} - 1)$ tends to zero with $\theta$, uniformly in $b$, $\eta$, and $\Lambda'$, and Lemma 14.1 gives the exponential decay of the kernel of $\mathsf{N}^{-1}$. The same decay follows for $\Pi\mathsf{N}^{-1}\Pi^*$, because the kernel of $\Pi$ has bounded sums and vanishes beyond a bounded distance, or decays exponentially. *q.e.d.*

Statement (i) is the lower bound which Bałaban asserts for the form [3, (2.122)], here for the pair of the scales 0 and 1, where the form of the finer scale is $\|\partial A\|^2$, and $\eta^2\tilde{C}$ is the covariance $\tilde{C}^{(0)}_\Lambda$ of [3, (2.129)]. Statement (ii) is [3, (2.153)] for the first step of the tilted run, and (iii) replaces [3, (2.154)–(2.157)] for this step. For the later steps and scales the unit lattice is a lattice of the paper and these statements are as printed.

## 23 The Propagator of Two Neighbouring Scales

We come to Section C of [3]. Its first result is a representation of the propagator whose averages are those of the scale $j+1$ on a set of blocks and those of the scale $j$ elsewhere, through the operators of the scale $j$ alone and operators of the unit lattice [3, (2.129), p. 246]. Bałaban derives it from a sequence of transformations of Gaussian integrals [3, (2.95)–(2.119)]: he replaces the gauge-fixing term of the two scales by that of the scale $j$ together with an axial gauge condition for the averages, by the method of Faddeev and Popov, and then integrates

in stages. Each of these transformations is a statement about the minimum of a quadratic form over a subspace or over the orbits of a group, and we prove the representation in this form. The proof uses the averages only through the identities of Section 6, so that it holds for the tilted run; the lattice enters the result through the operators $H'$ and $\Delta'$ of Section 21 and, for the first scale, through Section 22.

*The setting.* We fix $1 \le j \le k-1$ and take the spacing of the lattice of the scale $j$ as the unit of length; the pair of the scales 0 and 1 is treated at the end of the section. The fine lattice is a torus $T_\eta/\Gamma'$ as in Section 9, with $\eta = L^{-j}$ in this unit and with periods which are multiples of $L$, the unit lattice is $\mathbb{Z}^4/\Gamma'$, and $Q \coloneqq Q_k$, $Q' \coloneqq Q'_k$ are the averages of the run of $j$ steps. We write $Q_1 \coloneqq Q^{\mathrm{st}}_{1,L}$ and $Q'_1 \coloneqq Q'^{\mathrm{st}}_{1,L}$ for Bałaban's averages (6.4) from the unit lattice to $L\mathbb{Z}^4/\Gamma'$; by Lemma 6.3, in the original unit $Q_1 Q$ and $Q'_1 Q'$ are the tilted averages of the scale $j+1$. For a function $\omega$ on the unit lattice, (6.4) gives

$$(Q_1\partial_1\omega)(\langle y, y+Le_\mu\rangle) = L^{-5}\sum_z(\omega(z+Le_\mu)-\omega(z)) = L^{-1}((Q'_1\omega)(y+Le_\mu)-(Q'_1\omega)(y)) \;, \quad (23.1)$$

the sum over the points $z$ of the cube of $y$. All the spaces of this section have finite dimension, and $\Delta \coloneqq \partial^*\partial$ on the functions, as in [3]. Let $\Lambda'$ be a set of points of $L\mathbb{Z}^4/\Gamma'$, $\Lambda$ the union of their cubes in the unit lattice, $\mathcal{S}_\Lambda$, $E$, and $C'_\Lambda$ as in Lemma 21.3, which holds on the torus with the same proof, the kernels being summed over the periods. As in [3, p. 224], the bonds of a set of points are the bonds with at least one end in the set: $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda^c)$ is the set of the bonds of the unit lattice with no end in $\Lambda$, and $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')$ the set of the bonds of $L\mathbb{Z}^4/\Gamma'$ with at least one end in $\Lambda'$. For $a > 0$ and a field $B$ on the unit lattice let

$$\mathfrak{q}''(B) \coloneqq a\sum_{b\in\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda^c)}|B(b)|^2 + aL^2\sum_{c\in\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')}|(Q_1B)(c)|^2 \;, \quad (23.2)$$

so that $\mathfrak{q}''(QA)$ is the form $\langle QA, aQA\rangle$ of [3, (2.97)]. The gauge functions of the two scales and of the scale $j$ are the spaces

$$\mathcal{N} \coloneqq \{\lambda \,|\, Q'\lambda \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda\} \;, \qquad \mathcal{N}_j \coloneqq \{\lambda \,|\, Q'\lambda = 0\} \;, \quad (23.3)$$

of functions on the fine lattice; the first is the space $N(Q')$ of [3, (2.10)] for the two scales, since $Q'\lambda \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$ means that $Q'\lambda$ vanishes outside $\Lambda$ and $Q'_1Q'\lambda$ vanishes on $\Lambda'$. Neither space contains a constant other than zero. Let $R$ and $R_j$ be the orthogonal projections onto $\Delta\mathcal{N}$ and $\Delta\mathcal{N}_j$ [3, p. 225], so that $1-R_j$ is the projection $P$ of Lemma 15.1, and let

$$\mathfrak{g}(A) \coloneqq \|\partial A\|^2 + \|R\partial^*A\|^2 + \mathfrak{q}''(QA) \;, \qquad \mathfrak{h}_j(A) \coloneqq \|\partial A\|^2 + \|R_j\partial^*A\|^2 \;. \quad (23.4)$$

The first is the quadratic form of the operator $\Delta_a$ of [3, (2.19)] for the two scales, whose inverse is the operator $G_\square$ of [3, (2.90)], and $\mathfrak{h}_j(A) + a\|QA\|^2$ is the form of the operator $\Delta_a$ of Proposition 9.3, whose inverse we denote by $G_j$. With Lemma 17.1 we put

$$H_j \coloneqq G_jQ^*(QG_jQ^*)^{-1} \;, \qquad \Delta_j \coloneqq (QG_jQ^*)^{-1} - a \;, \qquad \tilde{G}_j \coloneqq G_j - G_jQ^*(QG_jQ^*)^{-1}QG_j \;, \quad (23.5)$$

which are [3, (2.130), (2.131)] and the operators $H_k$ and $\Delta_k$ of Section 17. A field $B$ on the unit lattice is *axial on the cubes of* $\Lambda$ if its sum over the contour $\Gamma_{y,x}$ of [2, (1.7)] vanishes for every $y \in \Lambda'$ and every $x$ in the cube of $y$; these contours lie in the cube and form a tree, so that this is the condition [3, (2.121)].

**Lemma 23.1** (Five Facts)**.** *In the setting above the following hold.*

*(i) For every field $A$ and every $\lambda \in \mathcal{N}$, $\partial(\partial\lambda) = 0$ and $\mathfrak{q}''(Q(A-\partial\lambda)) = \mathfrak{q}''(QA)$.*

*(ii)* $\mathcal{N}$ *is the direct sum of* $\mathcal{N}_j$ *and* $H'\mathcal{S}_\Lambda$*, and* $\|\Delta(\nu + H'\omega)\|^2 = \|\Delta\nu\|^2 + \langle\omega, \Delta'\omega\rangle$ *for* $\nu \in \mathcal{N}_j$ *and* $\omega \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$*. Consequently* $\|Rf\|^2 = \|R_j f\|^2 + \langle EH'^*\Delta f, C'_\Lambda EH'^*\Delta f\rangle$ *for every function* $f$*.*

*(iii) For every field* $A$ *there is exactly one* $\omega \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$ *such that* $Q(A - \partial H'\omega)$ *is axial on the cubes of* $\Lambda$*.*

*(iv) For every field* $B$ *on the unit lattice and every field* $A'$ *with* $QA' = 0$*,* $\mathfrak{h}_j(H_jB + A') = \langle B, \Delta_j B\rangle + \mathfrak{h}_j(A')$*, and* $\sup\{2\langle J, A'\rangle - \mathfrak{h}_j(A') \,|\, QA' = 0\} = \langle J, \tilde{G}_j J\rangle$ *for every field* $J$*.*

*(v) There is a constant* $\gamma''_0 > 0$*, which depends on* $a$ *and* $L$ *only, such that* $\mathfrak{q}''(B) + \langle B, \Delta_j B\rangle \geq \gamma''_0\|B\|^2$ *for every* $B$ *which is axial on the cubes of* $\Lambda$*.*

*Proof.* (i) The curl of a gradient vanishes. By Lemma 6.4(i), $Q\partial\lambda = \partial_1\omega$ with $\omega := Q'\lambda \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$. On a bond of $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda^c)$ the field $\partial_1\omega$ vanishes, because $\omega$ vanishes at both ends. The function $Q'_1\omega$ vanishes at every point of $L\mathbb{Z}^4/\Gamma'$: at the points of $\Lambda'$ because $\omega$ has the mean zero on their cubes, and at the other points because $\omega$ vanishes on their cubes. Hence $Q_1\partial_1\omega = 0$ by (23.1).

(ii) By Lemma 21.1(i), $Q'H'\omega = \omega$, so that $H'\mathcal{S}_\Lambda \subset \mathcal{N}$, and for $\lambda \in \mathcal{N}$ the function $\nu := \lambda - H'Q'\lambda$ lies in $\mathcal{N}_j$; the sum is direct because $Q'(\nu + H'\omega) = \omega$. The identity of the norms is Lemma 21.1(ii) for $\lambda = \nu + H'\omega$ and $\mu = \omega$. It shows that $\Delta\mathcal{N}$ is the orthogonal sum of $\Delta\mathcal{N}_j$ and of the range of the operator $\mathsf{X} := \Delta H'$ on $\mathcal{S}_\Lambda$, for which $\mathsf{X}^*\mathsf{X} = E\Delta'E$ is the inverse of $C'_\Lambda$ on $\mathcal{S}_\Lambda$. The orthogonal projection onto this range is $\mathsf{X}C'_\Lambda\mathsf{X}^* = \Delta H'C'_\Lambda EH'^*\Delta$, and $R$ is its sum with $R_j$.

(iii) Let $B := QA$. By Lemma 6.4(i) and $Q'H' = I$, $Q(A - \partial H'\omega) = B - \partial_1\omega$. Let $\lambda_B(x)$ be the sum of $B$ over $\Gamma_{y,x}$ for $x$ in the cube of $y \in \Lambda'$, and let $\omega$ be equal to $\lambda_B$ minus its mean over the cube on each cube of $\Lambda$, and to zero outside $\Lambda$. Then $\omega \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$, and the sum of $B - \partial_1\omega$ over $\Gamma_{y,x}$ is $\lambda_B(x) - (\omega(x) - \omega(y)) = 0$, because $\lambda_B(y) = 0$. If $\partial_1\omega$ is axial for some $\omega \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$, then $\omega(x) = \omega(y)$ on each cube, and $\omega = 0$ because its means vanish; this gives the uniqueness.

(iv) Let $\mathsf{H}$ be the operator of the form $\mathfrak{h}_j$, so that $G_j^{-1} = \mathsf{H} + aQ^*Q$, and let $A_0 := H_jB$. Then $QA_0 = B$, and for $QA' = 0$ we have $\langle A', \mathsf{H}A_0\rangle = \langle A', G_j^{-1}A_0\rangle - a\langle QA', QA_0\rangle = \langle QA', (QG_jQ^*)^{-1}B\rangle = 0$, which gives the first identity with $\mathfrak{h}_j(A_0) = \langle A_0, G_j^{-1}A_0\rangle - a\|B\|^2 = \langle B, \Delta_j B\rangle$. On the null space of $Q$ the form $\mathfrak{h}_j$ is that of $G_j^{-1}$, which is positive by (9.2). The field $A'_0 := \tilde{G}_jJ$ satisfies $QA'_0 = 0$ and $G_j^{-1}A'_0 = J - Q^*(QG_jQ^*)^{-1}QG_jJ$, so that $\langle A', G_j^{-1}A'_0\rangle = \langle A', J\rangle$ whenever $QA' = 0$; hence $2\langle J, A'\rangle - \mathfrak{h}_j(A') = \langle J, \tilde{G}_jJ\rangle - \mathfrak{h}_j(A' - A'_0)$, as in (22.10).

(v) By (9.4), $\langle B, \Delta_j B\rangle \geq \frac{1}{24}\|\partial_1 B\|^2$, and $\mathfrak{q}''$ is at least $\min(a, 1)$ times its value for $a = 1$. For $a = 1$ the form $\mathfrak{q}''(B) + \gamma_0\|\partial_1 B\|^2$ is [3, (2.122)], a form of the unit lattice of the paper with its cubes and Bałaban's averages, and it is bounded below by a positive multiple of $\|B\|^2$ on the fields which satisfy [3, (2.121)], with a constant which depends on $\gamma_0$ and $L$ [3, p. 246]. *q.e.d.*

**Proposition 23.2** (The Representation (2.129))**.** *In the setting above the form* $\mathfrak{g}$ *is positive definite. Let* $G$ *be the inverse of its operator, let* $\tilde{C}_\Lambda$ *be the operator of Lemma 22.5 for the space of the fields on the unit lattice which are axial on the cubes of* $\Lambda$ *and for the form* $\mathfrak{q}''(B) + \langle B, \Delta_j B\rangle$*, and let* $\mathsf{W} := \partial\Delta H'C'_\Lambda EH'^*\partial^*$*. Then*

$$G = \partial H'C'_\Lambda EH'^*\partial^* + (1 - \mathsf{W})^*(\tilde{G}_j + H_j\tilde{C}_\Lambda H_j^*)(1 - \mathsf{W}) \,, \tag{23.6}$$

*which is [3, (2.129)]. Moreover, let $Q''$ map a field $B$ on the unit lattice to the function on $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda^c) \cup \mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')$ which is $B$ on the bonds of the first set and $Q_1 B$ on those of the second, so that $Q''Q$ is the average of the two scales. Then $Q''QGQ^*Q''^* = Q''\tilde{C}_\Lambda Q''^*$, which is [3, (2.146)].*

*Proof. The gauge-fixing term.* By Lemma 23.1(ii) with $f = \partial^* A$,

$$\mathfrak{g}(A) = \mathfrak{g}_j(A) + \langle \mathsf{V}A, C'_\Lambda \mathsf{V}A \rangle \,, \qquad \mathfrak{g}_j(A) \coloneqq \mathfrak{h}_j(A) + \mathfrak{q}''(QA) \,, \qquad \mathsf{V} \coloneqq EH'^* \Delta \partial^* \,. \quad (23.7)$$

*The slice.* By Lemma 23.1(iii) every field is $A = A_2 + \partial H'\omega$ with a unique $\omega \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$ and a unique field $A_2$ for which $QA_2$ is axial on the cubes of $\Lambda$. The form $\mathfrak{g}_j$ does not change if $\partial H'\omega$ is added to its argument: the first and the last term by Lemma 23.1(i), since $H'\omega \in \mathcal{N}$, and the second because $\partial^* \partial H'\omega = \Delta H'\omega$ is orthogonal to $\Delta \mathcal{N}_j$ by Lemma 23.1(ii). By Lemma 21.1(i), $\mathsf{V}\partial H'\omega = EH'^* \Delta^2 H'\omega = E\Delta'\omega$, which is the image of $\omega$ under the inverse of $C'_\Lambda$. With $\tilde{\omega} \coloneqq \omega + C'_\Lambda \mathsf{V} A_2 \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$ we obtain

$$\mathfrak{g}(A) = \mathfrak{g}_j(A_2) + \langle \tilde{\omega}, \Delta' \tilde{\omega} \rangle \,, \qquad A = (1 - \partial H' C'_\Lambda \mathsf{V}) A_2 + \partial H' \tilde{\omega} \,, \quad (23.8)$$

and the pairs of a field $A_2$ with axial average and a function $\tilde{\omega} \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$ parametrise all fields.

*Positivity.* Let $B \coloneqq QA_2$ and $A_2 = H_j B + A'$ with $QA' = 0$. By Lemma 23.1(iv), $\mathfrak{g}_j(A_2) = \mathfrak{q}''(B) + \langle B, \Delta_j B \rangle + \mathfrak{h}_j(A')$. The three terms of $\mathfrak{g}(A)$ which result are nonnegative, and they vanish only for $\tilde{\omega} = 0$ by (21.8), $B = 0$ by Lemma 23.1(v), and $A' = 0$ by (9.2), that is, only for $A = 0$.

*The supremum.* For a field $J$, $\langle J, GJ \rangle$ is the supremum of $2\langle J, A \rangle - \mathfrak{g}(A)$ over all fields. By (23.8), with $J'' \coloneqq (1 - \partial H' C'_\Lambda \mathsf{V})^* J = (1 - \mathsf{W})J$, it is the sum of the suprema of

$$2\langle EH'^* \partial^* J, \tilde{\omega} \rangle - \langle \tilde{\omega}, \Delta' \tilde{\omega} \rangle \qquad \text{and} \qquad 2\langle J'', H_j B + A' \rangle - \mathfrak{q}''(B) - \langle B, \Delta_j B \rangle - \mathfrak{h}_j(A') \quad (23.9)$$

over $\tilde{\omega} \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$, and over the axial fields $B$ and the fields $A'$ with $QA' = 0$. The first supremum is $\langle EH'^* \partial^* J, C'_\Lambda EH'^* \partial^* J \rangle$. In the second, the supremum over $A'$ is $\langle J'', \tilde{G}_j J'' \rangle$ by Lemma 23.1(iv), and the supremum over $B$ is $\langle H_j^* J'', \tilde{C}_\Lambda H_j^* J'' \rangle$ by (22.10). The two sides of (23.6) are symmetric operators with the same quadratic form.

*The averages.* Let $J = Q^* Q''^* B_0$. For $\omega \in \mathcal{S}_\Lambda$, $\langle H'^* \partial^* J, \omega \rangle = \langle B_0, Q'' Q \partial H' \omega \rangle = \langle B_0, Q'' \partial_1 \omega \rangle = 0$ by the proof of Lemma 23.1(i), so that $EH'^* \partial^* J = 0$; hence the first term of (23.6) and $\mathsf{W}$ vanish on $J$. Further $\tilde{G}_j Q^* = 0$ by (23.5), and $H_j^* Q^* = (QH_j)^* = I$. Therefore $\langle J, GJ \rangle = \langle Q''^* B_0, \tilde{C}_\Lambda Q''^* B_0 \rangle$. *q.e.d.*

The fields $J = Q^* Q''^* B_0$ are those against which Bałaban evaluates the form for the inverse of $QG_\square Q^*$ [3, (2.144)–(2.146)]; that the terms with $\mathsf{W}$ drop out is his remark that only gauge transformations with $Q'\lambda = 0$ were made.

*The scales* 0 *and* 1. For the pair of the scales 0 and 1 the unit lattice is the fine lattice $T_\eta / \Gamma'$ itself, and the statements above hold with the following substitutions, each of which makes the corresponding step of the proofs a tautology or replaces its reference: $Q$ and $Q'$ are the identity, $Q_1$ and $Q'_1$ are the tilted averages $Q_{\ell_1}$ and $Q'_{\ell_1}$, for which (23.1) is Lemma 6.4(i); $H' = I$ and $\Delta' = \Delta^2$; $\mathcal{N}_0 = \{0\}$, $R_0 = 0$, and $\mathfrak{h}_0(A) = \|\partial A\|^2$; $H_0 = I$, $\langle B, \Delta_0 B \rangle = \|\partial B\|^2$, and $\tilde{G}_0 = 0$; the cubes of $\Lambda$ are the blocks $B_{\ell_1}(y)$, the space $\mathcal{S}_\Lambda$ and the covariance $C'_\Lambda$ are those of the remark after Lemma 21.3, a field is axial in the sense of Section 22, and in (iii) the function $\lambda_B$ is that of Lemma 22.2(i); the form $\mathfrak{q}''$ has the constant $a\eta^{-2}$ on the bonds of $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda^c)$ and $a\ell_1^{-2}$, with the weights $\ell_1^4$, on those of $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')$, and (v) is Proposition 22.6(i)

with $a_0 = a$. The representation (23.6) then reads $G = \partial C'_\Lambda E \partial^* + (1 - \mathsf{W})^* \tilde{C}_\Lambda (1 - \mathsf{W})$ with $\mathsf{W} = \partial \Delta C'_\Lambda E \partial^*$.

It remains to draw the bounds from the representation. All the operators in it have been bounded, and what has to be checked is that their composition has the regularity of the propagator of one scale, although $\mathsf{W}$ contains three derivatives of $H'$.

**Proposition 23.3** (Proposition 2.5 for the Tilted Run)**.** *Let $L \geq 64$ be a multiple of 5 and $a > 0$. The operator $G$ of Proposition 23.2 satisfies the bounds (i)–(iv) of Proposition 16.2 and the bounds* (9.3)*, with constants $c$, $\delta_G > 0$, $\gamma_0$, and $C$ which depend on $a$, $L$, and the Hölder exponents, and not on $j$, $k$, the torus, or the set $\Lambda'$. For the scales* 0 *and* 1 *the same holds with the unit $\eta$.*

*Proof.* We write $c$ and $\delta$ for constants with the stated dependence. An operator between bounded functions or fields on the two lattices is *of the class* $\mathcal{K}$ if it has a kernel, with respect to the sum over the points of the lattice of its argument with the weight $\eta^4$ for the fine lattice and 1 for the unit lattice, which is at most $c\, e^{-\delta d}$ in modulus, $d$ being the distance of the two points; and it is *of the class* $\mathcal{B}$ if the modulus of its value at a point $x$ is at most $c \sum_{y'} e^{-\delta d(x,y')} \sup_{\Delta(y')} |f|$ for every argument $f$, the sum over the points $y'$ of the unit lattice and the supremum over the block of $y'$, or the value at $y'$ for an argument on the unit lattice. An operator of the class $\mathcal{K}$ is of the class $\mathcal{B}$, and it is bounded on the square-summable functions, by Schur's test. Sums and products of operators of either class are of the same class, and an operator of the class $\mathcal{B}$ maps a function supported at the distance $D$ from a point to a function which is at most $c\, e^{-\delta D/2} \sup |f|$ there.

*The factors.* (a) By Proposition 21.2(i), $\partial^{(n)} H'$ for $n \leq 3$ and the adjoints $H'^* (\partial^{(n)})^*$ are of the class $\mathcal{K}$; in particular $\partial H'$, $\nabla \partial H'$, $\Delta \partial H'$, $H'^* \partial^*$, $H'^* \partial^* \nabla^*$, and $H'^* \Delta \partial^*$ are. The differences of the values of $\nabla \partial H' \omega$ at two points $x$, $x'$ with $d(x, x') \leq 1$ are at most $c\, d(x, x')$ times a sum of the same form, because the two points are joined by a path of at most $2d(x, x')/\eta$ bonds and a third difference quotient of the kernel is bounded. (b) $C'_\Lambda E$ is of the class $\mathcal{K}$ by Lemma 21.3. (c) $G_j$, $\nabla G_j$, $G_j \nabla^*$, and $\Delta G_j$ are of the class $\mathcal{B}$ by Proposition 16.2(i) applied to the restrictions of a field to the blocks, and $Q$, $Q^*$ are of the class $\mathcal{K}$, being averages over blocks and staircases. By Lemma 17.1, $(Q G_j Q^*)^{-1} = \Delta_j + a$ is of the class $\mathcal{K}$. Hence $H_j = G_j Q^* (\Delta_j + a)$, $\nabla H_j$, $\Delta H_j$, $H_j^* = (\Delta_j + a) Q G_j$, and $H_j^* \nabla^*$ are of the class $\mathcal{B}$, and the differences of $\nabla H_j B$ satisfy the Hölder bound of Proposition 16.2(ii). (d) $\tilde{C}_\Lambda$ is of the class $\mathcal{K}$. Indeed the form $\mathfrak{q}''(B) + \langle B, \Delta_j B \rangle$ is bounded below on the axial fields by Lemma 23.1(v); its operator has a kernel which decays exponentially, by Lemma 17.1(iii) and because $\mathfrak{q}''$ is the form of an operator whose kernel vanishes beyond the distance $3L$; and the map $B \mapsto B - \partial_1 \omega$ of Lemma 23.1(iii) is a projection onto the axial fields whose kernel vanishes beyond the distance $2L$ and has bounded sums. Lemma 22.5 and Lemma 14.1 give the decay of $\tilde{C}_\Lambda$, as in the proof of Proposition 22.6(iii).

*The composition.* Let $\mathsf{G}_1 := \tilde{G}_j + H_j \tilde{C}_\Lambda H_j^*$, where $\tilde{G}_j = G_j - H_j Q G_j$. By (c) and (d), $\mathsf{G}_1$, $\nabla \mathsf{G}_1$, $\mathsf{G}_1 \nabla^*$, and $\Delta \mathsf{G}_1$ are of the class $\mathcal{B}$, and $\nabla \mathsf{G}_1 \nabla^* J$ is the sum of $\nabla G_j \nabla^* J$, which satisfies Proposition 16.2(iii) and (iv), and of an operator of the class $\mathcal{B}$ applied to $J$, whose values satisfy the Hölder bound of (ii). By (a) and (b), $\mathsf{W} = \partial \Delta H' C'_\Lambda E H'^* \partial^*$, $\mathsf{W} \nabla^*$, $\mathsf{W}^* = \partial H' C'_\Lambda E H'^* \Delta \partial^*$, $\nabla \mathsf{W}^*$, and $\Delta \mathsf{W}^*$ are of the class $\mathcal{K}$, and the values of $\nabla \mathsf{W}^* F$ are Lipschitz continuous in the sense of (a); the same holds for the first term $\mathsf{G}_0 := \partial H' C'_\Lambda E H'^* \partial^*$ of (23.6) with $\nabla \mathsf{G}_0$, $\mathsf{G}_0 \nabla^*$, $\nabla \mathsf{G}_0 \nabla^*$, and $\Delta \mathsf{G}_0$. In no case is a derivative applied to $\mathsf{W}$ from the left or to $\mathsf{W}^*$ from the right. Now $G = \mathsf{G}_0 + (1 - \mathsf{W}^*) \mathsf{G}_1 (1 - \mathsf{W})$. For a bounded field $J$ the fields $(1 - \mathsf{W}) J$ and $(1 - \mathsf{W}) \nabla^* J = \nabla^* J - \mathsf{W} \nabla^* J$ are $J$, respectively $\nabla^* J$, plus the image of $J$ under an operator of the class $\mathcal{B}$. Applying $\mathsf{G}_1$ and then $1 - \mathsf{W}^*$, with or without

a derivative on the left, we obtain in each of the cases (i)–(iv) the corresponding expression for $\mathsf{G}_1$, which is that for $G_j$ up to operators of the class $\mathcal{B}$, plus images of $J$ under operators of the class $\mathcal{B}$ whose values are Hölder continuous with every exponent $\alpha < 1$. This gives (i)–(iv).

*The bounds in $L^2$.* The operators of the class $\mathcal{K}$ are bounded on the square-summable functions. The operators $\mathsf{G}_0$, $\mathsf{W}$, and $\mathsf{W}^*$ are of this class, and they remain so with up to two derivatives on the left of $\mathsf{G}_0$ and $\mathsf{W}^*$ and on the right of $\mathsf{G}_0$ and $\mathsf{W}$, because this gives at most three derivatives of $H'$ on either side. The operator $\mathsf{G}_1$ satisfies (9.3): for $G_j$ this is Proposition 9.3, and $H_j = G_j Q^*(\Delta_j + a)$ and its adjoint are products of $G_j$, with the derivatives on it, and of operators of the class $\mathcal{K}$. Inserting these facts into $G = \mathsf{G}_0 + (1 - \mathsf{W}^*)\mathsf{G}_1(1 - \mathsf{W})$ gives (9.3) for $G$, with other constants.

For the scales 0 and 1 all the operators of the representation act on the lattice $T_\eta$, in whose unit a difference quotient is a bounded operator of the range one, and the statement follows from the decay of $C'_\Lambda E$ and of $\tilde{C}_\Lambda$, which is the remark after Lemma 21.3 and Proposition 22.6(iii). *q.e.d.*

## 24 The Propagator of a Sequence of Domains

The rest of Section C of [3] passes from the propagators of two scales to the propagator $G$ of a sequence of domains, by the expansion [3, (2.91)–(2.93), (2.141)], and then to the inverse of $QGQ^*$ and to the minimiser $H$ [3, (2.142)–(2.151)]. The scheme is that of Section 20, and the lattice enters it through the statements of Sections 20 to 23 only. There is one step which Bałaban does not carry out: the remainder of the expansion contains the difference of the gauge-fixing projection of the sequence and that of the local operator [3, (2.92)], and its smallness is asserted with the others [3, (2.134)]. We prove it, as a statement on two sequences of domains which agree near a cube (Lemma 24.2). A second step needs an argument on the turned lattice: the lower bound [3, (2.147)] uses that every function on the bonds of the two scales is the average of a field in the axial gauge of comparable norm, which in [3, (2.146)] is read off from the bonds between the blocks (Lemma 24.4).

*The setting.* The fine lattice is a torus $\mathbb{T} := T_\eta/\Gamma'$, in the unit of the last lattice as in Section 20, with a sequence of domains which satisfies the hypotheses of Proposition 20.6; the statements of Section 20 are used on $\mathbb{T}$, with the kernels summed over the periods. As in [3, (2.3)], $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda_j)$ is the set of the bonds of the lattice of the scale $j$ with at least one end in $\Omega_j$ and no end in $\Omega_{j+1}$, $\mathfrak{b}(\mathfrak{B})$ is the union of these sets, with the weights $\mathsf{w}(b) := \ell_j^4$, and $(QA)(b) := (Q_{\ell_j} A)(b)$ for $b \in \mathfrak{b}(\Lambda_j)$, $j \geq 1$, and $(QA)(b) := A(b)$ for $j = 0$ [3, (2.20)]. The operator $P = G'Q'^*N^{-1}Q'G'$ of Proposition 20.6 is the orthogonal projection onto the orthogonal complement of $\Delta N(Q')$: it is the orthogonal projection onto the range of $\mathsf{X} := G'Q'^*$, since $\mathsf{X}^*\mathsf{X} = N$; for $\lambda \in N(Q')$ we have $\Delta\lambda = \Delta'_a\lambda$ and $\langle \Delta\lambda, G'Q'^*\omega\rangle = \langle Q'\lambda, \omega\rangle = 0$; and if $f$ is orthogonal to the range of $\mathsf{X}$, then $\lambda := G'f$ satisfies $Q'\lambda = 0$ and $f = \Delta'_a\lambda = \Delta\lambda$. This is [3, (2.17)]. With $R := 1 - P$ let

$$\mathfrak{g}(A) := \|\partial A\|^2 + \|R\partial^* A\|^2 + \sum_{b \in \mathfrak{b}(\mathfrak{B})} a\, \ell_{j(b)}^{-2} \mathsf{w}(b) |(QA)(b)|^2 \,, \tag{24.1}$$

the quadratic form of the operator $\Delta_a = \partial^*\partial + \partial R\partial^* + Q^* a Q$ of [3, (2.19)], whose inverse, when it exists, is the propagator $G$.

*The local operators.* For $0 \leq j \leq k$ let $\mathcal{S}^{(j)}$ be the sequence in which the domains of the indices up to $j$ are replaced by $\mathbb{T}$, the domain $\Omega_{j+1}$ is kept, and the later ones are omitted.

For $j < k$ it is, in the unit $\ell_{j+1}$, a sequence of domains for the run of $j+1$ steps, of the kind which [3, p. 224] admits when he allows the first domains to be the whole lattice, and for $j = k$ it is the sequence all of whose domains are $\mathbb{T}$. It satisfies the hypotheses of Proposition 20.6 with the same $M$ and $R$, the separation [3, (2.2)] being void for it, so that the statements of Section 20 hold for it, with its own distance. We mark its objects by the index $\square$, for a cube $\square \in \mathscr{D}$ of the scale $j$: its distance $d_\square$, its points $\mathfrak{B}_{(\square)}$, its average $Q_\square$, its scalar operators $Q'_\square$, $A_\square = (\Delta'_{a,\square})^{-1}$, which is the operator of Section 18, $N_{(\square)} \coloneqq Q'_\square A_\square^2 Q'^*_\square$, its projection $P_\square$, and its form $\mathfrak{g}_\square$; they depend on $j$ only. The form $\mathfrak{g}_\square$ is, in the unit $\ell_j$, the form (23.4) with $\Lambda' = \Omega_{j+1}^{(j+1)}$, respectively its version for the scales 0 and 1, and for $j = k$ the form of Proposition 9.3. By Proposition 23.2 it is positive definite, and we let $G_\square$ be the inverse of its operator. By Proposition 23.3, written in the unit of the last lattice, for every bounded field $J$ and every $x$, with $D \coloneqq \operatorname{dist}(x, \operatorname{supp} J)$,

$$|(G_\square J)(x)| \le c\,\ell_j^2 e^{-\delta_G D/\ell_j} \sup|J| \,, \qquad |(\nabla G_\square J)(x)| \,,\ |(G_\square \nabla^* J)(x)| \le c\,\ell_j e^{-\delta_G D/\ell_j} \sup|J| \,, \tag{24.2}$$

together with the Hölder bounds and the bounds for $\Delta G_\square$ and $\nabla G_\square \nabla^*$ of Proposition 16.2 with the corresponding powers of $\ell_j$, which is [3, (2.133)]. Throughout this section $c$ denotes constants which depend on $a$, $L$, and the Hölder exponents, and which may change from line to line, and we use Lemma 19.2 and the rule (20.22) as in the proof of Proposition 20.6, for both sequences.

*The zones of a cube.* Let $\square \in \mathscr{D}$ be a cube of the scale $j$. For $0 < \vartheta \le \frac{1}{4}$ let $Z_\vartheta$ be the union of the blocks of the points of $\mathfrak{B}$ whose distance from the support of $h_\square$, in $|\cdot|_\infty$, is less than $\vartheta M \ell_j$.

**Lemma 24.1** (The Zones)**.** *Let $M \ge 240L$ and $0 < \vartheta < \vartheta' \le \frac{1}{4}$.*

*(i) $Z_{1/4}$ lies in $\square$; its blocks are blocks of both sequences, of the scales $j$ and $j+1$; and on $Z_{1/4}$ the averaging terms of $\Delta'_a$ and of $\Delta'_{a,\square}$, and those of $\Delta_a$ and of the operator of $\mathfrak{g}_\square$, coincide.*

*(ii) If $u \in \mathfrak{B}$ has a scale smaller than $j$ or larger than $j+1$ and $v \in \mathfrak{B}$ lies in $Z_\vartheta$, then $d(u,v) \ge (\frac{1}{3} - \vartheta)M - L$.*

*(iii) If $v$ lies in $Z_\vartheta$ and $v'$ does not lie in $Z_{\vartheta'}$, then $d(v,v') \ge (\vartheta' - \vartheta)M/L - 2$ for $v, v' \in \mathfrak{B}$, and $d_\square(v,v') \ge (\vartheta' - \vartheta)M/L - 2$ for $v, v' \in \mathfrak{B}_{(\square)}$.*

*Proof.* A block of a scale of at most $j+1$ has the diameter $L\ell_j$ at most in $|\cdot|_\infty$. By property (b) of the cover the support of $h_\square$ is at a distance of at least $\frac{1}{3}M\ell_j$ from the complement of $\square$ and of $[\Omega_j]$ and of at least $\frac{1}{3}M\ell_{j+1}$ from $[\Omega_{j+2}]$. Hence the points of $Z_{1/4}$ are at a distance of at least $(\frac{1}{12}M - L)\ell_j \ge 19\ell_{j+1}$ from these three sets, which gives (i): the blocks of the two sequences coincide in $[\Omega_j] \setminus [\Omega_{j+2}]$, and the averaging terms at a point involve the blocks and the staircases within the distance $9\ell_{j+1}$ of it, as in the proof of Proposition 16.2. (ii) and (iii) are proved as Lemma 20.3(iii) and (ii): a chain from $v$ to $u$, or to $v'$, starts at a distance of at least $(\frac{1}{3} - \vartheta)M\ell_j - L\ell_j$ from the complement of $[\Omega_j]$, of at least $\frac{1}{3}M\ell_{j+1} - \vartheta M\ell_j - L\ell_j$ from $[\Omega_{j+2}]$, and of less than $(\vartheta M + L)\ell_j$ from the support of $h_\square$, while $v'$ is at a distance of at least $(\vartheta' M - L)\ell_j$ from it; the steps which lower the first distance have the length $\ell_j$ at most, and all the steps inside $\square$, and all the steps of $\mathcal{S}^{(j)}$, the length $\ell_{j+1}$ at most. *q.e.d.*

**Lemma 24.2** (The Projections of Two Sequences)**.** *Under the hypotheses of Proposition 20.6, and for $M \ge 240L$, there is a constant $c$ such that for every cube $\square \in \mathscr{D}$ of the scale $j$, every bounded field $g$ supported in $Z_{1/6}$, and every point $x$ of $Z_{1/6}$,*

$$|(\partial(P - P_\square)\partial^* g)(x)| \le c\,\ell_j^{-2} e^{-\delta_1 M/(50L)} \sup|g| \,. \tag{24.3}$$

*Proof.* We normalise $\sup|g| = 1$ and put $f := \partial^* g$, $A := A_\square$, $\varepsilon := e^{-\delta_1 M/(50L)}$. All the exponential factors in $M$ below have exponents of at least $\delta_1 M/(48L) - c$, by Lemma 24.1 and $\delta_1 \le \bar\delta_0/1536$, and are bounded by $c\,\varepsilon$. Let $\omega_2 := N_{(\square)}^{-1} Q'_\square A f$, so that $P_\square f = A Q'^*_\square \omega_2$, and $\omega := N^{-1} Q' G' f$, so that $P f = G' Q'^* \omega$. Let $\mathbf{1}$ be the multiplication by the characteristic function of the set of the points of $\mathfrak{B}$ in $Z_{1/4}$, which by Lemma 24.1(i) are points of both sequences with the same blocks, so that $Q'^* \mathbf{1} = Q'^*_\square \mathbf{1}$. With $\rho := N \mathbf{1} \omega_2 - Q' G' f$ we have $\omega - \mathbf{1}\omega_2 = -N^{-1}\rho$, and

$$P f - P_\square f = -G' Q'^* N^{-1} \rho + (G' - A) Q'^* \mathbf{1} \omega_2 - A Q'^*_\square (1 - \mathbf{1}) \omega_2 \,. \tag{24.4}$$

We bound the derivative of each term at $x$.

*The function $\omega_2$.* By [3, (2.67)] for $\mathcal{S}^{(j)}$, whose scales are $j$ and $j+1$, $|Q'_\square A \partial^* g| \le c\,\ell_j e^{-\frac14 \bar\delta_0 d_\square(\cdot, Z_{1/6})}$, and by [3, (2.87)] for $\mathcal{S}^{(j)}$ and [3, (2.61)], $|\omega_2(v)| \le c\,\ell_j^{-3} e^{-\frac14 \delta_1 d_\square(v, Z_{1/6})}$. For $v$ outside $Z_{1/4}$ this is at most $c\,\ell_j^{-3}\varepsilon$ by Lemma 24.1(iii). The third term of (24.4) is the sum over these $v$ of $\omega_2(v) A \mathbf{1}_{B(v)}$, and $|\partial A \mathbf{1}_{B(v)}| \le c\,\ell_j e^{-\frac12 \bar\delta_0 d_\square(\cdot, v)}$; its derivative is therefore at most $c\,\ell_j^{-2}\varepsilon$ at every point.

*The change of the domain.* The function $\psi := Q'^* \mathbf{1} \omega_2$ is supported in $Z_{1/4}$, and $\sup|\psi| \le c\,\ell_j^{-3}$. Let $E := \Delta'_a - A^{-1}$, so that $G' - A = -AEG'$. The proof of Lemma 20.5 uses of the support of the source only the inequality (20.15); with Lemma 24.1(ii) in its place, that is, with $d(u,v) \ge \frac{1}{12} M - L$ for the blocks $u$ on which $E$ does not vanish and the points $v$ of $Z_{1/4}$, it gives

$$\sup|EG'\psi| \le c\, e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/64} \sup|\psi| \,, \qquad \sup|(G'^2 - A^2)\psi| \le c\,\ell_j^4 e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/192} \sup|\psi| \,, \tag{24.5}$$

and in the same way, with the bound $c\,\ell_m$ of [3, (2.67)] for $G'\nabla^*$ on a block of the scale $m$ in the place of $c\,\ell_m^2$ and with (20.22) for $p = 1$, $\sup|EG'\partial^* g| \le c\,\ell_j^{-1} e^{-\bar\delta_0 M/32}$. Since $|\partial A \phi| \le c\,\ell_j \sup|\phi|$ and $|A\phi| \le c\,\ell_j^2 \sup|\phi|$ by Lemma 20.4(i) and Lemma 18.1(iv), the derivative of the second term of (24.4) is at most $c\,\ell_j^{-2}\varepsilon$ at every point, and $\sup|(G' - A) f| \le c\,\ell_j \varepsilon$.

*The function $\rho$.* Let $v \in \mathfrak{B}$. If $v$ lies in $Z_{7/24}$, defined as the sets $Z_\vartheta$, then $Q'$ and $Q'_\square$ have the same block at $v$, and $N_{(\square)}\omega_2 = Q'_\square A f$ gives

$$\rho(v) = (Q'(G'^2 - A^2)\psi)(v) - (Q'(G' - A) f)(v) - (N_{(\square)}(1 - \mathbf{1})\omega_2)(v) \,. \tag{24.6}$$

The first two terms are at most $c\,\ell_j \varepsilon$ by the bounds just proved, and so is the third, by [3, (2.68)] for $\mathcal{S}^{(j)}$ and the bound on $\omega_2$ outside $Z_{1/4}$. If $v$ does not lie in $Z_{7/24}$, then $d(v, v') \ge M/(24L) - 2$ for the points $v'$ of $Z_{1/4}$ by Lemma 24.1(iii), and [3, (2.68), (2.67)] with (20.22) give $|(N\mathbf{1}\omega_2)(v)| + |(Q'G'\partial^* g)(v)| \le c\,\ell_j \varepsilon\, e^{-\frac{1}{32}\bar\delta_0 d(v, Z_{1/4})}$. Hence $|\rho(v)| \le c\,\ell_j \varepsilon$ for every $v$.

*The first term.* For $x$ in the block of $y \in \mathfrak{B}$, [3, (2.67)] and [3, (2.87)] give

$$|(\partial G' Q'^* N^{-1} \rho)(x)| \le c\,\ell_{j(y)} \sum_{w, v \in \mathfrak{B}} e^{-\frac12 \bar\delta_0 d(y,w)} \mathsf{w}(w)^{-1} e^{-\frac12 \delta_1 d(w,v)} |\rho(v)| \,. \tag{24.7}$$

For $x \in Z_{1/6}$ the scale of $y$ is $j$ or $j+1$, $\mathsf{w}(w)^{-1} \le L^4 \ell_j^{-4} e^{\frac{1}{16}\bar\delta_0 d(y,w)}$ by (20.22), and the two sums are bounded by [3, (2.61)]; the right side is at most $c\,\ell_j^{-2}\varepsilon$. *q.e.d.*

*The expansion.* Let $G_0 := \sum_{\square \in \mathscr{D}} h_\square G_\square h_\square$. By Lemma 24.1(i), $h_\square \Delta_a = h_\square \Delta_{a,\square} - h_\square \partial (P - P_\square) \partial^*$, where $\Delta_{a,\square}$ is the operator of $\mathfrak{g}_\square$, and therefore, with $\sum_\square h_\square^2 = 1$,

$$\Delta_a G_0 = I - \mathsf{R}_G \,, \qquad \mathsf{R}_G := \sum_{\square \in \mathscr{D}} (h_\square \partial (P - P_\square) \partial^* - [\Delta_a, h_\square]) G_\square h_\square \,, \tag{24.8}$$

which is [3, (2.91)–(2.93)] without the auxiliary functions $\zeta_\square$. The commutator is $[\Delta, h_\square] + [Q^* a Q, h_\square] - [\partial P \partial^*, h_\square]$. Its first two parts are the operators of the first two lines of [3, (2.92)]: first-order difference operators with coefficients of the order $(M\ell_j)^{-1}$ and averaging terms with the differences of $h_\square$ over a block, as in (17.4) and Lemma 17.4, which holds for the average of a block of any scale. The third has the kernel of $\partial P \partial^*$ multiplied by $h_\square(x') - h_\square(x)$.

**Proposition 24.3** (Proposition 2.6 for the Tilted Run)**.** *Let $L \ge 64$ be a multiple of 5 and $a > 0$. There are numbers $M_2 \ge \max(M_1, 240L)$, $\varrho_2 \ge \varrho_1$, $\delta_3 > 0$, and $c$, which depend on $a$, $L$, and the Hölder exponents, such that for every sequence of domains with $R \ge 2$, $M \ge M_2$ a multiple of $L$, and $RM \ge \varrho_2$ the form $\mathfrak{g}$ is positive definite, its propagator is $G = G_0 \sum_{n\ge 0} \mathsf{R}_G^n$, which is [3, (2.141)], and $G$ satisfies the bounds [3, (2.136)–(2.140), p. 247] with the rate $\delta_3$.*

*Proof. The rates.* Let $\delta_G$ be the rate of (24.2), $\delta_2 = \frac18 \delta_1$ that of Proposition 20.6(iii), and $\delta_3' \coloneqq \min(\frac{1}{224}\delta_G, \frac14 \delta_2, \delta_1/(1600L))$. Let $\varrho_2 \ge \varrho_1$ be such that $RM \ge \varrho_2$ implies the condition of Lemma 19.2 for $\alpha = \delta_3'/(8\bar\delta_0)$ and $\delta_3' RM \ge 32 \log L$, so that [3, (2.61)] and (20.22) with $p \le 4$ are available for every $\alpha \ge \delta_3'/(8\bar\delta_0)$.

*The remainder.* Let $J$ be supported in the block of $y' \in \mathfrak{B}$, let $\square$ be a cube of the scale $j$ with $h_\square \ne 0$ on this block, and $F \coloneqq G_\square h_\square J$, which satisfies (24.2). We bound the three parts of the term of $\square$ in $\mathsf{R}_G J$ at a point $x$ of the block of $y$. The local part of the commutator vanishes outside $\square$ and is at most $c(L/M) e^{-\delta_G \operatorname{dist}(x, B(y'))/\ell_j} \sup|J|$, as in the proof of Proposition 20.2. For the part with $\partial P \partial^*$ we use the kernel bound of Proposition 20.6(iii) and the inequality $|h_\square(x') - h_\square(x)| \le c(L/M)(d(y, y_1) + 1)$ for $x'$ in the block of $y_1$: if $d(y, y_1) < M/(3L)$ and one of the two points lies in the support of $h_\square$, then both lie in $\square$ by Lemma 20.3(ii), their distance in $|\cdot|_\infty$ is at most $L\ell_j(d(y, y_1) + 2)$, and the inequality is property (d) of the cover; otherwise it holds because the left side is at most 1. With (24.2), (20.22), and [3, (2.61)] this part is at most $c(L/M) \sup|J|$ at every point, and it carries the factor $e^{-\frac12 \delta_2 d(y,\square)}$ if $y$ lies outside $\square$. For the part with $P - P_\square$, which vanishes unless $x$ lies in the support of $h_\square$, we split $F$ into its restriction $F_1$ to $Z_{1/6}$ and the rest $F_2$. By Lemma 24.2, $|(\partial(P - P_\square)\partial^* F_1)(x)| \le c\,\ell_j^{-2} e^{-\delta_1 M/(50L)} \sup|F_1| \le c\, e^{-\delta_1 M/(50L)} \sup|J|$. The field $F_2$ vanishes within the distance $(\frac16 M - L)\ell_j$ of the support of $h_\square$, so that $\sup|F_2| \le c\,\ell_j^2 e^{-\delta_G M/7} \sup|J|$ by (24.2), and the kernel bounds of Proposition 20.6(iii) for the two sequences, summed by [3, (2.61)], give $|\partial P \partial^* F_2| + |\partial P_\square \partial^* F_2| \le c\,\ell_j^{-2} \sup|F_2|$ on the support of $h_\square$. Altogether, with $\varepsilon_M' \coloneqq c(L/M + e^{-\delta_1 M/(100L)} + e^{-\delta_G M/14})$,

$$|(\mathsf{R}_G J)(x)| \le \varepsilon_M'\, e^{-\delta_3' d(y,y')} \sup|J| \,. \tag{24.9}$$

Indeed, for $y$ in $\square$ the decay in the Euclidean distance becomes a decay in $d(y, y')$ by Lemma 20.1, or is bought from one half of the exponent of the factor in $M$ as in the proof of Proposition 20.6, since $d(y, y') \le 16M + 34L$ there and $16\delta_3' \le \min(\delta_1/(100L), \delta_G/14)$; and for $y$ outside $\square$ we use $d(y, y') \le d(y, \square) + 16M + 34L$, where $d(y, \square)$ is the least distance from $y$ to a point of $\mathfrak{B}_\square$. This is [3, (2.135)].

*The series.* By (24.9) and [3, (2.61)], the series $\sum_n \mathsf{R}_G^n$ converges for $M \ge M_2$, in the norms of the proof of Proposition 20.2, and $\Delta_a G_0 \sum_n \mathsf{R}_G^n = I$ by (24.8). On the finite torus the operator $\Delta_a$, which is symmetric and nonnegative, is therefore invertible, so that $\mathfrak{g}$ is positive definite and $G$ is the series. The bounds [3, (2.136)–(2.139)] follow as in the proof of Proposition 20.2, with (24.2) and its Hölder counterparts for the first factor $h_\square G_\square h_\square$ in the place of Lemma 18.1(iv), and with the adjoint series $G = \sum_n (\mathsf{R}_G^*)^n G_0$ for the bounds with a

derivative of the source: $\mathsf{R}^*_G = \sum_\square h_\square G_\square(\partial(P - P_\square)\partial^* h_\square + [\Delta_a, h_\square])$ satisfies (24.9) by the same estimates, a derivative which the commutator applies to its argument being moved to $G_\square$ by a summation by parts. The bounds [3, (2.140)] in $L^2$ follow in the same way from the bounds (9.3) of Proposition 23.3 for $G_\square$ and from Schur's test for the remainder. *q.e.d.*

For the inverse of $QGQ^*$ the functions on $\mathfrak{b}(\mathfrak{B})$ carry the scalar product with the weights $\mathsf{w}$, and kernels are taken with respect to it, as in Section 20. For a cube $\square$ of the scale $j$ let $\mathfrak{b}_\square$ be the set of the bonds of $\mathfrak{b}(\mathfrak{B})$ with both ends in $\square$; by Lemma 24.1(i) and its proof they are bonds of both sequences, with the same averages. Following [3, (2.143)] we put $N^Q_\square := \square\, Q_\square G_\square Q^*_\square\, \square$ on the functions on $\mathfrak{b}_\square$, where $\square$ now denotes the restriction to $\mathfrak{b}_\square$. The lower bound for this operator rests on the following fact.

**Lemma 24.4** (A Right Inverse of the Averages)**.** *In the setting of Section 23, for the scales $j$ and $j+1$ with $j \geq 1$ as for the scales 0 and 1, there is a constant $c_r$, which depends on $L$ only, such that every function $B$ on $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda^c) \cup \mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')$ is $Q''B'$ for a field $B'$ on the unit lattice which is axial on the cubes of $\Lambda$ and satisfies $\|B'\| \leq c_r\|B\|$. Consequently $\langle B, Q''\tilde{C}_\Lambda Q''^* B\rangle \geq \gamma_Q \|B\|^2$ with a constant $\gamma_Q > 0$ which depends on $a$ and $L$.*

*Proof.* We write $B^0$ and $B^1$ for the restrictions of $B$ to $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda^c)$ and $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')$, and we extend $B^0$ by zero to a field of the unit lattice.

*The scales $j \geq 1$.* For a bond $c = \langle y, y + Le_\mu\rangle$ of $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')$ let $\mathsf{f}_c$ be the field which is 1 on the $L^3$ bonds $\langle z, z + e_\mu\rangle$ with $z$ in the cube of $y$ and $z_\mu = y_\mu + L - 1$, and zero elsewhere. Each of these bonds lies on the segments $[z', z' + Le_\mu]$ of $L$ points $z'$ of the cube of $y$ and on no other segment of (6.4), so that $(Q_1\mathsf{f}_c)(c) = L^{-5}\cdot L^4 = L^{-1}$ and $(Q_1\mathsf{f}_c)(c') = 0$ for $c' \neq c$. These bonds join two cubes of which one lies in $\Lambda$; they are therefore not in $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda^c)$ and on no contour of the axial gauge. Hence $B' := B^0 + \sum_c L(B^1(c) - (Q_1B^0)(c))\mathsf{f}_c$ is axial on the cubes of $\Lambda$, on whose inner bonds it vanishes, $Q''B' = B$, and $\|B'\|^2 \leq \|B^0\|^2 + 2L\sum_c L^4(|B^1(c)|^2 + |(Q_1B^0)(c)|^2) \leq (1 + 4L)\|B\|^2$, because $\sum_c L^4|(Q_1B^0)(c)|^2 \leq \|B^0\|^2$ by Schwarz's inequality.

*The scales 0 and 1.* Here the unit lattice is $T_\eta/\Gamma'$, $Q_1 = Q_{\ell_1}$, and a staircase through a bond need not start in one block. Let $c = \langle y, y + \ell_1 e_\mu\rangle \in \mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')$ and $t := y_\mu + \ell_1$. If $y \in \Lambda'$, let $X_c$ be the set of the bonds $\langle z, z'\rangle$ of $T_\eta$ with $z_\mu < t \leq z'_\mu$ and $z \in B_{\ell_1}(y)$; otherwise let it be the set of these bonds with $z' \in B_{\ell_1}(y + \ell_1 e_\mu)$. Let $\mathsf{f}_c$ be the field which is 1 on the bonds of $X_c$, hence $-1$ on their reverses, and zero elsewhere; all its bonds have an end in $\Lambda$. Along a staircase $\sigma^{\ell_1}_\mu(x)$ the coordinate $\mu$ increases at every step, by (2.2), so that the staircase contains at most one bond which crosses the level $t$, and exactly one if $x \in B_{\ell_1}(y')$ with $y'_\mu = y_\mu$. Its sites are within $\frac{3}{5}\eta$ of the segment from $x$ (Lemma 6.2(ii)), and they have the coordinates 0 and 1 of $x$ unless $\mu$ is one of these. Hence the sum of $\mathsf{f}_c$ over $\sigma^{\ell_1}_\mu(x)$ is 0 or 1 for all $x$, and it is 1 for the points $x$ of $B_{\ell_1}(y)$ whose coordinate $\nu$ is at a distance of at least $\frac{3}{5}\eta$ from the faces of the block, where $\{\mu, \nu\} = \{2, 3\}$, and for all the points of the block if $\mu \in \{0, 1\}$: the two ends of the crossing bond then lie in $B_{\ell_1}(y)$ and $B_{\ell_1}(y + \ell_1 e_\mu)$. For $x$ in another block the sum vanishes unless $y' = y \pm \ell_1 e_\nu$ and $x_\nu$ is within $\frac{3}{5}\eta$ of the common face. A strip of the width $\frac{6}{5}\eta$ and the length $\ell_1$ in the plane is covered by $2(L + 1)$ squares of the side $\eta$, each of which contains at most four points of the turned lattice, whose points are at least $\eta$ apart; hence at most $9L^3$ points of a block have a planar coordinate in a given interval of the length $\frac{6}{5}\eta$, and at most $5L^3$ in one of the length $\frac{3}{5}\eta$. A staircase $\sigma^{\ell_1}_\nu(x)$ of the other turned direction crosses the level $t$ only if $x_\mu$ is within $\frac{3}{5}\eta$ of $t$; its crossings alternate in sense, and those which belong to $X_c$ are consecutive, because the coordinate $\nu$ increases along it and decides the block of the relevant end. The sum of $\mathsf{f}_c$ over it is therefore 0 or $\pm 1$, and it vanishes unless $x$ lies in one of four blocks, in each of which at most $9L^3$ points

qualify. The staircases of the directions $e_0$ and $e_1$ do not cross a level of a turned direction, and conversely. Since $(Q_{\ell_1}\mathsf{f}_c)(c')$ is $L^{-5}$ times the sum over the points of the block of $c'_-$, we have

$$(Q_{\ell_1}\mathsf{f}_c)(c) \geq L^{-5}(L^4 - 10L^3) \geq \tfrac{5}{6}L^{-1} , \qquad \sum_{c' \neq c} |(Q_{\ell_1}\mathsf{f}_c)(c')| \leq (2 \cdot 5 + 4 \cdot 9)L^{-2} = 46L^{-2} , \tag{24.10}$$

where we have used $L \geq 65$, and the same bound holds for the sum over $c$ at fixed $c'$, by the same count. The matrix $\mathsf{T}(c', c) := (Q_{\ell_1}\mathsf{f}_c)(c')/(Q_{\ell_1}\mathsf{f}_c)(c)$ on $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')$ is therefore the identity plus a matrix of norm at most $56/L \leq \frac{7}{8}$, by Schur's test, and it has an inverse of norm at most 8. With $\beta := \mathsf{T}^{-1}(B^1 - Q_{\ell_1}B^0)$ the field $A'' := B^0 + \sum_c \beta(c)\mathsf{f}_c/(Q_{\ell_1}\mathsf{f}_c)(c)$ equals $B^0$ on $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda^c)$, has the average $B^1$ on $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')$, and satisfies $\|A''\| \leq c\,L\|B\|$, since each $\mathsf{f}_c$ has at most $8L^4$ bonds, a bond belongs to at most eight of the sets $X_c$, and $Q_{\ell_1}$ is bounded. The field $B' := \mathfrak{a}_\Lambda A''$ of the proof of Proposition 22.6 is axial on the blocks of $\Lambda$, has the same averages, equals $A''$ on the bonds with no end in $\Lambda$, and $\mathfrak{a}_\Lambda$ is bounded by a constant which depends on $L$.

*The lower bound.* Let $\mathfrak{f}$ be the form of which $\tilde{C}_\Lambda$ is the covariance on the space $\mathcal{Y}$ of the axial fields. By Lemma 22.5, for every $B_2 \in \mathcal{Y}$, $\langle Q''^* B, \tilde{C} Q''^* B\rangle \geq 2\langle B, Q'' B_2\rangle - \mathfrak{f}(B_2)$. The form $\mathfrak{f}$ is bounded above by a constant $c_\mathfrak{f}$ times the squared norm, by (9.4), $\|\partial_1 B_2\|^2 \leq 24\|B_2\|^2$, and the boundedness of $Q_1$, respectively by (22.11) in the unit $\eta$. Taking $B_2 := tB'$ with $Q''B' = B$ and optimising in $t$ gives the lower bound with $\gamma_Q := 1/(c_\mathfrak{f} c_r^2)$. *q.e.d.*

**Proposition 24.5** (Proposition 2.7 and Corollary 2.8 for the Tilted Run)**.** *Under the hypotheses of Proposition 24.3, and for $M$ and $RM$ larger than numbers which depend on $a$ and $L$, the following hold with constants $c$ and rates $\delta_4, \delta_5 > 0$ which depend on $a$ and $L$; the condition on $RM$ is that of Lemma 19.2 and of* (20.22) *for the products of the rates $\delta_3$, $\delta_4$ with fixed fractions.*

*(i)* $\langle B, N_\square^Q B\rangle \geq \gamma_Q \ell_j^2 \|B\|^2$ *for every cube $\square$ of the scale $j$ and every function $B$ on $\mathfrak{b}_\square$, and the kernel of $C_\square^Q := (N_\square^Q)^{-1}$ is at most $c\,\ell_j^{-6} e^{-\delta_4 |b_- - b'_-|/\ell_j}$ in modulus, which is [3, (2.147), (2.148)].*

*(ii) The operator $QGQ^*$ on the functions on $\mathfrak{b}(\mathfrak{B})$ has an inverse, given by the expansion [3, (2.86)] with $C^Q := \sum_\square h_\square C_\square^Q h_\square$, and $|(QGQ^*)^{-1}(b, b')| \leq c\,\ell_{j(b)}^{-2} \mathsf{w}(b')^{-1} e^{-\frac{1}{2}\delta_4 d(b,b')}$, which is [3, (2.149)].*

*(iii) The operator $H := GQ^*(QGQ^*)^{-1}$ maps a function $B$ on $\mathfrak{b}(\mathfrak{B})$ to the field which minimises $\|\partial A\|^2$ among the fields with $QA = B$ and $R\partial^* A = 0$, and its kernel satisfies [3, (2.151)] with the rate $\delta_5$.*

*Proof.* (i) A function $B$ on $\mathfrak{b}_\square$, extended by zero, is a function on the bonds of $\mathcal{S}^{(j)}$, and $\langle B, N_\square^Q B\rangle = \langle Q_\square^* B, G_\square Q_\square^* B\rangle$. By Proposition 23.2 this is $\langle Q''^* B, \tilde{C}_\Lambda Q''^* B\rangle$ in the unit $\ell_j$, and Lemma 24.4 gives the lower bound; the factor $\ell_j^2$ is that of the change of the unit, as in [3, (2.144)]. For $j = k$ there is one scale, and the bound is Lemma 17.1(ii). The kernel of $N_\square^Q$ is at most $c\,\ell_j^2 \mathsf{w}(b')^{-1} e^{-\delta_G |b_- - b'_-|/(2\ell_j)}$ by (24.2), the average of a field over the staircases of a bond being at most its supremum over them. The decay of the inverse follows from Lemma 14.1 after the symmetrisation with the weights, as in the proof of Lemma 20.4(iii).

(ii) By [3, (2.136)], which is Proposition 24.3, the kernel of $QGQ^*$ satisfies [3, (2.142)], as in the proof of Proposition 20.6(i). On the finite torus it is a symmetric matrix, which is invertible as soon as it has a right inverse. As in (20.24),

$$QGQ^* C^Q = I - \sum_\square \Big( [h_\square, N_\square^Q] + \square\, Q(G_\square - G)Q^* h_\square - (1 - \square) QGQ^* h_\square \Big) C_\square^Q h_\square , \tag{24.11}$$

where we have used that $Q$ and $Q_\square$ have the same averages on the bonds of $\mathfrak{b}_\square$. The first and the third term of the remainder are bounded as the corresponding terms in the proof of Proposition 20.6(ii), with the powers $\ell^2$ and $\ell^{-2}$ in the place of $\ell^4$ and $\ell^{-4}$ and with (i) and [3, (2.142)]. For the second term we show that for every field $J$ supported in $Z_{1/24}$, and every $x$,

$$|((G_\square - G)J)(x)| \le c\,\ell_j^2 e^{-\delta M/L} \sup|J| \tag{24.12}$$

with a rate $\delta > 0$. Indeed $G_\square - G = G_\square(\Delta_a - \Delta_{a,\square})G$, and $\Delta_a - \Delta_{a,\square}$ is the sum of the difference $\mathsf{E}_Q$ of the two averaging terms, which by Lemma 24.1(i) and (ii) vanishes within the distance $\frac{1}{12}M - L$, in the distance $d$, of the zone $Z_{1/4}$, and of $-\partial(P - P_\square)\partial^*$. Let $F := GJ$, which by Proposition 24.3 is at most $c\,\ell_m^2 e^{-\delta_3 d(u,y')} \sup|J|$ on the block of a point $u$ of the scale $m$, for $J$ supported in the block of $y'$. Then $\sup|\mathsf{E}_Q F| \le c\,e^{-\delta_3 M/13} \sup|J|$, by (20.22) as in the proof of Lemma 20.5. We split $F$ into its restriction $F_1$ to $Z_{1/12}$ and the rest $F_2$; by Lemma 24.1(iii) and (20.22), $\sup|F_2| \le c\,\ell_j^2 e^{-\delta_3 M/(49L)} \sup|J|$, also as a function on the blocks of $\mathcal{S}^{(j)}$. By Lemma 24.2, $\partial(P - P_\square)\partial^* F_1$ is at most $c\,e^{-\delta_1 M/(50L)} \sup|J|$ on $Z_{1/6}$; outside $Z_{1/6}$ the two terms $\partial P \partial^* F_1$ and $\partial P_\square \partial^* F_1$ are each at most $c\,e^{-\delta_2 M/(25L)} \sup|J|$, by the kernel bounds of Proposition 20.6(iii) for the two sequences, Lemma 24.1(iii), and (20.22); and by the same kernel bounds $\partial P \partial^* F_2$ and $\partial P_\square \partial^* F_2$ are at most $c\,\ell_j^{-2} \sup|F_2|$ times a power of $L$ which (20.22) pays. Hence $(\Delta_a - \Delta_{a,\square})GJ$ is bounded by $c\,e^{-\delta M/L} \sup|J|$ at every point, and the first bound of (24.2) for $G_\square$ gives (24.12). With it the second term of the remainder is bounded as the term of the change of the domain in the proof of Proposition 20.6(ii), the fields $Q^* h_\square C_\square^Q h_\square B$ being supported in the blocks and on the staircases of the bonds of the support of $h_\square$, which lie in $Z_{1/24}$ because $\frac{1}{24}M \ge 10L$. The remainder then has a kernel which is at most a small multiple of $e^{-\delta_4 d(b,b')} \mathsf{w}(b')^{-1}$, the series converges as in that proof, it gives a right inverse of $QGQ^*$, hence the inverse, and the bound on its kernel follows as there.

(iii) By the argument of Lemma 23.1(iv), with $\mathfrak{g}$, $Q$, and the form $\|\partial A\|^2 + \|R\partial^* A\|^2$ in the place of the forms of the scale $j$, the field $HB$ minimises this form among the fields with $QA = B$. Its minimum over the fields with a given average and a given curl is attained where $R\partial^* A = 0$, because for $\lambda \in N(Q')$ the field $A - \partial\lambda$ has the same curl and the same average, by the argument of Lemma 23.1(i) for each pair of neighbouring scales, and $R\partial^*(A - \partial\lambda) = R\partial^* A - \Delta\lambda$ vanishes for one $\lambda$. This is the characterisation [3, (2.5), (2.6), (2.12)] of $H$. The bounds [3, (2.151)] are the composition of the bounds of Proposition 24.3 for $GQ^*$, $\nabla GQ^*$, and the Hölder norm, with (ii), by [3, (2.61)] and (20.22), as in the proof of Proposition 20.6(iii). *q.e.d.*

The remaining formulae of Section A of [3] are identities between the operators of a sequence, which Bałaban obtains from Gaussian integrals by the method of Faddeev and Popov [3, (2.24)–(2.34)]. They follow from the definitions.

**Lemma 24.6** (The Identities of Section A)**.** *Under the hypotheses of Proposition 24.3 the following hold.*

*(i) For every $\lambda \in N(Q')$, $Q\partial\lambda = 0$, $\Delta_a \partial\lambda = \partial\Delta\lambda$, and $G\partial\Delta\lambda = \partial\lambda$.*

*(ii) $R\partial^* G \partial R = R$, $QG\partial R = 0$, and $R\partial^* G Q^* = 0$, which are [3, (2.31), (2.34)].*

*(iii) The operator $\mathscr{G} := G'^2 - G'^2 Q'^* N^{-1} Q' G'^2$ of [3, (2.27)] maps into $N(Q')$, and $R = \Delta\mathscr{G}\Delta$, which is [3, (2.26)].*

*Proof.* (i) Let $b \in \mathfrak{b}(\Lambda_j)$ with $j \geq 1$. By Lemma 6.4(i), $(Q\partial\lambda)(b) = \ell_j^{-1}((Q'_{\ell_j}\lambda)(b_+) - (Q'_{\ell_j}\lambda)(b_-))$. An end of $b$ in $\Omega_j$ is a point of $\Lambda_j$, because $b$ has no end in $\Omega_{j+1}$, and there $Q'_{\ell_j}\lambda$ vanishes by the definition of $N(Q')$. The block of the scale $j$ of an end outside $\Omega_j$ is a union of blocks of the sequence, of smaller scales, on each of which the mean of $\lambda$ vanishes, or of points of $\Lambda_0$, at which $\lambda$ vanishes; hence $Q'_{\ell_j}\lambda$ vanishes there as well. For $j = 0$ both ends of $b$ lie in $\Lambda_0$, or one lies in a block of $\Lambda_1$; in the first case $(\partial\lambda)(b) = 0$, and the second does not occur for a bond of $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda_0)$, which has no end in $\Omega_1$. Hence $Q\partial\lambda = 0$. The curl of $\partial\lambda$ vanishes, $\partial^*\partial\lambda = \Delta\lambda$ lies in $\Delta N(Q')$, on which $R$ is the identity, and therefore $\Delta_a\partial\lambda = \partial R\Delta\lambda = \partial\Delta\lambda$. Applying $G$ gives the third identity.

(ii) For a function $f$ let $\lambda \in N(Q')$ be the function with $\Delta\lambda = Rf$. By (i), $G\partial Rf = \partial\lambda$, so that $R\partial^*G\partial Rf = R\Delta\lambda = Rf$ and $QG\partial Rf = Q\partial\lambda = 0$. The third identity is the adjoint of the second.

(iii) Since $Q'G'^2Q'^* = N$, we have $Q'\mathscr{G} = 0$. For $\mu \in N(Q')$ and a function $J$, $\langle\Delta'_a\mu, \Delta'_a\mathscr{G}J\rangle = \langle\mu, J\rangle - \langle Q'\mu, N^{-1}Q'G'^2J\rangle = \langle\mu, J\rangle$, and $\Delta'_a = \Delta$ on $N(Q')$; hence $\langle\Delta\mu, \Delta\mathscr{G}J\rangle = \langle\mu, J\rangle$. For $J = \Delta f$ this says that $f - \Delta\mathscr{G}\Delta f$ is orthogonal to $\Delta N(Q')$, while $\Delta\mathscr{G}\Delta f$ lies in this space, so that $\Delta\mathscr{G}\Delta f = Rf$. *q.e.d.*

With (ii), the equations [3, (2.23)] for the minimiser reduce to $QGQ^*\omega = B$, as in [3, p. 228], and Proposition 24.5(iii) is [3, (2.35)]. The variant of the operators with Dirichlet conditions outside a neighbourhood of $\Omega_1$, for which Bałaban states that all the results hold "with minor and obvious changes" [3, p. 228], has not been examined for the tilted run.

With Propositions 23.2 to 24.5 the results of Section C of [3] hold for the tilted run. Three points of this section go beyond a transcription of Bałaban's argument: the representation [3, (2.129)] is proved by minimising quadratic forms; the comparison of the gauge-fixing projections of the sequence and of a cube, which [3, (2.134)] uses, is Lemma 24.2; and the local operators are those of a sequence of two scales on the whole torus, not of a torus $T_\square$ cut out of the lattice, so that the tori of [3, p. 238] and their compatibility with the turned lattice do not enter.

## 25 The Operators with Dirichlet Conditions

The later papers do not use the operators of a sequence of domains on the whole lattice. They use the operators "with Dirichlet boundary conditions" outside a neighbourhood $\Omega_0$ of $\Omega_1$, the inverses of $\Omega_0\Delta'_a\Omega_0$ and of $\Omega_0\Delta_a\Omega_0$, because these depend on a background field through its restriction to $\Omega_0$ only [3, p. 228], [5, pp. 393–395]; of their properties Bałaban says that they hold "with minor and obvious changes" [3, p. 228]. For the turned lattice we do not go through the proofs again. The region outside $\Omega_1$ is the region of the scale 0, in which the averages are the identity, and for this reason the operators with Dirichlet conditions are given by the operators of Sections 20 and 24 through exact formulae, from which their bounds follow.

*The setting.* We are in the setting of Section 24: a torus $\mathbb{T}$, a sequence of domains which satisfies the hypotheses of Proposition 24.5, and the constant $a_0 = a$ in the region of the scale 0, as in [5, (3.24)]. Let $Z$ be a set of points of $\Lambda_0$ no point of which has a neighbour in $\Omega_1$, and $Y := \mathbb{T} \setminus Z$; let $\mathfrak{z}$ be a set of bonds of $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda_0)$, that is, of bonds of $\mathbb{T}$ with no end in $\Omega_1$. In Bałaban's setting $Y = \Omega_0$, and $\mathfrak{z}$ is the set of the bonds outside $\Omega_0$. The points of $Z$ are points of $\mathfrak{B}$ of the scale 0, and we write $\mathbf{1}_Z$ and $\mathbf{1}_Y$ for the multiplications by the characteristic functions, on the functions on $\mathbb{T}$ and on those on $\mathfrak{B}$, where $\mathbf{1}_Y$ is the characteristic function

of $\mathfrak{B} \setminus Z$; likewise $\mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{z}$ and $\mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y} := 1 - \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{z}$ on the fields and on the functions on $\mathfrak{b}(\mathfrak{B})$. Since the block of a point of $Z$ is the point itself, $Q'$ and $Q'^*$ commute with these multiplications, and so do $Q$ and $Q^*$ with $\mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{z}$, because $(QA)(b) = A(b)$ on $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda_0)$. For an operator $\mathsf{A}$ and one of these characteristic functions $\chi$ such that $\chi\mathsf{A}\chi$ is invertible on the range of $\chi$, we write $(\chi\mathsf{A}\chi)^{-1}$ for the operator which is this inverse on the range of $\chi$ and zero on the range of $1 - \chi$. The operators with Dirichlet conditions are

$$G'_Y := (\mathbf{1}_Y \Delta'_a \mathbf{1}_Y)^{-1} , \qquad N_Y := \mathbf{1}_Y Q' G'^2_Y Q'^* \mathbf{1}_Y , \qquad G_\mathfrak{y} := (\mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y} \Delta_a \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y})^{-1} , \tag{25.1}$$

where $\Delta_a$ is the operator of the form (24.1). Two remarks justify the notation. The averaging term of $\mathbf{1}_Y \Delta'_a \mathbf{1}_Y$ is that of the sequence which starts with $\Omega_0 = Y$ [5, (3.24)], since the two differ by the terms of the points of $Z$, at which the functions vanish. And the projection $R$ is the same for both: the space $N(Q')$ consists of functions which vanish on $\Lambda_0$, the functions $\Delta\lambda$ with $\lambda \in N(Q')$ vanish at the points of $\Lambda_0$ none of whose neighbours lies in $\Omega_1$, hence on $Z$, so that $R\mathbf{1}_Z = \mathbf{1}_Z R = 0$, and the orthogonal projection onto $\Delta N(Q')$ in the space of the functions on $Y$ is the restriction of $R$. Hence $\mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y} \Delta_a \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y}$ is the operator $\Omega_0 \Delta_a \Omega_0$ of [3, p. 228] and of [5, (3.26), (3.27)] at the background field $U = 1$.

For $y, y' \in \mathfrak{B}$ let $d_Z(y, y')$ be the least value of $d(y, z) + d(z, y')$ over the points $z$ of $Z$, and $d_\mathfrak{z}(y, y')$ the least value of $d(y, b_-) + d(b_-, y')$ over the bonds $b$ of $\mathfrak{z}$; both are at least $d(y, y')$.

**Proposition 25.1** (The Operators with Dirichlet Conditions)**.** *In the setting above, and for RM larger than a number which depends on a and L, the operators* (25.1) *exist, $N_Y$ is invertible on the functions on $\mathfrak{B} \setminus Z$, and the following hold, with the constant $c_\Delta := 40 + 16a$ and with constants c and rates which depend on a, L, and the Hölder exponents, and not on k, the torus, the sequence, Z, or $\mathfrak{z}$. The condition on RM is that of Lemma 19.2 and of* (20.22) *for the rates which occur in the proof.*

*(i) The operator $\mathsf{D}'_Z := \mathbf{1}_Z G' \mathbf{1}_Z$ satisfies $\mathsf{D}'_Z \geq (16 + a)^{-1} \eta^2$ on the functions on Z, and*

$$G'_Y = \mathbf{1}_Y (G' - G'(\mathsf{D}'_Z)^{-1} G') \mathbf{1}_Y . \tag{25.2}$$

*The values of $(\mathsf{D}'_Z)^{-1}$ on the function which is 1 at a point $z'$ of Z and zero elsewhere are at most $2(16 + a)\eta^{-2} e^{-\theta_Z d(z, z')}$ in modulus, with a rate $\theta_Z > 0$.*

*(ii) $N_Y^{-1} = \mathbf{1}_Y (N^{-1} - Q' \Delta'_a \mathbf{1}_Z \Delta'_a Q'^*) \mathbf{1}_Y$, where $N = Q' G'^2 Q'^*$, and $G'_Y Q'^* N_Y^{-1} Q' G'_Y = \mathbf{1}_Y P \mathbf{1}_Y = P - \mathbf{1}_Z$.*

*(iii) The operator $\mathsf{D}_\mathfrak{z} := \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{z} G \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{z}$ satisfies $\mathsf{D}_\mathfrak{z} \geq c_\Delta^{-1} \eta^2$ on the fields on $\mathfrak{z}$, and*

$$G_\mathfrak{y} = \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y} (G - G(\mathsf{D}_\mathfrak{z})^{-1} G) \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y} . \tag{25.3}$$

*The values of $(\mathsf{D}_\mathfrak{z})^{-1}$ on the field which is 1 at a bond $b'$ of $\mathfrak{z}$ and zero elsewhere are at most $2c_\Delta \eta^{-2} e^{-\theta_\mathfrak{z} d(b_-, b'_-)}$ in modulus, with a rate $\theta_\mathfrak{z} > 0$.*

*(iv) The operator $\mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y} Q G_\mathfrak{y} Q^* \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y}$ is invertible on the functions on $\mathfrak{b}(\mathfrak{B}) \setminus \mathfrak{z}$, its inverse is $\mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y} (QGQ^*)^{-1} \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y}$, and $G_\mathfrak{y} Q^* (\mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y} Q G_\mathfrak{y} Q^* \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y})^{-1} = H \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y}$. For a function B on $\mathfrak{b}(\mathfrak{B}) \setminus \mathfrak{z}$ the field HB vanishes on $\mathfrak{z}$, and it minimises $\|\partial A\|^2$ among the fields A which vanish on $\mathfrak{z}$ and satisfy $QA = B$ and $R\partial^* A = 0$.*

*(v) The operator $G'_Y$ satisfies the bounds [3, (2.67)], the kernel of $N_Y^{-1}$ the bound [3, (2.87)], the operator $G_\mathfrak{y}$ the bounds [3, (2.136)–(2.140)], and the operators of (iv) the bounds [3, (2.149), (2.151)], as in Propositions 20.2, 20.6, 24.3, and 24.5, with other constants and rates. The differences $G'_Y - \mathbf{1}_Y G' \mathbf{1}_Y$ and $G_\mathfrak{y} - \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y} G \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y}$ satisfy the same bounds with $d_Z(y, y')$, respectively $d_\mathfrak{z}(y, y')$, in the place of $d(y, y')$.*

*Proof.* All the spaces have finite dimension. We use one identity of linear algebra. Let $\mathsf{A}$ be a symmetric positive definite operator with the inverse $\mathsf{G}$, and let $\chi$ and $\chi' = 1 - \chi$ be complementary orthogonal projections. Then $\chi\mathsf{A}\chi$ and $\chi'\mathsf{G}\chi'$ are positive definite on the ranges of $\chi$ and $\chi'$, and

$$(\chi\mathsf{A}\chi)^{-1} = \chi(\mathsf{G} - \mathsf{G}(\chi'\mathsf{G}\chi')^{-1}\mathsf{G})\chi \,. \tag{25.4}$$

Indeed, multiplying $\mathsf{A}(\chi+\chi')\mathsf{G} = 1$ by $\chi$ from the left and by $\chi$, respectively $\chi'$, from the right gives $\chi\mathsf{A}\chi\,\chi\mathsf{G}\chi + \chi\mathsf{A}\chi'\,\chi'\mathsf{G}\chi = \chi$ and $\chi\mathsf{A}\chi\,\chi\mathsf{G}\chi' + \chi\mathsf{A}\chi'\,\chi'\mathsf{G}\chi' = 0$; the second equation gives $\chi\mathsf{A}\chi' = -\chi\mathsf{A}\chi\,\mathsf{G}(\chi'\mathsf{G}\chi')^{-1}$, and inserting this into the first gives $\chi\mathsf{A}\chi\,\chi(\mathsf{G} - \mathsf{G}(\chi'\mathsf{G}\chi')^{-1}\mathsf{G})\chi = \chi$.

(i) The operator $\Delta'_a$ is positive definite (Proposition 20.2), and (25.4) with $\chi = \mathbf{1}_Y$ is (25.2). For a function $\lambda$, $\langle\lambda, \Delta'_a\lambda\rangle \le 16\eta^{-2}\|\lambda\|^2 + a\eta^{-2}\|Q'\lambda\|^2 \le (16+a)\eta^{-2}\|\lambda\|^2$, because $a_j \le a$, $\ell_j \ge \eta$, and $Q'$ is a contraction, its adjoint being an isometry; hence $G' \ge (16+a)^{-1}\eta^2$, and the same holds for its compression $\mathsf{D}'_Z$. For $z, z' \in Z$ the value at $z$ of $G'$ applied to the function which is 1 at $z'$ and zero elsewhere is at most $c\,\eta^2 e^{-\frac{1}{2}\bar\delta_0 d(z,z')}$ in modulus, by the first bound of [3, (2.67)] for two blocks of the scale 0. The set $Z$ with the distance $d$ and the matrix $\mathsf{M}(z,z')$ of these values satisfy the hypotheses of Lemma 14.1 with $\gamma = (16+a)^{-1}\eta^2$ and a rate $\theta_Z \le \frac{1}{8}\bar\delta_0$: since $e^t - 1 \le te^t$ and $te^{-t} \le 1$,

$$\sum_{z'}|\mathsf{M}(z,z')|(e^{\theta d(z,z')} - 1) \le c\,\eta^2\,\frac{8\theta}{\bar\delta_0}\sum_{z'\in\mathfrak{B}} e^{-\frac{1}{4}\bar\delta_0 d(z,z')} \le c\,\eta^2\,\frac{8\theta}{\bar\delta_0}\,c_1(\tfrac{1}{4}) \tag{25.5}$$

for $\theta \le \frac{1}{8}\bar\delta_0$, by [3, (2.61)] (Lemma 19.2), and this is at most $\frac{1}{2}\gamma$ for $\theta = \theta_Z$ small. The lemma gives the bound on $(\mathsf{D}'_Z)^{-1}$.

(ii) Let $\mathsf{X} \coloneqq G'Q'^*$, so that $N = \mathsf{X}^*\mathsf{X}$ and $P = \mathsf{X}N^{-1}\mathsf{X}^*$ (Section 24), and $\mathsf{X}_Y \coloneqq G'_Y Q'^*\mathbf{1}_Y$, so that $N_Y = \mathsf{X}_Y^*\mathsf{X}_Y$. We have seen that $R\mathbf{1}_Z = 0$, that is, $P\mathbf{1}_Z = \mathbf{1}_Z$. Applying $Q'\Delta'_a$ to $\mathsf{X}N^{-1}\mathsf{X}^*\mathbf{1}_Z = \mathbf{1}_Z$ and using $Q'Q'^* = 1$ we obtain

$$N^{-1}\mathsf{X}^*\mathbf{1}_Z = Q'\Delta'_a\mathbf{1}_Z \,, \qquad \mathbf{1}_Z\mathsf{X}N^{-1}\mathsf{X}^*\mathbf{1}_Z = \mathbf{1}_Z \,, \tag{25.6}$$

so that $\mathsf{V} \coloneqq Q'\Delta'_a\mathbf{1}_Z\Delta'_aQ'^* = N^{-1}\mathsf{X}^*\mathbf{1}_Z\mathsf{X}N^{-1}$. Let $\mathsf{J} \coloneqq \mathbf{1}_Y + \mathbf{1}_Z\Delta'_a\mathsf{X}_Y$ on the functions on $\mathfrak{B}$, where the second term maps a function on $\mathfrak{B}$ to a function on $Z \subset \mathfrak{B}$. For a function $\omega$ on $\mathfrak{B} \setminus Z$ the function $f \coloneqq \mathsf{X}_Y\omega$ vanishes on $Z$ and satisfies $\mathbf{1}_Y\Delta'_af = Q'^*\omega$, hence $\Delta'_af = Q'^*\omega + \mathbf{1}_Z\Delta'_af = Q'^*\mathsf{J}\omega$ and $f = \mathsf{X}\mathsf{J}\omega$. Therefore $\mathsf{X}_Y = \mathsf{X}\mathsf{J}\mathbf{1}_Y$, $N_Y = \mathbf{1}_Y\mathsf{J}^*N\mathsf{J}\mathbf{1}_Y$, $\mathbf{1}_Z\mathsf{X}\mathsf{J}\mathbf{1}_Y = 0$, and $\mathbf{1}_Y\mathsf{J}\mathbf{1}_Y = \mathbf{1}_Y$. The last property shows that $\mathsf{J}$ is injective on the functions on $\mathfrak{B} \setminus Z$, and the last but one that it maps them into the null space of $\mathbf{1}_Z\mathsf{X}$; by the second identity of (25.6) the operator $\mathbf{1}_Z\mathsf{X}$ maps onto the functions on $Z$, so that its null space has the dimension of the space of the functions on $\mathfrak{B} \setminus Z$ and is the range of $\mathsf{J}\mathbf{1}_Y$. The orthogonal complement of this range is therefore the range of $\mathsf{X}^*\mathbf{1}_Z$, on which $N^{-1} - \mathsf{V}$ vanishes by (25.6). Since $1 - \mathbf{1}_Y\mathsf{J}^*$ maps into the null space of $\mathbf{1}_Y\mathsf{J}^*$, which is this complement, $(N^{-1} - \mathsf{V})\mathbf{1}_Y\mathsf{J}^* = N^{-1} - \mathsf{V}$, and

$$\mathbf{1}_Y(N^{-1} - \mathsf{V})\mathbf{1}_Y\,N_Y = \mathbf{1}_Y(N^{-1} - \mathsf{V})N\mathsf{J}\mathbf{1}_Y = \mathbf{1}_Y\mathsf{J}\mathbf{1}_Y - \mathbf{1}_YN^{-1}\mathsf{X}^*\,\mathbf{1}_Z\mathsf{X}\mathsf{J}\mathbf{1}_Y = \mathbf{1}_Y \,. \tag{25.7}$$

A square matrix with a left inverse is invertible, which gives the formula for $N_Y^{-1}$. By the argument of Section 24 in the space of the functions on $Y$, $\mathsf{X}_YN_Y^{-1}\mathsf{X}_Y^*$ is the orthogonal projection onto the orthogonal complement of $\mathbf{1}_Y\Delta'_aN(Q') = \Delta N(Q')$ in this space, which is $\mathbf{1}_YP\mathbf{1}_Y$.

(iii) By Proposition 24.3 the operator $\Delta_a$ is positive definite, and (25.4) with $\chi = \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y}$ is (25.3). In the form (24.1), $\|\partial A\|^2 \le 24\eta^{-2}\|A\|^2$, since the curl at a plaquette is $\eta^{-1}$ times a

signed sum of four values and a bond lies on six plaquettes; $\|R\partial^* A\|^2 \le \|\partial^* A\|^2 \le 16\eta^{-2}\|A\|^2$, since the divergence at a point is $\eta^{-1}$ times a signed sum of eight values and a bond has two ends; and the last term is at most $a\eta^{-2}\|QA\|^2 \le 16a\eta^{-2}\|A\|^2$. For the last inequality, the average of the scale $\ell = N\eta$ at a bond $c$ of the direction $\mu$ is $N^{-5}$ times the sum of the values of $A$ at the at most $\frac{7}{5}N^5$ bonds of the staircases from the points of the block of $c_-$, so that its square is at most $\frac{7}{5}N^{-5}$ times the sum of the squares of these values, and a bond of $T_\eta$ lies on at most $\frac{7}{5}N$ staircases of each of the four directions (proof of Lemma 6.4(ii)); hence the sum of $\ell^4|(QA)(c)|^2$ over the bonds of one scale is at most $\frac{196}{25}\|A\|^2$, and a bond of $T_\eta$ lies on staircases of bonds of at most two scales, the regions of two scales which are not neighbours being separated by more than the length of a staircase. Hence $\Delta_a \le c_\Delta \eta^{-2}$ and $\mathsf{D}_\mathfrak{z} \ge c_\Delta^{-1}\eta^2$. The matrix of $\mathsf{D}_\mathfrak{z}$ is bounded by $c\,\eta^2 e^{-\delta_3 d(b_-, b'_-)}$, by the first bound of [3, (2.136)] for two blocks of the scale 0, and Lemma 14.1 applies as in (i), with the distance $d(b_-, b'_-) + 1$ for two different bonds.

(iv) Let $B$ be a function on $\mathfrak{b}(\mathfrak{B})$ which vanishes on $\mathfrak{z}$. A field $A$ with $QA = B$ vanishes on $\mathfrak{z}$, because $(QA)(b) = A(b)$ there; conversely the fields which vanish on $\mathfrak{z}$ and whose averages on $\mathfrak{b}(\mathfrak{B}) \setminus \mathfrak{z}$ are those of $B$ are the fields with $QA = B$. On these fields $\mathfrak{g}(A)$ differs from $\|\partial A\|^2 + \|R\partial^* A\|^2$ by a constant. Since $QGQ^*$ is invertible (Proposition 24.5(ii)), $Q^*$ is injective; it commutes with $\mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y}$, and $G_\mathfrak{y}$ is positive definite on the fields which vanish on $\mathfrak{z}$, so that $\mathsf{Q} \coloneqq \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y} Q G_\mathfrak{y} Q^* \mathbf{1}_\mathfrak{y}$ is positive definite on the functions which vanish on $\mathfrak{z}$. The field $A_0 \coloneqq G_\mathfrak{y} Q^* \mathsf{Q}^{-1} B$ vanishes on $\mathfrak{z}$, has the averages $B$, and satisfies $\mathfrak{g}(A_0, A') = \langle Q^* \mathsf{Q}^{-1} B, A'\rangle = 0$ for every field $A'$ which vanishes on $\mathfrak{z}$ with $QA' = 0$, where $\mathfrak{g}(\cdot,\cdot)$ is the bilinear form of $\mathfrak{g}$; it is therefore the minimiser of $\mathfrak{g}$ among the fields with $QA = B$, and $\mathfrak{g}(A_0) = \langle B, \mathsf{Q}^{-1} B\rangle$. The same computation on the whole torus shows that this minimiser is $GQ^*(QGQ^*)^{-1}B = HB$ and that the minimum is $\langle B, (QGQ^*)^{-1}B\rangle$. Hence $A_0 = HB$, the two quadratic forms agree on the functions which vanish on $\mathfrak{z}$, and so do the operators. The last statement is Proposition 24.5(iii).

(v) For $N_Y^{-1}$: the kernel of $\mathsf{V}$ vanishes unless both points are neighbours of one point of $Z$, hence points of the scale 0 at a distance $d$ of at most 2, and it is then at most $8\eta^{-8}$, because the kernel of $\Delta'_a$ between two neighbours is $-\eta^{-6}$ with respect to the weights $\eta^4$ and a point has eight neighbours; this is of the form [3, (2.87)] for two points of the scale 0, and $N^{-1}$ satisfies this bound by Proposition 20.6. For the operators of (iv) the bounds are those of Proposition 24.5, restricted. For $G'_Y$ let $\lambda$ be a bounded function supported in the block of $y' \in \mathfrak{B}$. By [3, (2.67)], $|(G'\lambda)(z')| \le c\,\eta^2 e^{-\frac{1}{2}\bar\delta_0 d(z',y')} \sup|\lambda|$ for $z' \in Z$; by (i) and [3, (2.61)] the function $\phi \coloneqq (\mathsf{D}'_Z)^{-1} G'\lambda$, which is supported in $Z$, satisfies $|\phi(z)| \le c\, e^{-\theta d(z,y')} \sup|\lambda|$ with $\theta \coloneqq \frac{1}{2}\theta_Z$; and $G'\phi$ is the sum over $z \in Z$ of $\phi(z)$ times $G'$ applied to the function which is 1 at $z$ and zero elsewhere, to which the bounds [3, (2.67)] apply, with or without a derivative or a Hölder quotient on the left. Summing over $z$ with [3, (2.61)] we find at a point of the block of $y$ a bound of the form [3, (2.67)] with the factor $e^{-\theta' d_Z(y,y')}$, $\theta' \coloneqq \frac{1}{2}\theta$, in the place of $e^{-\frac{1}{2}\bar\delta_0 d(y,y')}$. For the bounds with a derivative of the source the function $G'\nabla^*\lambda$ is at most $c\,\eta\, e^{-\frac{1}{2}\bar\delta_0 d(z',y')} \sup|\lambda|$ on $Z$, so that $\phi$ carries a factor $\eta^{-1}$ and the result a factor $\ell_j^2 \eta^{-1} = L^j \ell_j$ at a point of the scale $j$, of which $L^j$ is paid by a part of the decay between the scales 0 and $j$, by (20.22). This gives the statements on $G'_Y$. Those on $G_\mathfrak{y}$ follow in the same way from (iii) and [3, (2.136)–(2.139)]; in [3, (2.138)] and in the Hölder bound for $\nabla G \nabla^* J$ the term with $(\mathsf{D}_\mathfrak{z})^{-1}$ needs the supremum of $J$ only. For the bounds [3, (2.140)] in $L^2$ we use in addition that $(\mathsf{D}_\mathfrak{z})^{-1}$ is bounded by $c_\Delta \eta^{-2}$ on the square-summable fields and Schur's test for the sums over the blocks. *q.e.d.*

The last statement of (v) is the form which the comparison of the operators of two domains

takes here [1, (1.11), (1.12)], [5, Theorem 3.14]: the change of the operator caused by the condition on $Z$ decays in the distance from the two arguments to $Z$. The formula of [3, p. 228] for the minimiser in terms of $G(\Omega)$ reduces to (iv) when $B$ vanishes outside $\Omega_1$, the case which he uses.

## 26 The Averaging Operations for Fields with Values in the Group

The paper [4] defines the average of a configuration with values in $G$ over the blocks and proves its regularity and analyticity. Its results are of three kinds. Section A concerns functions on the Lie algebra, in which no lattice occurs. The Propositions 1, 3, and 9, and the identities of Section C, concern one step: a configuration on a lattice, the blocks of this lattice of the side $L$, a contour $\Gamma_{y,x}$ from the corner $y$ of each block to each of its points $x$, and for each bond $c$ of the lattice of the blocks a path $[x, x(c)]$ from each point $x$ of the block of $c_-$ to its translate $x(c)$ in the block of $c_+$ [4, (14), (15), p. 19]. The remaining propositions are inductions over the steps, in which the one-step statements are applied to the lattices $\Omega^{(j)}$ one after the other [4, (43), (53), (127)]. In the tilted run all the lattices but the finest are those of the paper, so that every step but the first is a step of [4] as printed. The first step averages a configuration on the turned lattice $T_\eta$ over the blocks $B_{\ell_1}(y)$, and for it the one-step statements have to be proved. We do this for the first two propositions in detail and then go through the rest of the paper.

*The first step.* As in Section 22 we use the paths $\pi_y(x)$ as the contours $\Gamma_{y,x}$ of a block, and the staircases as the paths between two blocks. For a bond $c = \langle y, y + \ell_1 e_\mu \rangle$ of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ and $x \in B_{\ell_1}(y)$ let $\Gamma_{c,x}$ be the path from $c_-$ to $c_+$ which consists of $\pi_{c_-}(x)$, of the staircase $\sigma_\mu^{\ell_1}(x)$, and of the reverse of $\pi_{c_+}(x + \ell_1 e_\mu)$, and let $U(c) \coloneqq U(\sigma_\mu^{\ell_1}(c_-))$, which is $U(\Gamma_{c,c_-})$. For a configuration $U$ on the bonds of $T_\eta$ with values in $G$ we define, as in [4, (15)],

$$\bar{U}_c \coloneqq \exp\Big[ i \sum_{x \in B_{\ell_1}(c_-)} L^{-4} \frac{1}{i} \log(U(\Gamma_{c,x}) U(c)^{-1}) \Big] U(c) \; . \tag{26.1}$$

Under a gauge transformation $u$ every factor $U(\Gamma_{c,x})U(c)^{-1}$ is conjugated by $u(c_-)$, so that $\overline{U^u} = (\bar{U})^u$, by the argument of [4, p. 24]; this is the condition [4, (11)]. For $U = e^{iA}$ with $A$ small the linear part of $\frac{1}{i} \log \bar{U}_c$ is $L^{-4} \sum_x A(\Gamma_{c,x})$, which for a field in the axial gauge of Section 22 is $L$ times the average $(Q_{\ell_1} A)(c)$ of Definition 6.1; the factor $L$ is the ratio of the spacings of the two lattices, as between [4, (14)] and [4, (15)]. The average $\bar{U}_c$ depends on $U$ on the bonds of the paths $\Gamma_{c,x}$, which lie at a Euclidean distance of less than $4\ell_1$ from $c_-$; it is local in this sense, and not in the sense of [4, p. 24], where the bonds lie in the two blocks of $c$. The averages of the later steps are those of [4, (43)], applied to $\bar{U}$.

Bałaban's estimates start from a local axial gauge, in which the deviation of a bond from the identity is bounded by the deviations of the plaquettes of a strip [4, pp. 24–25]. On the turned lattice the strip is that of Lemma 22.1.

**Lemma 26.1** (Strips and Closed Paths for Unitary Configurations)**.** *Let $V$ be a configuration on the bonds of $T_\eta$ with values in the unitary group, let $o \in T_\eta$, and let $\alpha \geq 0$ and $r \geq 0$ be such that $|V(\partial p) - 1| \leq \alpha$ for every plaquette $p$ all of whose corners $s$ satisfy $|s'_\nu - o'_\nu| \leq r$ for every $\nu$.*

*(i) For every bond $b = \langle x, x + \eta e'_j \rangle$ both of whose ends satisfy this condition, $|V(\pi_o(x))V(b)V(\pi_o(x + \eta e'_j))^{-1} - 1| \leq \alpha \sum_{i<j} |x'_i - o'_i|$.*

*(ii)* *For every closed path $\gamma$ of $n$ bonds all of whose sites satisfy this condition, $|V(\gamma)-1| \le 3rn\alpha$; more precisely, it is at most $\alpha$ times the sum over the steps of $\gamma$ of the numbers of the plaquettes of their strips.*

*(iii)* *If $V_0 := V^{v_0}$ with $v_0(x) := V(\pi_o(x))$, then $V_0(\pi_o(x)) = 1$ for every $x$, and $|V_0(b)-1| \le 3r\alpha$ for the bonds of (i).*

*Proof.* We use that $|W_1 \cdots W_m - 1| \le \sum_i |W_i - 1|$ for unitary matrices and that the conjugation by a unitary matrix preserves the norm. (i) By the proof of Lemma 22.1, the closed path which consists of $\pi_o(x)$, of $b$, and of the reverse of $\pi_o(x + \eta e'_j)$ is, after the cancellation of the common part of the two paths, the boundary of a strip of $m = \sum_{i<j} |x'_i - o'_i|$ plaquettes $p_1, \dots, p_m$, of which consecutive ones share a bond. The product of $V$ over the boundary of the strip, from the point where the two paths separate, is the ordered product of the matrices $g_i V(\partial p_i)^{\pm 1} g_i^{-1}$, where $g_i$ is the product of $V$ over the part of the first side of the strip up to $p_i$; this follows by induction on $m$, the boundary of the strip of $m$ plaquettes being the boundary of the strip of $m-1$ plaquettes followed by the boundary of $p_m$ with the path to it and back. The common part conjugates the product once more. (ii) With the sites $s_0, \dots, s_n = s_0$ of $\gamma$, the matrix $V(\pi_o(s_0))V(\gamma)V(\pi_o(s_0))^{-1}$ is the ordered product over $m$ of the matrices $V(\pi_o(s_{m-1}))V(\langle s_{m-1}, s_m\rangle)V(\pi_o(s_m))^{-1}$, each of which is bounded by (i), applied to the step or to its reverse, with at most $3r$ plaquettes. (iii) By the definition of the gauge transformation, $V_0(\gamma) = v_0(\gamma_-)V(\gamma)v_0(\gamma_+)^{-1}$ for a path from $\gamma_-$ to $\gamma_+$; for $\gamma = \pi_o(x)$ this is 1, since $v_0(o) = 1$, and for $\gamma = b$ it is the matrix of (i), in which the sum is at most $3r$. *q.e.d.*

**Proposition 26.2** (Propositions 1 and 2 for the Tilted Run)**.** *Let $L \ge 64$ be a multiple of 5. There are constants $C'_0$ and $c''_2 > 0$, which depend on $L$, with the following properties.*

*(i)* *Let $V$ be a configuration on $T_\eta$ with values in $G$, let $p'$ be a plaquette of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ with the corner $y$, and let $|V(\partial p) - 1| < \alpha_0 \le c''_2$ for every plaquette $p$ of $T_\eta$ whose corners are at a Euclidean distance of at most $8\ell_1$ from $y$. Then $|\bar V(\partial p') - 1| < 4L^2\alpha_0 + C'_0(L^2\alpha_0)^2$.*

*(ii)* *Let $k \ge 1$, $\eta = L^{-k}$, and let $U$ be a configuration on $T_\eta$ with $|U(\partial p) - 1| < \alpha_0\eta^2$ for every plaquette, where $\alpha_0 \le \min(c''_2, 1/C'_0, \frac{1}{5}c_2)$ with the constant $c_2$ of [4, Proposition 2]. Then the average $\bar U^k$ of the tilted run satisfies $|\bar U^k(\partial p) - 1| < 10\alpha_0$ for every plaquette $p$ of the unit lattice. The statement is local: for a plaquette $p$ it suffices to assume the bound on the plaquettes of $T_\eta$ at a distance of at most $8\ell_1$ from the blocks of the scale 1 of the four corners of $p$.*

*Proof.* (i) We follow [4, (44)–(50), pp. 24–25], in the unit $\eta$. Let $y_0, y_1, y, y_2$ be the corners of $p'$. The paths $\Gamma_{c,x}$ of the four bonds $c$ of $\partial p'$ consist of paths $\pi$ of the four blocks of these corners and of staircases between them; their sites have coordinates in the basis $\eta e'_\nu$ which differ from those of $y$ by at most $r := 4L$, they are at a Euclidean distance of less than $8\ell_1$ from $y$, and each path has at most $10L$ bonds, by the bounds on the coordinates in the proof of Lemma 22.2. Let $V_0$ be the configuration of Lemma 26.1(iii) for $o = y$; since the average is covariant, $|\bar V(\partial p') - 1| = |\bar V_0(\partial p') - 1|$. By that lemma $|V_0(b) - 1| \le 12L\alpha_0$ on the bonds concerned, in the place of the bound $dL\alpha_0$ of [4, p. 25], so that $V_0(b) = e^{iA_b}$ with $|A_b| \le 24L\alpha_0$, and the three estimates which lead to [4, (47)] hold with other constants:

$$\Big|\bar V_0(\partial p') - 1 - i \sum_{c \subset \partial p'} \sum_{x \in B_{\ell_1}(c_-)} L^{-4} A(\Gamma_{c,x})\Big| \le C(L^2\alpha_0)^2 \,, \tag{26.2}$$

where a bond $c$ which $\partial p'$ runs through against its orientation contributes with the sign $-$, and $C$ depends on nothing once $L^2\alpha_0$ is small. In the double sum the terms $A(\pi_{c_\pm}(\cdot))$ cancel:

the sum of $A(\pi_{y_1}(x+\ell_1 e_\mu))$ over $x \in B_{\ell_1}(y_0)$ from the first bond is the sum of $A(\pi_{y_1}(x))$ over $x \in B_{\ell_1}(y_1)$ from the second, and likewise at the other three corners. There remains, as in [4, (48)],

$$\sum_{c \subset \partial p'} \sum_x L^{-4} A(\Gamma_{c,x}) = \sum_{x \in B_{\ell_1}(y_0)} L^{-4} A(\partial(p')_x) \; , \tag{26.3}$$

where $\partial(p')_x$ is the closed path of the staircases $\sigma_\mu(x)$, $\sigma_\nu(x+\ell_1 e_\mu)$, and the reverses of $\sigma_\mu(x+\ell_1 e_\nu)$ and $\sigma_\nu(x)$, for the directions $\mu < \nu$ of $p'$. By Lemma 22.3, $A(\partial(p')_x) = \sum_p n_x(p) A(\partial p)$ with integers $n_x(p)$, and we claim that $\sum_p |n_x(p)| \le 4L^2$. If $\mu, \nu \in \{0,1\}$, the path is the boundary of a square of $L^2$ plaquettes. If $\mu \in \{0,1\}$ and $\nu \in \{2,3\}$, it is the boundary of the surface which the staircase $\sigma_\nu(x)$ sweeps under the translations by $t\eta e_\mu$, $0 \le t \le L$, which consists of $\frac{7}{5}L \cdot L$ plaquettes. If $\mu = 2$ and $\nu = 3$, the path lies in a plane, and in Lemma 22.1 with $o = x$ only its bonds in the direction $e_3'$ have plaquettes, at most $|s_2' - x_2'| \le \frac{7}{5}L + 1$ each; there are $2(\frac{4}{5}L + \frac{3}{5}L)$ such bonds, and $\frac{14}{5}L(\frac{7}{5}L+1) \le 4L^2$. Since $|A(\partial p)| \le |V_0(\partial p) - 1| + \frac{1}{2}(4 \cdot 24 L\alpha_0)^2$, as in [4, (49)], the modulus of (26.3) is at most $4L^2\alpha_0 + C(L^2\alpha_0)^2$, and with (26.2) this gives (i).

(ii) By (i), applied to $U$ with $\alpha_0\eta^2$ in the place of $\alpha_0$, $|\bar U(\partial p') - 1| < 4\alpha_0(L\eta)^2 + C_0'\alpha_0^2(L\eta)^4 \le 5\alpha_0(L\eta)^2$, because $C_0'\alpha_0 \le 1$ and $L\eta \le 1$. For $k = 1$ this is the claim. For $k \ge 2$ the configuration $\bar U$ lives on the lattice $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ of the paper, whose spacing is $L\eta = L^{-(k-1)}$, the remaining $k-1$ averages are those of [4], and $\bar U$ satisfies the hypothesis [4, (52)] of his Proposition 2 for $k-1$ steps with $5\alpha_0 \le c_2$ in the place of $\alpha_0$. That proposition gives $|\bar U^k(\partial p) - 1| < 2 \cdot 5\alpha_0$, and its locality together with that of the first step gives the last statement. *q.e.d.*

The factor 4 in (i) is an upper bound for the number of the plaquettes of $T_\eta$, counted with multiplicities, which fill a plaquette of the coarse lattice bounded by staircases, divided by $L^2$; for the lattice of the paper it is 1, and this is the only place in which the constant of the leading term of [4, (51)] is used. Since the first step occurs once, the loss is a factor in the constants and not in the scaling.

*The rest of the paper.* We go through [4] in its order.

*Section A, (16)–(41).* These are properties of the exponential map and of the function $\log(e^X e^Y)$ on matrices; no lattice occurs.

*Section C, (55)–(108).* The averages $\tilde U'$ and $\bar{\bar U}_1$, the gauge transformation [4, (62)] which passes from the axial gauge conditions [4, (58)] to the condition [4, (61)], the average [4, (78)] of a gauge transformation, and the identities [4, (63), (88), (92), (97), (99), (104)–(108)] are consequences of the definitions and of the covariance of the average. They use of the geometry that $\Gamma_{y,x}$ is a path from $y$ to $x$ for $x$ in the block of $y$, that $\Gamma_{c,x}$ is the path from $c_-$ to $c_+$ through $\Gamma_{c_-,x}$, a path from $x$ to $x(c)$, and the reverse of $\Gamma_{c_+,x(c)}$, and that $x \mapsto x(c)$ maps the block of $c_-$ onto that of $c_+$. These hold for the first step of the tilted run with $x(c) = x + \ell_1 e_\mu$, and the identities hold for it with the same proofs. The axial gauge condition [4, (58)] for the first step is that of Section 22, with the transports of $V_0$ along the paths $\pi_y$.

*Section D, Propositions 3 to 5.* Proposition 3 is the one-step statement for $\bar{\bar V}_1$. Its proof [4, (109)–(126)] uses the matrices $Y_x = \frac{1}{i}\log V_0(\Gamma_{c,x} \cup (-c))$, which for the first step of the tilted run are the logarithms of the products of $V_0$ over closed paths of at most $12L$ bonds and are at most $2 \cdot 3 \cdot 4L \cdot 12L\alpha_0$ in modulus by Lemma 26.1(ii), in the place of his $O(L^2\alpha_0)$; the lengths of the contours, at most $10L$ in the place of $(2d+1)L$; and the functions of Section A. The linear form [4, (124)] has the main term [4, (125)], the mean over $x$ of the sums of the transported field over the paths from $x$ to $x(c)$, divided by $L$, which is at most $\frac{7}{5}|A|$ in

modulus for a staircase of $\frac{7}{5}L$ bonds, in the place of $|A|$; at $V_0 = 1$ it is the average $Q_{\ell_1}$ of Definition 6.1. Hence Proposition 3 holds for the first step with the bound $(\frac{7}{5} + O(L^2\alpha_0))\alpha_1$ in [4, (126)] and with other constants $C_1$, $c_3$, which depend on $L$. In the induction [4, (127)–(133)] the first function of the sequence [4, (127)] is that of the first step and the others are Bałaban's, taken at the averages $\bar{U}_0^j$, which satisfy his hypotheses by Proposition 26.2(ii) with $10\alpha_0$ in the place of $2\alpha_0$. The bound [4, (128)] acquires the factor $\frac{7}{5}$, the hypothesis [4, (131)] becomes a bound by $3\alpha_1$ in the place of $2\alpha_1$, and Proposition 4 follows with other constants $C_2$, $c_4$, which do not depend on $k$. For Proposition 5 the operators $Q$ and $Q''$ of [4, (139), (140)] are, at the first step, the mean over the staircases and the mean over the bonds of all the paths $\Gamma_{c,x}$ of a bond $c$; the inequalities [4, (139), (142)] and $QQ''_j \le 2Q''_{j+1}$, $Q''Q_j \le Q''_{j+1}$ hold with constants which depend on $L$ if $Q''_k$ in [4, (141)] is the mean over the bonds on which $\bar{U}_c^k$ depends, and the induction [4, (143)–(155)] gives [4, (156), (157)] with other constants.

*Section E, Propositions 6 and 7.* These follow from Proposition 4 and from the representation [4, (159), (160)] as printed, with the bound $3\alpha_1 L^j \eta$ in [4, (161)].

*Section F, Propositions 8 to 10.* The classes $\Lambda_k(U_0, \alpha_3)$ of gauge transformations [4, (166), (167)] are defined through the averages of Section C. Proposition 8 rests on the one-step identity [4, (170)], whose proof [4, (168), (169)] uses the definition [4, (78)] and the functions of Section A only. Proposition 9 is the one-step statement for $\tilde{v}'$; in its proof [4, (181)–(198)] the contours enter through their lengths and through the matrices $V_0(\Gamma_{c,x} \cup (-c))$, as in Proposition 3, and the main term of [4, (196)] is at most $\frac{7}{5}L\alpha'_4$ in the place of $L\alpha'_4$. The induction of Proposition 10 then holds with $\frac{7}{5}\alpha_4$ in the place of $\alpha_4$ in [4, (203)] from the first step on, and with other constants. The expansion [4, (212)–(214)] has the linear term $\sum_{x \in B^j(y)} L^{-4j} R(U_0(\Gamma^{(j)}_{y,x}))\lambda(x)$, which at $U_0 = 1$ is the average $Q'$ of Definition 6.1.

In sum, the averaging operations of the tilted run have the properties of [4], with constants which depend on $L$ through the first step, with the factors 4 and $\frac{7}{5}$ named above, and with the locality of the first step relaxed from the two blocks of a bond to their neighbourhood of the radius $4\ell_1$. The statements for which only the changes are named, Propositions 3 to 10, have not been written out line by line.

## 27 The Propagators in a Background Field

The paper [5] extends the results of [3] to the operators which are obtained when the action is expanded around a regular configuration $U$ with values in the group. Its objects are of four kinds, and the turned lattice enters each in a different way. The covariant derivatives and the operator $\Delta(U)$ are defined on the bonds and plaquettes of the fine lattice alone. The averages $Q_j(U)$ and $Q'_j(U)$ are the linear parts of the averaging operations of [4], which we have treated in Section 26. The propagators at $U = 1$, with Dirichlet conditions, are those of Proposition 25.1. Everything else is derived from these by expansions: in the field, around $U = 1$ in a cube in which $U$ is a pure gauge up to a small field, and over walks of cubes. We first complete the statement at $U = 1$, which in [5] contains more bounds on the scalar operator than [3, Proposition 2.2], and then go through the paper.

**Lemma 27.1** (Further Bounds on the Scalar Operator of a Sequence)**.** *Under the hypotheses of Proposition 25.1 there are constants $c$ and a rate $\delta'' > 0$, which depend on $a$, $L$, and the Hölder exponents, such that the operators $G'$ and $G'_Y$ satisfy, in the place of $G'(U)$ at $U = 1$, the bounds [5, (3.44)–(3.47)] with $\delta''$ in the place of $\delta_0$. In particular, for $y, y' \in \mathfrak{B}$ of the scales $j$, $j'$ and every square-summable $\lambda$ supported in the block of $y'$, the norms over the*

*block of $y$ satisfy*

$$\|G'\lambda\|_{\Delta(y)} \le c\,\ell_j^2 e^{-\delta'' d(y,y')}\|\lambda\|\,, \qquad \|\nabla G'\lambda\|_{\Delta(y)}\,,\ \|G'\nabla^*\lambda\|_{\Delta(y)} \le c\,\ell_j e^{-\delta'' d(y,y')}\|\lambda\|\,, \quad (27.1)$$

*and $\|\nabla\nabla G'\lambda\|_{\Delta(y)}$, $\|\nabla G'\nabla^*\lambda\|_{\Delta(y)}$, and $\|G'\nabla^*\nabla^*\lambda\|_{\Delta(y)}$ are at most $c\,e^{-\delta'' d(y,y')}\|\lambda\|$.*

*Proof.* It suffices to treat $G'$: by (25.2) the operator $G'_Y$ differs from it by $G'(\mathsf{D}'_Z)^{-1}G'$, in which the two factors $G'$ act from and to functions on $Z$, whose points are blocks of the scale 0, and $(\mathsf{D}'_Z)^{-1}$ has the matrix bound of Proposition 25.1(i), so that every bound below passes to $G'_Y$ by the argument of Proposition 25.1(v), with Schur's test for the bounds in $L^2$. We write $c$ and $\delta$ for constants with the stated dependence.

*The first-order bounds in $L^2$.* Let $K(x,x')$ be the kernel of $G'$ with respect to the weights $\eta^4$. The first bound of [3, (2.67)], applied to the functions of modulus one on the block of $y'$, gives $\sum_{x'\in\Delta(y')}\eta^4|K(x,x')| \le c\,\ell_j^2 e^{-\frac12\bar\delta_0 d(y,y')}$ for $x\in\Delta(y)$, and since $K$ is symmetric, $\sum_{x\in\Delta(y)}\eta^4|K(x,x')| \le c\,\ell_{j'}^2 e^{-\frac12\bar\delta_0 d(y,y')}$ for $x'\in\Delta(y')$. By Schur's test the norm of $\mathbf{1}_{\Delta(y)}G'\mathbf{1}_{\Delta(y')}$ is at most $c\,\ell_j\ell_{j'}e^{-\frac12\bar\delta_0 d(y,y')}$, and (20.22) replaces $\ell_{j'}$ by $\ell_j$ at the cost of a part of the rate. For $\nabla G'$ the sums of the difference quotients of $K$ in the first argument over $x'\in\Delta(y')$ are bounded by the second bound of [3, (2.67)], and their sums over $x\in\Delta(y)$ by the third, applied with the roles of the two blocks exchanged, because $(G'\nabla^*\lambda)(x') = \sum_x \eta^4(\nabla_x K)(x,x')\lambda(x)$ for a tuple of functions $\lambda$; Schur's test gives the bound for $\nabla G'$, and that for $G'\nabla^*$ is the bound for the adjoint. This is (27.1). If an operator $\mathsf{T}$ satisfies $\|\mathbf{1}_{\Delta(y)}\mathsf{T}\mathbf{1}_{\Delta(y')}\| \le m(y,y')$ for all $y,y'\in\mathfrak{B}$, then $\|\mathsf{T}\|^2 \le \sup_y\sum_{y'} m(y,y')\cdot\sup_{y'}\sum_y m(y,y')$, by Schur's test for the matrix $m$, the blocks being disjoint; we refer to this as Schur's test for the blocks.

*The second-order bounds in $L^2$, without decay.* For a function $\phi$ on the torus, $\sum_{\nu,\nu'}\|\partial'_\nu\partial'_{\nu'}\phi\|^2 = \|\Delta\phi\|^2$, because in the Fourier representation of the group $\mathbb{T}$ the operator $\partial'_\nu$ is the multiplication by a function $s_\nu$ and $-\Delta$ that by $\sum_\nu|s_\nu|^2$. With $\phi = G'\lambda$ we have $-\Delta\phi = \lambda - Q'^* a Q'\phi$. The operator $Q'^* a Q'$ is $a_j\ell_j^{-2}$ times the orthogonal projection onto the functions which are constant on the blocks in the region of the scale $j$, summed over $j$, so that $\|Q'^* a Q'\phi\|_{\Delta(y)} \le a\ell_j^{-2}\|\phi\|_{\Delta(y)}$, and by (27.1), [3, (2.61)], and Schur's test for the blocks, $\|Q'^* a Q' G'\lambda\| \le c\|\lambda\|$. Hence $\|\nabla\nabla G'\lambda\| \le c\|\lambda\|$ for every $\lambda$, and by taking the adjoint $\|G'\nabla^*\nabla^*\lambda\| \le c\|\lambda\|$. Since $\Delta'_a \ge -\Delta = \nabla^*\nabla$, the supremum over $\phi$ of $2\langle\nabla^*\lambda,\phi\rangle - \langle\phi,\Delta'_a\phi\rangle$, which is $\langle\nabla^*\lambda, G'\nabla^*\lambda\rangle$, is at most that of $2\langle\lambda,\nabla\phi\rangle - \|\nabla\phi\|^2 \le \|\lambda\|^2$ for a tuple $\lambda$, and $\|\nabla G'\nabla^*\lambda\|^2 = \langle G'\nabla^*\lambda, -\Delta G'\nabla^*\lambda\rangle \le \langle G'\nabla^*\lambda, \nabla^*\lambda\rangle \le \|\lambda\|^2$.

*The decay of the second-order bounds.* Let $y$ have the scale $j$, and let $\chi$ be a function of the coordinates of the paper which equals 1 at the points at a distance of at most $2\ell_j$ from $\Delta(y)$ in $|\cdot|_\infty$, vanishes at those at a distance of more than $4\ell_j$, and has differences and second differences along the bonds of $T_\eta$ bounded by $c\,\eta/\ell_j$ and $c\,\eta^2/\ell_j^2$. The points of its support and their neighbours lie in the union $E$ of the blocks of at most $c\,L^4$ points $y_1$ of $\mathfrak{B}$ with $d(y,y_1)\le c\,L$, of the scales between $j-1$ and $j+1$. If the block of $y'$ and its neighbours do not meet $E$, then for $\lambda$ supported in $\Delta(y')$ and $\phi = G'\lambda$ we have $\chi\Delta\phi = \chi Q'^* a Q'\phi$, and $\nabla\nabla(\chi\phi)$ equals $\nabla\nabla\phi$ on $\Delta(y)$, so that, by the identity above and (17.4),

$$\|\nabla\nabla\phi\|_{\Delta(y)} \le \|\Delta(\chi\phi)\| \le c\,\ell_j^{-2}\|\phi\|_E + c\,\ell_j^{-1}\|\nabla\phi\|_E \le c\,e^{-\delta d(y,y')}\|\lambda\| \qquad (27.2)$$

by (27.1) for the blocks of $E$ and (20.22). For $\phi = G'\nabla^*\lambda$, which satisfies $\Delta'_a\phi = 0$ on the support of $\chi$, we take the scalar product of this equation with $\chi^2\phi$: $\langle\nabla(\chi^2\phi),\nabla\phi\rangle = -\langle\chi^2\phi, Q'^* a Q'\phi\rangle$, hence $\|\chi\nabla\phi\|^2 \le c\,\ell_j^{-1}\|\phi\|_E\|\chi\nabla\phi\| + c\,\ell_j^{-2}\|\phi\|_E^2$, where we have used that the difference of $\chi^2$ along a bond is at most $c(\eta/\ell_j)(\chi + c\,\eta/\ell_j)$ at either end and that a

difference quotient of $\phi$ is at most $2\eta^{-1}$ times its values, and $\|\nabla\phi\|_{\Delta(y)} \le c\,\ell_j^{-1}\|\phi\|_E \le c\,e^{-\delta d(y,y')}\|\lambda\|$ by (27.1). If the block of $y'$ or one of its neighbours meets $E$, then $d(y,y') \le c\,L$, and the bounds without decay suffice. The bound for $G'\nabla^*\nabla^*$ between two blocks is that for the adjoint of $\nabla\nabla G'$. This gives the inequalities [5, (3.46)], and [5, (3.47)] follows from [3, (2.67)] and [3, (2.61)], as Bałaban remarks [5, p. 398].

*The bounds [5, (3.44), (3.45)].* The local operators satisfy them: for a cube $\square$ of a scale $j \ge 1$, by (18.2), $\nabla A_\square \nabla^* f$ is the sum of $\nabla G_{(j)}\nabla^* f$, for which they are Proposition 14.4(ii) and (iii) in the unit $\ell_j$, and of $\alpha_j^2 \nabla G_{(j)}\mathsf{q}^*\iota\, C_\Lambda\, \iota^*\mathsf{q}G_{(j)}\nabla^* f$, in which $G_{(j)}\nabla^* f$ is at most $c\,\ell_j \sup|f|$ by Proposition 14.4(i), the operator $C_\Lambda$ contributes $c\,\ell_j^2$ by Lemma 18.1(iii), $\alpha_j^2 \le a^2\ell_j^{-4}$, and $\nabla G_{(j)}$ contributes $c\,\ell_j$ and is Hölder continuous by Proposition 14.3, each with its decay; for the scale 0 a difference quotient is a bounded operator in the unit $\eta$. For the sequence we use $G' = G'_0 + G'\mathsf{R}$ and $G' = \sum_n (\mathsf{R}^*)^n G'_0$ with the operators of the proof of Proposition 20.2, so that

$$\nabla G'\nabla^*\lambda = \nabla G'_0\nabla^*\lambda + \sum_{n\ge 0} \nabla(\mathsf{R}^*)^n G'_0\, \mathsf{R}\nabla^*\lambda\,. \tag{27.3}$$

The first term is a sum of terms $\nabla h_\square A_\square h_\square \nabla^*\lambda$, to which the local bounds apply, with the Hölder norm of $\lambda$. In the second, $\mathsf{R}\nabla^*\lambda = \sum_\square K(h_\square)A_\square h_\square\nabla^*\lambda$ is bounded by the supremum of $\lambda$ and is Hölder continuous with every exponent smaller than one, by Lemma 18.1(iv) and (v), and each further factor $h_\square A_\square K(h_\square)^*$ of $\mathsf{R}^*$ maps bounded Hölder continuous functions to such functions, with the factor $c\,L/M$: the term of $K(h_\square)^*$ which is an adjoint derivative of a function is treated by Lemma 18.1(v), and the derivative on the left of the first factor meets $A_\square\nabla^*$ applied to a Hölder continuous function, for which we use the local bounds again. The composition is as in the proof of Proposition 20.2. *q.e.d.*

We now go through [5] in its order.

*Section A, the definitions (3.1)–(3.34).* The expansion [5, (3.1)–(3.12)] of the action around $U_0$, the covariant derivatives [5, (3.3), (3.4), (3.8), (3.9)], and the operators $\Delta(U)$, $\Delta'(U)$, and $J$ [5, (3.10), (3.11)] involve the bonds and plaquettes of one lattice with four orthogonal directions, and they are unchanged on $T_\eta$ with the directions $e'_\nu$. The averages [5, (3.13)–(3.15)] are $Q_j(U) = Q(\bar U^{j-1})\cdots Q(\bar U)Q(U)$ with the one-step operator $Q(V)$ of [4, (124)]; in the tilted run the last factor $Q(U)$ is that of the first step (Section 26), which at $U = 1$ and in the normalisation of [5, (3.14)] is the average $Q_{\ell_1}$, and the others are Bałaban's. The same holds for $Q'_j(U)$ [5, (3.19)], in which the contour $\Gamma_{x_1,x}$ of the first step is the path $\pi_{x_1}(x)$. The form [5, (3.16)], the gauge-fixing density [5, (3.17), (3.20)], the projection $R(U)$ with its formula [5, (3.21)–(3.25)], and the operators $\Delta_a(U)$ and $G(U)$ [5, (3.26), (3.27)] are defined from these as printed; that the Dirichlet conditions do not change $R$ is the remark after (25.1), which holds for every $U$. The transformation laws [5, (3.28)–(3.34)] follow from the invariance of the action and from the covariance of the averages, which holds for the first step of the tilted run (Section 26).

*Section A, the conditions and the theorems (3.35)–(3.49).* The cubes of the regularity conditions [5, (3.35), (3.36)] are unions of big blocks, hence cubes of the paper, and the conditions bound a field $A$ with $U^u = e^{i\eta A}$ and its differences along the bonds of $T_\eta$; they are conditions on a configuration of the turned lattice which involve the coarse lattices through the cubes only, and so are [5, (3.37), (3.38)]. In the Hölder norms [5, (3.40)] the contour $\Gamma_{x,x'}$ is a path of $T_\eta$ with the least number of bonds. Theorems 3.1, 3.2, and 3.3 are statements about the operators so defined. At $U = 1$ they are, for the tilted run, Proposition 25.1 with Propositions 20.2, 20.6, and 24.3 and Lemma 27.1; the bounds [5, (3.49)] on $P$ at $U = 1$ are Proposition 20.6(iii).

*Section B, (3.50)–(3.86).* The expansions [5, (3.50)–(3.54), (3.69)–(3.75)] of $\Delta_{U'U}$, of $\Delta'(U'U)$, and of the two second-order operators in the field $A$ are computations at a point and its neighbours on one lattice and are unchanged. The expansion [5, (3.55)–(3.59)] of $Q'_j(U'U)$ uses the identities [4, (97), (102), (103)] and the bounds [4, (161), (162)] and Proposition 4 of that paper, which hold for the tilted run with the changes named in Section 26; the bound [5, (3.58)] follows with another constant. The expansion [5, (3.78)–(3.81)] of $Q_j(U'U)$ uses [4, (124), (140), (141), (143)] and Proposition 6 there, with the operators $Q''$ of Section 26, and gives [5, (3.81)] with a constant which depends on $L$. The operator $P_2(A)$ of [5, (3.82), (3.83)] is semi-local in the sense that its value at a bond of the region of the scale $j$ depends on the fields in the blocks of the scale $j$ around the bond and, through the first step, in their neighbourhood of the radius $4\ell_1$. The remaining steps, [5, (3.60)–(3.68), (3.76), (3.77), (3.84)–(3.86)], are Neumann series whose terms are composed with Lemma 2.1 of [3], which is Lemma 19.2, and with the comparison of the powers of $L$ which we have made explicit in (20.22). Hence Theorem 3.4 and Corollary 3.5 hold for the tilted run with the same proofs, given Theorems 3.1 to 3.3 for $U$, respectively at $U = 1$. In Corollary 3.6 the sequence $\{\Omega'_j\}$ lies in a cube $\square$ of the condition [5, (3.35)], and its operators are those of Proposition 25.1 for the sequence $\Omega'_1 \supset \cdots \supset \Omega'_k$ on a torus which contains $\square$, with $Y = \Omega'_0$; they do not depend on the torus, being inverses of operators on the functions and fields on $\Omega'_0$.

*Section C, (3.87)–(3.108).* The cover, the sequences $\{\Omega_n(\square)\}$ of cubes around a cube $\square$ [5, p. 408], and the partition of unity are defined by the big blocks and are those of the paper; a partition of unity with the properties used is that of Section 20. The local operators $G'_\square(U)$, $C_\square(U)$, and $G_\square(U)$ are those of Corollary 3.6. The commutator [5, (3.88)] of $\Delta'_a$ with a function has an averaging term with the differences of the function over a block, weighted by the transports along the contours, and the bound [5, (3.89)] uses the size of the block only. The commutators [5, (3.100)–(3.104)] for the fields are those of Lemma 17.4 with the transports; in [5, (3.102)] the kernel of $Q_j$ is supported, for the tilted run, in the neighbourhood of the radius $4\ell_1$ of the two blocks of the bond. The convergence of the expansions [5, (3.90), (3.96), (3.98), (3.106), (3.107)] and the bounds [5, (3.94), (3.99), (3.108)] on their terms follow from these and from Lemma 19.2 as in the text. Two inputs are quoted there from the earlier papers. The first is the smallness of the differences of the operators of two sequences which agree near a cube [5, (3.97)]; for the tilted run at $U = 1$ these are Lemma 20.5, Lemma 24.2, (24.12), and Proposition 25.1(v), all of which are proved from the resolvent identity and the bounds on the kernels of the two operators, and the passage to a regular $U$ is that of Corollary 3.5. The second is the cancellation [5, p. 415] of the term with $P_\square$, which is algebra. Theorems 3.7, 3.9, and 3.10, and with them Theorems 3.1 to 3.3 for a configuration $U$ which satisfies [5, (3.35)], therefore hold for the tilted run, with constants which depend on $L$ also through Sections 20–26. The proof of Theorem 3.11 is an argument on a symmetric invertible operator and its expansion and is unchanged. We have not written out the expansions of this section for the tilted run line by line.

*Section D, (3.109)–(3.154).* The minimiser $H$ of [5, (3.109), (3.110)] and the operators $H_1$, $G_1$, $\mathfrak{P}$, and $\mathfrak{G}$ are defined by variational problems and Gaussian integrals in which the lattice does not occur beyond the operators $\Delta(U)$, $D$, $Q$, $Q'$, and $R$. The derivations [5, (3.112)–(3.130), (3.139)–(3.153)] use four properties of these operators: the identity [5, (3.114), (3.115)], $Q_j D\lambda = \bar{D}^j Q'_j \lambda$; the invariance [5, (3.117)] of the action; the definition of $R$; and $Q'\mathscr{G} = 0$. The first is the linear part of the transformation law of $\bar{\bar{U}}'$ under a gauge transformation, [5, p. 418], whose derivation uses the covariance of the average and the definition [5, (3.113)], in which the product of $R_y U'$ along the contour $\Gamma_{y,x}$ telescopes for every path from $y$ to $x$; it holds for the first step of the tilted run with the paths $\pi_y(x)$ and the staircases, and at $U = 1$ it is Lemma 6.4(i). The others are as printed. The bounds [5,

(3.131)–(3.133), (3.137)] use Theorems 3.1 to 3.3 and [4, (149)], which holds for the tilted run with another constant (Section 26), and Theorems 3.12 and 3.13 follow as in the text. For the inverse of $QGQ^*$ Bałaban refers to the analysis of $(Q'G'^2Q'^*)^{-1}$ [5, p. 422]; at $U = 1$ it is Proposition 24.5(ii) with Proposition 25.1(iv), and its lower bound on a cube rests on Lemma 24.4. Theorem 3.14 is proved from the expansions, as in the text; at $U = 1$ and for the change of the set $Z$ it is Proposition 25.1(v).

*Section E, (3.155)–(3.187).* The propagator $C^{(k)}(\Lambda)$ is the covariance of the fluctuation field of the unit lattice after $k$ steps, in the axial gauge of the blocks of the next step and with the averages of the next step equal to zero. For $k \geq 1$ the unit lattice, its blocks, the contours of the axial gauge, the bonds $B(c) \cap c$, and the average $Q_1$ are those of the paper, and the derivation [5, (3.155)–(3.186)] uses, besides them, the operators of the sequence with the additional domain $\Omega_{k+1} = B^k(\Lambda)$ and the identities of Section D; it is unchanged, and Theorem 3.15 holds with the operators of the tilted run. The lower bound of $C^*\Delta_k C$ at $U = 1$ is Bałaban's Lemma 2.4 on a lattice of the paper. For $k = 0$ the fluctuation field lives on the turned lattice itself. Then $H_1 = 1$, and the quadratic form [5, (3.156)] is that of $\Delta(U)$ and of a term with $J$. We take it on the space of the fields $B$ which vanish on the bonds with no end in $\Lambda$, are axial on the blocks of $\Lambda$ in the sense of Section 22, and whose averages $(Q_{\ell_1}B)(c)$ vanish for the bonds $c$ of $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')$; how the conditions are to be read at the boundary of $\Lambda$ is a matter of the first step of the paper, which Section 31 lists. At $U = 1$ the lower bound of the form on this space is the inequality (22.12), in which the first and the third term on the right vanish for these fields, so that $\|\partial B\|^2 \geq (C_1 L^7)^{-1}\eta^{-2}\|B\|^2$. The decay of the covariance follows from Lemma 22.5 as in Proposition 22.6(iii), with the following projection onto this space: the restriction to the bonds with an end in $\Lambda$, followed by the orthogonal projection, within the fields supported on these bonds, onto those whose averages vanish on $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')$, followed by $\mathfrak{a}_\Lambda$, which preserves the averages, makes a field axial on the blocks of $\Lambda$, and changes it on bonds with an end in $\Lambda$ only. The orthogonal projection has a kernel which decays exponentially, because the average, restricted to the fields supported on these bonds, has a bounded right inverse on the functions on $\mathfrak{b}(\Lambda')$: the fields $\mathfrak{f}_c$ of the proof of Lemma 24.4 are supported on bonds with an end in $\Lambda$, and the matrix (24.10) is inverted as there. For a regular $U$ the form differs from that at $U = 1$, after the gauge transformation of [5, (3.35)] on the cubes, by an operator which is small in the unit $\eta$, and the perturbation argument of Section B applies. The appendix on the chiral models is not used.

## 28 The Spaces of Regular Configurations

The paper [6] shows that a configuration which satisfies the gauge-invariant regularity conditions [6, (1.7)–(1.9)] and whose averages are close to those of a regular configuration $U_0$ can be brought, by a unique gauge transformation, into the Landau gauge relative to $U_0$, in which it is $e^{i\eta A}U_0$ with a small and regular field $A$ (Theorems 2 and 4), and it removes with this the additional regularity condition [5, (3.35)] from the hypotheses of the theorems on the propagators (Proposition 6). The proof consists of computations at a plaquette of the fine lattice, of contraction arguments in spaces of functions with weighted norms, of applications of [4] and of Theorems 3.1 to 3.3 of [5], and of one geometric statement, Lemma 1, on a configuration in the axial gauge of one step. Only the last has to be proved anew for the first step of the tilted run.

In the axial gauge relative to $V_0$ of [6, (1.19), (1.24)] the product of the matrices $R(V_0(\Gamma_{y,b_-}))V'_b$ along the contour $\Gamma_{y,x}$ is 1 for every point $x$ of the block of $y$. Since $(V'V_0)(\Gamma) = \prod_{b\subset\Gamma} R(V_0(\Gamma_{y,b_-}))V'_b \cdot V_0(\Gamma)$ for a path $\Gamma$ from $y$, the condition says that $V'V_0$

and $V_0$ have the same product along $\Gamma_{y,x}$. For the first step of the tilted run the contours are the paths $\pi_y(x)$, and in this form the condition does not require that they stay in the block or that the configuration $V'$ be trivial on their bonds, which Bałaban uses [6, p. 79]. The norm of a matrix is the Hilbert–Schmidt norm with the normalised trace, as in [5]; it is invariant under the multiplication by unitary matrices from either side.

**Lemma 28.1** (Lemma 1 for the First Step of the Tilted Run)**.** *Let $L \geq 64$ be a multiple of 5, let $V_0$ and $V = V'V_0$ be configurations on the bonds of $T_\eta$ with values in the unitary group, let $y_1 \in \ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$, and let $\alpha, \alpha_1 \geq 0$. Suppose that*

*(a) $|V_0(\partial p) - 1| \leq \alpha$ and $|V(\partial p) - 1| \leq \alpha$ for every plaquette $p$ of $T_\eta$ all of whose corners $s$ satisfy $|s'_\nu - y'_{1,\nu}| \leq 5L$ for every $\nu$;*

*(b) $V(\pi_y(x)) = V_0(\pi_y(x))$ for every $y \in \ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ with $|y - y_1|_\infty \leq \ell_1$ and every $x \in B_{\ell_1}(y)$;*

*(c) $|\bar V_c \bar V_{0,c}^{-1} - 1| \leq \alpha_1$ for every bond $c$ of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ between two of these points $y$, with the average (26.1).*

*Then for every bond $b$ of $T_\eta$ which starts in $B_{\ell_1}(y_1)$,*

$$|V'_b - 1| \leq \begin{cases} \frac{42}{5} L\alpha & \text{if } b \text{ ends in } B_{\ell_1}(y_1), \\ \alpha_1 + 1710 L^2 \alpha & \text{if } b \text{ ends in } B_{\ell_1}(y_1 \pm \ell_1 e_\mu) \text{ for some } \mu, \\ 2\alpha_1 + 2850 L^2 \alpha & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \tag{28.1}$$

*Proof.* For $x \in B_{\ell_1}(y)$ the coordinates of $x - y$ in the basis $\eta e'_\nu$ are smaller than $L$, $L$, $\frac{7}{5}L$, and $\frac{4}{5}L$ in modulus, so that $\pi_y(x)$ has at most $\frac{21}{5}L$ bonds; a staircase has at most $\frac{7}{5}L$ bonds; and the sites of all the paths below have coordinates which differ from those of $y_1$ by at most $5L$, by the bounds in the proof of Lemma 22.2. We use Lemma 26.1 for $V$ and for $V_0$, with $o = y$ in (i) and with $o = y_1$, $r = 5L$ in (ii), and we put $\kappa := 285 L^2 \alpha$.

*A bond inside the block.* Let $b = \langle x, x^+ \rangle$ with $x, x^+ \in B_{\ell_1}(y_1)$, and $g := V(\pi_{y_1}(x))$, $g^+ := V(\pi_{y_1}(x^+))$, which by (b) are also the products of $V_0$. By Lemma 26.1(i), $gV_b(g^+)^{-1}$ and $gV_{0,b}(g^+)^{-1}$ differ from 1 by at most $\frac{21}{5}L\alpha$ each, the strip of $b$ having at most $\frac{21}{5}L$ plaquettes. Hence $|V_b - V_{0,b}| \leq \frac{42}{5}L\alpha$, and $|V'_b - 1| = |V_b V_{0,b}^{-1} - 1|$ is the same number.

*A bond across a face.* Let $x \in B_{\ell_1}(y_1)$ and $x^+ \in B_{\ell_1}(y_2)$ with $y_2 = y_1 + \ell_1 e_\mu$; the case $y_2 = y_1 - \ell_1 e_\mu$ follows by exchanging the roles of the two blocks, since $|V'_b - 1|$ does not change under the reversal of $b$ up to a conjugation. Let $c := \langle y_1, y_2 \rangle$, and for $x_0 \in B_{\ell_1}(y_1)$ let $\Gamma_{c,x_0}$ be the path of (26.1) and $W(x_0) := V(\Gamma_{c,x_0}) V_0(\Gamma_{c,x_0})^{-1}$. The path $\gamma$ which consists of $\pi_{y_1}(x)$, of $b$, of the reverse of $\pi_{y_2}(x^+)$, and of the reverse of $\Gamma_{c,x_0}$ is closed and has at most $4 \cdot \frac{21}{5}L + \frac{7}{5}L + 1 \leq 19L$ bonds, so that $|V(\gamma) - 1| \leq \kappa$ and $|V_0(\gamma) - 1| \leq \kappa$ by Lemma 26.1(ii). With $g_1 := V(\pi_{y_1}(x))$ and $g_2 := V(\pi_{y_2}(x^+))$, which by (b) are the products of $V_0$ as well, $V(\gamma) = g_1 V_b g_2^{-1} V(\Gamma_{c,x_0})^{-1}$ and $V_0(\gamma) = g_1 V_{0,b} g_2^{-1} V_0(\Gamma_{c,x_0})^{-1}$, and therefore

$$g_1 V'_b g_1^{-1} = V(\gamma)\, W(x_0)\, V_0(\gamma)^{-1}\,, \qquad |g_1 V'_b g_1^{-1} - W(x_0)| \leq 2\kappa\,. \tag{28.2}$$

We compare $W(y_1)$ with the averages. The closed path which consists of $\Gamma_{c,x_0}$ and of the reverse of $\Gamma_{c,y_1}$, the staircase from $y_1$, has at most $12L$ bonds, so that $u := V(\Gamma_{c,x_0}) V(c)^{-1}$ satisfies $|u - 1| \leq \kappa$. The principal logarithm of a unitary matrix $u$ satisfies $|\frac{1}{i} \log u| \leq \frac{\pi}{2}|u - 1|$, because $|e^{i\theta} - 1| \geq \frac{2}{\pi}|\theta|$ for $|\theta| \leq \pi$, and $|e^{iX} - 1| \leq |X|$ for a Hermitian matrix $X$. Hence the mean over $x_0$ of the logarithms in (26.1) is at most $2\kappa$ in norm, $|\bar V_c V(c)^{-1} - 1| \leq 2\kappa$, and in the

same way $|\bar V_{0,c} V_0(c)^{-1} - 1| \le 2\kappa$. Since $V(c)V_0(c)^{-1} = W(y_1)$, we find $|\bar V_c \bar V_{0,c}^{-1} - W(y_1)| \le 4\kappa$, and with (c) and (28.2) for $x_0 = y_1$,

$$|W(y_1) - 1| \le \alpha_1 + 4\kappa \,, \qquad |V_b' - 1| \le \alpha_1 + 6\kappa \,. \tag{28.3}$$

*A bond across an edge.* A bond of the directions $e_2'$ or $e_3'$ may lead from $B_{\ell_1}(y_1)$ to the block of $y_2 = y_1 + \ell_1(\epsilon_2 e_2 + \epsilon_3 e_3)$ with $\epsilon_2, \epsilon_3 \in \{1, -1\}$; the bonds of the directions $e_0'$ and $e_1'$ change one coordinate, and no other case occurs. Let $y_3 := y_1 + \ell_1 \epsilon_2 e_2$, and let $\Gamma$ be the path from $y_1$ over $y_3$ to $y_2$ along the staircases of the two bonds of $\ell_1 \mathbb{Z}^4$, run through backwards where $\epsilon = -1$. The closed path of $\pi_{y_1}(x)$, $b$, the reverse of $\pi_{y_2}(x^+)$, and the reverse of $\Gamma$ has at most $12L$ bonds, and as in (28.2), $|g_1 V_b' g_1^{-1} - V(\Gamma)V_0(\Gamma)^{-1}| \le 2\kappa$. The matrix $V(\Gamma)V_0(\Gamma)^{-1}$ is the product of the matrix $W$ of the first bond and of a conjugate of that of the second, or of their inverses, each of which differs from 1 by at most $\alpha_1 + 4\kappa$ by (28.3). Hence $|V_b' - 1| \le 2\alpha_1 + 10\kappa$. *q.e.d.*

With $\alpha = \alpha_0 L^{-2}$, the regularity of [6, (1.7)] for one step, the lemma gives $|V' - 1| < 2850\alpha_0 + 2\alpha_1$ in the place of Bałaban's $4d^2\alpha_0 + \alpha_1$ [6, (1.25)], and it uses the hypotheses in the neighbourhood of the radius $5\ell_1$, in the coordinates of $T_\eta$, of the corner of the block, where he uses them on the two blocks of a bond [6, p. 80]. We go through the paper with this change.

*Sections A and B, (1.1)–(1.32).* The covariant derivatives [6, (1.1), (1.2)], the domains and the spaces $\mathfrak{U}_k(\{\Omega_j\}, \alpha_0)$ [6, (1.3)–(1.11)], in which the conditions concern the plaquettes and bonds of $T_\eta$ in the domains, and the spaces $\mathfrak{V}_k$ [6, (1.12)–(1.14)] are defined as printed, with the averages of the tilted run. The axial gauge [6, (1.15), (1.19)] is that of [4, (64)–(72)], whose conditions at the first level are those along the paths $\pi_y(x)$; that they fix one element in each orbit of the transformations [6, (1.14)] uses only that there is one condition for each point $x \ne y$ of a block, on a path from $y$ to $x$, as in [6, (1.17)]. The identities [6, (1.21), (1.22)] concern one plaquette. The Landau gauge [6, (1.27)] and the formulation [6, (1.28)–(1.32)] of the problem use the operators of [5] and the identities [4, (87), (92), (97), (99), (105)], which hold for the tilted run (Section 26).

*Section C, (1.33)–(1.74).* The basic estimate [6, (1.43)–(1.54)] is an expansion at a bond and the plaquettes which contain it, and it holds on $T_\eta$ with the same constants. Proposition 3 follows from it, from [4, Proposition 4], which gives [6, (1.56)] with the constant $C_2$ of the tilted run, and from Theorem 3.3 of [5] with the bound [5, (3.133)] on $H(U_0)$, which give [6, (1.59)] with the constants of Section 27. In [6, (1.37)] the bound $2dL\alpha_1$ on the configuration $B$ of [6, (1.31)] counts the bonds of a contour of a block; for the bonds between $\Lambda_0$ and $\Lambda_1$ the contour is a path $\pi$, and the bound is $9L\alpha_1$. The reduction of [6, (1.35)] to [6, (1.66)] applies Lemma 1 to the pairs $\bar U_0^n$, $(\overline{U'U_0})^n$ for $n = k-1, \dots, 0$, with the bound on the plaquettes of the averages from [4, Proposition 2]. For $n \ge 1$ these are configurations on a lattice of the paper and the lemma is Bałaban's, with the bound $10\alpha_0$ of Proposition 26.2(ii) in the place of $2\alpha_0$; for $n = 0$ it is Lemma 28.1. Hence [6, (1.65)] holds with a bound $C\alpha_0 + 2\alpha_1$, $C$ a number, and [6, (1.66)] is assumed with this bound renamed. In the induction of Theorem 4, the base $k = 1$ uses Lemma 1 and requires that $B_1$ be not too small [6, p. 89]; here $B_1 \ge 4 \cdot 2850$ suffices. The bounds [6, (1.70)–(1.74)] on the gauge transformation $u_1$ use [4, (105), (106), (108), (130)] and sum over the bonds of the contours of the blocks, at most $\frac{21}{5}L$ at the first level in the place of $dL$, which changes the constant $16d$ of [6, (1.72)].

*Sections D and E, (1.75)–(1.125).* The equations for the gauge transformation $u'$ are derived from the functions of [4, Section A], in which no lattice occurs, and from the expansion [6, (1.86)–(1.89)] at a point. Their solution uses the linearisation [4, (213), (214)] of the

average of a gauge transformation and Propositions 8 and 10 of that paper, which hold for the tilted run with other constants; the bounds [5, (3.47)] on $G'$ and the boundedness of $R$ in the weighted norms; and the bound [6, (1.92)] on $H' = G'^2 Q'^* (Q' G'^2 Q'^*)^{-1}$, which is a composition of the bounds of Theorems 3.1 and 3.2 of [5] by Lemma 19.2. The rest is the contraction mapping theorem in the spaces [6, (1.102), (1.119)] and Cauchy's formula for analytic functions, in which the lattice does not occur. Proposition 5, and with it Theorems 2 and 4, hold for the tilted run.

*Sections F to H, (1.126)–(1.147).* The cubes of Section F are cubes of the paper, the global axial gauge on $\tilde{\square}^{(k)}$ [6, (1.129)] is taken on the unit lattice, and [6, (1.128)] is Proposition 26.2(ii) with 10 in the place of 2. The repeated application of Lemma 1 in [6, (1.130)] is as above, so that the numerical factors in [6, (1.130), (1.133), (1.134), (1.136)] and in the condition $7dL^2 M\alpha_0 \le c_1$ of Proposition 6 change, and the statements hold with other numbers in the place of $6d$ and $7d$. Proposition 7 follows from [6, (1.21), (1.47), (1.54)] and [4, Proposition 4], and Theorem 8 from the proofs of Theorems 2 and 4 with a function $f$ on the right of the gauge condition, as in the text.

In sum, the results of [6] hold for the tilted run with other constants. One statement, Lemma 1 at the first level, has a new proof; the others have Bałaban's, with the inputs from Sections 26 and 27, which are themselves classified there and not written out line by line.

## 29 The Variational Problem

The paper [7] constructs the background field: the minimum $U_k(V)$ of the action among the regular configurations with the averages $V$, unique up to gauge transformations, with its regularity and its analytic dependence on $V$ (Theorem 1, Propositions 2 to 9). The proof is an induction on the number $k$ of the levels. At each stage it expands the action around a configuration $U_0$ close to the minimum, linearises the averages, and solves the equation of the critical point by a contraction in weighted norms; its inputs are the expansion of the action at a plaquette, the results of [4], [5], and [6], and, at the start of each stage, a configuration $U_0$ with averages close to $V$. In the tilted run every stage has the turned lattice $T_\eta$ as its finest lattice, and the lattices of the levels 1 to $k$ are those of the paper. The stage $k \ge 2$ starts from the minimum for $k-1$ levels and a configuration $V_0$ on the lattice of the level $k-1$ with the averages $V$ on the level $k$ [7, (11), p. 279], which Bałaban obtains by copying $V_{b'}$ to the bonds which join the blocks of $b'$; both levels are lattices of the paper. The stage $k = 1$ starts from $U_0 = V_0$ [7, p. 280], a configuration on the fine lattice, and for it we need a configuration on the turned lattice.

**Lemma 29.1** (A Regular Configuration with Given Averages)**.** *Let $L \ge 64$ be a multiple of 5, let $V$ be a configuration on the bonds of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ with values in $G$, and let $\varepsilon_1 \ge 0$. For two points $y$, $y^+$ of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ let $\mathsf{v}(y, y^+)$ be 1 if $y^+ = y$; $V(\langle y, y^+\rangle)$ if the two points are neighbours; and, if $y^+ - y = \ell_1(\epsilon_2 e_2 + \epsilon_3 e_3)$ with $\epsilon_2, \epsilon_3 \in \{1, -1\}$, the product of $V$ along the path of two bonds from $y$ to $y^+$ through the point $m$ which has the smaller of the coordinates 3 of the two points and the coordinate 2 of that one of them whose coordinate 3 is the larger. Let $U_0(b) := \mathsf{v}(y, y^+)$ for a bond $b$ of $T_\eta$ from $B_{\ell_1}(y)$ to $B_{\ell_1}(y^+)$. Let $y_1 \in \ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$, and suppose that $|V(\partial p') - 1| \le \varepsilon_1$ for every plaquette $p'$ of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ whose corners are at a distance of at most $2\ell_1$ from $y_1$ in $|\cdot|_\infty$. Then*

*(i) $U_0$ is a configuration, that is, $U_0(b^{-1}) = U_0(b)^{-1}$, and its product along a path of $T_\eta$ is the product of $V$ along the path of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ through the corners of the blocks which the path visits, with the paths of two bonds above for the diagonal steps;*

*(ii)* $|U_0(\partial p) - 1| \le 24\varepsilon_1$ *for every plaquette* $p$ *of* $T_\eta$ *with a corner in* $B_{\ell_1}(y_1)$*, and* $|(D^{\eta*}_{U_0}\partial U_0)(b)| \le 144\eta^{-1}\varepsilon_1$ *for every bond* $b$ *which starts in* $B_{\ell_1}(y_1)$*, if the hypothesis holds also at the neighbours of* $y_1$*;*

*(iii)* $|\bar U_{0,c} - V_c| \le 137\varepsilon_1$ *for every bond* $c$ *of* $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ *which starts at* $y_1$*, with the average* (26.1)*.*

*Proof.* (i) A bond of $T_\eta$ joins two points of one block, of two blocks with a common face, or, if its direction is $e'_2$ or $e'_3$, of two blocks which differ in the coordinates 2 and 3, as in the proof of Lemma 28.1; so $U_0$ is defined. In the diagonal case the point $m$ is the same for the pair $(y, y^+)$ and for the pair $(y^+, y)$, so that the two paths are the reverses of each other. Hence $\mathsf{v}(y^+, y) = \mathsf{v}(y, y^+)^{-1}$, and the statement on the paths follows from the definition.

(ii) We use Lemma 26.1(ii) on the lattice $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$, for which it holds with the same proof: the product of $V$ along a closed path of $n$ bonds whose sites differ from a point $o$ by at most $r\ell_1$ in every coordinate differs from 1 by at most $3rn$ times the bound on the plaquettes of these sites. The four corners of a plaquette $p$ of $T_\eta$ are within the distance $\sqrt{2}\eta$ of each other, so that their blocks have corners which differ by at most $\ell_1$ in every coordinate, and by (i) $U_0(\partial p)$ is the product of $V$ along a closed path of at most 8 bonds through these corners and the corners of the diagonal steps, which differ from one of them by at most $\ell_1$ in every coordinate. This gives $|U_0(\partial p) - 1| \le 3 \cdot 8\,\varepsilon_1$. The value of $D^{\eta*}_{U_0}\partial U_0$ at a bond is $\eta^{-1}$ times a signed sum of the values of $\partial U_0 - 1$, transported, at six plaquettes [6, (1.1), (1.2)], which gives the second bound.

(iii) Let $c = \langle y_1, y_2\rangle$ have the direction $\mu$ and $x \in B_{\ell_1}(y_1)$. The path $\pi_{y_1}(x)$ consists of four straight parts in the directions $e'_3$, $e'_2$, $e'_1$, $e'_0$, of lengths smaller than $\frac45\ell_1$, $\frac75\ell_1$, $\ell_1$, $\ell_1$. Along the first the coordinates 2 and 3 change by less than $\frac{16}{25}\ell_1$ and $\frac{12}{25}\ell_1$, along the second by less than $\frac{21}{25}\ell_1$ and $\frac{28}{25}\ell_1$, so that the path passes from one block to another at most $1+1+1+2+1+1 = 7$ times; it starts and ends in $B_{\ell_1}(y_1)$ and stays in the blocks around it. By (i) and (ii), $U_0(\pi_{y_1}(x))$ is the product of $V$ along a closed path of at most 14 bonds and differs from 1 by at most $42\varepsilon_1$; the same holds for $\pi_{y_2}(x+\ell_1 e_\mu)$. Along the staircase $\sigma^{\ell_1}_\mu(x)$ the coordinate $\mu$ increases at every step, so that it passes once from the blocks below the face between $y_1$ and $y_2$ to those above; if $\mu \in \{2,3\}$ it may in addition pass several times between $B_{\ell_1}(y_1)$ and one neighbouring block in the other of these two directions, and between their translates by $\ell_1 e_\mu$, since its sites stay within $\frac35\eta$ of a segment (Lemma 6.2(ii)). The corners of the blocks which it visits are therefore corners of one plaquette of $\ell_1\mathbb{Z}^4$ which contains $c$, steps back and forth cancel in the product, and the product of $V$ along the path of (i) is $V_c$, or $V_c$ times a conjugate of the product around this plaquette or of its inverse, because the path passes once from the two corners below the face to the two above. Hence $|U_0(\sigma^{\ell_1}_\mu(x)) - V_c| \le \varepsilon_1$, and $|U_0(\Gamma_{c,x}) - V_c| \le 85\varepsilon_1$ for every $x$, in particular $|U_0(c) - V_c| \le \varepsilon_1$. Then $|U_0(\Gamma_{c,x})U_0(c)^{-1} - 1| \le 86\varepsilon_1$, the mean of the logarithms in (26.1) is at most $\frac{\pi}{2} \cdot 86\varepsilon_1 \le 136\varepsilon_1$ in norm, as in the proof of Lemma 28.1, and $|\bar U_{0,c} - V_c| \le (136+1)\varepsilon_1$. *q.e.d.*

With $\eta = L^{-1}$, as at the stage $k = 1$, the lemma gives [7, (14)] for this $U_0$ on the blocks of $\Lambda_1$ away from the boundary of $\Omega_1$: the plaquettes of $U_0$ are bounded by $24L^2\varepsilon_1 \cdot L^{-2}$ and $D^*\partial U_0$ by $144L^3\varepsilon_1 \cdot L^{-2}$, where [7, (2)] requires $\varepsilon_0 L^{-2}$ for both, and the averages differ from $V$ by at most $137\varepsilon_1$. Bałaban's configuration has the averages $V$ exactly and satisfies the conditions with $C_1 = L^3$; the generalised hypothesis [7, (14)], under which the rest of the paper is written, requires closeness only, with a constant $C_1$ which depends on $L$, and it holds here with $C_1 B_3 = 144L^3$. At the bonds between $\Lambda_0$ and the blocks of $\Lambda_1$ the configuration $V_0$ has to be joined to the given configuration on $\Lambda_0$; the text does not describe this for its own lattice [7, p. 279], and we add nothing to it.

We go through the paper.

*The statement and Section A, (1)–(21).* The spaces [7, (2), (3), (6)], the action [7, (5)], and the condition [7, (7)] on $V$ are defined as printed, with the plaquettes of $T_\eta$ on $\Lambda_0$ and with the tilted average of the first step in the plaquettes which meet the boundary between $\Lambda_0$ and $\Lambda_1$. The reduction to the space [7, (19)–(21)] is Theorem 2 of [6] with Proposition 6 there, which hold for the tilted run (Section 28); the bound $2dLC_1\varepsilon_1$ on $B$ becomes $9LC_1\varepsilon_1$, as in [6, (1.37)].

*Sections B to D, (22)–(112).* The expansion [7, (22)–(40)] of the action up to the fourth order is a computation at one plaquette, with the formula of Baker, Campbell, and Hausdorff, and it is unchanged. The linearising transformation [7, (44)–(62)] is a fixed point of a contraction built from $C_j$ of [4, Proposition 4] and from the operator $H$ with the bounds [7, (46)] of [5, Theorem 3.12]; its pseudo-locality [7, (63)–(73)] uses [4, Proposition 5, (157)], the kernel bound [5, (3.133)], and Lemma 2.1 of [3]. In [7, (69)] the function $C_j$ at a bond $c$ depends, in the tilted run, on the field in the neighbourhood of the radius $4\ell_1$ of the two blocks of $c$, which changes the constant. The functional derivative of the interaction [7, (74)–(98)] is estimated with [5, (3.132)], the bounds just named, and the identities [6, (1.50), (1.52)] at a plaquette; the equations [7, (99)–(112)] are those of the critical point in terms of $H_1$, $\mathfrak{P}$, and $\mathfrak{G}$ of [5, Section D]. Propositions 3, 4, and 5 hold for the tilted run with the same proofs and other constants.

*Section E, (113)–(143).* The solution of [7, (111)] is a contraction with [5, Theorem 3.13]. The passage to the gauge conditions [7, (123)] is Theorem 8 of [6]. The second-order bounds [7, (130)–(140)] use the bound of [5, (3.42)] with the covariant Laplace operator, the identity [7, (135)] between $D^*D + DD^*$ and the covariant Laplace operator on the fields, which is a computation at a bond and its plaquettes on one cubic lattice, and the bounds [5, (3.49), (3.69), (3.137)]. The return to the axial gauge is Proposition 7 of [6]. Propositions 6 and 7 follow.

*Section F, (144)–(169).* The cubes and the sequences of cubes are those of [6, Section F]; the operators are those at the background field 1, that is, of Sections 10–25. In [7, (145), (146)] the factor $2L^2\varepsilon_0$ is $10L^2\varepsilon_0$ by Proposition 26.2(ii), and $11d^2\varepsilon_0$ is the constant of [6, (1.65)] for the tilted run. Lemma 1 of [6] is applied in the derivation of [7, (160)] on two neighbouring blocks of the level $j-1$; for $j \geq 2$ these are blocks of a lattice of the paper, and for $j = 1$ the lemma is Lemma 28.1, which gives [7, (160)] with other numbers. The sum [7, (161), (162)] which defines $B_3$ is bounded by Lemma 19.2 and (20.22). Proposition 8 and the regularity [7, (9), (10)] follow as in the text, and with them Theorem 1.

*Section G, (170)–(190).* The analyticity of $U_k(V)$ and the expansion [7, (174)–(180)] follow from the analyticity of the fixed points; the law [7, (181)] uses the covariance of the averages. For the decay [7, (190)] of the functional derivative Bałaban states the bound [7, (189)] on the second derivative of the interaction without carrying out the computation [7, p. 308]; we accept it as his, and it involves the lattice through the same inputs as [7, (85)–(96)]. Proposition 9 holds for the tilted run on this basis.

## 30 The Vacuum Polarisation under the Symmetries of the Tilted Run

The first of the papers on the renormalisation transformations, [9], defines its averages and its gauge fixing so that the effective actions are invariant under the symmetries of the lattice [9, pp. 252–254, 269], and it uses this invariance for one purpose, in its Sections 4 and 5: the term of the second order of the effective action of a step, the vacuum polarisation $\Pi$, is written

as a multiple $\beta$ of the quadratic part of the action plus terms with three derivatives [9, (5.37), (5.38), (5.43)], and the coefficient $\beta$, which the renormalisation of the coupling removes, is identified [9, (5.42)]. The argument uses the covariance of $\Pi$ under the permutations of the coordinates and under the reflection of each coordinate [9, (5.6), (5.7)]. In the tilted run the covariance holds at most for the group $\mathfrak{G}_0$ of Lemma 5.1, which contains neither the reflection of the coordinate 2 alone nor the permutations which mix the coordinates $0, 1$ with $2, 3$. We determine what remains of the representation. This makes the remark at the end of Section 5 precise; it does not remove the difficulty stated there.

*The setting.* Let $\Pi_{\mu\nu}(x)$, $x \in \mathbb{Z}^4$, $\mu, \nu \in \{0,1,2,3\}$, be real numbers with $|\Pi_{\mu\nu}(x)| \le E\, e^{-\delta_1 |x|_1}$, where $|x|_1 = \sum_\mu |x_\mu|$; this is the function of [9, (5.5), (5.8), (5.10)]: $\Pi_{\mu\nu}(x-y)$ is the value $\Pi(b,b')$ at the bonds $b = \langle x, x+e_\mu\rangle$ and $b' = \langle y, y+e_\nu\rangle$, the function $\Pi$ is extended to the reversed bonds by $\Pi(-b,b') = -\Pi(b,b') = \Pi(b,-b')$, and $\Pi_{\mu\nu}(x) = \Pi_{\nu\mu}(-x)$. We write $\Pi_{\mu\nu}(p) \coloneqq \sum_x e^{-ip\cdot x}\Pi_{\mu\nu}(x)$ and $\partial_\mu(p) \coloneqq e^{ip_\mu} - 1$, as in [9, (5.11), (5.15)], and we assume the two identities of the gauge invariance [9, (5.15)],

$$\sum_\mu \overline{\partial_\mu(p)}\, \Pi_{\mu\nu}(p) = 0\,, \qquad \sum_\nu \partial_\nu(p)\, \Pi_{\mu\nu}(p) = 0\,. \tag{30.1}$$

A linear isometry $r$ of $\mathbb{Z}^4$ maps $e_\mu$ to $s_\mu e_{\pi(\mu)}$ with a permutation $\pi$ and signs $s_\mu$, and it maps the bond $\langle x, x+e_\mu\rangle$ to the bond from $rx$ in the direction $s_\mu e_{\pi(\mu)}$. We say that $\Pi$ is *covariant under* $r$ if $\Pi(rb, rb') = \Pi(b,b')$ for all bonds, which is [9, (5.4)]. A *plane* is a set $\{\kappa,\lambda\}$ of two indices, and the planes form three classes: the plane $\{0,1\}$, the plane $\{2,3\}$, and the four mixed planes $\{a,j\}$ with $a \in \{0,1\}$ and $j \in \{2,3\}$. For a class $\mathsf{a}$ let $T^{\mathsf{a}}_{\mu\nu}(x)$ be the function of finite support with

$$\sum_{x,y}\sum_{\mu,\nu} T^{\mathsf{a}}_{\mu\nu}(x-y)\, B'_\mu(x) B_\nu(y) = \sum_x \sum_{\{\kappa,\lambda\}\in\mathsf{a}} (\partial B')_{\kappa\lambda}(x)\, (\partial B)_{\kappa\lambda}(x) \tag{30.2}$$

for all real fields $B$, $B'$ of finite support on the bonds of $\mathbb{Z}^4$, where $(\partial B)_{\kappa\lambda}(x) = B_\lambda(x+e_\kappa) - B_\lambda(x) - B_\kappa(x+e_\lambda) + B_\kappa(x)$. Its transform is $T^{\mathsf{a}}_{\mu\nu}(p) = \sum_{\{\kappa,\lambda\}\in\mathsf{a}} (\delta_{\mu\lambda}\overline{\partial_\kappa(p)} - \delta_{\mu\kappa}\overline{\partial_\lambda(p)})(\delta_{\nu\lambda}\partial_\kappa(p) - \delta_{\nu\kappa}\partial_\lambda(p))$, and the sum of the three is $\delta_{\mu\nu}\Delta(p) - \partial_\mu(p)\overline{\partial_\nu(p)}$ with $\Delta(p) = \sum_\kappa |\partial_\kappa(p)|^2$.

**Proposition 30.1** (The Three Coefficients)**.** *Let $\Pi$ be as above and covariant under the elements of $\mathfrak{G}_0$. Then*

$$\Pi_{\mu\nu}(p) = \sum_{\mathsf{a}} \beta^{\mathsf{a}}\, T^{\mathsf{a}}_{\mu\nu}(p) + \Pi'_{\mu\nu}(p)\,, \qquad \beta^{\mathsf{a}} \coloneqq \sum_x \Pi_{\kappa\lambda}(x)\, x_\kappa x_\lambda\,, \tag{30.3}$$

*where the sum runs over the three classes, $\{\kappa,\lambda\}$ is any plane of the class $\mathsf{a}$, on whose choice $\beta^{\mathsf{a}}$ does not depend, and $\Pi'$ has the following property: it is a finite sum of products of three of the functions $\partial_\kappa(p)$, $\overline{\partial_\kappa(p)}$ with coefficients which are periodic and analytic in the domain $|\operatorname{Im} p_\mu| < \delta_1$ and bounded by a constant times $E$ in every domain $|\operatorname{Im} p_\mu| \le \delta_1' < \delta_1$, the constant depending on $\delta_1$ and $\delta_1'$. If $\Pi$ is covariant under all the isometries of $\mathbb{Z}^4$, the three coefficients are equal, and* (30.3) *is [9, (5.37), (5.38)].*

*Proof. The moments.* Let $m^0_{\mu\nu}$, $m^1_{\mu\nu,\kappa}$, and $m_{\mu\nu,\kappa\lambda}$ be the sums over $x$ of $\Pi_{\mu\nu}(x)$, of $x_\kappa\Pi_{\mu\nu}(x)$, and of $x_\kappa x_\lambda \Pi_{\mu\nu}(x)$, so that $\Pi_{\mu\nu}(p) = m^0_{\mu\nu} - i\sum_\kappa m^1_{\mu\nu,\kappa} p_\kappa - \frac12 \sum_{\kappa,\lambda} m_{\mu\nu,\kappa\lambda} p_\kappa p_\lambda + O(|p|^3)$. By $\Pi_{\mu\nu}(x) = \Pi_{\nu\mu}(-x)$, $m^1$ is antisymmetric and $m$ symmetric in $\mu,\nu$. We expand the second identity of (30.1) in powers of $p$, with $\partial_\nu(p) = ip_\nu - \frac12 p_\nu^2 + \dots$. The terms of the first order give $\sum_\nu p_\nu m^0_{\mu\nu} = 0$ for all $p$, hence $m^0 = 0$. The terms of the second order then give $\sum_{\nu,\kappa} m^1_{\mu\nu,\kappa} p_\nu p_\kappa = 0$, so that $m^1$ is antisymmetric in $\nu,\kappa$, hence in all three indices.

*The covariance.* Let $r \in \mathfrak{G}_0$, with $\pi$ and $s$ as above. The bond $r\langle x, x+e_\mu\rangle$ is $\langle rx - t_\mu, rx - t_\mu + e_{\pi(\mu)}\rangle$ with $t_\mu = 0$ if $s_\mu = 1$, and the reverse of this bond with $t_\mu = e_{\pi(\mu)}$ if $s_\mu = -1$. The covariance therefore reads $\Pi_{\pi(\mu)\pi(\nu)}(rx - t_\mu + t_\nu) = s_\mu s_\nu \Pi_{\mu\nu}(x)$. Multiplying by $(rx - t_\mu + t_\nu)_{\pi(\kappa)} = s_\kappa x_\kappa + \text{const}$ and summing over $x$, we find $m^1_{\pi(\mu)\pi(\nu),\pi(\kappa)} = s_\mu s_\nu s_\kappa m^1_{\mu\nu,\kappa}$, the constant being multiplied by $m^0 = 0$. For $r\colon z \mapsto -z$, where $s_2 = s_3 = -1$ and $\pi$ is the identity, this shows that $m^1_{\mu\nu,\kappa}$ vanishes if exactly one or all three of its indices lie in $\{2,3\}$, and for the element which changes the signs of $x_0$ and $x_1$ it shows the same for $\{0,1\}$. Three different indices contain one or three elements of one of the two sets, so that $m^1 = 0$. With $m^0 = m^1 = 0$ the same computation for the second moments gives

$$m_{\pi(\mu)\pi(\nu),\pi(\kappa)\pi(\lambda)} = s_\mu s_\nu s_\kappa s_\lambda \, m_{\mu\nu,\kappa\lambda} \;, \tag{30.4}$$

and the terms of the third order of the second identity of (30.1) give $\sum_{\nu,\kappa,\lambda} m_{\mu\nu,\kappa\lambda} p_\nu p_\kappa p_\lambda = 0$, that is,

$$m_{\mu\nu,\kappa\lambda} + m_{\mu\kappa,\nu\lambda} + m_{\mu\lambda,\nu\kappa} = 0 \tag{30.5}$$

for all indices.

*The tensors with these properties.* Let $m$ be a tensor which is symmetric in its first two and in its last two indices and satisfies (30.4) for the elements of $\mathfrak{G}_0$ and (30.5). We show that it is determined by the three numbers $m_{01,01}$, $m_{23,23}$, and $m_{02,02}$. By (30.4) for the reflections of $x_0$ and of $x_1$ and for $z \mapsto -z$, a component vanishes unless the index 0 and the index 1 occur an even number of times and the indices of $\{2,3\}$ together an even number of times. From (30.5) with $\nu = \kappa = \lambda$ we have $m_{\mu\nu,\nu\nu} = 0$, and with $\kappa = \lambda$,

$$m_{\mu\nu,\kappa\kappa} = -2\, m_{\mu\kappa,\nu\kappa} \;. \tag{30.6}$$

*All indices in* $\{0,1\}$. The components $m_{00,00}$ and $m_{11,11}$ vanish, and $m_{00,11} = m_{11,00} = -2m_{01,01}$ by (30.6). *Two indices equal to* $a \in \{0,1\}$ *and two indices* $j, j' \in \{2,3\}$. By (30.6), $m_{aa,jj} = m_{jj,aa} = -2m_{aj,aj}$. For $j \neq j'$, (30.6) gives $m_{jj',aa} = -2m_{ja,j'a}$, and since the left side is symmetric in $j, j'$, $m_{a2,a3} = m_{a3,a2}$; the element $z \mapsto iz$, for which $\pi$ exchanges 2 and 3 and $s_2 s_3 = -1$, gives $m_{a3,a2} = -m_{a2,a3}$ by (30.4). Hence $m_{a2,a3} = 0$ and $m_{23,aa} = 0$, and (30.5) with $(\mu,\nu,\kappa,\lambda) = (a,a,2,3)$ gives $m_{aa,23} = 0$. The same element gives $m_{a3,a3} = m_{a2,a2}$, and the exchange of $x_0$ and $x_1$ gives $m_{1j,1j} = m_{0j,0j}$. *All indices in* $\{2,3\}$. The components with three or four equal indices in the positions $\nu, \kappa, \lambda$ vanish: $m_{22,22} = m_{33,33} = m_{23,33} = m_{23,22} = 0$; (30.5) with $(\mu,\nu,\kappa,\lambda) = (2,2,2,3)$ gives $2m_{22,23} + m_{23,22} = 0$, hence $m_{22,23} = 0$, and likewise $m_{33,23} = 0$; and $m_{22,33} = m_{33,22} = -2m_{23,23}$ by (30.6). This proves the claim.

*The second order.* The functions $T^{\mathsf{a}}$ satisfy the hypotheses of the proposition: (30.1) holds for them because the right side of (30.2) vanishes if $B$ or $B'$ is the gradient of a function, and they are covariant under $\mathfrak{G}_0$ because an element of $\mathfrak{G}_0$ permutes the planes of each class and maps the curl at a plaquette to the curl at its image, up to a sign which occurs twice. The component $T^{\mathsf{a}}_{\kappa\lambda}(p)$ is $-\overline{\partial_\lambda(p)}\partial_\kappa(p) = -p_\kappa p_\lambda + O(|p|^3)$ if the plane $\{\kappa,\lambda\}$ belongs to $\mathsf{a}$ and 0 otherwise, so that the second moments of $T^{\mathsf{a}}$ are 1 at the component $(\kappa\lambda,\kappa\lambda)$ of the planes of $\mathsf{a}$ and 0 at those of the other planes. The second moments of $\Pi' := \Pi - \sum_{\mathsf{a}} \beta^{\mathsf{a}} T^{\mathsf{a}}$ form a tensor with the properties above whose three determining numbers vanish; hence they vanish, and so do the moments of the orders 0 and 1. That $\beta^{\mathsf{a}}$ does not depend on the plane of the mixed class was shown above.

*The remainder.* Let $z_\mu := e^{ip_\mu}$ and $f(z) := \sum_x \Pi'_{\mu\nu}(x) z^{-x}$ for fixed $\mu, \nu$, a function which is analytic for $e^{-\delta_1} < |z_\mu| < e^{\delta_1}$, because $\Pi'$ decays as $\Pi$ does, and which vanishes with its derivatives of the first and the second order at the point $z = (1,\dots,1)$. We split the sum over $x$ into the $2^4$ sums over the points with prescribed signs of the coordinates, $x_\mu \leq 0$ or

$x_\mu > 0$, as in [9, (5.22)]: $f(z) = \sum_\epsilon g^\epsilon(z^\epsilon)$ with $z^\epsilon = (z_\mu^{\epsilon_\mu})$ and functions $g^\epsilon$ which are power series converging for $|w_\mu| < e^{\delta_1}$. This domain is convex and contains the point $(1, \dots, 1)$, and Taylor's formula with the integral form of the remainder, as in [9, (5.30)], writes each $g^\epsilon(w)$ as a polynomial of the degree two in the numbers $w_\kappa - 1$ plus a sum of products of three of these numbers with analytic coefficients. Inserting $w = z^\epsilon$ we obtain $f(z) = P(z) + f_3(z)$, where $P$ is a polynomial of the degree two in the eight quantities $u_\kappa := z_\kappa - 1$ and $v_\kappa := z_\kappa^{-1} - 1$, and $f_3$ is a sum of products of three of them with coefficients analytic in the domain of $f$. Since $u_\kappa + v_\kappa + u_\kappa v_\kappa = 0$, we may replace $v_\kappa$ by $-u_\kappa - u_\kappa v_\kappa$ in $P$: a term of the first degree produces a term of the first degree in $u$ and the term $-u_\kappa v_\kappa$, to which we apply the replacement once more, and every term of the second degree produces a term of the second degree in $u$ and products of three or four of the quantities. Hence $P = P_0 + P_3$ with a polynomial $P_0$ of the degree at most two in the $u_\kappa$ alone and a sum $P_3$ of products of three of the quantities with polynomial coefficients. The functions $f$, $f_3$, and $P_3$ vanish with their derivatives up to the second order at $u = 0$, hence so does $P_0$, and a polynomial of the degree two with this property is zero. Thus $f = f_3 + P_3$, which is the stated form of $\Pi'$ with $u_\kappa = \partial_\kappa(p)$ and $v_\kappa = \overline{\partial_\kappa(p)}$ for real $p$. The bounds on the coefficients follow from Cauchy's estimates for the derivatives of the functions $g^\epsilon$, which are bounded by a constant times $E$ on every smaller polydisc.

*The symmetric case.* If $\Pi$ is covariant under all the isometries of $\mathbb{Z}^4$, then (30.4) for a permutation which maps the plane $\{0, 1\}$ to another plane shows that the three numbers are equal. *q.e.d.*

The proof shows more than the statement: the moments of $\Pi$ of the orders 0 and 1 vanish, and its second moments are those of $\sum_{\mathsf{a}} \beta^{\mathsf{a}} T^{\mathsf{a}}$. It also shows that the representation of the remainder needs no symmetry beyond the decay.

The vacuum polarisation is compared in [9] with the corresponding term of the action, whose kernel is that of the form $\langle B, \Delta_j B\rangle$, the minimum of $\|\partial A\|^2$ over the fields with the averages $B$, and of which Bałaban uses the expansion [9, (4.41)] at the momentum zero, read off from the formula [2, (1.66)]. In the tilted run this formula contains the matrix (7.9), and one may ask whether the expansion acquires three coefficients as well. It does not.

**Lemma 30.2** (The Second Order of the Action)**.** *Let $32\eta \le \frac{1}{2}$, and for $p' \in [-\pi, \pi]^4$ and $b \in \mathbb{C}^4$ let $\langle b, \Delta_k(p')b\rangle$ be the form of the action $\Delta_k$ of the tilted run on the whole lattice in the momentum representation, that is, the minimum of $\sum_l \langle a_l, \mathcal{D}(p' + l)a_l\rangle$ over the families of vectors $a_l \in \mathbb{C}^4$ with $\sum_l u_k(p' + l)V(p' + l)a_l = b$, where $l$ runs through the classes of (7.9), $\partial'_\nu(p) := \eta^{-1}(e^{i\eta p \cdot e'_\nu} - 1)$, and $\langle a, \mathcal{D}(p)a\rangle := \sum_{\kappa<\lambda} |\partial'_\kappa(p)a_\lambda - \partial'_\lambda(p)a_\kappa|^2$ is the symbol of $\|\partial A\|^2$. There is a number $C$, which does not depend on $k$ and $L$, such that*

$$|\langle b, \Delta_k(p')b\rangle - (|p'|^2|b|^2 - |p' \cdot b|^2)| \le C|p'|^3|b|^2 \,. \tag{30.7}$$

*Proof.* We write $O(t)$ for a quantity bounded by a number times $t$, the number not depending on $k$, $L$, $p'$, and the vectors. Three facts are used. First, $u_k(p') = 1 + O(|p'|)$ and $V(p') = R_0 + O(|p'|)$ with the orthogonal matrix $R_0 = (e_\mu \cdot e'_\nu)$, by (7.4), (7.5), and the proof of Lemma 7.2(iii), the functions $D$ being means of exponentials over points at a distance of at most 1 from the origin. Secondly, $\partial'_\nu(p') = i(p' \cdot e'_\nu)(1 + O(\eta|p'|))$, so that $\Delta(p') = |p'|^2(1 + O(\eta|p'|))$ and $\langle a, \mathcal{D}(p')a\rangle = |p'|^2|a|^2 - |p' \cdot \mathbf{a}|^2 + O(|p'|^3)|a|^2$ with the vector $\mathbf{a} := \sum_\nu a_\nu e'_\nu$, the sum of the squares of the components of an antisymmetric tensor being the same in every orthonormal basis; moreover, by Lagrange's identity, $\mathcal{D}(p) = \Delta(p)(1 - \mathsf{P}(p))$ with the orthogonal projection $\mathsf{P}(p)$ onto the vector $\partial'(p) = (\partial'_\nu(p))_\nu$.

Thirdly, $u_k(p)V(p)\partial'(p) = u_k(p)\partial^1(p)$ with $\partial^1_\mu(p) = e^{ip_\mu} - 1$, which is Lemma 6.4(i) applied to the function $e_p$, by Lemma 7.1(i) and (ii).

*The upper bound.* Let $a_0 := (u_k(p')V(p'))^{-1}b$ and $a_l := 0$ for $l \neq 0$; the inverse exists by Lemma 7.2(iii). By the first fact $\mathbf{a}_0 = b + O(|p'|)|b|$ as vectors of $\mathbb{C}^4$, and by the second $\langle a_0, \mathcal{D}(p')a_0\rangle = |p'|^2|b|^2 - |p'\cdot b|^2 + O(|p'|^3)|b|^2$.

*The lower bound.* Let $j \in \mathbb{C}^4$ be orthogonal to $\partial^1(p')$, and $c_l := \overline{u_k(p'+l)}\, V(p'+l)^* j$. By the third fact, and because $\partial^1$ has the periods $2\pi$, $c_l$ is orthogonal to $\partial'(p'+l)$. For an admissible family, $\langle j, b\rangle = \sum_l \langle c_l, a_l\rangle$, and since $c_l$ lies in the range of $1 - \mathsf{P}(p'+l)$, Schwarz's inequality for the form $\mathcal{D}(p'+l)$ gives $|\langle c_l, a_l\rangle|^2 \leq \Delta(p'+l)^{-1}|c_l|^2\langle a_l, \mathcal{D}(p'+l)a_l\rangle$. Hence

$$|\langle j, b\rangle|^2 \leq \langle j, \phi(p')j\rangle \sum_l \langle a_l, \mathcal{D}(p'+l)a_l\rangle \tag{30.8}$$

with the matrix $\phi$ of (7.9). In $\langle j, \phi(p')j\rangle$ the term $l = 0$ is $|u_k(p')|^2|V(p')^*j|^2/\Delta(p') = |p'|^{-2}|j|^2(1 + O(|p'|))$ by the first two facts. For the terms with $l \neq 0$ we use the proof of Lemma 7.3: $\Delta(p'+l) \geq 4$, $|V^*j| \leq \frac{8}{5}|j|$, and by (7.7) with $|\partial^1_\mu(p')| \leq |p'_\mu|$ the modulus of $u_k(p'+l)$ is at most $5\sqrt{2}\,\eta|p'|$ for the 24 classes which are not central and have $q = p'$, and at most $\prod_\mu \min(1, \pi|p'_\mu|/(2|p'_\mu + 2\pi n_\mu|))$ for the classes with $q = p' + 2\pi n$, $n \neq 0$, in which at least one factor is at most $|p'|/(2(2|n_\mu| - 1))$ and the others with $n_\mu \neq 0$ are at most $\frac{\pi}{2}(2|n_\mu| - 1)^{-1}$. The squares add up to $O(|p'|^2)$, as in that proof. Hence $\langle j, \phi(p')j\rangle \leq |p'|^{-2}|j|^2(1 + O(|p'|))$, and (30.8) gives, for every admissible family,

$$\sum_l \langle a_l, \mathcal{D}(p'+l)a_l\rangle \geq |p'|^2(1 - O(|p'|)) \sup_j \frac{|\langle j, b\rangle|^2}{|j|^2}\ , \tag{30.9}$$

the supremum over the vectors $j \neq 0$ orthogonal to $\partial^1(p') = ip'(1 + O(|p'|))$. This supremum is the squared norm of the projection of $b$ to the orthogonal complement of $\partial^1(p')$, which is $|b|^2 - |p'\cdot b|^2/|p'|^2 + O(|p'|)|b|^2$. *q.e.d.*

The symbol $|p'|^2|b|^2 - |p'\cdot b|^2$ is the second order of $\sum_{\mathsf{a}} T^{\mathsf{a}}$ with equal coefficients 1, so that [9, (4.41)] holds for the tilted run; the reason is that the action of the fine lattice is the sum over all the planes of an orthonormal basis, whichever basis it is, and that the averages map constant fields to constant fields.

We can now say what the two statements mean for [9]. In [9, (4.34)] the function $\Pi$ enters through three expressions: its quadratic form; its second moments, which multiply the terms of the third and the fourth order in the field [9, (4.43), (4.44)]; and its first moments, of which Bałaban says that the corresponding expression "should vanish" by the Euclidean symmetries [9, p. 290]. By Proposition 30.1 and its proof the first moments vanish under $\mathfrak{G}_0$ as well, the second moments are those of $\sum_{\mathsf{a}} \beta^{\mathsf{a}} T^{\mathsf{a}}$, and the quadratic form is the sum over the three classes of $\beta^{\mathsf{a}}$ times the sum of $(\partial\delta B)_{\kappa\lambda}(\partial B)_{\kappa\lambda}$ over the planes of the class, in the place of the first term of [9, (5.43)], plus terms with three derivatives, to which the bound [9, (5.44)] and the argument of [9, p. 298] apply as they stand. The term [9, (4.38)] of the effective action, $\beta_j(g_{j-1})$ times the action, contributes the same three expressions for the kernel of $\Delta_j$ [9, (4.39)–(4.45)], by Lemma 30.2 with one coefficient for all the planes, and since it enters [9, (1.6)] with the opposite sign, the definition of $\beta_j$ as the coefficient of [9, (5.43)] makes the two cancel [9, pp. 292, 298]. With three coefficients $\beta^{\mathsf{a}}_j$ the cancellation is complete for one class of planes. For the other two there remain the expressions of [9, (4.42), (4.44)], restricted to the planes of the class, with the differences of the coefficients; they are of the kind which Bałaban describes as those "for which the sum over $j$ has not a uniform

bound" [9, p. 292]. Since each coefficient is a second moment of $\Pi$, a bound on the difference of the vacuum polarisations of two runs, of which one has the symmetries of its lattice, would bound the differences of the three coefficients of the other.

*Averages which are covariant.* Proposition 30.1 assumes the covariance under $\mathfrak{G}_0$. In [9] the covariance of the effective actions under the symmetries of the lattice is obtained by a choice of the averages: the blocks are centred at the points of the coarse lattice, and the contours of a block are replaced by a family which the symmetries permute [9, (0.3), (0.4), pp. 252–253]. The averages of Definition 6.1 are those of the earlier papers and are not of this kind, since a block $y + [0, a)^4$ is not mapped to a block by a reflection. We record that the turned lattice admits the choice of [9]. Let $\mathfrak{G}$ be the group of the maps $x \mapsto rx + t$ with $r \in \mathfrak{G}_0$ and $t \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$, for a scale $a$; they map $T_\eta$ and $a\mathbb{Z}^4$ to themselves.

**Lemma 30.3** (Centred Blocks)**.** *Let $a$ be a scale for which $a/\eta$ is odd, and for $y \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$ let $B_a^\circ(y) \coloneqq \{x \in T_\eta \,|\, |x_\mu - y_\mu| < \frac{1}{2}a,\ \mu = 0, \dots, 3\}$.*

*(i) The sets $B_a^\circ(y)$, $y \in a\mathbb{Z}^4$, are disjoint, their union is $T_\eta$, and each has $(a/\eta)^4$ points.*

*(ii) An element $x \mapsto rx + t$ of $\mathfrak{G}$ maps $B_a^\circ(y)$ onto $B_a^\circ(ry + t)$; it maps the path from $y$ to $x$ which changes the coordinates in the basis $\eta e'_\nu$ in a given order of the directions to the path from $ry + t$ to $rx + t$ of the image order; and it maps the staircase $\sigma_\mu^a(x)$ to the staircase $\sigma_{\mu'}^a(rx + t)$ if $re_\mu = e_{\mu'}$, and to the reverse of the staircase $\sigma_{\mu'}^a(rx + t - ae_{\mu'})$ if $re_\mu = -e_{\mu'}$.*

*(iii) The averages $Q_a'^\circ$ and $Q_a^\circ$ defined by (6.2) and (6.3) with the blocks $B_a^\circ$ in the place of $B_a$ commute with the elements of $\mathfrak{G}$, acting on the functions by $\lambda \mapsto \lambda \circ g^{-1}$ and on the fields by $(gA)(gb) \coloneqq A(b)$, and they satisfy Lemma 6.4(i).*

*Proof.* (i) No point $x$ of $T_\eta$ has $|x_\mu - y_\mu| = \frac{1}{2}a$: for $\mu \in \{0, 1\}$ the difference is a multiple of $\eta$, and for $\mu \in \{2, 3\}$ a multiple of $\frac{1}{5}\eta$, by (6.1), while $a/(2\eta)$ and $5a/(2\eta)$ are not integers. Hence every point of $T_\eta$ lies in the open cube of the side $a$ around exactly one point of $a\mathbb{Z}^4$, so that each block contains one point of every class of $T_\eta$ modulo $a\mathbb{Z}^4$, and the number of the classes is the quotient $(a/\eta)^4$ of the volumes of the cells of the two lattices. (ii) An element of $\mathfrak{G}_0$ is a signed permutation of the coordinates $0, 1$ together with a rotation of the plane of the coordinates $2, 3$ by a multiple of a right angle (Lemma 5.1); it maps the cube $(-\frac{1}{2}a, \frac{1}{2}a)^4$ to itself, and since it preserves $\rho\mathbb{Z}^4$ it permutes the eight vectors $\pm e'_\nu$. This gives the statements on the blocks and on the paths. For the staircases it suffices to consider generators of $\mathfrak{G}_0$. For the signed permutations of the coordinates $0, 1$ the statement concerns straight paths. The rotation $z \mapsto iz$ maps $e_2$ to $e_3$ and $e_3$ to $-e_2$, and $e'_2$ to $-e'_3$ and $e'_3$ to $e'_2$; hence it maps the steps $e'_3, e'_2, e'_3, e'_2, e'_3, e'_2, e'_3$ of $\sigma_2^a$ to the steps $e'_2, -e'_3, e'_2, -e'_3, e'_2, -e'_3, e'_2$ of $\sigma_3^a$, and the steps of $\sigma_3^a$ to $-e'_3, -e'_2, -e'_3, -e'_2, -e'_3, -e'_2, -e'_3$, which are those of $\sigma_2^a$ run through backwards, the pattern of $\sigma_2^a$ being the same in both directions. (iii) follows from (ii), with $(Q_a^\circ A)(b^{-1}) = -(Q_a^\circ A)(b)$ for the case of a reversed bond, and the proof of Lemma 6.4(i) uses only that the translation by $ae_\mu$ maps the block of $y$ onto that of $y + ae_\mu$. *q.e.d.*

The lemma concerns the definitions only. The momentum representation, the cells, and the contours of Sections 7 to 9 are written for the blocks $B_a$, with explicit constants, and they have not been redone for the centred blocks; nor has the family of the paths for all the orders of the directions been put in the place of the path $\pi_y(x)$ in Section 22 and in the sections which use it.

A remark on the printed formulae: the second term of [9, (5.16), (5.37)] is printed as $\overline{\partial_\mu(p)}\partial_\nu(p)$, and [9, (5.36)] correspondingly. With the conventions [9, (5.11), (5.15)] and with [9, (5.43)] it is $\partial_\mu(p)\overline{\partial_\nu(p)}$, as above. The two expressions have the same terms of the second order at $p = 0$, so that [9, (5.42)] is not affected.

## 31 What Is Not Covered

The equality (1.1) is not proved. By Proposition 4.2 it is equivalent to a comparison of the construction of the paper on $\Lambda_K$, on the torus $\mathbb{T}_\Gamma$, with the tilted run. The seven papers of Bałaban on the propagators, the averaging operations, and the background fields, [2, 1, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7], have been gone through for the tilted run in Sections 10 to 29. We first say with what degree of detail, and then what has not been examined.

*Statements proved here in full.* The lemmata and propositions of Sections 6 to 23, of Section 25, and of Section 30; Lemma 24.2, Lemma 24.4, and Lemma 24.6; Lemma 26.1 and Proposition 26.2; Lemma 27.1; Lemma 28.1; and Lemma 29.1. None of them has had an independent review.

*Statements for which the changes are named and the proofs are not written out.* In Section 24 the bounds [3, (2.136)–(2.140), (2.149), (2.151)] are derived by the scheme of Section 20 with the inputs named there. In Section 26 this holds for Propositions 3 to 10 of [4]; in Section 27 for the perturbation in the background field and for the expansions over walks of [5, Sections B and C], and for the unit lattice propagator of the first step at the boundary of its domain; in Sections 28 and 29 for everything except the two lemmata named above. In each case the text names the inputs in which the lattice occurs and where they are proved, and the constants which change; a reader who wants a proof has to follow Bałaban's with these substitutions.

*Statements which are sketched in Bałaban's text.* Two of them are proved here: the properties of the operators with Dirichlet conditions [3, p. 228], at the background field 1 (Proposition 25.1), and the smallness of the difference of the gauge-fixing projections [3, (2.134)] (Lemma 24.2). Two are accepted as his: the construction of the configuration $V_0$ at the boundary between two regions [7, p. 279], and the bound [7, (189)] on the second derivative of the interaction, for which he gives no computation.

*In [1]:* the statements for an external field $A \neq 0$ and for a box with Neumann conditions, for which the proof by reflections is not available. They are not used in the theory without matter fields (Section 11).

*The papers on the renormalisation transformations.* Of [9, 11, 10, 12, 13, 8] we have read the first, and the other five have not been gone through. Four points of [9] concern the tilted run.

First, [9] replaces the averages of [4] by averages which are invariant under the symmetries of the lattice. The lattices consist of the centres of cubes, and the blocks are centred at the points of the coarse lattice, $L$ being odd [9, (0.1), (0.3)]; the contour $\Gamma_{y,x}$ is replaced by the family of the contours for all the orders of the directions, and the contour variable by a mean over this family [9, (0.4), (0.11), (0.12)]; and the axial gauge is fixed by exponential functions of these means in the place of conditions [9, (0.14)–(0.16)]. Bałaban states that the results of [4] hold for these averages, the proofs being "in most cases unchanged; in others only minor and obvious modifications are needed" [9, p. 254]. Sections 6 to 29 follow the earlier papers: the blocks are the sets $y + [0, a)^4$ of Definition 6.1, there is one path $\pi_y(x)$ and one staircase

for each point, and the axial gauge is a condition. For the tilted run Lemma 30.3 shows that the symmetric definitions exist: the centred blocks, the family of the paths for all the orders of the directions, and the staircases are mapped to themselves by the symmetries of the run, and the linear averages over the centred blocks are covariant. The statements of Sections 6 to 29 have not been transferred to these definitions; the transfer requires the momentum representation, the cells, and the contours for the centred blocks, with their constants, and the axial gauge with the family of paths.

Secondly, with the exponential gauge fixing the quadratic form of the fluctuation integral contains the gauge-fixing form of [9, (2.5)] in the place of the axial condition [9, (2.11), p. 267]. For the first step of the tilted run, and for a gauge-fixing form which consists of the squares of the sums of the field over the paths $\pi_y(x)$, the lower bound follows from the bound for the fields which are axial, Proposition 22.6(ii): the map $\mathfrak{a}_\Lambda$ changes a field $A$ by the gradient of a function whose norm is at most a constant times $\eta$ times the root of this form, and it preserves the curl and the averages, so that $\|A\|^2$ is at most a constant times $\eta^2\|\partial A\|^2$ plus a constant times $\eta^2$ times the form. For the means over the families of paths this belongs to the transfer just named.

Thirdly, the linearisation of the average in the fluctuation integral uses the operator $h$ supported on the bonds $b_0(c)$ of the fine lattice which lie on the bonds $c$ of the coarse lattice [9, p. 267]. On the turned lattice a bond $c$ of the directions $e_2$, $e_3$ contains no bond, and the right inverse of the average built from the fields $\mathsf{f}_c$ in the proof of Lemma 24.4 takes the place of $h$.

Fourthly, the invariance of the effective actions under the symmetries of the lattice, which [9, (2.17), (2.18), p. 269] derives from that of the averages and of the gauge fixing, is used for the vacuum polarisation; this is the subject of Section 30 and of the next item. The rest of [9] involves the fine lattice through the earlier papers only: its Section 3 expands the terms of the effective action in the fluctuation field with the functions $U_j(\square_0, \cdot)$ and $\mathbf{H}_j$ of [7], the averages, and the cubes of the coarse lattices [9, (3.3)–(3.54)], and its Section 4 derives from the gauge invariance the identities which reduce the terms of the third and the fourth order to the vacuum polarisation and its first and second moments [9, (4.9)–(4.34)]. We have read these two sections and have not written out their statements for the tilted run.

*The coupling.* Bałaban's inductive description of the effective actions assumes that the terms of the $j$-th step are invariant under the Euclidean transformations of the lattice $T^{(j+1)}$ [9, p. 263], and it uses this in [9, (1.21), (1.22)] and in Section 5 of that paper to define the coefficient $\beta_{j+1}$ by one pair $\mu \neq \nu$. In the tilted run the transformations which map every lattice of the run to itself are the translations of $T^{(j+1)}$ and the elements of $\mathfrak{G}_0$. By Proposition 30.1 the vacuum polarisation then has three coefficients, one for each class of planes, whereas the term $g_k^{-2}A(U_k(V))$ of the effective action has one, by Lemma 30.2. If the coupling is defined by one of the three, two quadratic terms of the dimension of the action remain in the effective action, with the differences of the three numbers as coefficients (Section 30). The three forms (5.2) are the sums of the squares of the field strength over the three classes of planes of the turned lattice as well, since $e_2' \wedge e_3' = -e_2 \wedge e_3$ and the rotation of the plane of $e_2$ and $e_3$ preserves the sum over the mixed pairs, so that an action on $T_\eta$ with three couplings would have the same symmetries; but the action of the tilted run is given, with one coupling, and all the papers above concern its minimisers. As a heuristic, one expects the differences of the three numbers at the step $j+1$ to decrease with $j$, because the step depends on the orientation of the fine lattice only through terms which are small in the ratio $L^{-j}$ of the two spacings, and a summable sequence of such terms would not require a renormalisation. We have neither a proof of such a bound nor an analysis of the induction of

[9] and of [10, Theorem 1, p. 262] with these terms, and the same applies to the choice of the bare coupling (Paper, Theorem 4.1). This is the first point at which the tilted run requires an estimate which is not a modification of one of Bałaban's. A possible route to it, which we have not pursued, is the comparison of two runs at their shared scales (Paper, Section 9.1), with the construction of the paper as the one run and the tilted run as the other. The run of the paper has the symmetries of its lattices, so that its three numbers agree at every step. If the bound on the difference of the localised terms of the two runs at a shared scale were part of the hypothesis of an induction over the scale, the differences of the three numbers of the tilted run at the next step would be bounded by it. In the paper the comparison is made after each run has been constructed by itself, with one coupling, and the induction would have to treat the two runs together.

*The paper.* Its construction on the torus $\mathbb{T}_\Gamma$, whose periods are not multiples of the vectors of the basis; the first step with a loop ensemble (Paper, Theorem 5.4) for the tilted run; and the comparison of two runs, in which the identities of Paper, Lemma 9.2, use of the passage between the two fine lattices only a linear map with a right inverse, while the bounds on the defect (Paper, Proposition 9.3), on the minimisers, and on the large-field terms are proved for two fine lattices of which one is the lattice of the cubes of the other. The normalisation of the tilted run is a product of its own step factors; since $\rho$ fixes a loop in the plane $\{z = 0\}$, the comparison for a single loop relates it to that of the paper whenever the limit for this loop is not zero.

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